

WOODS COMIC
POEMS



COMPLETE EDITION

ILLUSTRATED

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***** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK THE COMIC
POEMS OF THOMAS HOOD *****

[Contents.](#)
[List of Illustrations](#)

THE
COMIC POEMS
OF
THOMAS HOOD.



FAULTS ON BOTH SIDES.



WAR DANCE—THE OPENING OF THE BALL.

**THE COMIC POEMS
OF
THOMAS HOOD.**

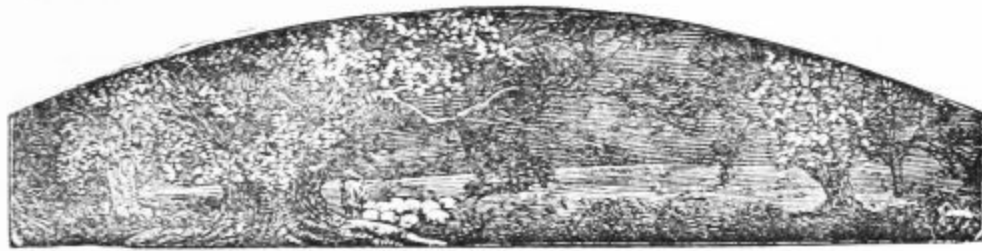
*WITH A PREFACE BY
THOMAS HOOD THE YOUNGER.*

A NEW AND COMPLETE EDITION.



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PREFACE.

IF the general public, acquainted only with the comic works of THOMAS HOOD, were taken by surprise when they found how he could handle serious and solemn themes; those who saw him in the flesh must have been equally astonished to learn how grave and melancholy a man the famous wit was to all appearance. The chronic ill health, which gave this expression to his countenance, was, however, powerless to affect the tone of his mind. "Here lies one who spat more blood and made more puns than any man living," was the epitaph he half-jestingly proposed for himself. The connection between the disease and the comic faculty is not so unreasonable as it appears at first. The invalid, who could supply mirth for millions while he himself was propped up with pillows on the bed of sickness, was not a jester whose sole stock in trade consisted in mere animal spirits—which are too often mistaken for wit, but have in common with other spirits a tendency to evaporate somewhat rapidly. HOOD's wit was the fruit of an even temperament, a cheery and contented mind endowed with a keen appreciation of the ludicrous. This acute perception of what is ludicrous is the foundation of all wit, but it may influence the mind in two ways. It may render its possessor as indifferent to the feelings as it makes him alive to the failings of others. How often does the wit, delighting in the flash and report of his jest, forget the wound it may inflict!

But, on the other hand, the shrewd appreciation of the weaknesses of others assists a kindly and well-balanced mind to avoid the infliction of pain; and the wit of THOMAS HOOD was of this nature. It was all the brighter because it was never stained by a tear wantonly caused. Even the

temptations of practical joking—and they have a strong influence on those who enjoy the comic side of things—never betrayed him into any freak that could give pain. He worked away industriously with wood, paint, and glue to send his friend FRANCK a new and killing bait for the early spring—a veritable *Poisson d’Avril*, constructed to come in half after a brief immersion, and reveal the inscription, “Oh, you April Fool!” He could gravely persuade his young wife, when she was first learning the mysteries of housekeeping, that she must never purchase plaice with red spots, for they were a proof that the fish were not fresh. But he was incapable of any of the cruel pleasantries for which THEODORE HOOK was famous: indeed, the only person he ever frightened, even, with a practical joke, was himself; when as a boy he traced with the smoke of a candle on the ceiling of a passage outside his bedroom a diabolical face, which was intended to startle his brother, but which so alarmed the artist himself, when he was going to bed forgetful of his own feat, that he ran down stairs—in a panic and in his night-dress—into the presence of his father’s guests assembled in the drawing-room. He used to enjoy so heartily and chuckle so merrily over his innocent practical jokes and hoaxes (he was never more delighted than when a friend of his was completely imposed on by a sham account of a survey of the Heavens through Lord ROSSE’s “monster telescope”) that the tenderness he showed for the feelings of others is more remarkable. The same forbearance characterises his writings. In spite of many and great provocations, he seldom, or never, wrote a bitter word, though that he could have been severe is amply indicated in his “Ode to RAE WILSON,” or still more in certain letters on “Copyright and Copywrong,” which he was spurred on by injustice and ill-usage to address to the *Athenæum*. He was a Shandean, who carried out in his life as well as his writings the principles which STERNE confined to the latter.

The first appearance of THOMAS HOOD as a comic writer was in the year 1826, when he published the First Series of “Whims and Oddities.” The critics in many instances took offence at his puns, as might have been expected, for his style was new and startling. His book was full of word-play, and it is easy to conceive—as he wrote in his address to the Second Edition—“how gentlemen with one idea were perplexed with a double meaning.” However, the public approved if the critics did not, and called for a second and soon after a third edition. Finally, after the publication of a second series, a fourth issue, containing the two series in one volume, was

demanded. “Come what may,” said HOOD, “this little book will now leave four imprints behind it—and a horse could do no more!”

He had by this time commenced the *Comic Annuals*, a series which he carried on for many years, and by which he established his fame as the first wit and humourist of his day. When this publication ceased he wrote first for *Colburn’s New Monthly*, of which he was appointed Editor on HOOK’s death; and subsequently, and up to the time of his death, in his own periodical, *Hood’s Magazine*.

Puns have been styled the lowest form of wit, and the critics have fallen foul of them from time immemorial until the present day. But a pun proper—and there should be a strict definition of a pun—is, it is humbly submitted, of so complicated a nature as to be anything but a low form of wit. A mere jingle of similar sounds, or a distortion of pronunciation does not constitute a pun—a double meaning is essential to its existence—a play of sense as well as of sound. That the latter was in HOOD’s opinion the more important feature of the two is to be inferred from his statement that “a pun is something like a cherry: though there may be a slight outward indication of partition—of duplicity of meaning, yet no gentleman need make two bites at it against his own pleasure.” In other words, the sense is complete without any reference to the second meaning. Tested by this rule, the majority of so-called puns, which have brought discredit on punning, would be immediately condemned, the only excuse for the form in which they are written being the endeavour to tack on a second meaning, or too often only an echo of sound without meaning.

Perhaps the best defence of punning is to be found in the following stanzas of “Miss Kilmansegg:”



HERE'S strength in double joints, no doubt,
In double X Ale, and Dublin Stout,
That the single sorts know nothing about—
And the fist is strongest when doubled—
And double aqua-fortis, of course,
And double soda-water, perforce,
Are the strongest that ever bubbled!

“There's double beauty whenever a Swan
Swims on a Lake, with her double thereon;
And ask the gardener, Luke or John,
Of the beauty of double-blowing—
A double dahlia delights the eye;
And it's far the loveliest sight in the sky
When a double rainbow is glowing!

“There's warmth in a pair of double soles;
As well as a double allowance of coals—
In a coat that is double-breasted—
In double windows and double doors;
And a double U wind is blest by scores
For its warmth to the tender-chested.

“There's a twofold sweetness in double pipes;
And a double barrel and double snipes
Give the sportsman a duplicate pleasure;
There's double safety in double locks;
And double letters bring cash for the box;
And all the world knows that double knocks
Are gentility's double measure.

“There's double sweetness in double rhymes,
And a double at Whist and a double Times
In profit are certainly double—
By doubling, the hare contrives to escape;
And all seamen delight in a doubled Cape,
And a double-reef'd topsail in trouble.

“There’s a double chuck at a double chin,
And of course there’s a double pleasure therein,
If the parties were brought to telling:
And however our Denises take offence,
A double meaning shows double sense;
And if proverbs tell truth,
A double tooth
Is Wisdom’s adopted dwelling!”

The reputation of THOMAS HOOD as a wit and humourist rests on his writings chiefly. His recorded sayings are few, for in general society he was shy and reserved, seldom making a joke, or doing it with so grave a face that the witticism seemed an accident, and was in many cases possibly allowed to pass unnoticed, for a great number of people do not recognise a joke that is not prefaced by a jingle of the cap and bells. When in the company of a few intimate friends, however, he was full of fun and good spirits. Unfortunately, on such occasions the good things were not “set in a note-book,” and so were for the most part lost; though at times an anecdote, well-authenticated, turns up to make us regret that more have not been preserved.

One such anecdote, which has not hitherto appeared in print, may not be out of place here. HOOD and “PETER PRIGGINS”—the Rev. Mr. HEWLETT—went on a visit to a friend of the latter’s, residing near Ramsgate. As they drove out of the town they passed a board on which was printed in large letters

BEWARE THE DOG.

A glance at the premises which the announcement was intended to guard showed that the quadruped was not forthcoming, whereupon HOOD jumped out of the gig, and, picking up a bit of chalk (plentiful enough in the neighbourhood), wrote under the warning—

WARE BE THE DOG?

These introductory remarks cannot be better wound-up than by a quotation from a preface to “HOOD’S Own,” in which is laid down the system of “Practical Cheerful Philosophy,” which is reflected in his writings, and which influenced his life. The reader will more thoroughly appreciate the comic writings of THOMAS HOOD after its perusal:

In the absence of a certain thin “blue and yellow” visage, and attenuated figure,—whose effigies may one day be affixed to the present work,—you will not be prepared to learn that some of the merriest effusions in the forthcoming numbers have been the relaxations of a gentleman literally enjoying bad health—the carnival, so to speak, of a personified Jour Maigre. The very fingers so aristocratically slender, that now hold the pen, hint plainly of the “*ills that flesh is heir to*.”—my coats have become great coats, my pantaloons are turned into trowsers, and, by a worse bargain than Peter Schemihl’s, I seem to have retained my shadow and sold my substance. In short, as happens to prematurely old port wine, I am of a bad colour with very little body. But what then? That emaciated hand still lends a hand to embody in words and sketches the creations or recreations of a Merry Fancy: those gaunt sides yet shake heartily as ever at the Grotesques and Arabesques and droll Picturesques that my good Genius (a Pantagrueian Familiar) charitably conjures up to divert me from more sombre realities. It was the whim of a late pleasant Comedian, to suppose a set of spiteful imps sitting up aloft, to aggravate all his petty mundane annoyances; whereas I prefer to believe in the ministry of kindlier Elves that “nod to me and do me courtesies.” Instead of scaring away these motes in the sunbeam, I earnestly invoke them, and bid them welcome; for the tricky spirits make friends with the animal spirits, and do not I, like a father romping with his own urchins,—do not I forget half my cares whilst partaking in their airy gambols? Such sports are as wholesome for the mind as the other frolics for the body. For on our own treatment of that excellent Friend or terrible Enemy the Imagination, it depends whether we are to be scared and haunted by a Scratching Fanny, or tended by an affectionate Invisible Girl—like an unknown Love, blessing us with “favours secret, sweet, and precious,” and fondly stealing us from this worky-day world to a sunny sphere of her own.

This is a novel version, Reader, of “Paradise and the Peri,” but it is as true as it is new. How else could I have converted a serious illness into a comic wellness—by what other agency could I have transported myself, as a Cockney would say, from *Dullage* to *Grinnage*? It was far from a practical joke to be laid up in ordinary in a foreign land, under the care of Physicians quite as much abroad as myself with the case; indeed, the shades of the gloaming were stealing over my prospect; but I resolved, that, like the sun, so long as my day lasted, I would look on the bright side of everything. The raven croaked, but I persuaded myself that it was the nightingale! there was the smell of the mould, but I remembered that it nourished the violets. However my body might cry craven, my mind luckily had no mind to give in. So, instead of mounting on the black long-tailed coach horse, she vaulted on her old Hobby that had capered in the Morris-Dance, and began to exhort from its back. To be sure, said she, matters look darkly enough; but the more need for the lights. Allons! Courage! Things may take a turn, as the pig said on the spit. Never throw down your cards, but play out the game. The more certain to lose, the wiser to get all the play you can for your money. Come—give us a song! chirp away like that best of cricket-players, the cricket himself. Be bowled out or caught out, but never throw down the bat. As to Health, it’s the weather of the body—it hails, it rains, it blows, it snows, at present, but it may clear up by-and-bye. You cannot eat, you say, and you must not drink; but laugh and make believe, like the Barber’s wise brother at the Barmecide’s feast. Then, as to thinness, not to flatter, you look like a lath that has had a split with the carpenter and a fall out with the plaster; but so much the better: remember how the smugglers trim the sails of the lugger to escape the notice of the cutter. Turn your edge to the old enemy, and mayhap he won’t see you! Come—be alive! You have no more right to slight your life than to neglect your wife—they are the two better halves that make a man of you! Is not life your means of living? So stick to thy business, and thy business will stick to thee. Of course, continued my mind, I am quite disinterested in this advice—for I am aware of my own immortality—but for that very reason, take care of the mortal body, poor body, and give it as long a day as you can.

Now, my mind seeming to treat the matter very pleasantly as well as profitably, I followed her counsel, and instead of calling out for relief according to the fable, I kept along on my journey, with my bundle of sticks,—i.e., my arms and legs. Between ourselves, it would have been “extremely inconvenient,” as I once heard the opium-eater declare, to pay the debt of nature at that particular

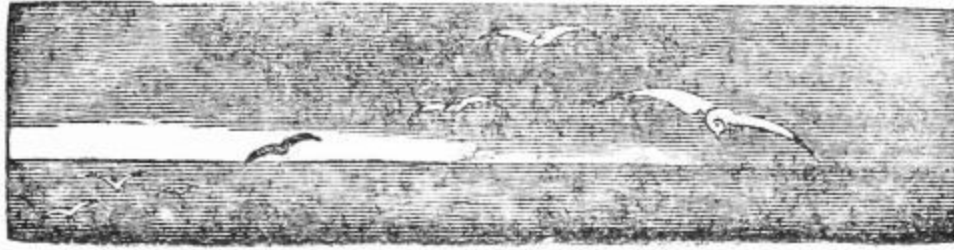
juncture; nor do I quite know, to be candid, when it would altogether suit me to settle it, so, like other persons in narrow circumstances, I laughed, and gossipped, and played the agreeable with all my might, and as such pleasant behaviour sometimes obtains a respite from a human creditor, who knows but that it may prove successful with the Universal Mortgagee? At all events, here I am, humming “Jack’s Alive!” and my own dear skilful native physician gives me hopes of a longer lease than appeared from the foreign reading of the covenants. He declares, indeed, that, anatomically, my heart is lower hung than usual—but what of that? *The more need to keep it up!*



EDITORIAL NOTE.

THIS new issue of HOOD'S Poems has been completely revised, and will be found not only larger in size, but far richer in contents, than any previous edition. This, with the companion volume of "Serious Poems," will be found to contain *the entire poetical works of Thomas Hood*. The volume has been, moreover, enriched by the addition of a large number of the highly humorous illustrations, in which Thomas Hood's comic power was displayed.

July, 1876.



CONTENTS.

	PAGE
Reply to a Pastoral Poet	1
A Tale of Temper	2
The Captain's Cow	5
The Doves and the Crows	9
A Tale of a Trumpet	10
An Open Question	32
The Turtles	37
Town and Country	41
No!	44
The Lost Heir	44
She is far from the Land	48
Anacreontic	50
The Forlorn Shepherd's Complaint	51
Huggins and Duggins	52
Pain in a Pleasure-Boat	55
Gog and Magog	58
The Sweep's Complaint	60
The Carelesse Nurse Mayd	63
Jarvis and Mrs. Cope	64
A Lay of Real Life	66
The Lark and the Rook	68
A Nocturnal Sketch	69
Domestic Asides	70

John Day	71
Number One	74
The Drowning Ducks	76
Dibdin Modernized	78
The Storm	79
I'm not a Single Man	80
The Ghost	84
The Double Knock	86
Our Village	87
Pair'd <i>not</i> Matched	89
The Boy at the Nore	91
The Supper Superstition	93
The Broken Dish	95
Literary and Literal	96
The Sub-Marine	100
The Lament of Toby	102
My Son and Heir	104
Clubs	107
The United Family	110
The Dead Robbery	115
A Parental Ode to my Son	120
A Serenade	121
An Incendiary Song	122
Copy	125
Skippping	126
A Butcher	128
A Public Dinner	129
A Charity Sermon	133
The China Mender	135
On a Picture of Hero and Leander	138
Miss Fanny's Farewell Flowers	138
The Stage-Struck Hero	140
Ye Tourists and Travellers	142
Rural Felicity	143

The Doctor	148
Laying down the Law	150
A Black Job	153
A Discovery in Astronomy	159
The Sausage Maker's Ghost	159
To Joseph Hume, Esq., M.P.	161
To Admiral Gambier, G.C.B.	164
To Spencer Perceval, Esq., M.P.	166
To Miss Kelly	167
To Doctor Hahnemann	168
To the Advocates for the Removal of Smithfield Market	172
To Mary	175
To Fanny	177
To Mr. Malthus	179
To St. Swithin	182
To a Lady on her Departure for India	185
Sir John Bowring	186
To Mr. M'Adam	187
<i>A Friendly Epistle to Mrs. Fry, in Newgate</i>	190
To Mr. Dymoke	194
To Joseph Grimaldi, Senior	196
To Sylvanus Urban, Esq.	200
To W. Kitchener, M.D.	202
To the Dean and Chapter of Westminster	207
On an Unfavourable Review	210
To Peace	211
For Ninth November	212
On the Celebration of Peace	216
To Mr. Izaak Walton	217
To Mary Housemaid	221
To a Bad Rider	222
To a Critic	222
The Sweets of Youth	223
To Henrietta	223

Hints to Paul Pry	224
On Steam	227
Allegory—A Moral Vehicle	228
A Somnambulist	228
To Vauxhall	229
To a Scotch Girl washing Linen	229
To a Decayed Seaman	230
To Lord Wharncliffe	230
Lieutenant Luff	231
Love has not eyes	232
A Happy New Year	233
Sea Song	236
Reflections on a New Year's Day	237
Written under the Fear of Bailiffs	238
A Few Lines on completing Forty-seven	238
A Bull	239
On the Death of the Giraffe	239
On the Removal of a Menagerie	239
Her Majesty's Visit to the City	240
On the Queen's Visit by a Cornhill Tradesman	240
On the Trafalgar Square Statues	240
On a Picture of Solomon Eagle	240
Heart Springs	240
Change of Ministry	241
A Pig in a Poke	241
On Reading a Diary	241
The Pursuit of Letters	241
A Reflection	241
Laying the Dust	242
On Lieutenant Eyre's Narrative of the Disasters at Cabul	242
Superiority of Machinery	242
Party Spirit	242
Lord B——	242
Traitors' Aims	243

On a Certain Locality	243
On the Art Unions	243
A Morning Thought	243
Wellington's Statue	244
On a Daguerreotype Portrait of a Lady	244
Suggestions by Steam	244
Punishment of Suicides	245
Athol Brose	245
On the Depreciated Money	245
On Mrs. Parkes's Pamphlet	245
An Explanation	246
On the New Half-farthings	246
The Surplice Question	246
The Epping Hunt	247
Jack Hall	261
Her Pedigree	269
Her Birth	271
Her Christening	276
Her Childhood	280
Her Education	281
Her Accident	285
Her Precious Leg	289
Her Fame	292
Her First Step	294
Her Fancy Ball	295
Her Dream	303
Her Courtship	307
Her Marriage	311
Her Honeymoon	318
Her Misery	325
Her Last Will	329
Her Death	330
Her Moral	334
John Trot	334

The Widow	337
“Don’t you smell Fire?”	341
The Wee Man	343
“The Last Man”	344
Backing the Favourite	351
The Ballad of “Sally Brown and Ben the Carpenter”	352
Love	355
As it fell upon a day	356
A Fairy Tale	356
The Fall of the Deer	360
Tim Turpin	361
The Monkey-Martyr	364
Craniology	368
A Sailor’s Apology for Bow-Legs	371
The Stag-eyed Lady	373
Faithless Nelly Gray	378
The Sea-Spell	380
The Demon-Ship	384
Mary’s Ghost	387
Ode to Mr. Brunel	389
Anacreontic	390
A Waterloo Ballad	391
Cockle v. Cackle	394
Playing at Soldiers	398
“Napoleon’s Midnight Review”	400
Ode to Dr. Kitchener	402
The Cigar	404
An Ancient Concert	405
A Report from Below	408
The Last Wish	410
The Devil’s Album	411
A Valentine	412
Conveyancing	412
The Angler’s Farewell	414

A Blow up	416
The Schoolmaster's Motto	420
The Kangaroos	422
I cannot bear a Gun	424
Trimmer's Exercise	427
An Address to the Steam Washing Company	428
The Blue Boar	435
A Flying Visit	442
A Row at the Oxford Arms	450
A Table of Errata	454
The Green Man	457
Ben Bluff	463
Sally Simpkin's Lament	465
I'm going to Bombay	467
John Jones	469
Pompey's Ghost	471
To Mr. Wrench at the English Opera House	475
Love, with a Witness	476
Lines by a School Boy	477
Address to Maria Darlington	477
Ode to R. W. Elliston, Esq.	480
Shooting Pains	482
The Duel	485
Dog-grel Verses	487
"Up the Rhine"	490
The Comet	491
More Hullah-Baloo	493
There's no Romance in that	499
The Painter Puzzled	502
A True Story	504
The Logicians	510
Little O'P.	513
The Assistant Draper's Petition	514
Symptoms of Ossification	516





LIST OF ILLUSTRATIONS.

Arthur's Seat.	A Total Eclipse of the Son.
Fancy Portrait—Mrs. Trimmer.	Palman qui Meruit Ferat.
Faults on Both Sides.	War Dance—The Opening of the Ball.
Son and Hair.	The Buoy at the Nore.
The Bottle Imp.	The Ides of March are come.
Overtaker and Undertaker.	The Bath Guide.
See View—Broad Stairs.	The Isle of Man.
A Public Dinner.	A Day's Sport on the Moors.
Death's Door.	Barrister on Circuit.
Fanny.	Finding a May'r's Nest.
Dog-Berry.	I wish you may get it.
The Judgment of Solomon.	The Box Seat.
Accustomed to the care of Children.	Does your Mother know you're out?
A Hard Roe.	To Ladies's Eyes a round, Boys.
A Child's Call to be disposed of.	Wether Wise.
The Duke of Well—— and Prince of Water——.	The Widow's Mite.
High and Low Born.	A Plaster Cast.
Violinist.	A Strange Bird.
Sea Consumption—waisting away.	Crane-iology.
Due at Michaelmas.	James's Powder.
A Minor Cannon.	Joining in a Catch.
The Top of his Profession.	Single Blessedness.
Love and a Cottage.	Long Commons and Short
The Judges of A-size.	

Commons.
The Last Cut.



HOOD'S POETICAL WORKS.

COMIC.

REPLY TO A PASTORAL POET.



TELL us not of bygone days!
Tell us not of forward times!

What's the future—what's the past—

Save to fashion rhymes?

Show us that the corn doth thrive!

Show us there's no wintry weather!

Show us we may laugh and live—

(Those who love—together.)

Senses have we for sweet blossoms—

Eyes, which could admire the sun—

Passions blazing in our bosoms—

Hearts, that may be won!

But Labour doth for ever press us,

And Famine grins upon our board;

And none will help us, none will bless us,

With one gentle word!

None, none! our birthright or our fate,

Is hunger and inclement air—

Perpetual toil—the rich man's hate—

Want, scorn—the pauper's fare:

We fain would gaze upon the sky,

Lie pensive by the running springs;

But if we stay to gaze or sigh,

We starve—though the cuckoo sings!

The moon casts cold on us below;

The sun is not our own;

The very winds which fragrance blow,

But blanch us to the bone;

The rose for us ne'er shows its bloom,

The violet its blue eye;

From cradle murmuring to the tomb,

We feel no beauty, no perfume,

But only toil—and die!

PAUPER.

A TALE OF TEMPER.



O'F all cross breeds of human sinners,
The crabbedest are those who dress our dinners;
Whether the ardent fires at which they roast
And broil and bake themselves like Smithfield martyrs,
Are apt to make them crusty, like a toast,
Or drams, encouraged by so hot a post;
However, cooks are generally Tartars;
And altogether might be safely cluster'd
In scientific catalogues
Under two names, like Dinmont's dogs,
Pepper and Mustard.

The case thus being very common,
It followed, quite of course, when Mr. Jervis
Engaged a clever culinary woman,
He took a mere Xantippe in his service—
In fact—her metal not to burnish,
As vile a shrew as Shrewsbury could furnish—
One who in temper, language, manners, looks,
In every respect
Might just have come direct
From him, who is supposed to send us cooks.

The very day she came into her place
She slapp'd the scullion's face;
The next, the housemaid being rather pert,
Snatching the broom, she "treated her like dirt"—
The third, a quarrel with the groom she hit on—
Cyrus, the page, had half-a-dozen knocks;
And John, the coachman, got a box
He couldn't sit on.

Meanwhile, her strength to rally,
Brandy, and rum, and shrub she drank by stealth,
Besides the Cream of some mysterious Valley
That may, or may not, be the Vale of Health:
At least while credit lasted, or her wealth—

For finding that her blows came only thicker,
Invectives and foul names but flew the quicker,
The more she drank, the more inclined to bicker,
 The other servants one and all,
 Took Bible oaths whatever might befall,
Neither to lend her cash, nor fetch her liquor!

 This caused, of course, a dreadful schism,
And what was worse, in spite of all endeavour,
 After a fortnight of Tea-totalism,
The Plague broke out more virulent than ever!
The life she led her fellows down the stairs!
The life she led her betters in the parlour!
No parrot ever gave herself such airs,
No pug-dog cynical was such a snarler!
At woman, man, and child, she flew and snapp'd,
No rattlesnake on earth so fierce and rancorous—
 No household cat that ever lapp'd
 To swear and spit was half so apt—
No bear, sore-headed, could be more cantankerous—
No fretful porcupine more sharp and crabbed—
 No wolverine
 More full of spleen—
In short, the woman was completely rabid!

 The least offence of look or phrase,
The slightest verbal joke, the merest frolic,
Like a snap-dragon set her in a blaze,
 Her spirit was so alcoholic!
 And woe to him who felt her tongue!
It burnt like caustic—like a nettle stung,
Her speech was scalding—scorching—vitriolic!
 And larded, not with bacon fat,
 Or anything so mild as that,
But curses so intensely diabolic,
So broiling hot, that he, at whom she levell'd,
Felt in his very gizzard he was devill'd!

Often and often Mr. Jervis
Long'd, and yet feared, to turn her from his service;
For why? Of all his philosophic loads
Of reptiles loathsome, spiteful, and pernicious,
Stuff'd Lizards, bottled Snakes, and pickled Toads,
Potted Tarantulas, and Asps malicious,
And Scorpions cured by scientific modes,
He had not any creature half so vicious!

At last one morning
The coachman had already given warning,
And little Cyrus
Was gravely thinking of a new cockade,
For open War's rough sanguinary trade,
Or any other service, quite desirous,
Instead of quarrelling with such a jade—
When accident explain'd the coil she made,
And whence her Temper had derived the virus!

Struck with the fever, called the scarlet,
The Termagant was lying sick in bed—
And little Cyrus, that precocious varlet,
Was just declaring her “as good as dead,”
When down the attic stairs the housemaid, Charlotte,
Came running from the chamber overhead,
Like one demented;
Flapping her hands, and casting up her eyes,
And giving gasps of horror and surprise,
Which thus she vented—
“O Lord! I wonder that she didn't bite us!
Or sting us like a Tantalizer,^[1]
(The note will make the reader wiser,)
And set us all a dancing like St. Witus!

“Temper! No wonder that the creature had
A temper so uncommon bad!
She's just confessed to Doctor Griper
That being out of Rum, and like denials,

Which always was prodigious trials,—
Because she couldn't pay the piper,
She went one day, she did, to Master's wials,
And drunk the spirit as preserved the Wiper!”

THE CAPTAIN'S COW.

A ROMANCE OF THE IRON AGE.

“Water, water everywhere,
But not a drop to drink.”—COLERIDGE.



T is a jolly Mariner
As ever knew the billows' stir,
Or battled with the gale;
His face is brown, his hair is black,
And down his broad gigantic back
There hangs a platted tail.

In clusters, as he rolls along,
His tarry mates around him throng,
Who know his budget well;
Betwixt Canton and Trinidad
No Sea-Romancer ever had
Such wondrous tales to tell!

Against the mast he leans a-slope,
And thence upon a coil of rope
Slides down his pitchy "starn;"
Heaves up a lusty hem or two,
And then at once without ado
Begins to spin his yarn:—

"As from Jamaica we did come,
Laden with sugar, fruit and rum,
It blew a heavy gale:
A storm that scar'd the oldest men
For three long days and nights, and then
The wind began to fail.

"Still less and less, till on the mast
The sails began to flap at last,
The breezes blew so soft;
Just only now and then a puff,
Till soon there was not wind enough
To stir the vane aloft.

"No, not a cat's paw anywhere:
Hold up your finger in the air

You couldn't feel a breath
For why, in yonder storm that burst,
The wind that blew so hard at first
Had blown itself to death.

"No cloud aloft to throw a shade;
No distant breezy ripple made
The ocean dark below.
No cheering sign of any kind;
The more we whistled for the wind
The more it did not blow.

"The hands were idle, one and all;
No sail to reef against a squall;
No wheel, no steering now!
Nothing to do for man or mate,
But chew their cud and ruminate,
Just like the Captain's Cow.

"Day after day, day after day,
Becalm'd the Jolly Planter lay,
As if she had been moor'd:
The sea below, the sky a-top
Fierce blazing down, and not a drop
Of water left aboard!

"Day after day, day after day,
Becalm'd the Jolly Planter lay,
As still as any log;
The Parching seamen stood about,
Each with his tongue a-lolling out,
And panting like a dog—

"A dog half mad with summer heat
And running up and down the street,
By thirst quite overcome;
And not a drop in all the ship
To moisten cracking tongue and lip,
Except Jamaica rum!

EXCEPT JAMAICA RUN:

“The very poultry in the coop
Began to pine away and droop—
 The cock was first to go;
And glad we were on all our parts,
He used to damp our very hearts
 With such a ropy crow.

“But worst it was, we did allow,
To look upon the Captain’s Cow,
 That daily seemed to shrink:
Deprived of water hard or soft,
For, though we tried her oft and oft,
 The brine she wouldn’t drink:

“But only turn’d her bloodshot eye,
And muzzle up towards the sky,
 And gave a moan of pain,
A sort of hollow moan and sad,
As if some brutish thought she had
 To pray to heav’n for rain;

“And sometimes with a steadfast stare
Kept looking at the empty air,
 As if she saw beyond,
Some meadow in her native land,
Where formerly she used to stand
 A-cooling in the pond.

“If I had only had a drink
Of water then, I almost think
 She would have had the half:
But as for John the Carpenter,
He couldn’t more have pitied her
 If he had been her calf.

“So soft of heart he was and kind
To any creature lame, or blind,

Unfortunate, or dumb:
Whereby he made a sort of vow,
In sympathising with the Cow,
To give her half his rum;—

“An oath from which he never swerved,
For surely as the rum was serv’d
He shared the cheering dram;
And kindly gave one half at least,
Or more, to the complaining beast,
Who took it like a lamb.

“At last with overclouding skies
A breeze again began to rise,
That stiffen’d to a gale:
Steady, steady, and strong it blew;
And were not we a joyous crew,
As on the Jolly Planter flew
Beneath a press of sail!

“Swiftly the Jolly Planter flew,
And were not we a joyous crew,
At last to sight the land!
A glee there was on every brow,
That like a Christian soul the Cow
Appear’d to understand.

“And was not she a mad-like thing
To land again and taste the spring,
Instead of fiery glass:
About the verdant meads to scour,
And snuff the honey’d cowslip flower,
And crop the juicy grass!

“Whereby she grew as plump and hale
As any beast that wears a tail,
Her skin as sleek as silk;
And through all parts of England now

Is grown a very famous Cow,
By giving Rum-and-Milk!”

THE DOVES AND THE CROWS.



OME all ye sable little girls and boys,
Ye coal-black Brothers—Sooty Sisters,
come!

With kitty-katties make a joyful noise;
With snaky-snekies, and the Eboe drum!
From this day forth your freedom is your own:
Play, Sambo, play,—and, Obadiah, groan!

Ye vocal Blackbirds, bring your native pipes,
Your own *Moor's* Melodies, ye niggers, bring;
To celebrate the fall of chains and stripes,
Sing “Possum up a gum-tree,”—roar and sing!
From this day forth your freedom is your own:
Chaunt, Sambo, chaunt,—and, Obadiah, groan!

Bring all your woolly pickaninnies dear—
Bring John Canoe and all his jolly gang:
Stretch ev’ry blubber-mouth from ear to ear,
And let the driver in his whip go hang!
From this day forth your freedom is your own:
Grin, Sambo, grin,—and, Obadiah, groan!

Your working garb indignantly renounce;
Discard your slops in honour of the day—
Come all in frill, and furbelow, and flounce,
Come all as fine as Chimney Sweeps in May—
From this day forth your freedom is your own:
Dress, Sambo, dress,—and, Obadiah, groan!

Come, join together in the dewy dance,
With melting maids in steamy mazes go;
Humanity delights to see you prance,
Up with your sooty legs and jump Jim Crow—
From this day forth your freedom is your own:
Skip, Sambo, skip,—and, Obadiah, groan!

Kiss dark Diana on her pouting lips,

And take black Phœbe by her ample waist—
Tell them to-day is Slavery's eclipse,

And Love and Liberty must be embraced—
From this day forth your freedom is your own:
Kiss, Sambo, kiss,—and, Obadiah, groan!

With bowls of sangaree and toddy come!

Bring lemons, sugar, old Madeira, limes,
Whole tanks and water-barrels full of rum,
To toast the whitest date of modern times—
From this day forth your freedom is your own:
Drink, Sambo, drink,—and, Obadiah, groan!

Talk, all together, talk! both old and young,

Pour out the fulness of the negro heart;
Let loose the now emancipated tongue,
And all your new-born sentiments impart—
From this day forth your freedom is your own:
Spout, Sambo, spout,—and, Obadiah, groan!

Huzza! for equal rights and equal laws;

The British parliament has doff'd your chain—
Join, join in gratitude your jetty paws,
And swear you never will be slaves again—
From this day forth your freedom is your own:
Swear, Sambo, swear,—and, Obadiah, groan!

A TALE OF A TRUMPET.

“Old woman, old woman, will you go a-shearing?
Speak a little louder, for I’m very hard of hearing.”
Old Ballad.



O'F all old women hard of hearing,
The deafest, sure, was Dame Eleanor Spearing!
On her head, it is true,
Two flaps there grew,
That served for a pair of gold rings to go through,
But for any purpose of ears in a parley,
They heard no more than ears of barley.

No hint was needed from D. E. F.
You saw in her face that the woman was deaf:
From her twisted mouth to her eyes so peery,
Each queer feature ask'd a query;
A look that said in a silent way,
"Who? and What? and How? and Eh?
I'd give my ears to know what you say!"

And well she might! for each auricular
Was deaf as a post—and that post in particular
That stands at the corner of Dyott Street now,
And never hears a word of a row!
Ears that might serve her now and then
As extempore racks for an idle pen;
Or to hang with hoops from jewellers' shops
With coral, ruby, or garnet drops;
Or, provided the owner so inclined,
Ears to stick a blister behind;
But as for hearing wisdom, or wit,
Falsehood, or folly, or tell-tale-tit,
Or politics, whether of Fox or Pitt,
Sermon, lecture, or musical bit,
Harp, piano, fiddle, or kit,
They might as well, for any such wish,
Have been butter'd, done brown, and laid in a dish!

She was deaf as a post,—as said before—
And as deaf as twenty similes more,
Including the adder, that deafest of snakes,

Which never hears the coil it makes.

She was deaf as a house—which modern tricks
Of language would call as deaf as bricks—

For her all human kind were dumb,
Her drum, indeed, was so muffled a drum,
That none could get a sound to come,
Unless the Devil who had Two Sticks!

She was deaf as a stone—say, one of the stones
Demosthenes suck'd to improve his tones;
And surely deafness no further could reach
Than to be in his mouth without hearing his speech!

She was deaf as a nut—for nuts, no doubt,
Are deaf to the grub that's hollowing out—
As deaf, alas! as the dead and forgotten—
(Gray has noticed the waste of breath,
In addressing the “dull, cold ear of death”),
Or the Felon's ear that was stuff'd with Cotton—
Or Charles the First *in statue quo*;
Or the still-born figures of Madame Tussaud,
With their eyes of glass, and their hair of flax,
That only stare whatever you “ax,”
For their ears, you know, are nothing but wax.

She was deaf as the ducks that swam in the pond,
And wouldn't listen to Mrs. Bond,—
As deaf as any Frenchman appears,
When he puts his shoulders into his ears:
And—whatever the citizen tells his son—
As deaf as Gog and Magog at one!
Or, still to be a simile-seeker,
As deaf as dogs'-ears to Enfield's Speaker!
She was deaf as any tradesman's dummy,
Or as Pharaoh's mother's mother's mummy;
Whose organs, for fear of our modern sceptics,
Were plugg'd with gums and antiseptics.

She was deaf as a nail—that you cannot hammer
A meaning into, for all your clamour—
There never *was* such a deaf old Gammer!

So formed to worry
Both Lindley and Murray,
By having no ear for Music or Grammar!

Deaf to sounds, as a ship out of soundings,
Deaf to verbs, and all their compoundings,
Adjective, noun, and adverb, and particle,
Deaf to even the definite article—
No verbal message was worth a pin,
Though you hired an earwig to carry it in!

In short, she was twice as deaf as Deaf Burke,
Or all the Deafness in Yearsley's work,
Who in spite of his skill in hardness of hearing,
Boring, blasting, and pioneering,
To give the dummy organ and clearing,
Could never have cured Dame Eleanor Spearing.

Of course the loss was a great privation,
For one of her sex—whatever her station—
And none the less that the Dame had a turn
For making all families one concern,
And learning whatever there was to learn
In the prattling, tattling village of Tringham—
As who wore silk? and who wore gingham?
And what the Atkins's shop might bring 'em?
How the Smiths contrived to live? and whether
The fourteen Murphys all pigg'd together?
The wages per week of the Weavers and Skinners,
And what they boil'd for their Sunday dinners?
What plates the Bugsbys had on the shelf,
Crockery, china, wooden, or delf?
And if the parlour of Mrs. O'Grady
Had a wicked French print, or Death and the Lady?

Did Snip and his wife continue to jangle?
Had Mrs. Wilkinson sold her mangle?
What liquor was drunk by Jones and Brown?
And the weekly score they ran up at the Crown?
If the Cobbler could read, and believed in the Pope?
And how the Grubbs were off for soap?
If the Snobbs had furnish'd their room up-stairs,
And how they managed for tables and chairs,
Beds, and other household affairs,
Iron, wooden, and Staffordshire wares?

And if they could muster a whole pair of bellows?
In fact, she had much of the spirit that lies
Perdu in a notable set of Paul Prys,

By courtesy call'd Statistical Fellows—
A prying, spying, inquisitive clan,
Who have gone upon much of the self-same plan,
Jotting the Labouring Class's riches;
And after poking in pot and pan,
And routing garments in want of stitches,
Have ascertain'd that a working man
Wears a pair and a quarter of average breeches!

But this alas! from her loss of hearing,
Was all a seal'd book to Dame Eleanor Spearing;
And often her tears would rise to their founts—
Supposing a little scandal at play
'Twixt Mrs. O'Fie and Mrs. Au Fait—
That she couldn't audit the Gossips' accounts.
'Tis true, to her cottage still they came,
And ate her muffins just the same,
And drank the tea of the widow'd Dame,
And never swallow'd a thimble the less
Of something the Reader is left to guess,
For all the deafness of Mrs. S.,

Who saw them talk, and chuckle, and cough,
But to see and not share in the social flow,
She might as well have lived, you know,
In one of the houses in Owen's Row,

Near the New River Head, with its water cut off!

And yet the almond-oil she had tried,
And fifty infallible things beside,
Hot, and cold, and thick, and thin,
Dabb'd, and dribbled, and squirted in:
But all remedies fail'd; and though some it was clear
 Like the brandy and salt
 (We now exalt)
Had made a noise in the public ear,
She was just as deaf as ever, poor dear!

At last—one very fine day in June—
 Suppose her sitting,
 Busily knitting,
And humming she didn't quite know what tune;
 For nothing she heard but a sort of a whizz,
Which, unless the sound of the circulation,
Or of thoughts in the process of fabrication,
By a Spinning-Jennyish operation,
 It's hard to say what buzzing it is.
However, except that ghost of a sound,
She sat in a silence most profound—
The cat was purring about the mat,
But her Mistress heard no more of that
Than if it had been a boatswain's cat;
And as for the clock the moments nicking,
The Dame only gave it credit for ticking.
The bark of her dog she did not catch;
Nor yet the click of the lifted latch;
Nor yet the creak of the opening door;
Nor yet the fall of a foot on the floor—
But she saw the shadow that crept on her gown
And turn'd its skirt of a darker brown.

And lo! a man! a Pedlar! ay, marry,
With the little back-shop that such tradesmen carry
Stock'd with brooches, ribbons, and rings,

Spectacles, razors, and other odd things,
For lad and lass, as Autolycus sings;
A chapman for goodness and cheapness of ware,
Held a fair dealer enough at a fair,
But deem'd a piratical sort of invader
By him we dub the "regular trader,"
Who—luring the passengers in as they pass
By lamps, gay panels, and mouldings of brass,
And windows with only one huge pane of glass,
And his name in gilt characters, German or Roman,—
If he isn't a Pedlar, at least he's a Showman!

However, in the stranger came,
And, the moment he met the eyes of the Dame,
Threw her as knowing a nod as though
He had known her fifty long years ago;
And presto! before she could utter "Jack"—
Much less "Robinson"—open'd his pack—
And then from amongst his portable gear,
With even more than a Pedlar's tact,—
(Slick himself might have envied the act)—
Before she had time to be deaf, in fact—
Popp'd a Trumpet into her ear.

"There, Ma'am! try it!
You needn't buy it—

The last New Patent—and nothing comes nigh it
For affording the Deaf, at a little expense,
The sense of hearing, and hearing of sense!
A Real Blessing—and no mistake,
Invented for poor Humanity's sake;
For what can be a greater privation
Than playing Dummy to all creation,
And only looking at conversation—
Great Philosophers talking like Platos,
And Members of Parliament moral as Catos,
And your ears as dull as waxy potatoes!

Not to name the mischievous quizzers,
 Sharp as knives, but double as scissors,
 Who get you to answer quite by guess
 Yes for No, and No for Yes.”
 (“That’s very true,” says Dame Eleanor S.)
 “Try it again! No harm in trying—
 I’m sure you’ll find it worth your buying,
 A little practice—that is all—
 And you’ll hear a whisper, however small,
 Through an Act of Parliament party-wall,—
 Every syllable clear as day,
 And even what people are going to say—
 I wouldn’t tell a lie, I wouldn’t,
 But my Trumpets have heard what Solomon’s couldn’t;
 And as for Scott he promises fine,
 But can he warrant his horns like mine
 Never to hear what a Lady shouldn’t—
 Only a guinea—and can’t take less.”
 (“That’s very dear,” says Dame Eleanor S.)

 “Dear!—Oh dear, to call it dear!
 Why it isn’t a horn you buy, but an ear;
 Only think, and you’ll find on reflection
 You’re bargaining, Ma’am, for the Voice of Affection;
 For the language of Wisdom, and Virtue, and Truth,
 And the sweet little innocent prattle of youth:
 Not to mention the striking of clocks—
 Cackle of hens—crowing of cocks—
 Lowing of cow, and bull, and ox—
 Bleating of pretty pastoral flocks—
 Murmur of waterfall over the rocks—
 Every sound that Echo mocks—
 Vocals, fiddles, and musical-box—
 And zounds! to call such a concert dear!
 But I mustn’t ‘swear with my horn in your ear.’
 Why in buying that Trumpet you buy all those
 That Harper, or any trumpeter, blows
 At the Queen’s Levees or the Lord Mayor’s Shows

At the Queen's Levees or the Lord Mayor's Shows,
At least as far as the music goes,
Including the wonderful lively sound,
Of the Guards' key-bugles all the year round:
Come—suppose we call it a pound!

“Come,” said the talkative Man of the Pack,
“Before I put my box on my back,
For this elegant, useful Conductor of Sound,
Come—suppose we call it a pound!
Only a pound! it's only the price
Of hearing a Concert once or twice,
It's only the fee
You might give Mr. C.
And after all not hear his advice,
But common prudence would bid you stump it;
For, not to enlarge,
It's the regular charge
At a Fancy Fair for a penny trumpet.
Lord! what's a pound to the blessing of hearing!
 (“A pound's a pound,” said Dame Eleanor Spearing.)

“Try it again! no harm in trying!
A pound's a pound there's no denying;
But think what thousands and thousands of pounds
We pay for nothing but hearing sounds:
Sounds of Equity, Justice, and Law,
Parliamentary jabber and jaw,
Pious cant and moral saw,
Hocus-pocus, and Nong-tong-paw,
And empty sounds not worth a straw;
Why it costs a guinea, as I'm a sinner,
To hear the sounds at a Public Dinner!
One pound one thrown into the puddle,
To listen to Fiddle, Faddle, and Fuddle!
Not to forget the sounds we buy
From those who sell their sounds so high,
That, unless the Managers pitch it strong,
The great Singers would be no more

to get a signora to wardie a song,
You must fork out the blunt with a haymaker's prong!

"It's not the thing for me—I know it,
To crack my own Trumpet up and blow it;
But it is the best, and time will show it.

There was Mrs. F.

So very deaf,

That she might have worn a percussion-cap,
And been knock'd on the head without hearing it snap,
Well, I sold her a horn, and the very next day
She heard from her husband at Botany Bay!
Come—eighteen shillings—that's very low,
You'll save the money as shillings go,
And I never knew so bad a lot,
By hearing whether they ring or not!

"Eighteen shillings! it's worth the price,
Supposing you're delicate-minded and nice,
To have the medical man of your choice,
Instead of the one with the strongest voice—
Who comes and asks you, how's your liver,
And where you ache, and whether you shiver,
And as to your nerves, so apt to quiver,
As if he was hailing a boat on the river!
And then, with a shout, like Pat in a riot,
Tells you to keep yourself perfectly quiet!

"Or a tradesman comes—as tradesmen will—
Short and crusty about his bill,

Of patience, indeed, a perfect scorner,
And because you're deaf and unable to pay,
Shouts whatever he has to say,
In a vulgar voice, that goes over the way,

Down the street and round the corner!
Come—speak your mind—it's 'No or Yes.' ”
("I've half a mind," said Dame Eleanor S.)

"Try it again — no harm in trying

try it again—no harm in trying,
Of course you hear me, as easy as lying;
No pain at all, like a surgical trick,
To make you squall, and struggle, and kick,
 Like Juno, or Rose,
 Whose ear undergoes
Such horrid tugs at membrane and gristle,
For being as deaf as yourself to a whistle!

“You may go to surgical chaps if you choose,
Who will blow up your tubes like copper flues,
Or cut your tonsils right away,
As you’d shell out your almonds for Christmas-day;
And after all a matter of doubt,
Whether you ever would hear the shout
Of the little blackguards that bawl about,
‘There you go with your tonsils out!’

 Why I knew a deaf Welshman, who came from Glamorgan
On purpose to try a surgical spell,
And paid a guinea, and might as well

 Have call’d a monkey into his organ!
For the Aurist only took a mug,
And pour’d in his ear some acoustical drug,
That, instead of curing, deafen’d him rather,
As Hamlet’s uncle served Hamlet’s father!
That’s the way with your surgical gentry!

 And happy your luck
 If you don’t get stuck
Through your liver and lights at a royal entry,
Because you never answer’d the sentry!

“Try it again, dear Madam, try it!
Many would sell their beds to buy it.
I warrant you often wake up in the night,
Ready to shake to a jelly with fright,
And up you must get to strike a light,
And down you go, in you know what,
Whether the weather is chilly or hot,—

That's the way a cold is got,—
To see if you heard a noise or not!

“Why, bless you, a woman with organs like yours
Is hardly safe to step out of doors!
Just fancy a horse that comes full pelt,
But as quiet as if he was ‘shod with felt,’
Till he rushes against you with all his force,
And then I needn’t describe the course,
While he kicks you about without remorse,
How awkward it is to be groom’d by a horse!
Or a bullock comes, as mad as King Lear,
And you never dream that the brute is near,
Till he pokes his horn right into your ear,
Whether you like the thing or lump it,—
And all for want of buying a trumpet!

“I’m not a female to fret and vex,
But if I belonged to the sensitive sex,
Exposed to all sorts of indelicate sounds,
I wouldn’t be deaf for a thousand pounds.
 Lord! only think of chucking a copper
To Jack or Bob with a timber limb,
Who looks as if he was singing a hymn,
 Instead of a song that’s very improper!
Or just suppose in a public place
You see a great fellow a-pulling a face,
With his staring eyes and his mouth like an O,—
And how is a poor deaf lady to know,—
The lower orders are up to such games—
If he’s calling ‘Green Peas,’ or calling her names?”
(“They’re tenpence a peck!” said the deafest of Dames.)

“ ’Tis strange what very strong advising,
By word of mouth, or advertising,
By chalking on walls, or placarding on vans,
With fifty other different plans,
The very high pressure, in fact, of pressing,

It needs to persuade one to purchase a blessing!
Whether the Soothing American Syrup,
A Safety Hat or a Safety Stirrup,—
Infallible Pills for the human frame,
Or Rowland's O-don't-o (an ominous name)!
A Doudney's suit which the shape so hits
That it beats all others into *fits*;
A Mechi's razor for beards unshorn,
Or a Ghost-of-a-Whisper-Catching Horn!

“Try it again, Ma'am, only try!”
Was still the voluble Pedlar's cry;
“It's a great privation, there's no dispute,
To live like the dumb unsociable brute,
And to hear no more of the *pro* and *con*,
And how Society's going on,
Than Mumbo Jumbo or Prester John,
And all for want of this *sine quâ non*;
Whereas, with a horn that never offends,
You may join the genteelest party that is,
And enjoy all the scandal, and gossip, and quiz,
And be certain to hear of your absent friends;—
Not that elegant ladies, in fact,
In genteel society ever detract,
Or lend a brush when a friend is black'd,—
At least as a mere malicious act,—
But only talk scandal for fear some fool
Should think they were bred at *charity* school.
Or, maybe, you like a little flirtation,
Which even the most Don Juanish rake
Would surely object to undertake
At the same high pitch as an altercation.
It's not for me, of course, to judge
How much a Deaf Lady ought to begrudge;
But half-a-guinea seems no great matter—
Letting alone more rational patter—
Only to hear a parrot chatter:
Not to mention that feather'd wit,

The Starling, who speaks when his tongue is slit;
The Pies and Jays that utter words,
And other Dicky Gossips of birds,
That talk with as much good sense and decorum,
As many *Beaks* who belong to the quorum.

“ ‘Try it—buy it—say ten and six,
The lowest price a miser could fix:
I don’t pretend with horns of mine,
Like some in the advertising line,
To ‘*magnify sounds*’ on such marvellous scales
That the sounds of a cod seem as big as a whale’s;
But popular rumours, right or wrong,—
Charity sermons, short or long,—
Lecture, speech, concerto, or song,
All noises and voices, feeble or strong,
From the hum of a gnat to the clash of a gong,
This tube will deliver distinct and clear;
Or, supposing by chance
You wish to dance,
Why, it’s putting a *Horn-pipe* into your ear!
Try it—buy it!
Buy it—try it!
The last New Patent, and nothing comes nigh it,
For guiding sounds to their proper tunnel:
Only try till the end of June,
And if you and the Trumpet are out of tune
I’ll turn it gratis into a funnel!”

In short, the pedlar so beset her,—
Lord Bacon couldn’t have gammon’d her better,—
With flatteries plump and indirect,
And plied his tongue with such effect,—
A tongue that could almost have butter’d a crumpet,—
The deaf old woman bought the Trumpet.

* * * * *

The pedlar was gone. With the horn’s assistance.

She heard his steps die away in the distance;
And then she heard the tick of the clock,
The purring of puss and the snoring of Shock;
And she purposely dropp'd a pin that was little,
And heard it fall as plain as a skittle!

'Twas a wonderful horn, to be but just!
Nor meant to gather dust, must and rust;
So in half a jiffy, or less than that,
In her scarlet cloak and her steeple-hat,
Like old Dame Trot, but without her cat,
The gossip was hunting all Tringham through,
As if she meant to canvass the borough,
Trumpet in hand, or up to the cavity;—
And, sure, had the horn been one of those
The wild Rhinoceros wears on his nose,
It couldn't have ripp'd up more depravity!

Depravity! mercy shield her ears!
'Twas plain enough that her village peers
In the ways of vice were no raw beginners;
For whenever she raised the tube to her drum
Such sounds were transmitted as only come
From the very Brass Band of human sinners!
Ribald jest and blasphemous curse
(Bunyan never vented worse),
With all those weeds, not flowers, of speech
Which the Seven Dialecticians teach;
Filthy Conjunctions, and Dissolute Nouns,
And Particles pick'd from the kennels of towns,
With Irregular Verbs for irregular jobs,
Chiefly active in rows and mobs,
Picking possessive Pronouns' fobs,
And Interjections as bad as a blight,
Or an Eastern blast, to the blood and the sight;
Fanciful phrases for crime and sin,
And smacking of vulgar lips where Gin,
Garlic, Tobacco, and offals go in—

Game, tobacco, and cards go in
A jargon so truly adapted, in fact,
To each thievish, obscene, and ferocious act,
So fit for the brute with the human shape,
Savage Baboon, or libidinous Ape,
From their ugly mouths it will certainly come
Should they ever get weary of shamming dumb!

Alas! for the Voice of Virtue and Truth,
And the sweet little innocent prattle of Youth!
The smallest urchin whose tongue could tang,
Shock'd the Dame with a volley of slang,
Fit for Fagin's juvenile gang;
 While the charity chap,
 With his muffin cap,
 His crimson coat, and his badge so garish,
Playing at dumps, or pitch in the hole,
Cursed his eyes, limbs, body and soul,
 As if they didn't belong to the Parish!

'Twas awful to hear, as she went along,
The wicked words of the popular song;
 Or supposing she listen'd—as gossips will—
At a door ajar, or a window agape,
To catch the sounds they allow'd to escape,
 Those sounds belong'd to Depravity still!
The dark allusion, or bolder brag
Of the dexterous “dodge,” and the lots of “swag,”
The plunder'd house—or the stolen nag—
The blazing rick, or the darker crime,
That quench'd the spark before its time—
The wanton speech of the wife immoral—
The noise of drunken or deadly quarrel,
With savage menace, which threaten'd the life,
Till the heart seem'd merely a strop “for the knife;”
The human liver, no better than that,
Which is sliced and thrown to an old woman's cat;
 And the head, so useful for shaking and nodding,
To be crush'd into holes like “a shocking bad hat.”

to be punch'd into holes, like a shocking bad hat,
That is only fit to be punch'd into wadding!

In short, wherever she turn'd the horn,
To the highly bred, or the lowly born,
The working man, who look'd over the hedge,
Or the mother nursing her infant pledge,
The sober Quaker, averse to quarrels,
Or the Governess pacing the village through,
With her twelve Young Ladies, two and two,
Looking, as such young ladies do,
Truss'd by Decorum and stuff'd with morals—
Whether she listen'd to Hob or Bob,
Nob or Snob,
The Squire on his cob,
Or Trudge and his ass at a tinkering job,
To the "Saint" who expounded at "Little Zion"—
Or the "Sinner" who kept "the Golden Lion"—
The man teetotally wean'd from liquor—
The Beadle, the Clerk, or the Reverend Vicar—
Nay, the very Pie in its cage of wicker—
She gather'd such meanings, double or single,
That like the bell,
With muffins to sell,
Her ear was kept in a constant tingle!

But this was nought to the tales of shame,
The constant runnings of evil fame,
Foul, and dirty, and black as ink,
That her ancient cronies, with nod and wink,
Pour'd in her horn like slops in a sink:
While sitting in conclave, as gossips do,
With their Hyson or Howqua, black or green,
And not a little of feline spleen
Lapp'd up in "Catty packages," too,
To give a zest to the sipping and supping;
For still by some invisible tether,
Scandal and Tea are link'd together,

As surely as Scarification and Cupping;
Yet never since Scandal drank Bohea—
Or sloe, or whatever it happen'd to be,
For some grocerly thieves
Turn over new leaves,
Without much amending their lives or their tea—
No, never since cup was fill'd or stirr'd
Were such wild and horrible anecdotes heard,
As blacken'd their neighbours of either gender,
Especially that, which is called the Tender,
But, instead of the softness we fancy therewith,
Was harden'd in vice as the vice of a smith.

Women! the wretches! had soil'd and marr'd
Whatever to womanly nature belongs;
For the marriage tie they had no regard,
Nay, sped their mates to the sexton's yard,
(Like Madame Laffarge, who with poisonous pinches
Kept cutting off her L by inches)—
And as for drinking, they drank so hard
That they drank their flat-irons, pokers, and tongs!
The men—they fought and gambled at fairs;
And poach'd—and didn't respect grey hairs—
Stole linen, money, plate, poultry, and corses;
And broke in houses as well as horses;
Unfolded folds to kill their own mutton,—
And would their own mothers and wives for a button;
But not to repeat the deeds they did,
Backsliding in spite of all moral skid,
If all were true that fell from the tongue,
There was not a villager, old or young,
But deserved to be whipp'd, imprison'd, or hung,
Or sent on those travels which nobody hurries,
To publish at Colburn's, or Longman's, or Murray's.

Meanwhile the Trumpet, *con amore*,
Transmitted each vile diabolical story;
And gave the least whisper of slips and falls,

As that Gallery does in the Dome of St. Paul's,
Which, as all the world knows, by practice or print,
Is famous for making the most of a hint.

Not a murmur of shame,
Or buzz of blame,
Not a flying report that flew at a name,
Not a plausible gloss, or significant note,
Not a word in the scandalous circles afloat,
Of a beam in the eye, or diminutive note,
But vortex-like that tube of tin
Suck'd the censorious particle in;
And, truth to tell, for as willing an organ
As ever listen'd to serpent's hiss,
Nor took the viperous sound amiss,
On the snaky head of an ancient Gorgon!

The Dame, it is true, would mutter "shocking!"
And give her head a sorrowful rocking,
And make a clucking with palate and tongue,
Like the call of Partlett to gather her young,
A sound, when human, that always proclaims
At least a thousand pities and shames;

But still the darker the tale of sin,
Like certain folks, when calamities burst,
Who find a comfort in "hearing the worst,"
The farther she poked the Trumpet in.
Nay, worse, whatever she heard, she spread
East and West, and North and South,
Like the ball which, according to Captain Z.,
Went in at his ear, and came out at his mouth.

What wonder between the Horn and the Dame,
Such mischief was made wherever they came,
That the parish of Tringham was all in a flame!
For although it required such loud discharges,
Such peals of thunder as rumbled at Lear,
To turn the smallest of table-beer,
A little whisper breathed into the ear

Will sour a temper “as sour as varges.”
In fact such very ill blood there grew,
From this private circulation of stories,
That the nearest neighbours the village through,
Look’d at each other as yellow and blue,
As any electioneering crew
Wearing the colours of Whigs and Tories.

Ah! well the Poet said, in sooth,
That “whispering tongues can poison Truth,”—
Yea, like a dose of oxalic acid,
Wrench and convulse poor Peace, the placid,
And rack dear Love with internal fuel,
Like arsenic pastry, or what is as cruel,
Sugar of lead, that sweetens gruel,—
At least such torments began to ring ’em
From the very morn
When that mischievous Horn
Caught the whisper of tongues in Tringham.

The Social Clubs dissolved in huffs,
And the Sons of Harmony came to cuffs,
While feuds arose and family quarrels,
That discomposed the mechanics of morals,
For screws were loose between brother and brother,
While sisters fasten’d their nails on each other;
Such wrangles, and jangles, and miff, and tiff,
And spar, and jar—and breezes as stiff
As ever upset a friendship—or skiff!
The plighted lovers, who used to walk,
Refused to meet, and declined to talk;
And wish’d for *two* moons to reflect the sun,
That they mightn’t look together on one;
While wedded affection ran so low,
That the oldest John Anderson snubbed his Jo—
And instead of the toddle adown the hill,
Hand in hand,
As the song has plann’d.

Scratch'd her, penniless, out of his will!

In short, to describe what came to pass
In a true, though somewhat theatrical way,
Instead of "Love in a Village"—alas!
The piece they perform'd was "The Devil to Pay!"

However, as secrets are brought to light,
And mischief comes home like chickens at night;
And rivers are track'd throughout their course,
And forgeries traced to their proper source;—
And the sow that ought
By the ear is caught,—
And the sin to the sinful door is brought;
And the cat at last escapes from the bag—
And the saddle is placed on the proper nag—
And the fog blows off, and the key is found—
And the faulty scent is pick'd out by the hound—
And the fact turns up like a worm from the ground—
And the matter gets wind to waft it about;
And a hint goes abroad, and the murder is out—
And the riddle is guess'd—and the puzzle is known—
So the truth was sniff'd, and the Trumpet was *blown*!

* * * * *

'Tis a day in November—a day of fog—
But the Tringham people are all agog;
Fathers, Mothers, and Mothers' Sons,—
With sticks, and staves, and swords, and guns,—
As if in pursuit of a rabid dog;
But their voices—raised to the highest pitch—
Declare that the game is "a Witch!—a Witch!"

Over the Green, and along by The George—
Past the Stocks, and the Church, and the Forge,
And round the Pound, and skirting the Pond,
Till they come to the whitewash'd cottage beyond,
And there at the door they muster and cluster,
And thump and kick and hellow and bluster—

And tramp, and men, and cown, and craster
Enough to put Old Nick in a fluster!
A noise, indeed, so loud and long,
And mix'd with expressions so very strong,
That supposing, according to popular fame,
“Wise Woman” and Witch to be the same,
No hag with a broom would unwisely stop,
But up and away through the chimney-top;
Whereas, the moment they burst the door,
Planted fast on her sanded floor,
With her Trumpet up to her organ of hearing,
Lo and behold! Dame Eleanor Spearing!

Oh! then arises the fearful shout—
Bawl'd and scream'd, and bandied about—
“Seize her!—Drag the old Jezebel out!”
While the Beadle—the foremost of all the band,
Snatches the Horn from her trembling hand—
And after a pause of doubt and fear,
Puts it up to his sharpest ear.

“Now silence—silence—one and all!”
For the Clerk is quoting from Holy Paul!
But before he rehearses
A couple of verses,
The Beadle lets the Trumpet fall:
For instead of the words so pious and humble,
He hears a supernatural grumble.

Enough, enough! and more than enough;—
Twenty impatient hands and rough,
By arm, and leg, and neck, and scruff,
Apron, ‘kerchief, gown of stuff—
Cap, and pinner, sleeve, and cuff—
Are clutching the Witch wherever they can,
With the spite of Woman and fury of Man;
And then—but first they kill her cat,
And murder her dog on the very mat—
And crush the infernal Trumnet flat.—

And crash the infernal trumpet hat,
And then they hurry her through the door
She never, never will enter more!

Away! away! down the dusty lane
They pull her, and haul her, with might and main;
And happy the hawbuck, Tom or Harry,
Dandy, or Sandy, Jerry, or Larry,
Who happens to get “a leg to carry!”
And happy the foot that can give her a kick,
And happy the hand that can find a brick—
And happy the fingers that hold a stick—
Knife to cut, or pin to prick—
And happy the Boy who can lend her a lick;—
Nay, happy the urchin—Charity-bred,
Who can shy very nigh to her wicked old head!

Alas! to think how people’s creeds
Are contradicted by people’s deeds!
But though the wishes that Witches utter
Can play the most diabolical rigs—
Send styes in the eye—and measles the pigs—
Grease horses’ heels—and spoil the butter;
Smut and mildew the corn on the stalk—
And turn new milk to water and chalk,—
Blight apples—and give the chickens the pip—
And cramp the stomach—and cripple the hip—
And waste the body—and addle the eggs—
And give a baby bandy legs;
Though in common belief a Witch’s curse
Involves all these horrible things, and worse—
As ignorant bumpkins all profess,
No bumpkin makes a poke the less
At the back or ribs of old Eleanor S.!
As if she were only a sack of barley!
Or gives her credit for greater might
Than the Powers of Darkness confer at night
On that other old woman, the parish Charley!

There are folks about town—to name no names—
Who much resemble that deafest of Dames!

And over their tea, and muffins, and crumpets,
Circulate many a scandalous word,
And whisper tales they could only have heard
Through some such Diabolical Trumpets!

AN OPEN QUESTION.

“It is the king’s highway, that we are in, and in this way it is that thou hast placed the lions.”—
BUNYAN.



HAT! shut the gardens! lock the latticed gate!
Refuse the shilling and the fellow's ticket!
And hang a wooden notice up to state,
 "On Sundays no admittance at this wicket!"
The birds, the beasts, and all the reptile race
 Denied to friends and visitors till Monday!
Now, really, this appears the common case
 Of putting too much Sabbath into Sunday—
 But what is your opinion, Mrs. Grundy?

The Gardens,—so unlike the ones we dub
 Of Tea, wherein the artisan carouses,—
Mere shrubberies without one drop of shrub,—
 Wherefore should they be closed like public-houses?
No ale is vended at the wild Deer's Head,—
 Nor rum—nor gin—not even of a Monday—
The Lion is not carved—or gilt—or red,
 And does not send out porter of a Sunday—
 But what is your opinion, Mrs. Grundy?

The bear denied! the leopard under locks!
 As if his spots would give contagious fevers;
The beaver close as hat within its box;
 So different from other Sunday beavers!
The birds invisible—the gnaw-way rats—
 The seal hermetically seal'd till Monday—
The monkey tribe—the family of cats,—
 We visit other families on Sunday—
 But what is your opinion, Mrs. Grundy?

What is the brute profanity that shocks
 The super-sensitively serious feeling?
The kangaroo—is he not orthodox
 To bend his legs, the way he does, in kneeling?
Was strict Sir Andrew, in his sabbath coat,
 Struck all a heap to see a *Coati Mundi*?
Or did the Kentish Plumtree faint to note

The pelicans presenting bills on Sunday?—
But what is your opinion, Mrs. Grundy?

What feature has repulsed the serious set?
What error in the bestial birth or breeding,
To put their tender fancies on the fret?
One thing is plain—it is not in the feeding!
Some stiffish people think that smoking joints
Are carnal sins 'twixt Saturday and Monday—
But then the beasts are pious on these points,
For they all eat cold dinners on a Sunday—
But what is your opinion, Mrs. Grundy?

What change comes o'er the spirit of the place,
As if transmuted by some spell organic?
Turns fell hyæna of the ghoulish race?
The snake, *pro tempore*, the true Satanic?
Do Irish minds,—(whose theory allows
That now and then Good Friday falls on Monday)—
Do Irish minds suppose that Indian Cows
Are wicked Bulls of Bashan on a Sunday—
But what is your opinion, Mrs. Grundy?

There are some moody fellows, not a few,
Who, turn'd by Nature with a gloomy bias,
Renounce black devils to adopt the blue,
And think when they are dismal they are pious:
Is't possible that Pug's untimely fun
Has sent the brutes to Coventry till Monday—
Or p'rhaps some animal, no serious one,
Was overheard in laughter on a Sunday—
But what is your opinion, Mrs. Grundy?

What dire offence have serious fellows found
To raise their spleen against the Regent's spinney?
Were charitable boxes handed round,
And would not guinea pigs subscribe their guinea?
Perchance the Demoiselle refused to moult

The feathers in her head—at least till Monday;
Or did the elephant unseemly, bolt
A tract presented to be read on Sunday—
But what is your opinion, Mrs. Grundy?

At whom did Leo struggle to get loose?
Who mourns through monkey tricks his damaged clothing?
Who has been hiss'd by the Canadian goose?
On whom did Llama spit in utter loathing?
Some Smithfield saint did jealous feelings tell
To keep the Puma out of sight till Monday,
Because he played extempore as well
As certain wild Itinerants on Sunday—
But what is your opinion, Mrs. Grundy?

To me it seems that in the oddest way
(Begging the pardon of each rigid Socius)
Our would-be keepers of the Sabbath-day
Are like the keepers of the brutes ferocious—
As soon the tiger might expect to stalk
About the grounds from Saturday till Monday
As any harmless man to take a walk,
If saints could clap him in a cage on Sunday—
But what is your opinion, Mrs. Grundy?

In spite of all hypocrisy can spin,
As surely as I am a Christian scion,
I cannot think it is a mortal sin—
(Unless he's loose) to look upon a lion.
I really think that one may go, perchance,
To see a bear, as guiltless as on Monday—
(That is, provided that he did not dance)
Bruin's no worse than baking on a Sunday—
But what is your opinion, Mrs. Grundy?

In spite of all the fanatic compiles,
I cannot think the day a bit diviner,
Because no children, with forestalling smiles,

Throng, happy, to the gates of Eden Minor—
It is not plain, to my poor faith at least,
That what we christen “Natural” on Monday,
The wondrous History of bird and beast,
Can be unnatural because it’s Sunday—
But what is your opinion, Mrs. Grundy?

Whereon is sinful fantasy to work?
The dove, the wing’d Columbus of man’s haven?
The tender love-bird—or the filial stork?
The punctual crane—the providential raven?
The pelican whose bosom feeds her young?
Nay, must we cut from Saturday till Monday
That feather’d marvel with a human tongue,
Because she does not preach upon a Sunday—
But what is your opinion, Mrs. Grundy?

The busy beaver—that sagacious beast!
The sheep that owned an Oriental Shepherd—
That desert-ship the camel of the East,
The horn’d rhinoceros—the spotted leopard—
The creatures of the Great Creator’s hand
Are surely sights for better days than Monday—
The elephant, although he wears no band,
Has he no sermon in his trunk for Sunday—
But what is your opinion, Mrs. Grundy?

What harm if men who burn the midnight-oil,
Weary of frame, and worn and wan in feature,
Seek once a week their spirits to assoil,
And snatch a glimpse of “Animated Nature?”
Better it were if, in his best of suits,
The artisan, who goes to work on Monday,
Should spend a leisure hour amongst the brutes,
Than make a beast of his own self on Sunday—
But what is your opinion, Mrs. Grundy?

Why, zounds! what raised so Protestant a fuss

(Omit the zounds! for which I make apology)
But that the Papists, like some fellows, thus
Had somehow mixed up *Dens* with their theology?
Is Brahma's bull—a Hindoo god at home—
A papal bull to be tied up till Monday—
Or Leo, like his namesake, Pope of Rome,
That there is such a dread of them on Sunday—
But what is your opinion, Mrs. Grundy?

Spirit of Kant! have we not had enough
To make religion sad, and sour, and snubbish
But saints zoological must cant their stuff,
As vessels cant their ballast—rattling rubbish!
Once let the sect, triumphant to their text,
Shut Nero^[2] up from Saturday till Monday,
And sure as fate they will deny us next
To see the dandelions on a Sunday—
But what is your opinion, Mrs. Grundy?

NOTE.—There is an anecdote of a Scotch Professor who happened during a Sunday walk to be hammering at a geological specimen which he had picked up, when a peasant gravely accosted him, and said, very seriously, “Eh! Sir, you think you are only breaking a stone, but you are breaking the Sabbath.”

In a similar spirit, some of our over-righteous sectarians are fond of attributing all breakage to the same cause—from the smashing of a parish lamp, up to the fracture of a human skull;—the “breaking into the bloody house of life,” or the breaking into a brick-built dwelling. They all originate in the breaking of the Sabbath. It is the source of every crime in the country—the parent of every illegitimate child in the parish. The picking of a pocket is ascribed to the picking of a daisy—the robbery on the highway to a stroll in the fields—the incendiary fire to a hot dinner—on Sunday. All other causes—the want of education—the want of moral culture—the want of bread itself, are totally repudiated. The criminal himself is made to confess at the gallows that he owes his appearance on the scaffold to a walk with “Sally in our alley” on the “day that comes between a Saturday and Monday.”

Supposing this theory to be correct, and made like the law “for every degree,” the wonder of Captain Macheath that we haven't “better company at Tyburn tree” (now the New Drop) must be fully shared by everybody who has visited the Ring in Hyde Park on the day in question. But how much greater must be the wonder of any person who has happened to reside, like myself, for a year or two in a continental city, inhabited, according to the strict construction of our Mawworms, by some fifteen or twenty thousand of habitual Sabbath-breakers, and yet, without hearing of murder and robbery as often as of blood-sausages and dollars! A city where the Burgomaster himself must have come to a bad end, if a dance upon Sunday led so inevitably to a dance upon nothing!

The “saints” having set up this absolute dependence of crime on Sabbath-breaking, their relative proportions become a fair statistical question; and, as such, the inquiry is seriously recommended to the rigid legislator, who acknowledges, indeed, that the Sabbath was “made for man,” but, by a singular interpretation, conceives that the man for whom it was made is himself!

THE TURTLES.

A FABLE.

“The rage of the vulture, the love of the turtle.”—BYRON.



ONE day, it was before a civic dinner,
Two London Aldermen, no matter which,
Cordwainer, Girdler, Patten-maker, Skinner—
But both were florid, corpulent, and rich,
And both right fond of festive demolition,
Set forth upon a secret expedition.
Yet not, as might be fancied from the token,
To Pudding Lane, Pie Corner, or the Street
Of Bread, or Grub, or anything to eat,
Or drink, as Milk, or Vintry, or Portsoken,
But eastward to that more aquatic quarter,
Where folks take water,
Or bound on voyages, secure a berth
For Antwerp or Ostend, Dundee or Perth,
Calais, Boulogne, or any Port on earth!
Jostled and jostling, through the mud,
Peculiar to the Town of Lud,
Down narrow streets and crooked lanes they dived,
Past many a gusty avenue, through which
Came yellow fog, and smell of pitch,
From barge, and boat, and dusky wharf derived;
With darker fumes, brought eddying by the draught,
From loco-smoko-motive craft;
Mingling with scents of butter, cheese, and gammons,
Tea, coffee, sugar, pickles, rosin, wax,
Hides, tallow, Russia-matting, hemp and flax,
Salt-cod, red-herrings, sprats, and kipper'd salmons,
Nuts, oranges, and lemons,
Each pungent spice, and aromatic gum,
Gas, pepper, soaples, brandy, gin, and rum;
Alamode-beef and greens—the London soil—
Glue, coal, tobacco, turpentine and oil,
Bark, assafoetida, squills, vitriol, hops,
In short, all whiffs, and sniffs, and puffs and snuffs,
From metals, minerals, and dyewood stuffs,
Fruits, victual, drink, solidities, or slops—
In flasks, casks, hales, trucks, waggons, taverns, shons.

in houses, eases, eases, eases, eases, eases, eases,
Boats, lighters, cellars, wharfs, and warehouse-tops,
That, as we walk upon the river's ridge,
Assault the nose—below the bridge.

A walk, however, as tradition tells,
That once a poor blind Tobit used to choose,
Because, incapable of other views,
He met with “such a sight of smells.”

But on, and on, and on,
In spite of all unsavoury shocks,
Progress the stout Sir Peter and Sir John,
Steadily steering ship-like for the docks—
And now they reach a place the Muse, unwilling,
Recalls for female slang and vulgar doing,
The famous Gate of Billing,
That does not lead to cooing—
And now they pass that House that is so ugly
A Customer to people looking “smuggley”—
And now along that fatal Hill they pass
Where centuries ago an Oxford bled,
And proved—too late to save his life, alas!—
That *he* was “off his head.”

At last before a lofty brick-built pile
Sir Peter stopp'd, and with mysterious smile
Tingled a bell that served to bring
The wire-drawn genius of the ring,
A species of commercial Samuel Weller—
To whom Sir Peter—tipping him a wink,
And something else to drink—
“Show us the cellar.”

Obsequious bow'd the man, and led the way
Down sundry flights of stairs, where windows small,
Dappled with mud, let in a dingy ray—
A dirty tax, if they were tax'd at all.

At length they came into a cellar damp,
With venerable cobwebs fringed around,
 A cellar of that stamp
Which often harbours vintages renown'd,
The feudal Hock, or Burgundy the courtly,
 With sherry, brown or golden,
 Or port, so olden,
Bereft of body 'tis no longer portly—
But old or otherwise—to be veracious—
That cobwebb'd cellar, damp, and dim, and spacious,
 Held nothing crusty—but crustaceous.

 Prone, on the chilly floor,
Five splendid Turtles—such a five!
Natives of some West Indian shore,
 Were flapping all alive,
Late landed from the Jolly Planter's yawl—
A sight whereon the dignitaries fix'd
Their eager eyes, with ecstasy unmix'd,
Like fathers that behold their infants crawl,
 Enjoying every little kick and sprawl.
Nay—far from fatherly the thoughts they bred
Poor loggerheads from far Ascension ferried!
The Aldermen too plainly wish'd them dead
 And Aldermanbury'd!

“There!” cried Sir Peter, with an air
Triumphant as an ancient victor's,
And pointing to the creatures rich and rare,
 “There's picters!”

“Talk of Olympic Games! They're not worth mention;
The real prize for wrestling is when Jack,
 In Providence or Ascension,
Can throw a lively turtle on its back!”

“Aye!” cried Sir John, and with a score of nods,
Thoughtful of classical symposium,

“There’s food for Gods!
There’s nectar! there’s ambrosium!
There’s food for Roman Emperors to eat—
 Oh, there had been a treat
(Those ancient names will sometimes hobble us)
 For Helio-gobble-us!”

“There were a feast for Alexander’s Feast!
The real sort—none of your mock or spurious!”
And then he mention’d Aldermen deceased,
 And “Epicurius,”
And how Tertullian had enjoy’d such foison;
And speculated on that *verdigrease*
 That isn’t poison.

“Talk of your Spring, and verdure, and all that!
 Give *me* green fat!
As for your Poets with their groves of myrtles
 And billing turtles,
Give me, for poetry, them Turtles there,
 A-billing in a bill of fare!”

“Of all the things I ever swallow—
Good, well-dressed turtle beats them hollow—
 It almost makes me wish, I vow,
 To have *two* stomachs, like a cow!”
And lo! as with the cud, an inward thrill
Upheaved his waistcoat and disturb’d his frill,
His mouth was oozing and he work’d his jaw—
“I almost think that I could eat one raw!”

And thus, as “inward love breeds outward talk,”
The portly pair continued to discourse;
And then—as Gray describes of life’s divorce—
With “longing lingering look” prepared to walk,—
Having thro’ one delighted sense, at least,
Enjoy’d a sort of Barmecidal feast,
And with prophetic gestures, strange to see,

Forestall'd the civic Banquet yet to be,
Its callipash and callipee!

A pleasant prospect—but alack!
Scarcely each Alderman had turn'd his back,
When seizing on the moment so propitious,
And having learn'd that they were so delicious
To bite and sup,
From praises so high flown and injudicious,—
And nothing could be more pernicious!
The turtles fell to work, and ate each other up!

MORAL.

Never, from folly or urbanity,
Praise people thus profusely to their faces,
Till quite in love with their own graces,
They're eaten up by vanity!

TOWN AND COUNTRY.

AN ODE.

O! Well may poets make a fuss
In summer time, and sigh "*O rus!*"
Of London pleasures sick:
My heart is all at pant to rest
In greenwood shades—my eyes detest
This endless meal of brick!

What joy have I in June's return?
My feet are parch'd, my eyeballs burn,
I scent no flowery gust:
But faint the flagging zephyr springs,
With dry Macadam on its wings,
And turns me "dust to dust."

My sun his daily course renews
Due east, but with no Eastern dews;
The path is dry and hot!
His setting shows more tamely still,
He sinks behind no purple hill,
But down a chimney's pot!

O! but to hear the milkmaid blithe,
Or early mower wet his scythe
The dewy meads among!—
My grass is of that sort, alas!
That makes no hay—called sparrow-grass
By folks of vulgar tongue!

O! but to smell the woodbines sweet!
I think of cowslip cups—but meet
With very vile rebuffs!
For meadow-buds I get a whiff
Of Cheshire cheese,—or only sniff
The turtle made at Cuft's.

How tenderly Rousseau reviewed
His periwinkles!—mine are stewed!

My rose blooms on a gown!—
I hunt in vain for eglantine,
And find my blue-bell on the sign
That marks the Bell and Crown:

Where are ye, birds! that blithely wing
From tree to tree, and gaily sing
Or mourn in thickets deep?
My cuckoo has some ware to sell,
The watchman is my Philomel,
My blackbird is a sweep!

Where are ye, linnet, lark, and thrush!
That perch on leafy bough and bush,
And tune the various song?
Two hurdigurdists, and a poor
Street-Handel grinding at my door,
Are all my “tuneful throng.”

Where are ye, early-purling streams,
Whose waves reflect the morning beams,
And colours of the skies?
My rills are only puddle-drains
From shambles, or reflect the stains
Of calimanco-dyes!

Sweet are the little brooks that run
O’er pebbles glancing in the sun,
Singing in soothing tones:—
Not thus the city streamlets flow;
They make no music as they go,
Though never “off the stones.”

Where are ye, pastoral pretty sheep,
That wont to bleat, and frisk, and leap
Beside your woolly dams?
Alas! instead of harmless crooks,
My Corydons use iron hooks,
And skin—not shear—the lambs

AND SMELL—NOT SWEET—THE LAMBS.

The pipe whereon, in olden day,
The Arcadian herdsman used to play
 Sweetly, here soundeth not;
But merely breathes unwholesome fumes,
Meanwhile the city boor consumes
 The rank weed—"piping hot."

All rural things are vilely mock'd,
On every hand the sense is shock'd,
 With objects hard to bear:
Shades—vernal shades!—where wine is sold!
And, for a turfy bank, behold
 An Ingram's rustic chair!

Where are ye, London meads and bowers,
And gardens redolent of flowers
 Wherein the zephyr wons?
Alas! Moor Fields are fields no more.
See Hatton's Gardens bricked all o'er,
 And that bare wood—St. John's.

No pastoral scenes procure me peace;
I hold no Leasowes in my lease,
 No cot set round with trees:
No sheep-white hill my dwelling flanks;
And Omnium furnishes my banks
 With brokers—not with bees.

O! well may poets make a fuss
In summer time, and sigh "*O rus!*"
 Of city pleasures sick:
My heart is all at pant to rest
In greenwood shades—my eyes detest
 That endless meal of brick!

NO!

No sun—no moon!
No morn—no noon—
No dawn—no dusk—no proper time of day—
No sky—no earthly view—
No distance looking blue—
No road—no street—no “t’other side the way”—
No end to any Row—
No indications where the Crescents go—
No top to any steeple—
No recognitions of familiar people—
No courtesies for showing ’em—
No knowing ’em!—
No travelling at all—no locomotion,
No inkling of the way—no notion—
“No go”—by land or ocean—
No mail—no post—
No news from any foreign coast—
No Park—no Ring—no afternoon gentility—
No company—no nobility—
No warmth, no cheerfulness, no healthful ease,
No comfortable feel in any member—
No shade, no shine, no butterflies, no bees,
No fruits, no flowers, no leaves, no birds,—
November!

THE LOST HEIR.

“Oh, where, and oh where
Is my bonny laddie gone?”—OLD SONG



NE day, as I was going by
That part of Holborn christened
High,
I heard a loud and sudden cry
That chill'd my very blood;
And lo! from out a dirty alley,
Where pigs and Irish wont to rally,
I saw a crazy woman sally,
Bedaub'd with grease and mud.
She turn'd her East, she turn'd her West,
Staring like Pythoness possest,
With streaming hair and heaving breast
As one stark mad with grief.
This way and that she wildly ran,
Jostling with woman and with man—
Her right hand held a frying pan,
The left a lump of beef.
At last her frenzy seem'd to reach
A point just capable of speech,
And with a tone almost a screech,
As wild as ocean birds,
Or female Ranter mov'd to preach,
She gave her “sorrow words.”

“Oh Lord! oh dear, my heart will break, I shall go stick stark staring wild!
Has ever a one seen anything about the streets like a crying lost-looking
child?

Lawk help me, I don’t know where to look, or to run, if I only knew which
way—

A child as is lost about London streets, and especially Seven Dials, is a
needle in a bottle of hay.

I am all in a quiver—get out of my sight, do, you wretch, you little Kitty
M’Nab!

You promised to have half an eye on him, you know you did, you dirty
deceitful young drab.

The last time as ever I see him, poor thing, was with my own blessed
Motherly eyes,

Sitting as good as gold in the gutter, a playing at making little dirt pies.

I wonder he left the court where he was better off than all the other young
boys,

With two bricks, an old shoe, nine oyster-shells, and a dead kitten by way of
toys.

When his father comes home, and he always comes home as sure as ever
the clock strikes one,

He’ll be rampant, he will, at his child being lost; and the beef and the
inguns not done!

La bless you, good folks, mind your own consarns, and don’t be making a
mob in the street;

Oh Serjeant M’Farlane! you have not come across my poor little boy, have
you, in your beat?

Do, good people, move on! don’t stand staring at me like a parcel of stupid
stuck pigs;

Saints forbid! but he’s p’r’aps been inviggled away up a court for the sake
of his clothes by the prigs;

He’d a very good jacket, for certain, for I bought it myself for a shilling one
day in Rag Fair;

And his trousers considering not very much patch’d, and red plush, they
was once his Father’s best pair.

His shirt, it’s very lucky I’d got washing in the tub, or that might have gone
with the rest;

But he’d got on a very good pinafore with only two slits and a burn on the

But he's got on a very good phillorie with only two shirts and a shirt on the breast.

He'd a goodish sort of hat, if the crown was sew'd in, and not quite so much jagg'd at the brim.

With one shoe on, and the other shoe is a boot, and not a fit, and you'll know by that if it's him.

Except being so well dress'd my mind would misgive, some old beggar woman in want of an orphan,

Had borrow'd the child to go a begging with, but I'd rather see him laid out in his coffin!

Do, good people, move on, such a rabble of boys! I'll break every bone of 'em I come near,

Go home—you're spilling the porter—go home—Tommy Jones, go along home with your beer.

This day is the sorrowfullest day of my life, ever since my name was Betty Morgan,

Them vile Savoyards! they lost him once before all along of following a Monkey and an Organ.

Oh my Billy—my head will turn right round—if he's got kiddynapp'd with them Italians,

They'll make him a plaster parish image boy, they will, the outlandish tatterdemalions.

Billy—where are you, Billy?—I'm as hoarse as a crow, with screaming for ye, you young sorrow!

And shan't have half a voice, no more I shan't, for crying fresh herrings to-morrow.

Oh Billy, you're bursting my heart in two, and my life won't be of no more vally,

If I'm to see other folks' darlins, and none of mine, playing like angels in our alley.

And what shall I do but cry out my eyes, when I looks at the old three-legged chair

As Billy used to make coach and horses of, and there an't no Billy there!

I would run all the wide world over to find him, if I only know'd where to run,

Little Murphy, now I remember, was once lost for a month through stealing a penny bun,—

The Lord forbid of any child of mine! I think it would kill me raily

'To find my Bill holdin' up his little innocent hand at the Old Bailey.
For though I say it as oughtn't, yet I will say, you may search for miles and
mileses
And not find one better brought up, and more pretty behaved, from one end
to t'other of St. Giles's.
And if I call'd him a beauty, it's no lie, but only as a Mother ought to speak;
You never set eyes on a more handsomer face, only it hasn't been wash'd
for a week;
As for hair, tho' it's red, it's the most nicest hair when I've time to just show
it the comb;
I'll owe 'em five pounds, and a blessing besides, as will only bring him safe
and sound home.
He's blue eyes, and not to be call'd a squint, though a little cast he's
certainly got;
And his nose is still a good un, tho' the bridge is broke, by his falling on a
pewter pint pot;
He's got the most elegant wide mouth in the world, and very large teeth for
his age;
And quite as fit as Mrs. Murdockson's child to play Cupid on the Drury
Lane Stage.
And then he has got such dear winning ways—but oh I never never shall
see him no more!
O dear! to think of losing him just after nursing him back from death's
door!
Only the very last month when the windfalls, hang 'em, was at twenty a
penny!
And the threepence he'd got by grottoing was spent in plums, and sixty for
a child is too many.
And the Cholera man came and whitewash'd us all and, drat him, made a
seize of our hog.
It's no use to send the Crier to cry him about, he's such a blunderin'
drunken old dog;
The last time he was fetch'd to find a lost child, he was guzzling with his
bell at the Crown,
And went and cried a boy instead of a girl, for a distracted Mother and
Father about Town.
Billy—where are you, Billy, I say? come Billy, come home, to your best of
Mothers!

I'm scared when I think of them Cabroleys, they drive so, they'd run over
their own Sisters and Brothers.
Or may be he's stole by some chimbly sweeping wretch, to stick fast in
narrow flues and what not,
And be poked up behind with a picked pointed pole, when the soot has
ketch'd, and the chimbly's red hot.
Oh I'd give the whole wide world, if the world was mine, to clap my two
longin' eyes on his face.
For he's my darlin of darlins, and if he don't soon come back, you'll see me
drop stone dead on the place.
I only wish I'd got him safe in these two Motherly arms, and wouldn't I hug
him and kiss him!
Lauk! I never knew what a precious he was—but a child don't not feel like
a child till you miss him.
Why there he is! Punch and Judy hunting, the young wretch, it's that Billy
as sartin as sin!
But let me get him home, with a good grip of his hair, and I'm blest if he
shall have a whole bone in his skin!"

SHE IS FAR FROM THE LAND.



ABLES entangling her,
Shipspars for mangling
her,

Ropes, sure of strangling her;
Blocks over-dangling her;
Tiller to batter her,
Topmast to shatter her,
Tobacco to spatter her;
Boreas blustering,
Boatswain quite flustering,
Thunder clouds mustering
To blast her with sulphur—
If the deep don't engulph her;
Sometimes fear's scrutiny
Pries out a mutiny,
Sniffs conflagration,
Or hints at starvation:—
All the sea-dangers,
Buccaneers, rangers,
Pirates, and Sallee-men,
Algerine galley-men,
Tornadoes and typhons,
And horrible syphons,
And submarine travels
Thro' roaring sea-navels;
Every thing wrong enough,
Long boat not long enough,
Vessel not strong enough;
Pitch marring frippery,
The deck very slippery,
And the cabin—built sloping,
The Captain a-toping,
And the Mate a blasphemmer,
That names his Redeemer,—
With inward uneasiness;
The cook, known by greasiness,
The victuals heslubber'd

THE VICTIMS DESCRIBED,
Her bed—in a cupboard;
Things of strange christening,
Snatch'd in her listening,
Blue lights and red lights
And mention of dead lights,
And shrouds made a theme of,
Things horrid to dream of,—
And *buoys* in the water
To fear all exhort her;
Her friend no Leander,
Herself no sea gander,
And ne'er a cork jacket
On board of the packet;
The breeze still a stiffening,
The trumpet quite deafening;
Thoughts of repentance,
And doomsday and sentence;
Everything sinister,
Not a church minister,—
Pilot a blunderer,
Coral reefs under her,
Ready to sunder her;
Trunks tipsy-toppsy,
The ship in a dropsy;
Waves oversurging her,
Syrens a-dirgeing her;
Sharks all expecting her,
Sword-fish dissecting her,
Crabs with their hand-vices
Punishing land vices;
Sea-dogs and unicorns,
Things with no puny horns,
Mermen carnivorous—
“Good Lord deliver us!”

ANACREONTIC.

BY A FOOTMAN.

IT'S wery well to talk in praise
Of Tea and Water-drinking
ways,
In proper time and place;
Of sober draughts, so clear and cool,
Dipp'd out of a transparent pool
Reflecting heaven's face.

Of babbling brooks, and purling rills,
And streams as gushes from the hills,
It's wery well to talk;—
But what becomes of all sich schemes,
With ponds of ice, and running streams
As doesn't even walk?



A PUBLIC DINNER.



A DAY'S SPORT ON THE MOORS.

When Winter comes with piercing cold,
And all the rivers, new or old,
 Is frozen far and wide;
And limpid springs is solid stuff,
And crystal pools is hard enough
 To skate upon and slide;—

What then are thirsty men to do,
But drink of ale, and porter too,
 Champagne as makes a fizz;
Port, sherry, or the Rhenish sort,
And p'rhaps a drop of summut short—
 The water-pipes is friz!

THE FORLORN SHEPHERD'S COMPLAINT.

AN UNPUBLISHED POEM, FROM SYDNEY.



ELL! Here I am—no Matter how it suits,
A-keeping Company with them dumb
Brutes,
Old Park vos no bad Judge—confound his vig!
Of vot vood break the Sperrit of a Prig!

“The like of Me, to come to New Sow Wales
To go a-tagging arter Vethers’ Tails
And valk in Herbage as delights the Flock,
But stinks of Sweet Herbs vorser nor the Dock!

“To go to set this solitary Job
To Von whose Vork vos alvay in a Mob!
It’s out of all our Lines, for sure I am
Jack Shepherd even never kep a Lamb!

“I arn’t ashamed to say I sit and veep
To think of Seven Years of keepin Sheep,
The spooniest Beasts in Nater, all to Sticks,
And not a Votch to take for all their Ticks!

“If I’d fore-seed how Transports vood turn out
To only Baa! and Botanize about,
I’d quite as leaf have had the t’other Pool,
And come to Cotton as to all this Vool!

“Von only happy moment I have had
Since here I come to be a Farmer’s Cad,
And then I cotch’d a vild Beast in a Snooze,
And pick’d her Pouch of three young Kangaroos!

“Vot chance have I to go to Race or Mill?
Or show a sneaking Kindness for a Till;
And as for Vashings, on a hedge to dry,
I’d put the Natives’ Linen in my Eye!

“If this whole Lot of Mutton I could scrag,
And find a fence to turn it into Swag

And had a fence to turn it into swag,
I'd give it all in Lonnon Streets to stand,
And if I had my pick, I'd say the Strand!

“But ven I goes, as maybe vonce I shall,
To my old crib to meet with Jack, and Sal,
I've been so gallows honest in this Place,
I shan't not like to show my sheepish Face.

“It's wery hard for nothing but a Box
Of Irish Blackguard to be keepin' Flocks,
'Mong naked Blacks, sich Savages to hus,
They've nayther got a Poker nor a Pus.

“But Folks may tell their Troubles till they're sick
To dumb brute Beasts,—and so I'll cut my Stick!
And vot's the Use a Feller's Eyes to pipe
Vere von can't borrow any Gemman's Vipe?’

HUGGINS AND DUGGINS.

A PASTORAL AFTER POPE.



WO swains or clowns—but call them swains—
While keeping flocks on Salisbury Plains,
For all that tend on sheep as drovers,
Are turned to songsters, or to lovers,
Each of the lass he called his dear,
Began to carol loud and clear.

First Huggins sang, and Duggins then,
In the way of ancient shepherd men;
Who thus alternate hitch'd in song,
“All things by turns, and nothing long.”

HUGGINS.

Of all the girls about our place,
There's one beats all in form and face,
Search through all Great and Little Bumpstead,
You'll only find one Peggy Plumpstead.

DUGGINS.

To groves and streams I tell my flame,
I make the cliffs repeat her name:
When I'm inspired by gills and noggins,
The rocks re-echo Sally Hoggins!

HUGGINS.

When I am walking in the grove,
I think of Peggy as I rove.
I'd carve her name on every tree,
But I don't know my A, B, C.

DUGGINS.

Whether I walk in hill or valley,
I think of nothing else but Sally.
I'd sing her praise, but I can sing
No song, except "God save the King."

HUGGINS.

My Peggy does all nymphs excel,
And all confess she bears the bell,—
Where'er she goes swains flock together,
Like sheep that follow the bellwether.

DUGGINS.

Sally is tall and not too straight,—
Those very poplar shapes I hate;
But something twisted like an S,—
A crook becomes a shepherdess.

HUGGINS.

When Peggy's dog her arms imprison,
I often wish my lot was hisn;
How often I should stand and turn,
To get a pat from hands like hern.

DUGGINS.

I tell Sall's lambs how blest they be,
To stand about and stare at she;
But when I look, she turns and shies,
And won't bear none but their sheep's-eyes?

HUGGINS.

Love goes with Peggy where she goes,—
Beneath her smile the garden grows;
Potatoes spring, and cabbage starts,
'Tatoes have eyes, and cabbage hearts!

HUGGINS.

Where Sally goes it's always spring,
Her presence brightens every thing;
The sun smiles bright, but where her grin is,
It makes brass farthings look like guineas.

HUGGINS.

For Peggy I can have no joy,
She's sometimes kind, and sometimes coy,
And keeps me, by her wayward tricks,
As comfortless as sheep with ticks.

DUGGINS.

Sally is ripe as June or May,
And yet as cold as Christmas day;
For when she's asked to change her lot,
Lamb's wool,—but Sally, she wool not.



SEE-VIEW—BROAD STAIRS.



THE ISLE OF MAN.

HUGGINS.

Only with Peggy and with health,
I'd never wish for state or wealth;
Talking of having health and more pence,
I'd drink her health if I had fourpence.

DUGGINS.

Oh, how that day would seem to shine,
If Sally's banns were read with mine;
She cries, when such a wish I carry,
"Marry come up!" but will not marry.

PAIN IN A PLEASURE-BOAT.

A SEA ECLOCUE.

“I apprehend you!”—SCHOOL OF REFORM.

BOATMAN.



HOVE off there!—ship the rudder, Bill—cast off! she’s under way!

MRS. F.

She’s under what?—I hope she’s not! good gracious, what a spray!

BOATMAN.

Run out the jib, and rig the boom! keep clear of those two brigs!

MRS. F.

I hope they don’t intend some joke by running of their rigs!

BOATMAN.

Bill, shift them bags of ballast aft—she’s rather out of trim!

MRS. F.

Great bags of stones! they’re pretty things to help a boat to swim!

BOATMAN.

The wind is fresh—if she don’t scud, it’s not the breeze’s fault!

MRS. F.

Wind fresh, indeed, I never felt the air so full of salt!

BOATMAN.

That schooner, Bill, harn't left the roads, with oranges and nuts!

MRS. F.

If seas have roads, they're very rough—I never felt such ruts!

BOATMAN.

Its neap, ye see, she's heavy lade, and couldn't pass the bar.

MRS. F.

The bar! what, roads with turnpikes too? I wonder where they are!

BOATMAN.

Ho! brig ahoy! hard up! hard up! that lubber cannot steer!

MRS. F.

Yes, yes,—hard up upon a rock! I know some danger's near!
Lord, there's a wave! it's coming in! and roaring like a bull!

BOATMAN.

Nothing, Ma'am, but a little slop! go large, Bill! keep her full!

MRS. F.

What, keep her full! what daring work! when full, she must go down!

BOATMAN.

Why, Bill, it lulls! ease off a bit—it's coming off the town!
Steady your helm! we'll clear the *Pint*! lay right for yonder pink!

MRS. F.

Be steady—well, I hope they can! but they've got a pint of drink!

BOATMAN.

Bill, give that sheet another haul—she'll fetch it up this reach.

MRS. F.

I'm getting rather pale, I know, and they see it by that speech!
I wonder what it is, now, but—I never felt so queer!

BOATMAN.

Bill, mind your luff—why Bill, I say, she's yawing—keep her near!

MRS. F.

Keep near! we're going further off; the land's behind our backs.

BOATMAN.

Be easy, Ma'am, it's all correct, that's only 'cause we tacks:
We shall have to beat about a bit,—Bill, keep her out to sea.

MRS. F.

Beat who about? keep who at sea?—how black they look at me!

BOATMAN.

It's veering round—I knew it would! oft with her head! stand by!

MRS. F.

Off with her head! whose? where? what with?—an axe I seem to spy!

BOATMAN.

She can't not keep her own, you see; we shall have to pull her in!

MRS. F.

They'll drown me, and take all I have! my life's not worth a pin!

BOATMAN.

Look out you know, be ready, Bill—just when she takes the sand!

MRS. F.

The sand—O Lord! to stop my mouth! how every thing is plann'd!

BOATMAN.

The handspike, Bill—quick, bear a hand! now Ma'am, just step ashore!

MRS. F.

What! an't I going to be kill'd—and welter'd in my gore?
Well, Heaven be praised! but I'll not go a-sailing any more!

GOG AND MAGOG.

A GUILDHALL DUET.

MAGOG.

WHY, Gog, I say, it's after One,
And yet no dinner carved;
Shall we endure this sort of fun,
And stand here to be starved?

GOG.

I really think our City Lords
Must be a shabby set;
I've stood here since King Charles's time,
And had no dinner yet!

MAGOG.

I vow I can no longer stay;
I say, are we to dine to-day?

GOG.

My hunger would provoke a saint,
I've waited till I'm sick and faint;
I'll tell you what, they'll starve us both,
I'll tell you what, they'll stop our growth.

MAGOG.

I wish I had a round of beef
My hungry tooth to charm;
I've wind enough in my inside
To play the Hundredth Psalm.

GOG.

And yet they feast beneath our eyes
Without the least remorse;
This very week I saw the Mayor
A feeding like a horse!

MAGOG.

Such loads of fish, and flesh, and fowl,
To think upon it makes me growl!

GOG.

I wonder where the fools were taught,
That they should keep a giant short!
They'll stop our growth, they'll stop our growth;
They'll starve us both, they'll starve us both!

MAGOG.

They said, a hundred years ago,
That we should dine at One;
Why, Gog, I say, our meat by this
Is rather over-done.

GOG.

I do not want it done at all,
So hungry is my maw,
Give me an Alderman in chains,
And I will eat him raw!

MAGOG.

Of starving weavers they discuss,
And yet they never think of us.
I say, are we to dine to-day;
Are we to dine to-day?

GOG.

Oh dear, the pang it is to feel
So mealy-mouthed without a meal!

MAGOG.

I'll tell you what, they'll stop our growth!

GOG.

I'll tell you what, they'll starve us both!

BOTH.

They'll stop our growth, they'll starve us both!

THE SWEEP'S COMPLAINT.

“I like to meet a sweep—such as come forth with the dawn, or somewhat earlier, with their little professional notes, sounding like the *peep, peep* of a young sparrow.”—ESSAYS OF ELIA.

——“A voice cried Sweep no more!
Macbeth hath murdered sweep.”—SHAKSPEARE.



NE morning ere my usual time
I rose, about the seventh chime,
When little stunted boys that climb
Still linger in the street:
And as I walked, I saw indeed
A sample of the sooty breed,
Though he was rather run to seed,
In height about five feet.
A mongrel tint he seem'd to take,
Poetic simile to make,
DAY through his MARTIN 'gan to break,
Quite overcoming jet.
From side to side he cross'd oblique,
Like Frenchman who has friends to seek,
And yet no English word can speak,
He walk'd upon the fret:
And while he sought the dingy job,
His lab'ring breast appear'd to throb
And half a hiccup half a sob
Betray'd internal woe.
To cry the cry he had by rote
He yearn'd, but law forbade the note,
Like Chanticleer with roudy throat,
He gaped—but not a crow!
I watch'd him, and the glimpse I snatch'd
Disclosed his sorry eyelids patch'd
With red, as if the soot had catch'd
That hung about the lid;
And soon I saw the tear-drop stray,
He did not care to brush away;
Thought I the cause he will betray—
And thus at last he did.

Well, here's a pretty go! here's a Gagging Act, if ever there was a gagging!
But I'm bound the members as silenced us, in doing it had plenty of
magging.

They had better send us all off, they had, to the School for the Deaf and
Dumb,

To unlarn us our mother tongues, and to make signs and be regularly mum.
But they can't undo natur—as sure as ever the morning begins to peep,
Directly I open my eyes, I can't help calling out Sweep
As natural as the sparrows among the chimbley-pots that say Cheep!
For my own part I find my suppress'd voice very uneasy,
And comparable to nothing but having your tissue stopt when you are
sneezy.

Well, it's all up with us! tho' I suppose we mustn't cry all up.
Here's a precious merry Christmas, I'm blest if I can earn either bit or sup!
If crying Sweep, of mornings, is going beyond quietness's border,
Them as pretends to be fond of silence oughtn't to cry hear, hear, and order,
order.

I wonder Mr. Sutton, as we've sut-on too, don't sympathise with us
As a Speaker what don't speak, and that's exactly our own cus.
God help us if we don't not cry, how are we to pursue our callings?
I'm sure we're not half so bad as other businesses with their bawlings.
For instance, the general postmen, that at six o'clock go about ringing,
And wake up all the babbies that their mothers have just got to sleep with
singing.

Greens oughtn't to be cried no more than blacks—to do the impartial job,
If they bring in a Sooty Bill, they ought to have brought in a Dusty Bob.
Is a dustman's voice more sweet than ourn, when he comes a seeking arter
the cinders,

Instead of a little boy like a blackbird in spring, singing merrily under your
windows?

There's the omnibus cads as plies in Cheapside, and keeps calling out Bank
and City;

Let his Worship, the Mayor, decide if our call of Sweep is not just as pretty.
I can't see why the Jews should be let go about crying Old Close thro' their
hooky noses,

And Christian laws should be ten times more hard than the old stone laws
of Moses

OF MUFFINS.

Why isn't the mouths of the muffin-men compell'd to be equally shut?
Why, because Parliament members eat muffins, but they never eat no sut.
Next year there won't be any May-day at all, we shan't have no heart to
dance,

And Jack in the Green will go in black like mourning for our mischance;
If we live as long as May, that's to say, through the hard winter and
pinching weather,

For I don't see how we're to earn enough to keep body and soul together.
I only wish Mr. Wilberforce or some of them that pities the niggers,
Would take a peep down in our cellars, and look at our miserable starving
figures,

A-sitting idle on our empty sacks, and all ready to eat each other,
And a brood of little ones crying for bread to a heart-breaking Father and
Mother.

They haven't a rag of clothes to mend, if their mothers had thread and
needles,

But crawl naked about the cellars, poor things, like a swarm of common
black beadies.

If they'd only inquired before passing the Act and taken a few such peeps,
I don't think that any real gentleman would have set his face against
sweeps.

Climbin's an ancient respectable art, and if History's of any vally,
Was recommended by Queen Elizabeth to the great Sir Walter Raleigh,
When he wrote on a pane of glass how I'd climb, if the way I only knew,
And she writ beneath, if your heart's afeard, don't venture up the flue.
As for me I was always loyal, and respected all powers that are higher,
But how can I now say God save the King, if I an't to be a Cryer?

There's London milk, that's one of the cries, even on Sunday the law
allows,

But ought black sweeps, that are human beasts, to be worser off than black
cows?

Do we go calling about, when it's church time, like the noisy Billingsgate
vermin,

And disturb the parson with "All alive O!" in the middle of a funeral
sermon?

But the fish won't keep, not the mackarel won't, is the cry of the Parliament
elves,

—

Every thing, except the sweeps I think, is to be allowed to keep themselves!
Lord help us! what's to become of us if we mustn't cry no more?
We shan't do for black mutes to go a standing at a death's door.
And we shan't do to emigrate, no not even to the Hottentot nations,
For as time wears on, our black will wear off, and then think of our
situations!
And we should not do, in lieu of black-a-moor footmen, to serve ladies of
quality nimbly,
For when we're drest in our sky-blue and silver, and large frills, all
clean and neat, and white silk stockings, if they pleased to
desire us to sweep the hearth, we couldn't resist the chimbley.

THE CARELESSE NURSE MAYD.

 SAWE a Mayd sitte on a Bank,
Beguiled by Wooer fayne and fond;
And whiles His flatteryng Vowes She drank,
Her Nurselynge slipt within a Pond!

All Even Tide they Talkde and Kist,
For She was fayre and He was Kinde;
The Sunne went down before She wist
Another Sonne had sett behinde!

With angrie Hands and frownyng Browe,
That deemed Her owne the Urchine's Sinne,
She pluckt Him out, but he was nowe
Past being whipt for fallynge in.

She then begins to wayle the Ladde
With Shrikes that Echo answerde round—
O! foolishe Mayd to be soe sadde
The Momente that her Care was drownd!

JARVIS AND MRS. COPE.

A DECIDEDLY SERIOUS BALLAD.

N Bunhill Row, some years ago,
There lived one Mrs. Cope;
A pious woman she was call'd,
As Pius as a Pope.

Not pious in its proper sense,
But chatt'ring like a bird
Of sin and grace—in such a case
Mag-piety's the word.

Cries she, "The Reverend Mr. Trigg
This day a text will broach,
And much I long to hear him preach,
So, Betty, call a coach."

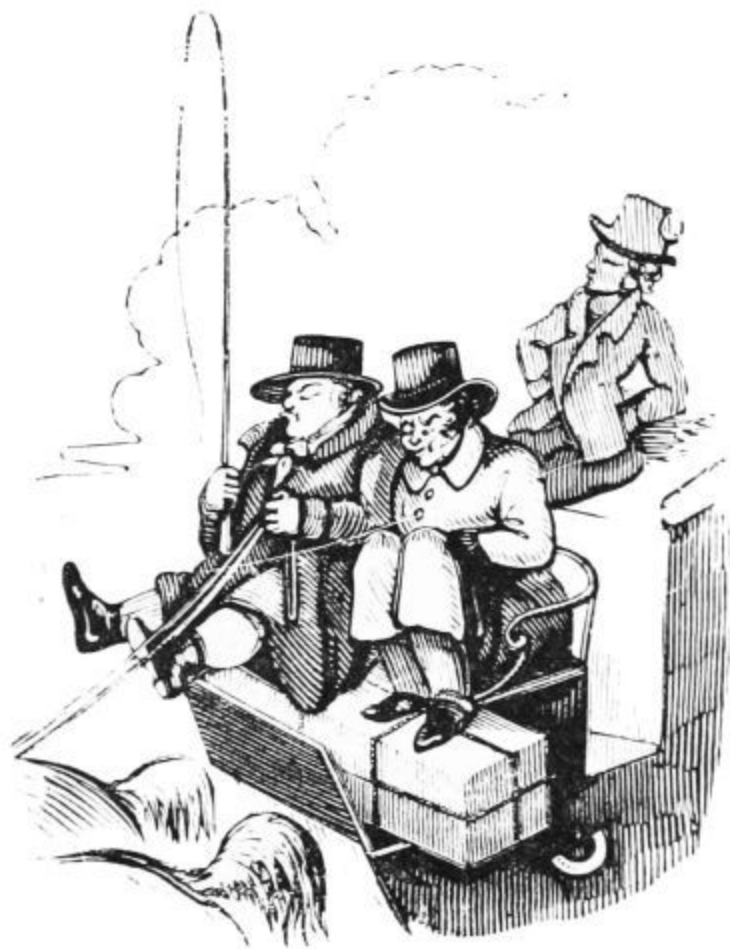
A bargain though she wish'd to make,
Ere they began to jog—
"Now, Coachman, what d'ye take me for?"
Says Coachman, "for a hog."

But Jarvis, when he set her down,
A second *hog* did lack—
Whereas she only offered him
One shilling and "a track."

Said he, "There ain't no tracks in Quaife,
You and your tracks be both—"



“ACCUSTOMED TO THE CARE OF CHILDREN.”



THE BOX SEAT.

And, affidavit-like, he clench'd
Her shilling with an oath.

Said she, "I'll have you fined for this,
And soon it shall be done,
I'll have you up at Worship Street,
You wicked one, naught one!"

And sure enough at Worship Street
That Friday week they stood;
She said *bad* language he had used,
And thus she "*made it good.*"

"He said two shilling was his fare,
And wouldn't take no less—
I said one shilling was enough,—
And he said C—U—S!

"And when I raised my eyes at that,
He swore again at them,
I said he was a wicked man,
And he said D—A—M."

Now Jarvy's turn was come to speak,
So he stroked down his hair,
"All what she says is false—cause why?
I'll swear I never swear!

"There's old Joe Hatch, the waterman,
Can tell you what I am;
I'm one of seven children, all
Brought up without a Dam!

"He'll say from two year old and less
Since ever I were nust,
If ever I said C—U—S,
I wish I may be cust!

“At Sion Cottage I takes up,
And raining all the while,
To go to New Jerusalem,
A wery long two mile.

“Well, when I axes for my fare,
She rows me in the street,
And uses words as is not fit
For coachmen to repeat!

“Says she,—I know where you will go,
You sinner! I know well,—
Your worship, it’s the P—I—T
Of E and double L;”

Now here his worship stopp’d the case—
Said he—I’ll fine you both!
And of the two—why Mrs. Cope’s
I think the biggest oath?”

A LAY OF REAL LIFE.

“Some are born with a wooden spoon in their mouths, and some with a golden ladle.”—
GOLDSMITH.

“Some are born with tin rings in their noses, and some with silver ones.”—
SILVERSMITH.



HO ruined me ere I was born,
Sold every acre, grass or corn,
And left the next heir all forlorn?
My Grandfather.

Who said my mother was no nurse,
And physicked me and made me worse,
Till infancy became a curse?
My Grandfather.

Who left me in my seventh year,
A comfort to my mother dear,
And Mr. Pope, the overseer?
My Father.

Who let me starve, to buy her gin,
Till all my bones came through my skin,
Then called me “ugly little sin?”
My Mother.

Who said my mother was a Turk,
And took me home—and made me work,
But managed half my meals to shirk?
My Aunt.

Who “of all earthly things” would boast,
“He hated other’s brats the most,”
And therefore made me feel my post?
My Uncle.

Who got in scrapes, an endless score,
And always laid them at my door,
Till many a bitter bang I bore?
My Cousin.

Who took me home when mother died,
Again with father to reside,
Black shoes, clean knives, run far and wide?

DICK SHOES, CLEAN KNIVES, FAT FAT AND WIDE:

My Stepmother.

Who marred my stealthy urchin joys,
And when I played cried “What a noise!—
Girls always hector over boys—

My Sister.

Who used to share in what was mine,
Or took it all, did he incline,
‘Cause I was eight, and he was nine?

My Brother.

Who stroked my head, and said “Good lad,”
And gave me sixpence, “all he had;”
But at the stall the coin was bad?

My Godfather.

Who, gratis, shared my social glass,
But when misfortune came to pass,
Referr’d me to the pump? Alas!

My Friend.

Through all this weary world, in brief,
Who ever sympathised with grief,
Or shared my joy—my sole relief?

Myself.

THE LARK AND THE ROOK.

A FABLE.

“Lo! hear the gentle lark!”—SHAKESPEARE.



ONCE on a time—no matter where—
A lark took such a fancy to the air,
That though he often gazed beneath,
Watching the breezy down, or heath,
Yet very, very seldom he was found
To perch upon the ground.
Hour after hour,
Through ev'ry change of weather hard or soft,
Through sun and shade, and wind and show'r,
Still fluttering aloft;
In silence now, and now in song,
Up, up in cloudland all day long,
On weary wing, yet with unceasing flight,
Like to those Birds of Paradise, so rare,
Fabled to live, and love, and feed in air,
But never to alight.

It caused, of course, much speculation
Among the feather'd generation;
Who tried to guess the riddle that was in it—
The robin puzzled at it, and the wren,
The swallows, cock and hen,
The wagtail, and the linnet,
The yellowhammer, and the finch as well—
The sparrow ask'd the tit, who couldn't tell,
The jay, the pie—but all were in the dark,
Till out of patience with the common doubt,
The Rook at last resolved to worm it out,
And thus accosted the mysterious Lark:—

“Friend, prithee, tell me why
You keep this constant hovering so high,
As if you had some castle in the air,
That you are always poisoning there,
A speck against the sky—
Neglectful of each old familiar feature
Of Earth that nursed you in your callow state—

You think you're only soaring at heaven's gate,
Whereas you're flying in the face of Nature!"

"Friend," said the Lark, with melancholy tone,
And in each little eye a dewdrop shone,
"No creature of my kind was ever fonder
Of that dear spot of earth
Which gave it birth—
And I was nestled in the furrow yonder!
Sweet is the twinkle of the dewy heath,
And sweet that thymy down I watch beneath,
Saluted often with a living sonnet:
But Men, vile Men, have spread so thick a scurf
Of dirt and infamy about the Turf,
I do not like to settle on it!"

MORAL.

Alas! how Nobles of another race
Appointed to the bright and lofty way
Too willingly descend to haunt a place
Polluted by the deeds of Birds of Prey!

A NOCTURNAL SKETCH.



VEN is come; and from the dark Park, hark,
The signal of the setting sun—one gun!
And six is sounding from the chime, prime time
To go and see the Drury-Lane Dane slain,—
Or hear Othello's jealous doubt spout out,—
Or Macbeth raving at that shade-made blade,
Denying to his frantic clutch much touch;—
Or else to see Ducrow with wide stride ride
Four horses as no other man can span;
Or in the small Olympic Pit, sit split
Laughing at Liston, while you quiz his phiz.

Anon Night comes, and with her wings brings things,
Such as, with his poetic tongue, Young sung;
The gas up-blazes with its bright white light,
And paralytic watchmen prowl, howl, growl,
About the streets and take up Pall-Mall Sal,
Who, hasting to her nightly jobs, robs fobs.

Now thieves to enter for your cash, smash, crash,
Past drowsy Charley, in a deep sleep, creep,
But frighten'd by Policeman B 3, flee,
And while they're going, whisper low, "No go!"

Now puss, while folks are in their beds, treads leads,
And sleepers waking, grumble—"Drat that cat!"
Who in the gutter caterwauls, squalls, mauls
Some feline foe, and screams in shrill ill-will.

Now Bulls of Bashan, of a prize size, rise
In childish dreams, and with a roar gore poor
Georgy, or Charley, or Billy, willy-nilly;—
But Nursemaid in a nightmare rest, chest-press'd,
Dreameth of one of her old flames, James Games,

And that she hears—what faith is man's—Ann's banns
And his, from Reverend Mr. Rice, twice, thrice:

White ribbons flourish, and a stout shout out,
That upward goes, shows Rose knows those bows' woes!

DOMESTIC ASIDES; OR, TRUTH IN PARENTHESSES.

“I really take it very kind
This visit, Mrs. Skinner!
I have not seen you such an age—
(The wretch has come to dinner!)

“Your daughters, too, what loves of girls—
What heads for painters’ easels!
Come here and kiss the infant, dears,—
(And give it p’rhaps the measles!)

“Your charming boys I see are home
From Reverend Mr. Russel’s;
'Twas very kind to bring them both,—
(What boots for my new Brussels!)

“What! little Clara left at home?
Well, now, I call that shabby:
I should have loved to kiss her so,—
(A flabby, dabby babby!)

“And Mr. S., I hope he’s well;
Ah! though he lives so handy,
He never now drops in to sup,—
(The better for our brandy!)

“Come, take a seat—I long to hear
About Matilda’s marriage;
You’re come of course to spend the day!—
(Thank Heav’n, I hear the carriage!)

“What, must you go? next time I hope
You’ll give me longer measure;
Nay—I shall see you down the stairs—
(With most uncommon pleasure!)

“Good-bye! good-bye! remember all,
Next time you’ll take your dinners!
(Now David mind I’m not at home

(NOW, DAVID, mind I'm not at home
In future to the Skinners!")

JOHN DAY.

A PATHETIC BALLAD.

“A Day after the Fair.”—OLD PROVERB.



JOHN DAY he was the biggest man
Of all the coachman-kind,
With back too broad to be conceived
By any narrow mind.

The very horses knew his weight
When he was in the rear,
And wished his box a Christmas-box
To come but once a year.

Alas! against the shafts of love
What armour can prevail?
Soon Cupid sent an arrow through
His scarlet coat of mail.

The barmaid of the Crown he loved,
From whom he never ranged,
For tho' he changed his horses there,
His love he never changed.

He thought her fairest of all fares,
So fondly love prefers;
And often, among twelve outsides,
Deemed no outside like hers.

One day as she was sitting down
Beside the porter-pump—
He came, and knelt with all his fat,
And made an offer plump.

Said she, my taste will never learn
To like so huge a man,
So I must beg you will come here
As little as you can.

But still he stoutly urged his suit,
With vows, and sighs, and tears,
Yet could not pierce her heart altho'

But could not pierce her heart, and
He drove the Dart for years.

In vain he wooed, in vain he sued;
The maid was cold and proud,
And sent him off to Coventry,
While on his way to Stroud.

He fretted all the way to Stroud,
And thence all back to town;
The course of love was never smooth,
So his went up and down.

At last her coldness made him pine
To merely bones and skin;
But still he loved like one resolved
To love through thick and thin.

Oh, Mary, view my wasted back,
And see my dwindled calf;
Tho' I have never had a wife,
I've lost my better half.

Alas, in vain he still assail'd
Her heart withstood the dint;
Though he had carried sixteen stone
He could not move a flint.

Worn out, at last he made a vow
To break his being's link;
For he was so reduced in size
At nothing he could shrink.

Now some will talk in water's praise
And waste a deal of breath,
But John, tho' he drank nothing else—
He drank himself to death.

The cruel maid that caused his love,

Found out the fatal close,
For, looking in the butt, she saw
The butt-end of his woes.

Some say his spirit haunts the Crown,
But that is only talk—
For after riding all his life,
His ghost objects to walk.

NUMBER ONE.

VERSIFIED FROM THE PROSE OF A YOUNG LADY.

T'S very hard!—and so it is,
To live in such a row,
And witness this that every Miss
But me, has got a Beau.
For Love goes calling up and down,
But here he seems to shun;
I'm sure he has been asked enough
To call at Number One!

I'm sick of all the double knocks
That come to Number Four!
At Number Three, I often see
A Lover at the door:
And one in blue, at Number Two,
Calls daily like a dun,—
It's very hard they come so near,
And not to Number One!

Miss Bell I hear has got a dear
Exactly to her mind,
By sitting at the window pane
Without a bit of blind;
But I go in the balcony,
Which she has never done,
Yet arts that thrive at Number Five
Don't take at Number One!

'Tis hard with plenty in the street,
And plenty passing by,—
There's nice young men at Number Ten,
But only rather shy;
And Mrs. Smith across the way
Has got a grown-up son,
But la! he hardly seems to know
There is a Number One!

There's Mr. Wick at Number Nine,

But he's intent on pelf,
And though he's pious, will not love
His neighbour as himself.
At Number Seven there was a sale—
The goods had quite a run!
And here I've got my single lot
On hand at Number One!

My mother often sits at work
And talks of props and stays,
And what a comfort I shall be
In her declining days.
The very maids about the house
Have set me down a nun;
The sweethearts all belong to them
That call at Number One!

Once only when the flue took fire,
One Friday afternoon,
Young Mr. Long came kindly in
And told me not to swoon:
Why can't he come again without
The Phoenix and the Sun!
We cannot always have a flue
On fire at Number One!

I am not old! I am not plain!
Nor awkward in my gait—
I am not crooked, like the bride
That went from Number Eight:
I'm sure white satin made her look
As brown as any bun—
But even beauty has no chance,
I think, at Number One!

At Number Six they say Miss Rose
Has slain a score of hearts,
And Cupid, for her sake, has been

Quite prodigal of darts.
The Imp they show with bended bow,
I wish he had a gun!
But if he had, he'd never deign
To shoot with Number One.

It's very hard, and so it is,
To live in such a row!
And here's a ballad singer come
To aggravate my woe.
Oh take away your foolish song
And tones enough to stun—
There is "Nae luck about the house,"
I know, at Number One!

THE DROWNING DUCKS.



AMONGST the sights that Mrs. Bond
Enjoyed, yet grieved at more than others—
Were little ducklings in the pond,
Swimming about beside their mothers—
Small things like living water lilies,
But yellow as the daffo-*dillies*.

“It’s very hard,” she used to moan,
“That other people have their ducklings
To grace their waters—mine alone
Have never any pretty chucklings.”
For why!—each little yellow navy
Went down—all downy—to old Davy!

She had a lake—a pond I mean—
It’s wave was rather thick than pearly—
She had two ducks, their napes were green—
She had a drake, his tail was curly,—
Yet spite of drake, and ducks, and pond,
No little ducks had Mrs. Bond!

The birds were both the best of mothers—
The nests had eggs—the eggs had luck—
The infant D.’s came forth like others—
But there, alas! the matter stuck!
They might as well have all died addle,
As die when they began to paddle!

For when, as native instinct taught her,
The mother set her brood afloat,
They sank ere long right under water,
Like any overloaded boat;
They were web-footed too to see,
As ducks and spiders ought to be!

No peccant humour in a gander
Brought havoc on her little folks,—

No poaching cook—a trying pander
To appetite,—destroyed their yolks,—
Beneath her very eyes, Od’ rot ’em!
They went like plummets to the bottom.

The thing was strange—a contradiction
It seemed of nature and her works!
For little ducks, beyond conviction,
Should float without the help of corks:
Great Johnson it bewildered him!
To hear of chicks that could not swim.

Poor Mrs. Bond! what could she do
But change the breed—and she tried divers,
Which dived as all seemed born to do;
No little ones were e’er survivors—
Like those that copy gems, I’m thinking,
They all were given to die-sinking!

In vain their downy coats were shorn:
They floundered still;—Batch after batch went!
The little fools seemed only born
And hatched for nothing but a hatchment!
Whene’er they launched—oh sight of wonder!
Like fires the water “got them under!”

No woman ever gave their lucks
A better chance than Mrs. Bond did;
At last quite out of heart and ducks,
She gave her pond up and desponded;
For Death among the water lilies,
Cried “*Duc ad me,*” to all her dillies.

But though resolved to breed no more,
She brooded often on this riddle—
Alas! twas darker than before!
At last, about the summer’s middle,
What Johnson, Mrs. Bond, or none did,
To clear the matter up the sun did!

To clear the matter up the sun did:

The thirsty Sirius, dog-like, drank
So deep his furious tongue to cool,
The shallow waters sank and sank,
And lo, from out the wasted pool,
Too hot to hold them any longer,
There crawled some eels as big as conger!

I wish all folks would look a bit,
In such a case below the surface;
But when the eels were caught and split
By Mrs. Bond, just think of *her* face,
In each inside at once to spy
A duckling turned to gible pie!

The sight at once explained the case,
Making the Dame look rather silly,
The tenants of that *Eely Place*
Had found the way to *Pick a dilly*,
And so by under-water suction,
Had wrought the little ducks abduction.

DIBDIN MODERNIZED.

I *steamed* from the Downs in the Nancy,
My jib how she *smoked* through the breeze.
She's a vessel as tight to my fancy
As ever *boil'd* through the salt seas.

* * * * *

When up the *flue* the sailor goes
And ventures on the *pot*,
The landsman, he no better knows,
But thinks hard is his lot.

Bold Jack with smiles each danger meets,
Weighs anchor, lights the log;
Trims up the fire, picks out the slates,
And drinks his can of grog.

* * * * *

Go patter to lubbers and swabs, do you see,
'Bout danger, and fear, and the like;
But a *Boulton and Watt* and good *Wall's end* give me;
And it an't too a little I'll strike.

Though the tempest our *chimney* smack smooth shall down smite,
And shiver each *bundle* of wood;
Clear the wreck, *stir the fire*, and stow everything tight,
And *boiling a gallop* we'll scud.

THE STORM

RE-WITTEN.

ARK, the boatswain hoarsely bawling,
By shovel, tongues, and poker stand;
Down the scuttle quick be hauling,
 Down your bellows, hand, boys, hand;
Now it freshens,—blow like blazes;
 Now unto the coal-hole go;
Stir, boys, stir, don't mind black faces,
 Up your ashes nimbly throw.

Ply your bellows, raise the wind, boys,
 See the valve is clear of course;
Let the paddles spin, don't mind, boys,
 Though the weather should be worse.
Fore and aft a proper draft get,
 Oil the engines, see all clear;
Hands up, each a sack of coal get,
 Man the boiler, cheer, lads, cheer.

Now the dreadful thunder's roaring,
 Peal on peal contending clash;
On our heads fierce rain falls pouring,
 In our eyes the paddles splash.
One wide water all around us,
 All above one smoke-black sky:
Different deaths at once surround us;
 Hark! what means that dreadful cry?

The funnel's gone! cries ev'ry tongue out,
 The engineer's washed off the deck;
A leak beneath the coal-hole's sprung out
 Call all hands to clear the wreck.
Quick, some coal, some nubbly pieces;
 Come, my hearts, be stout and bold;
Plumb the boiler, speed decreases,
 Four feet water getting cold.

While o'er the ship wild waves are beating,

We for wives or children mourn;
Alas! from hence there's no retreating;
Alas! to them there's no return.
The fire is out—we've burst the bellows,
The tinder-box is swamped below;
Heaven have mercy on poor fellows,
For only that can serve us now!

I'M NOT A SINGLE MAN.

“Double, single, and the rub.”—HOYLE.

“This, this is Solitude.”—BYRON.

I.



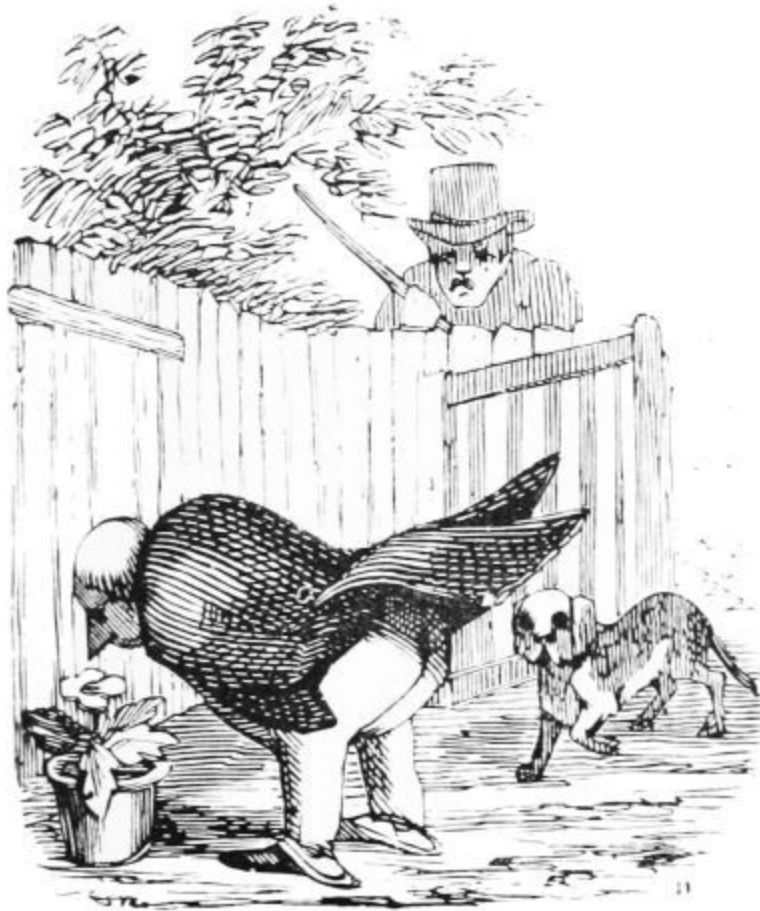
WELL, I confess, I did not guess
A simple marriage vow
Would make me find all womenkind
Such unkind women now!
They need not, sure, as *distant* be
As Javo or Japan,—
Yet every Miss reminds me this—
I'm not a single man!

II.

Once they made choice of my bass voice
To share in each duett;



SEA CONSUMPTION—WAISTING AWAY.



A STRANGE BIRD.

So well I danced, I somehow chanced
To stand in every set:
They now declare I cannot sing,
And dance on Bruin's plan;
Me draw!—me paint!—me anything!—
I'm not a single man!

III.

Once I was asked advice, and task'd
What works to buy or not,
And “would I read that passage out
I so admired in Scott?”
They then could bear to hear one read;
But if I now began,
How they would snub “My pretty page,”
I’m not a single man!

IV.

One used to stitch a collar then,
Another hemmed a frill;
I had more purses netted then
Than I could hope to fill.
I once could get a button on,
But now I never can—
My buttons then were Bachelor’s—
I’m not a single man!

V.

Oh how they hated politics
Thrust on me by papa:
But now my chat—they all leave that
To entertain mamma.
Mamma, who praises her own self,
Instead of Jane or Ann,
And lays “her girls” upon the shelf—
I’m not a single man!

VI.

Ah me, how strange it is the change,
In parlour and in hall!
They treat me so, if I but go
To make a morning call.
If they had hair in papers once,
Bolt up the stairs they ran;
They now sit still in dishabille—
I'm not a single man!

VII.

Miss Mary Bond was once so fond
Of Romans and of Greeks;
She daily sought my cabinet,
To study my antiques.
Well, now she doesn't care a dump
For ancient pot or pan,
Her taste at once is modernised—
I'm not a single man!

VIII.

My spouse is fond of homely life,
And all that sort of thing;
I go to balls without my wife,
And never wear a ring:
And yet each Miss to whom I come,
As strange as Genghis Khan,
Knows by some sign, I can't divine,—
I'm not a single man!

IX.

Go where I will, I but intrude;
I'm left in crowded rooms,
Like Zimmerman on Solitude,
Or Hervey at his tombs.
From head to heel, they make me feel
Of quite another clan;
Compelled to own, though left alone,
I'm not a single man!

X.

Miss Towne the toast, though she can boast
A nose of Roman line,
Will turn up even that in scorn
Of compliments of mine:
She should have seen that I have been
Her sex's partisan,
And really married all I could—
I'm not a single man!

XI.

'Tis hard to see how others fare,
Whilst I rejected stand,—
Will no one take my arm because
They cannot have my hand?
Miss Parry, that for some would go
A trip to Hindostan,
With me don't care to mount a stair—
I'm not a single man!

XII.

Some change, of course, should be in force
But, surely, not so much—
There may be hands I may not squeeze
But must I never touch?—
Must I forbear to hand a chair
And not pick up a fan?
But I have been myself picked up—
I'm not a single man!

XIII.

Others may hint a lady's tint
Is purest red and white—
May say her eyes are like the skies,
So very blue and bright,—
I must not say that she *has eyes*;
Or if I so began,
I have my fears about my ears,—
I'm not a single man!

XIV.

I must confess I did not guess
A simple marriage vow,
Would make me find all women-kind
Such unkind women now;—
I might be hash'd to death, or smash'd
By Mr. Pickford's van,
Without, I fear, a single tear.
I'm not a single man!

THE GHOST.

A VERY SERIOUS BALLAD.

“I’ll be your second.”—LISTON.



AT-TAT it went upon the lion's chin,
"That hat, I know it!" cried the joyful girl:
"Summer's it is, I know him by his knock,
Comers like him are welcome as the day!
Lizzy! go down and open the street-door,
Busy I am to any one but *him*.
Know him you must—he has been often here;
Show him up stairs, and tell him I'm alone."

Quickly the maid went tripping down the stair;
Thickly the heart of Rose Matilda beat;
"Sure he has brought me tickets for the play—
Drury—or Covent Garden—darling man!—
Kemble will play—or Kean who makes the soul
Tremble; in Richard or the frenzied Moor—
Farren, the stay and prop of many a farce
Barren beside—or Liston, Laughter's Child—
Kelly the natural, to witness whom
Jelly is nothing to the public's jam—
Cooper, the sensible—and Walter Knowles
Super, in William Tell—now rightly told.
Better—perchance, from Andrews, brings a box,
Letter of boxes for the Italian stage—
Brocard! Donzelli! Taglioni! Paul!
No card,—thank Heaven—engages me to-night!
Feathers, of course, no turban, and no toque—
Weather's against it, but I'll go in curls.
Dearly I dote on white—my satin dress,
Merely one night—it won't be much the worse—
Cupid—the New Ballet I long to see—
Stupid! why don't she go and ope the door?"
Glisten'd her eye as the impatient girl
Listen'd, low bending o'er the topmost stair.
Vainly, alas! she listens and she bends,
Plainly she hears this question and reply:
"Axes your pardon, Sir, but what d'ye want?"
"Taxes," says he, "and shall not call again!"

✓ ✓ ✓ ✓

OUR VILLAGE.—BY A VILLAGER.



OUR village, that's to say not Miss Mitford's village, but our village of Bullock Smithy,

Is come into by an avenue of trees, three oak pollards, two elders, and a withy;

And in the middle, there's a green of about not exceeding an acre and a half;

It's common to all, and fed off by nineteen cows, six ponies, three horses, five asses, two foals, seven pigs, and a calf!

Besides a pond in the middle, as is held by a similar sort of common law lease,

And contains twenty ducks, six drakes, three ganders, two dead dogs, four drown'd kittens, and twelve geese.

Of course the green's cropt very close, and does famous for bowling when the little village boys play at cricket;

Only some horse, or pig, or cow, or great jackass is sure to come and stand right before the wicket.

There's fifty-five private houses, let alone barns and workshops, and pigsties, and poultry huts, and such-like sheds;

With plenty of public-houses—two Foxes, one Green Man, three Bunch of Grapes, one Crown, and six King's Heads.

The Green Man is reckon'd the best, as the only one that for love or money can raise

A postilion, a blue jacket, two deplorable lame white horses, and a ramshackled "neat post-chaise."

There's one parish church for all the people, whatsoever may be their ranks in life or their degrees,

Except one very damp, small, dark, freezing-cold, little Methodist chapel of Ease;

And close by the church-yard, there's a stone-mason's yard, that when the time is seasonable

Will furnish with afflictions sore and marble urns and cherubims very low and reasonable.

There's a cage, comfortable enough; I've been in it with Old Jack Jeffrey and Tom Pike;

For the Green Man next door will send you in ale, gin, or any thing else you like.

I can't speak of the stocks: as nothing remains of them but the upright post.

I can't speak of the stocks, as nothing remains of them but the upright post,
But the pound is kept in repairs for the sake of Cob's horse, as is always
there almost.

There's a smithy of course, where that queer sort of a chap in his way, Old
Joe Bradley,
Perpetually hammers and stammers, for he stutters and shoes horses very
badly.

There's a shop of all sorts, that sells every thing, kept by the widow of Mr.
Task;

But when you go there it's ten to one she's out of every thing you ask.
You'll know her house by the swarm of boys, like flies, about the old
sugary cask.

There are six empty houses, and not so well paper'd inside as out,
For bill-stickers won't beware, but sticks notices of sales and election
placards all about.

That's the Doctor's with a green door, where the garden pots in the
windows is seen;

A weakly monthly rose that don't blow, and a dead geranium, and a tea-
plant with five black leaves and one green.

As for hollyoaks at the cottage doors, and honeysuckles and jasmines, you
may go and whistle;

But the Tailor's front garden grow two cabbages, a dock, a ha'porth of
pennyroyal, two dandelions, and a thistle.

There are three small orchards—Mr. Busby's the schoolmaster's is the chief
—

With two pear-trees that don't bear; one plum and an apple, that every year
is stripp'd by a thief.

There's another small day-school too, kept by the respectable Mrs. Gaby;
A select establishment, for six little boys and one big, and four little girls
and a baby.

There's a rectory, with pointed gables and strange old chimneys that never
smokes,

For the rector don't live on his living like other Christian sort of folks;

There's a barber's once a week well filled with rough black-bearded shock-
headed churls,

And a window with two feminine men's heads, and two masculine ladies in
false curls;

There's a butcher's and a carpenter's and a plumber's and a small green-

grocer's, and a baker
But he won't bake on a Sunday, and there's a sexton that's a coal-merchant
besides, and an undertaker;
And a toy-shop, but not a whole one, for a village can't compare with the
London shops;
One window sells drums, dolls, kites, carts, bats, Clout's balls, and the other
sells malt and hops.
And Mrs. Brown, in domestic economy not to be a bit behind her betters,
Lets her house to a milliner, a watchmaker, a rat-catcher, a cobbler, lives in
it herself, and it's the post-office for letters.
Now I've gone through all the village—ay, from end to end, save and
except one more house,
But I haven't come to that—and I hope I never shall—and that's the Village
Poor-House!

PAIR'D *NOT* MATCH'D.



F wedded bliss
Bards sing amiss,
I cannot make a song of it;
 For I am small,
 My wife is tall,
And that's the short and long of it.

 When we debate
 It is my fate
To always have the wrong of it;
 For I am small,
 And she is tall,
And that's the short and long of it!

 And when I speak
 My voice is weak,
But hers—she makes a gong of it!
 For I am small,
 And she is tall,
And that's the short and long of it!

 She has, in brief,
 Command in Chief,
And I'm but Aide-de-camp of it;
 For I am small,
 And she is tall,
And that's the short and long of it!

 She gives to me
 The weakest tea,
And takes the whole Souchong of it;
 For I am small,
 And she is tall,
And that's the short and long of it!

 She'll sometimes grip
 My buggy whip,

And make me reel the thong of it;
For I am small
And she is tall,
And that's the short and long of it!

Against my life
She'll take a knife,
Or fork, and dart the prong of it;
For I am small,
And she is tall,
And that's the short and long of it!

I sometimes think
I'll take to drink,
And hector when I'm strong of it;
For I am small,
And she is tall,
And that's the short and long of it!

O, if the bell
Would ring her knell,
I'd make a gay ding-dong of it;
For I am small,
And she is tall,
And that's the short and long of it!



The Buoy at the Nore.



Son and Hair.

THE BOY AT THE NORE.

“Alone I did it!—Boy!”—CORIOLANUS.



SAY, little Boy at the Nore,
Do you come from the small Isle of Man?
Why, your history a mystery must be,—
Come tell us as much as you can,
Little Boy at the Nore!

You live it seems wholly on water,
Which your Gambier calls living in clover;—
But how comes it, if that is the case,
You're eternally half seas over,—
Little Boy at the Nore?

While you ride—while you dance—while you float—
Never mind your imperfect orthography;—
But give us as well as you can,
Your watery auto-biography,
Little Boy at the Nore!

LITTLE BOY AT THE NORE LOQUITOR.

I'm the tight little Boy at the Nore,
In a sort of sea negus I dwells;
Half and half 'twixt saltwater and Port,
I'm reckon'd the first of the swells—
I'm the Boy at the Nore!

I lives with my toes to the flounders,
And watches through long days and nights;
Yet, cruelly eager, men look—
To catch the first glimpse of my lights—
I'm the Boy at the Nore.

I never gets cold in the head,
So my life on salt water is sweet,—
I think I owes much of my health
To being well used to wet feet—
As the Boy at the Nore.

There's one thing, I'm never in debt:
Nay!—I liquidates more than I *oughtor*;^[3]
So the man to beat Cits as goes by,
In keeping the head above water,
Is the Boy at the Nore.

I've seen a good deal of distress,
Lots of Breakers in Ocean's Gazette;
They should do as I do—rise o'er all;
Aye, a good floating capital get,
Like the Boy at the Nore!

I'm a'ter the sailor's own heart,
And cheers him, in deep water rolling;
And the friend of all friends to Jack Junk,
Ben Backstay, Tom Pipes, and Tom Bowling,
Is the Boy at the Nore!

Could I e'er but grow up, I'd be off
For a week to make love with my wheelbarrow.

For a week to make love with my wheedles,
If the tight little boy at the Nore
Could but catch a nice girl at the Needles,
We'd have *two* at the Nore!

They thinks little of sizes on water,
On big waves the tiny one skulks,—
While the river has Men of War on it—
Yes—the Thames is oppressed with Great Hulks,
And the Boy's at the Nore!

But I've done—for the water is heaving
Round my body, as though it would sink it!
And I've been so long pitching and tossing,
That sea-sick—you'd hardly now think it—
Is the Boy at the Nore!

THE SUPPER SUPERSTITION.

A PATHETIC BALLAD.

“Oh flesh, flesh, how art thou fishified!”—MERCUTIO.

I.

’Twas twelve o’clock by Chelsea chimes,
When all in hungry trim,
Good Mister Jupp sat down to sup
With wife, and Kate, and Jim.

II.

Said he, “Upon this dainty cod
How bravely I shall sup,”—
When whiter than the table-cloth,
A GHOST came rising up!

III.

“O, father dear, O, mother dear,
Dear Kate, and brother Jim,—
You know when some one went to sea,—
Don’t cry—but I am him!

IV.

“You hope some day with fond embrace
To greet your absent Jack,
But oh, I am come here to say
I’m never coming back!

V.

“From Alexandria we set sail,
With corn, and oil, and figs,
But steering ‘too much Sow,’ we struck
Upon the Sow and Pigs!

VI.

“The ship we pump’d till we could see
Old England from the tops;
When down she went with all our hands,
Right in the Channel’s Chops.

VII.

“Just give a look in Norey’s chart,
The very place it tells;
I think it says twelve fathom deep,
Clay bottom, mixed with shells.

VIII.

“Well, there we are till ‘hands aloft,’
We have at last a call;
The pug I had for brother Jim,
Kate’s parrot too, and all.

IX.

“But oh, my spirit cannot rest,
In Davy Jones’s sod,
Till I’ve appear’d to you and said,—
Don’t sup on that ‘ere Cod!

X.

“You live on land, and little think
What passes in the sea;
Last Sunday week, at 2 P.M.
That Cod was picking me!

XI.

“Those oysters too, that look so plump,
And seem so nicely done,
They put my corpse in many shells,
Instead of only one.

XII.

“O, do not eat those oysters then,
And do not touch the shrimps;
When I was in my briny grave,
They suck’d my blood like imps!

XIII.

“Don’t eat what brutes would never eat,
The brutes I used to pat,
They’ll know the smell they used to smell;
Just try the dog and cat!”

XIV.

The Spirit fled—they wept his fate,
And cried, Alack, alack!
At last up started brother Jim,
“Let’s try if Jack was Jack!”

XV.

They call'd the Dog, they call'd the Cat,
And little Kitten too,
And down they put the Cod and sauce,
To see what brutes would do.

XVI.

Old Tray lick'd all the oysters up,
Puss never stood at crimps,
But munch'd the Cod—and little Kit
Quite feasted on the shrimps!

XVII.

The thing was odd, and minus Cod
And sauce, they stood like posts;
O, prudent folks, for fear of hoax,
Put no belief in Ghosts!

THE BROKEN DISH.



HAT'S life but full of care and doubt,
With all its fine humanities,
With parasols we walk about,
Long pigtails and such vanities.

We plant pomegranate trees and things
And go in gardens sporting,
With toys and fans of peacocks' wings,
To painted ladies courting.

We gather flowers of every hue,
And fish in boats for fishes,
Build summer-houses painted blue,—
But life's as frail as dishes.

Walking about their groves of trees,
Blue bridges and blue rivers,
How little thought them two Chinese
They'd both be smash'd to shivers.

LITERARY AND LITERAL.



HE March of Mind upon its mighty stilts,
(A spirit by no means to fasten mocks on,)
In travelling through Berks, Beds, Notts, and Wilts,
Hants—Bucks, Herts, Oxon,

Got up a thing our ancestors ne'er thought on,
A thing that, only in our proper youth,
We should have chuckled at—in sober truth,
A *Conversazione* at Hog's Norton!

A place whose native dialect, somehow,
Has always by an adage been affronted,
And that it is all *gutturals*, is now
Taken for grunted.

Conceive the snoring of a greedy swine,
The slobbering of a hungry Ursine Sloth—
If you have ever heard such creature dine—
And—for Hog's Norton, make a mix of both!—

O shades of Shakspeare! Chaucer! Spenser!
Milton! Pope! Gray! Warton!
O Colman! Kenny! Planche! Poole! Peake!
Pocock! Reynolds! Morton!
O Grey! Peel! Sadler! Wilberforce! Burdett!
Hume! Wilmot Horton!
Think of your prose and verse, and worse—delivered in
Hog's Norton!—

The founder of Hog's Norton Athenæum
Framed her society
With some variety
From Mr. Roscoe's Liverpool museum;
Not a mere pic-nic, for the mind's repast,
But tempting to the solid knife-and-forker,
It held its sessions in the house that last
Had killed a porker.

It chanced one Friday,
One Farmer Grayley stuck a very big hog,
A perfect Gog or Magog of a pig-hog,
Which made of course a literary high day,—
Not that our Farmer was a man to go
With literary taste—so far from suiting 'em,
When he heard mention of Professor *Crowe*,
Or *Lalla-Rookh*, he always was for shooting 'em!
In fact in letters he was quite a log,
 With him great Bacon
 Was literally taken.

And Hogg—the Poet—nothing but a Hog!
As to all others on the list of Fame,
Although they were discuss'd and mention'd daily,
He only recognised one classic name,
And thought that *she* had hung herself—*Miss Baillie*!

To balance this, our Farmer's only daughter
Had a great taste for the Castalian water—
A Wordsworth worshipper—a Southey wooer,—
(Though men that deal in water-colour cakes
May disbelieve the fact—yet nothing's truer)
 She got the *bluer*

The more she dipped and dabbled in the *Lakes*.
The secret truth is, Hope, the old deceiver,
At future Authorship was apt to hint,
Producing what some call the *Type-us* Fever,
Which means a burning to be seen in print.

Of learning's laurels—Miss Joanna Baillie—
Of Mrs. Hemans—Mrs. Wilson—daily
Dreamt Anne Priscilla Isabella Grayley;
And Fancy hinting that she had the better
Of L.E.L. by one initial letter,
She thought the world would quite enraptur'd see

“LOVE LAYS AND LYRICS

BY

A P I G.”

Accordingly, with very great propriety,
She joined the H. N. B. and double S.,
That is,—Hog’s Norton Blue Stocking Society;
And saving when her Pa his pigs prohibited,

Contributed

Her pork and poetry towards the mess.
This feast, we said, one Friday was the case,
When farmer Grayley—from Macbeth to quote—
Screwing his courage to the “sticking place,”
Stuck a large knife into a grunter’s throat;—
A kind of murder that the law’s rebuke
Seldom condemns by shake of its peruke,
Showing the little sympathy of *big-wigs*
With *pig-wigs*!

The swine—poor wretch!—with nobody to speak for it,
And beg its life, resolved to have a squeak for it;
So—like the fabled swan—died singing out,
And, thus, there issued from the farmer’s yard
A note that notified without a card,
An invitation to the evening rout.

And when the time came duly,—“At the close of
The day,” as Beattie has it, “when the ham—”
Bacon and pork were ready to dispose of,
And pettitoes and chit’lings too, to cram,—
Walked in the H. N. B. and double S.’s,
All in appropriate and swinish dresses,
For lo! it is a fact, and not a joke,
Although the Muse might fairly jest upon it,
They came—each “Pig-faced Lady,” in that bonnet
We call *a poke*.

The Members all assembled thus, a rare woman
At pork and poetry was chosen *chairwoman*;—
In fact, the bluest of the Blues, Miss Ikey,
Whose whole pronunciation was so piggy,

She always named the authoress of "*Psyche*"—
As Mrs. *Tiggey*!

And now arose a question of some moment,—
What author for a lecture was the richer,
Bacon or Hogg? there were no votes for Beaumont,
But some for *Flitcher*;
While others, with a more sagacious reasoning,
Proposed another work,
And thought their pork
Would prove more relishing from Thomson's Season-ing!

But practised in Shakspearian readings daily,—
O! Miss Macaulay! Shakspeare at Hog's Norton!—
Miss Anne Priscilla Isabella Grayley
Selected *him* that evening to snort on.
In short, to make our story not a big tale,
Just fancy her exerting
Her talents, and converting
The Winter's Tale to something like a pig-tale!
Her sister auditory
All sitting round, with grave and learned faces,
Were very plauditory,
Of course, and clapped her at the proper places.

Till fanned at once by fortune and the Muse,
She thought herself the blessedest of Blues.
But Happiness, alas! has blights of ill,
And Pleasure's bubbles in the air explode;—
There is no travelling through life but still
The heart will meet with breakers on the road!

With that peculiar voice
Heard only from Hog's Norton throats and noses,
Miss G., with Perdita, was making choice
Of buds and blossoms for her summer posies,
When coming to that line, where Proserpine
Lets fall her flowers from the wain of Dis;

Imagine this—
Uprose on his hind legs old Farmer Grayley,
Grunting this question for the club's digestion,
“Do *Dis's Waggon* go from the Ould Bääley?”

THE SUB-MARINE.

T was a brave and jolly wight,
His cheek was baked and brown,
For he had been in many climes
With captains of renown,
And fought with those who fought so well
At Nile and Camperdown.

His coat it was a soldier coat,
Of red with yellow faced,
But (merman-like) he look'd marine
All downward from the waist;
His trowsers were so wide and blue,
And quite in sailor taste!

He put the rummer to his lips,
And drank a jolly draught;
He raised the rummer many times—
And ever as he quaff'd,
The more he drank the more the ship
Seem'd pitching fore and aft!

The ship seem'd pitching fore and aft,
As in a heavy squall;
It gave a lurch and down he went,
Head-foremost in his fall!
Three times he did not rise, alas!
He never rose at all!

But down he went, right down at once
Like any stone he dived,
He could not see, or hear, or feel—
Of senses all deprived!
At last he gave a look around
To see where he arrived!

And all that he could see was green,
Sea-green on every hand!

A

And then he tried to sound beneath,
And all he felt was sand!
There he was fain to lie, for he
Could neither sit nor stand!

And lo! above his head there bent
A strange and staring lass;
One hand was in her yellow hair,
The other held a glass;
A mermaid she must surely be
If ever mermaid was!

Her fish-like mouth was open'd wide,
Her eyes were blue and pale,
Her dress was of the ocean green,
When ruffled by a gale;
Thought he "beneath that petticoat
She hides a salmon-tail!"

She look'd as siren ought to look,
A sharp and bitter shrew,
To sing deceiving lullabies
For mariners to rue,—
But when he saw her lips apart,
It chill'd him through and through!

With either hand he stopp'd his ears
Against her evil cry;
Alas, alas, for all his care,
His doom it seem'd to die,
Her voice went ringing through his head
It was so sharp and high!

He thrust his fingers farther in
At each unwilling ear,
But still in very spite of all,
The words were plain and clear;
"I can't stand here the whole day long,
To hold your glass of beer!"

to hold your glass of beer:

With open'd mouth and open'd eyes,
Up rose the Sub-marine,
And gave a stare to find the sands
And deeps where he had been:
There was no siren with her glass
No waters ocean-green!

The wet deception from his eyes
Kept fading more and more,
He only saw the bar-maid stand
With pouting lip before—
The small green parlour of the Ship,
And little sanded floor.

THE LAMENT OF TOBY,

THE LEARNED PIG.

“A little learning is a dangerous thing.”—POPE.



HEAVY day! O day of woe!
To misery a poster,
Why was I ever farrow'd—why
Not spitted for a roaster?

In this world, pigs, as well as men,
Must dance to fortune's fiddlings,
But must I give the classics up,
For barley-meal and middlings?

Of what avail that I could spell
And read, just like my betters,
If I must come to this at last,
To litters, not to letters?

O, why are pigs made scholars of?
It baffles my discerning,
What griskens, fry, and chitterlings
Can have to do with learning.

Alas! my learning once drew cash,
But public fame's unstable,
So I must turn a pig again,
And fatten for the table.

To leave my literary line
My eyes get red and leaky;
But Giblett doesn't want me *blue*,
But red and white, and streaky.

Old Mullins used to cultivate
My learning like a gard'ner;
But Giblett only thinks of lard,
And not of Doctor Lardner!

He does not care about my brain
The value of two coppers,
All that he thinks about my head

And that he thinks about my head
Is, how I'm off for choppers.

Of all my literary kin
A farewell must be taken,
Good-bye to the poetic Hogg!
The philosophic Bacon!

Day after day my lessons fade,
My intellect gets muddy;
A trough I have, and not a desk,
A sty—and not a study!

Another little month, and then
My progress ends like Bunyan's;
The seven sages that I loved
Will be chopp'd up with onions!

Then over head and ears in brine
They'll souse me, like a salmon,
My mathematics turn to brawn,
My logic into gammon.

My Hebrew will all retrograde,
Now I'm put up to fatten;
My Greek, it will all go to grease;
The Dogs will have my Latin!

Farewell to Oxford!—and to Bliss!
To Milman, Crowe, and Glossop,—
I now must be content with chats,
Instead of learned gossip!

Farewell to "Town!" farewell to "Gown!"
I've quite outgrown the latter,—
Instead of Trencher-cap my head
Will soon be in a platter!

O why did I at Brazen-Nose

Rout up the roots of knowledge?
A butcher that can't read will kill
A pig that's been to college!

For sorrow I could stick myself,
But conscience is a clasher;
A thing that would be rash in man,
In me would be a rasher!

One thing I ask when I am dead,
And past the Stygian ditches—
And that is, let my schoolmaster
Have one of my two flitches:

'Twas he who taught my letters so
I ne'er mistook or miss'd 'em,
Simply by *ringing* at the nose,
According to Bell's system.

MY SON AND HEIR.

I.



Y mother bids me bind my heir,
But not the trade where I should
bind;
To place a boy—the how and where—
It is the plague of parent-kind!

II.

She does not hint the slightest plan,
Nor what indentures to endorse;
Whether to bind him to a man,—
Or, like Mazeppa, to a horse.

III.

What line to choose of likely rise,
To something in the Stocks at last,—
“Fast bind, fast find,” the proverb cries,
I find I cannot bind so fast!

IV.

A Statesman James can never be;
A Tailor?—there I only learn
His chief concern is cloth, and he
Is always cutting his concern.

V.

A Seedsman?—I'd not have him so;
A Grocer's plum might disappoint;
A Butcher?—no, not that—although
I hear “the times are out of joint!”

VI.

Too many of all trades there be,
Like Pedlars, each has such a pack;
A merchant selling coals?—we see
The buyer send to cellar back.

VII.

A Hardware dealer?—that might please,
But if his trade's foundation leans
On spikes and nails, he won't have ease
When he retires upon his means.

VIII.

A Soldier?—there he has not nerves;
A Sailor seldom lays up pelf:
A Baker?—no, a baker serves
His customer before himself.

IX.

Dresser of hair?—that's not the sort;
A joiner jars with his desire—
A Churchman?—James is very short,
And cannot to a church aspire.

X.

A Lawyer?—that's a hardish term!
A Publisher might give him ease,
If he could into Longman's firm
Just plunge at once "in medias Rees."

XI.

A shop for pot, and pan, and cup,
Such brittle Stock I can't advise;
A Builder running houses up,
Their gains are stories—maybe lies!

XII.

A Coppersmith I can't endure—
Nor petty Usher A, B, C-ing;
A Publican? no father, sure,
Would be the author of his being!

XIII.

A Paper-maker?—come he must
To rags before he sells a sheet—
A Miller?—all his toil is just
To make a meal—he does not eat.

XIV.

A Currier?—that by favour goes—
A Chandler gives me great misgiving—
An Undertaker?—one of those
That do not hope to get their living!

XV.

Three Golden Balls?—I like them not;
An Auctioneer I never did—
The victim of a slavish lot,
Obliged to do as he is bid!

XVI.

A Broker watching fall and rise
Of Stock?—I'd rather deal in stone,—
A Printer?—there his toils comprise
Another's work beside his own.

XVII.

A Cooper?—neither I nor Jem
Have any taste or turn for that,—
A fish-retailer?—but with him,
One part of trade is always flat.

XVIII.

A Painter?—long he would not live,—
An Artist's a precarious craft—
In trade Apothecaries give,
But very seldom take, a draught.

XIX.

A Glazier?—what if he should smash!
A Crispin he shall not be made—
A Grazier may be losing cash,
Although he drives a "roaring trade."

XX.

Well, something must be done! to look
On all my little works around—
James is too big a boy, like book,
To leave upon the shelf unbound.

XXI.

But what to do?—my temples ache
From evening's dew till morning's pearl,
What course to take my boy to make—
Oh could I make my boy—a girl!

CLUBS,

TURNUED UP BY A FEMALE HAND.

“Clubs! Clubs! part 'em! part 'em! Clubs! Clubs!”—ANCIENT CRIES OF LONDON.



Of all the modern schemes of Man,
That time has brought to bear,
A plague upon the wicked plan
That parts the wedded pair!
My female friends they all agree
They hardly know their hubs;
And heart and voice unite with me,
“We hate the name of Clubs!”

One selfish course the Wretches keep;
They come at morning chimes,
To snatch a few short hours of sleep—
Rise—breakfast—read the Times—
Then take their hats, and post away,
Like Clerks or City scrubs,
And no one sees them all the day,—
They live, eat, drink, at Clubs!

On what they say, and what they do,
They close the Club-House gates;
But one may guess a speech or two,
Though shut from their debates:
“The Cook’s a *hasher*—nothing more—
The Children noisy grubs—
A Wife’s a quiz, and home’s a bore”—
Yes,—that’s the style at Clubs!

With Rundle, Dr. K., or Glasse,
And such Domestic Books,
They once put up—but now, alas!
It’s hey! for foreign cooks!
“When *will* you dine at home, my Dove?”
I say to Mister Stubbs,—
“When Cook can make an omelette, love,—
An omelette like the Clubs!”

Time was, their hearts were only placed

On snug domestic schemes,
The book for two—united taste,—
And such connubial dreams,—
Friends dropping in at close of day
To singles, doubles, rubs,—
A little music—then the tray—
And not a word of Clubs!

But former comforts they condemn;
French kickshaws they discuss,
They take their wine, the wine takes them,
And then they favour us:—
From some offence they can't digest,
As cross as bears with cubs,
Or sleepy, dull, and queer, at best—
That's how they come from Clubs!

It's very fine to say "Subscribe
To Andrews'—can't you read?"
When Wives, the poor neglected tribe,
Complain how they proceed!
They'd better recommend at once
Philosophy and tubs,—
A woman need not be a dunce
To feel the wrong of Clubs.

A set of savage Goths and Picts,
Would seek us now and then—
They're pretty pattern-Benedicts
To guide our single men!
Indeed my daughters both declare
"Their Beaux shall not be subs.
To White's, or Black's, or anywhere,—
They've seen enough of Clubs!"

They say, "*without* the marriage ties,
They can devote their hours
To catechize or botanize—

Shells, Sunday Schools, and flow'rs—
Or teach a Pretty Poll new words,
Tend Covent-Garden shrubs,
Nurse dogs and chirp to little birds—
As Wives do since the Clubs."

Alas! for those departed days
Of social wedded life,
When married folks had married ways,
And lived like Man and Wife!
Oh! Wedlock then was pick'd by none—
As safe a lock as Chubb's!
But couples, that should be as one,
Are now the Two of Clubs!

Of all the modern schemes of man
That time has brought to bear,
A plague upon the wicked plan
That parts the wedded pair!
My female friends they all allow
They meet with slights, and snubs,
And say, "They have no husbands now,—
They're married to their Clubs!"

THE UNITED FAMILY.

“We stick at nine.”—MRS. BATTLE.

“Thrice to thine
And thrice to mine,
And thrice again,
To make up nine.”

—*The Weird Sisters in Macbeth.*



HOW oft in families intrudes
The demon of domestic feuds,
One liking this, one hating that,
Each snapping each, like dog and cat,
With divers bents and tastes perverse,
One's bliss, in fact, another's curse.
How seldom anything we see
Like our united family!

Miss Brown of chapels goes in search,
Her sister Susan likes the church;
One plays at cards, the other don't;
One will be gay, the other won't:
In pray'r and preaching one persists,
The other sneers at Methodists;
On Sundays ev'n they can't agree
Like our united family.

There's Mr. Bell, a Whig at heart,
His lady takes the Tories' part,
While William, junior, nothing loth,
Spouts Radical against them both.
One likes the News, one takes the Age,
Another buys the unstamped page;
They all say *I*, and never *we*,
Like our united family.

Not so with us;—with equal zeal
We all support Sir Robert Peel;



LOVE AND A COTTAGE.



SINGLE BLESSEDNESS.

Of Wellington our mouths are full,
We dote on Sundays on John Bull,
With Pa and Ma on selfsame side,
Our house has never to divide—
No opposition members be
In our united family.

Miss Pope her “Light Guitar” enjoys,
Her father “cannot bear the noise,”
Her mother’s charm’d with all her songs,
Her brother jangles with the tongs.
Thus discord out of music springs,
The most unnatural of things,
Unlike the genuine harmony
In our united family!

We *all* on vocal music dote;
To each belongs a tuneful throat,
And all prefer that Irish boon
Of melody—“The Young May Moon”—
By choice we all select the harp,
Nor is the voice of one too sharp,
Another flat—all in one key
Is our united family.

Miss Powell likes to draw and paint,
But then it would provoke a saint,
Her brother takes her sheep for pigs,
And says her trees are periwigs.
Pa praises all, black, blue, or brown;
And so does Ma—but upside down!
They cannot with the same eye see,
Like our united family.

Miss Patterson has been to France,
Her heart’s delight is in a dance;
The thing her brother cannot bear,

So she must practise with a chair.
Then at a waltz her mother winks;
But Pa says roundly what he thinks,
All dos-à-dos, not vis-à-vis,
Like our united family.

We none of us that whirling love,
Which both our parents disapprove,
A hornpipe we delight in more,
Or graceful Minuet de la Cour—
A special favourite with Mamma,
Who used to dance it with Papa,
In this we still keep step, you see,
In our united family.

Then books—to bear the Cobb's debates!
One worships Scott—another hates,
Monk Lewis Ann fights stoutly for,
And Jane likes "Bunyan's Holy War."
The father on Macculloch pores,
The mother says *all* books are bores;
But blue serene as heav'n are we,
In our united family.

We never wrangle to exalt
Scott, Banim, Bulwer, Hope, or Galt,
We care not whether Smith or Hook,
So that a novel be the book,
And in one point we all are fast,
Of novels we prefer the last,—
In that the very heads agree
Of our united family!

To turn to graver matters still,
How much we see of sad self-will!
Miss Scrope, with brilliant views in life,
Would be a poor lieutenant's wife.
A lawyer has her Pa's good word,

Her Ma has looked her out a Lord,
What would they not all give to be
Like our united family!

By one congenial taste allied,
Our dreams of bliss all coincide,
We're all for solitudes and cots,
And love, if we may choose our lots.
As partner in the rural plan
Each paints the same dear sort of man;
One heart alone there seems to be
In our united family.

One heart, one hope, one wish, one mind,—
One voice, one choice, all of a kind,—
And can there be a greater bliss—
A little heav'n on earth—than this?
The truth to whisper in your ear,
It must be told!—we are not near
The happiness that ought to be
In our united family!

Alas! 'tis our congenial taste
That lays our little pleasures waste—
We all delight, no doubt, to sing,
We all delight to touch the string,
But where's the heart that nine may touch?
And nine "May Moons" are eight too much—
Just fancy nine, all in one key,
Of our united family!

The play—Oh how we love a play,
But half the bliss is shorn away;
On winter nights we venture nigh,
But think of houses in July!
Nine crowded in a private box,
Is apt to pick the stiffest locks—
Our curls would all fall out, though we

Are united family!

Are one united family!

In art the self-same line we walk,
We all are fond of heads in chalk,
We one and all our talent strain
Adelphi prizes to obtain;
Nine turban'd Turks are duly sent,
But can the royal Duke present
Nine silver palettes—no, not he—
To our united family.

Our eating shows the very thing,
We all prefer the liver-wing,
Asparagus when scarce and thin,
And peas directly they come in,
The marrow-bone—if there be one—
The ears of hare when crisply done,
The rabbit's brain—we all agree
In our united family.

In dress the same result is seen,
We all so doat on apple-green;
But nine in green would seem a school
Of charity to quizzing fool—
We cannot all indulge our will
With “that sweet silk on Ludgate Hill,”
No *remnant* can sufficient be
For our united family.

In reading hard is still our fate,
One cannot read o'erlooked by eight,
And nine “Disowned”—nine “Pioneers,”
Nine “Chaperons,” nine “Buccaneers,”
Nine “Maxwells,” nine “Tremaines,” and such,
Would dip into our means too much—
Three months are spent o'er volumes three,
In our united family.

Thou art the Muse of the Nine

Unhappy Muses: if the Nine
Above in doom with us combine,—
In vain we breathe the tender flame,
Our sentiments are all the same,
And nine complaints address'd to Hope
Exceed the editorial scope,
One in, and eight *put out*, must be
Of our united family!

But this is nought—of deadlier kind,
A ninefold woe remains behind.
O why were we so art and part?
So like in taste, so one in heart?
Nine cottages may be to let,
But here's the thought to make us fret,
We cannot each add Frederick B.
To our united family.

THE DEAD ROBBERY.

“Here’s that will sack a city.”—HENRY THE IVTH.



O'f all the causes that induce mankind
To strike against themselves a mortal docket,
Two eminent above the rest we find—
To be in love, or to be out of pocket:
Both have made many melancholy martyrs,
But p'rhaps, of all the felonies de se,
By ponds, and pistols, razors, ropes, and garters,
Two-thirds have been through want of £. s. d.!

Thus happen'd it with Peter Bunce;
Both in the *dumps* and out of them at once,
From always drawing blanks in Fortune's lottery,
At last, impatient of the light of day,
He made his mind up to return his clay
Back to the pottery.

Feigning a raging tooth that drove him mad,
From twenty divers druggists' shops
He begg'd enough of laudanum by drops
T' effect the fatal purpose that he had;
He drank them, died, and while old Charon ferried him,
The Coroner convened a dozen men,
Who found his death was *phial*-ent—and then
The Parish buried him!
Unwatch'd, unwept,
As commonly a Pauper sleeps, he slept;
There could not be a better opportunity
For bodies to steal a body so ill kept,
With all impunity.

In fact, when Night o'er human vice and folly
Had drawn her very necessary curtains,
Down came a fellow with a sack and spade,
Accustom'd many years to drive a trade,
With that Anatomy more Melancholy
Than Burton's!

The Watchman in his box was dozing;
The Sexton drinking at the Cheshire Cheese;

No fear of any creature interposing,
The human Jackal work'd away at ease:
 He toss'd the mould to left and right,
 The shabby coffin came in sight,
And soon it open'd to his double-knocks,—
When lo! the stiff'un that he thought to meet,
Starts sudden up, like Jacky-in-a-box,
 Upon his seat!
 Awaken'd from his trance,
For so the laudanum had wrought by chance,
Bunce stares up at the moon, next looking level,
He spies a shady Figure, tall and bony,
Then shudders out these words "Are—you—the—Devil?"
"The Devil a bit of him," says Mike Mahoney,
"I'm only com'd here, hoping no affront,
To pick up honestly a little blunt—"
"Blunt!" echoes Bunce, with a hoarse croak of laughter,—
"Why, man, I turn'd life's candle in the socket,
 Without a rap in either pocket,
For want of that same blunt you're looking after!"
"That's true," says Mike, "and many a pretty man
Has cut his stick upon your very plan,
Not worth a copper, him and all his trumps,
And yet he's fetch'd a dacent lot of stuff,
Provided he was sound and fresh enough,
 And dead as dumps."
"I take," quoth Bunce, with a hard wink, "the fact is,
You mean a subject for a surgeon's practice,—
I hope the question is not out of reason,
But just suppose a lot of flesh and bone,
 For instance, like my own,
What might it chance to fetch now, at this season?"
"Fetch, is it?" answers Mike, "why prices differ,—
But taking this same small bad job of ours,
 I reckon, by the pow'rs!
I've lost ten pound by your not being stiffer!"

"Ten pounds!" Bunce echoes in a sort of flurry

Ten pounds. Bunce echoes in a sort of hurry,

“Odd zounds!

Ten pounds,

How sweet it sounds,

Ten pounds!”

And on his feet upspringing in a hurry—

It seem’d the operation of a minute—

A little scuffle—then a whack—

And then he took the Body Snatcher’s sack

And poked him in it!

Such is this life!

A very pantomime for tricks and strife!

See Bunce, so lately in Death’s passive stock,

Invested, now as active as a griffin,

Walking—no ghost—in velveteens and smock,

To sell a stiff’un!

A flash of red, then one of blue,

At last, like lighthouse, came in view;

Bunce rang the nightbell; wiped his highlows muddy;

His errand told; the sack produced;

And by a sleepy boy was introduced

To Dr. Oddy, writing in his study

The bargain did not take long time to settle,

“Ten pounds,

Odd zounds!

How well it sounds,

Ten pounds,”

Chink’d into Bunce’s palm in solid metal.

With joy half-crazed,

It seem’d some trick of sense, some airy gammon,

He gazed and gazed,

At last, possess’d with the old lust of Mammon,

Thought he, “With what a very little trouble,

This little capital I now might double——”

Another scuffle of its usual brevity,—

And Doctor Oddy, in his suit of black,

Was finishing, within the sack,

“Ten pounds, Bunce echoes in a sort of hurry,

His "Thoughts upon Longevity!"

The trick was done. Without a doubt,
The sleepy boy let Bunce and burthen out;
Who coming to a lone convenient place,
The body stripp'd; hid all the clothes; and then,
Still favoured by the luck of evil men,
Found a new customer in Dr. Case.
All more minute particulars to smother,
Let it suffice,
Nine guineas was the price
For which one doctor bought the other;
As once I heard a Preacher say in Guinea,
"You see how one black sin bring on anudder,
Like little nigger pickaninny,
A-riding pick-a-back upon him mudder!"
"Humph!" said the Doctor, with a smile sarcastic,
Seeming to trace
Some likeness in the face,
"So death at last has taken old Bombastic!"
But in the very middle of his joking,—
The *subject*, still unconscious of the scoff—
Seized all at once with a bad fit of choking,
He too was *taken of*!
Leaving a fragment "On the Hooping Cough."

Satan still sending luck,
Another body found another buyer:
For ten pounds ten the bargain next was struck,
Dead doctors going higher.
"Here," said the purchaser, with smile quite pleasant,
Taking a glimpse at his departed brother,
"Here's half a guinea in the way of present—
Subjects are scarce, and when you get another,
Let *me* be first."—Bunce took him at his word,
And suddenly his old atrocious trick did,
Sacking M.D. the third,
Ere he could furnish "Hints to the Afflicted."

Flush'd with success,
Beyond all hope or guess,
His new dead robbery upon his back,
Bunce plotted—such high flights ambition takes,—
To treat the Faculty like ducks and drakes,
And sell them all ere they could utter “Quack!”
But fate opposed. According to the schools,
When men become insufferably bad,
The gods confer to drive them mad;
March hairs upon the heads of April fools!
Tempted by the old demon avaricious,
Bunce traded on too far into the morning;
Till nods, and winks, and looks, and signs suspicious,
Ev'n words malicious,
Forced on him rather an unpleasant warning.
Glad was he to perceive, beside a wicket,
A porter, ornamented with a ticket,
Who did not seem to be at all too busy—
“Here, my good man,
Just show me, if you can,
A doctor's—if you want to earn a tizzy!”

Away the porter marches,
And with grave face, obsequious precedes him,
Down crooked lanes, round corners, under arches;
At last, up an old-fashion'd staircase leads him,
Almost impervious to the morning ray,
Then shows a door—“There, that's a doctor's reckon'd,
A rare Top-Sawyer, let who will come second—
Good day.”

“I'm right,” thought Bunce, “as any trivet;
Another venture—and then up I give it!”
He rings—the door, just like a fairy portal,
Opens untouch'd by mortal——
He gropes his way into a dingy room,
And hears a voice come growling through the gloom,

“Well—eh?—Who? What?—Speak out at once!”

“I will,” says Bunce.

“I’ve got a sort of article to sell;

Medical gemmen knows me very well—”

But think Imagination how it shock’d her

To hear the voice roar out, “Death! Devil! d—n!

Confound the vagabond, he thinks I am

A rhubarb-and-magnesia Doctor!”

“No Doctor!” exclaim’d Bunce, and dropp’d his jaw,

But louder still the voice began to bellow,

“Yes,—yes,—odd zounds!—I *am* a Doctor, fellow,

At law!”

The word sufficed.—Of things Bunce feared the most

(Next to a ghost)

Was law,—or any of the legal corps,—

He dropp’d at once his load of flesh and bone,

And, caring for no body, save his own,

Bolted,—and lived securely till fourscore,

From never troubling Doctors any more!

A PARENTAL ODE TO MY SON, AGED THREE YEARS AND FIVE
MONTHS.



THOU happy, happy elf!
(But stop,—first let me kiss away that tear)

Thou tiny image of myself!
(My love, he's poking peas into his ear!)
Thou merry, laughing sprite!
With spirits feather-light,
Untouch'd by sorrow, and unsoil'd by sin—
(Good heavn's! the child is swallowing a pin!)
Thou little tricky Puck!
With antic toys so funnily bestuck,
Light as the singing bird that wings the air—
(The door! the door! he'll tumble down the stair!)
Thou darling of thy sire!
(Why, Jane! he'll set his pinafore a-fire!)
Thou imp of mirth and joy!
In Love's dear chain so strong and bright a link,
Thou idol of thy parents—(Drat the boy!
There goes my ink!)

Thou cherub—but of earth;
Fit playfellow for Fays, by moonlight pale,
In harmless sport and mirth,
(That dog will bite him if he pulls its tail!)

Thou human humming-bee, extracting hone
From ev'ry blossom in the world that blows,
Singing in Youth's Elysium ever sunny,
(Another tumble!—that's his precious nose!)

Thy father's pride and hope!
(He'll break the mirror with that skipping-rope!)



ARTHUR'S SEAT.



A TOTAL ECLIPSE OF THE SON.

With pure heart newly stamp'd from Nature's mint—
(Where *did* he learn that squint?)

Thou young domestic dove!
(He'll have that jug off, with another shove!)
Dear nurseling of the hymeneal nest!
(Are those torn clothes his best?)
Little epitome of man!
(He'll climb upon the table, that's his plan!)
Touched with the beauteous tints of dawning life—
(He's got a knife!)

Thou enviable being!
No storms, no clouds, in thy blue sky foreseeing,
Play on, play on,
My elfin John!
Toss the light ball—bestride the stick—
(I knew so many cakes would make him sick!)
With fancies, buoyant as the thistle-down,
Prompting the face grotesque, and antic brisk,
With many a lamb-like frisk,
(He's got the scissors, snipping at your gown!)

Thou pretty opening rose!
(Go to your mother, child, and wipe your nose!)
Balmy and breathing music like the South,
(He really brings my heart into my mouth!)
Fresh as the morn, and brilliant as its star,—
(I wish that window had an iron bar!)
Bold as the hawk, yet gentle as the dove,
(I tell you what, my love,
I cannot write unless he's sent above!)

A SERENADE.

“Lullaby, oh, lullaby!”
Thus I heard a father cry,
“Lullaby, oh, lullaby!”
The brat will never shut an eye;
Hither come, some power divine!
Close his lids or open mine!”

“Lullaby, oh, lullaby!”
What the devil makes him cry?
“Lullaby, oh, lullaby!”
Still he stares—I wonder why?
Why are not the sons of earth
Blind, like puppies, from the birth?

“Lullaby, oh, lullaby!”
Thus I heard the father cry;
“Lullaby, oh, lullaby!”
Mary, you must come and try!—
Hush, oh, hush, for mercy’s sake—
The more I sing, the more you wake!”

“Lullaby, oh, lullaby!”
Fie, you little creature, fie;
Lullaby, oh, lullaby!
Is no poppy-syrup nigh?
Give him some, or give him all,
I am nodding to his fall!”

“Lullaby, oh, lullaby!”
Two such nights, and I shall die!
Lullaby, oh, lullaby!
He’ll be bruised, and so shall I,—
How can I from bedposts keep,
When I’m walking in my sleep?”

“Lullaby, oh, lullaby!”
Sleep his very looks deny—
“ ” “ ” “ ” “ ”

Lullaby, on, lullaby!
Nature soon will stupify—
My nerves relax,—my eyes grow dim—
Who's that fallen—me or him?"

AN INCENDIARY SONG.

OME, all conflagrating fellows,
Let us have a glorious rig:
Sing old Rose, and burn the bellows!
Burn me, but I'll burn my wig!

Christmas time is all before us:
Burn all puddings, north and south.
Burn the Turkey—Burn the Devil!
Burn snap-dragon! burn your mouth!

Burn the coals! they're up at sixty!
Burn Burn's Justice—burn Old Coke.
Burn the chestnuts! Burn the shovel!
Burn a fire, and burn the smoke!

Burn burnt almonds. Burn burnt brandy.
Let all burnings have a turn.
Burn Chabert, the Salamander,—
Burn the man that wouldn't burn!

Burn the old year out, don't ring it;
Burn the one that must begin.
Burn Lang Syne; and, whilst you're burning,
Burn the burn he paidled in.

Burn the boxing! Burn the Beadle!
Burn the baker! Burn his man!
Burn the butcher—Burn the dustman,
Burn the sweeper, if you can!

Burn the Postman! burn the postage,
Burn the knocker—burn the bell!
Burn the folks that come for money!
Burn the bills—and burn 'em well.

Burn the Parish! Burn the rating!
Burn all taxes in a mass.
Burn the paving! Burn the lightning!

Burn the Tallow. Burn the lightning.
Burn the burners! Burn the gas!

Burn all candles, white or yellow—
Burn for war, and not for peace;
Burn the Czar of all the Tallow!
Burn the King of all the Greece!

Burn all canthers—burn in Smithfield.
Burn Tea-Total hum and bug.
Burn his kettle, burn his water,
Burn his muffin, burn his mug!

Burn the breeks of meddling vicars,
Picking holes in Anna's Urns!
Burn all Steers's Opodeldoc,
Just for being good for burns.

Burn all Swindlers! Burn Asphaltum!
Burn the money-lenders down—
Burn all schemes that burn one's fingers!
Burn the Cheapest House in town!

Burn all bores and boring topics;
Burn Brunel—aye, in his hole!
Burn all *subjects* that are Irish!
Burn the niggers black as coal!

Burn all Boz's imitators!
Burn all tales without a head!
Burn a candle near the curtain!
Burn your Burns, and burn your bed!

Burn all wrongs that won't be righted,
Poor poor Soup, and Spanish claims—
Burn that Bell, and burn his Vixen!
Burn all sorts of burning shames!

Burn the Whigs! and burn the Tories!

Burn all parties, great and small!
Burn that everlasting Poynder—
Burn his Suttees once for all!

Burn the fop that burns tobacco.
Burn a Critic that condemns.—
Burn Lucifer and all his matches!
Burn the fool that burns the Thames!

Burn all burning agitators—
Burn all torch-parading elves!
And oh! burn Parson Stephen's speeches,
If they haven't burnt themselves.

COPY.

A NEW SPECIES OF POETRY.

 F I were used to writing verse,
And had a Muse not so perverse,
But prompt at Fancy's call to spring
And Carol like a bird in Spring;
Or like a Bee, in summer time,
That hums about a bed of thyme,
And gathers honey and delights
From ev'ry blossom where it 'lights;
If I, alas! had such a Muse,
To touch the Reader or amuse,
And breathe the true poetic vein,
This page should not be fill'd in vain!
But ah! the power was never mine
To dig for gems in Fancy's mine:
Or wander over land and main
To seek the Fairies' old domain—
To watch Apollo while he climbs
His throne in oriental climes;
Or mark the "gradual dusky veil"
Drawn over Tempé's tuneful vale,
In classic lays remembered long—
Such flights to bolder wings belong;
To Bards who on that glorious height,
Of sun and song, Parnassus hight,
Partake the fire divine that burns, }
In Milton, Pope, and Scottish Burns, }
Who sang his native braes and burns. }

For me a novice strange and new,
Who ne'er such inspiration knew,
But weave a verse with travail sore,
Ordain'd to creep and not to soar,
A few poor lines alone I write,
Fulfilling thus a friendly rite,
Not meant to meet the Critic's eye,
For oh! to hope from such as I,
For anything that's fit to read,

Were trusting to a broken reed!

1st of April, 1840.

E. M. G.

SKIPPING. A MYSTERY.



LITTLE Children skip,
The rope so gaily gripping,
Tom and Harry,
Jane and Mary,
Kate, Diana,
Susan, Anna,
All are fond of skipping!

The Grasshoppers all skip,
The early dew-drop sipping,
Under, over,
Bent and clover,
Daisy, sorrel,
Without quarrel,
All are fond of skipping!

The tiny Fairies skip,
At midnight softly tripping;
Puck and Peri,
Never weary,
With an antic,
Quite romantic,
All are fond of skipping!

The little Boats they skip,
Beside the heavy Shipping,
While the squalling
Winds are calling,
Falling, rising,
Rising, falling,
All are fond of skipping!

The pale Diana skips,
The silver billows tipping,
With a dancing
Lustre glancing
To the motion

Of the ocean—
All are fond of skipping!

The little Flounders skip,
When they feel the dripping;
 Scorching, frying,
 Jumping, trying
 If there is not
 Any shying,
All are fond of skipping!

The very Dogs they skip,
While threatened with a whipping,
 Wheeling, prancing,
 Learning dancing,
 To a measure,
 What a pleasure!
All are fond of skipping!

The little Fleas they skip,
And nightly come a nipping,
 Lord and Lady,
 Jude and Thady,
 In the night
 So dark and shady—
All are fond of skipping!

The Autumn Leaves they skip;
When blasts the trees are stripping;
 Bounding, whirling,
 Sweeping, twirling,
 And in wanton
 Mazes curling,
All are fond of skipping!

The Apparitions skip,
Some mortal grievance ripping,
 Thorough many
 A creek and canyon

A crack and cranny,
And the keyhole
Good as any—
Are all fond of skipping!

But oh! how Readers skip,
In heavy volumes dipping!

* * * * * and * * * * *

* * * * * and * * * * *

* * * and * * * * *

* * * * * * * *

All are fond of skipping!

A BUTCHER.



HOE'ER has gone thro' London Street,
Has seen a Butcher gazing at his meat,
And how he keeps
Gloating upon a sheep's
Or bullock's personals, as if his own;
How he admires his halves,
And quarters—and his calves,
As if in truth upon his own legs grown;—
His fat! his suet!
His kidneys peeping elegantly thro' it!
His thick flank!
And his thin!
His shank!
His shin!
Skin of his skin, and bone too of his bone!

With what an air
He stands aloof, across the thoroughfare
Gazing—and will not let a body by,
Tho' buy! buy! buy! be constantly his cry;
Meanwhile his arms a-kimbo, and a pair
Of Rhodian legs, he revels in a stare
At his Joint Stock—for one may call it so,
Howbeit without a Co.
The dotage of self-love was never fonder
Than he of his brute bodies all a-row.

Narcissus in the wave did never ponder,
With love so strong,
On his “portrait charmant,”
As our vain butcher on his carcass yonder.
Look at his sleek round skull!
How bright his cheek, how rubicund his nose is!
His visage seems to be
Ripe for beef-tea;
Of brutal juices the whole man is full—
In fact, fulfilling the metempsychosis,

The Butcher is already half a Bull.



A PUBLIC DINNER.

“Sit down and fall to, said the Barmecide.”—ARABIAN NIGHTS.



T seven you just nick it,
Give card—get wine ticket;
Walk round through the Babel,
From table to table,
To find—a hard matter—
Your name in a platter;
Your wish was to sit by
Your friend Mr. Whitby,
But Steward's assistance
Has placed you at distance,
And, thanks to arrangers,
You sit among strangers;
But too late for mending;
Twelve sticks come attending
A stick of a Chairman,
A little dark spare man,
With bald shining nob,
'Mid Committee swell-mob;
In short, a short figure,
You thought the Duke bigger;
Then silence is wanted,
Non Nobis is chanted;
Then Chairman reads letter,
The Duke's a regretter,
A promise to break it,
But chair he can't take it;
Is grieved to be from us,
But sends friend Sir Thomas,
And what is far better,
A cheque in the letter.
Hear! hear! and a clatter,
And there ends the matter.

Now soups come and fish in,
And C—— brings a dish in;
Then rages the battle,
Knives clatter, forks rattle,

Steel forks with black handles,
Under fifty wax candles;
Your soup-plate is soon full,
You sip just a spoonful.
Mr. Roe will be grateful
To send him a plateful;
And then comes the waiter,
“Must trouble for tater;”
And then you drink wine off
With somebody—nine off;
Bucellas made handy,
With Cape and bad Brandy,
Or East India Sherry,
That’s very hot—very.
You help Mr. Myrtle,
Then find your mock-turtle
Went off, while you lingered,
With waiter light-fingered.
To make up for gammon,
You order some salmon,
Which comes to your fauces
With boats without sauces.
You then make a cut on
Some Lamb big as Mutton;
And ask for some grass too,
But that you must pass too;
It served the first twenty,
But toast there is plenty.
Then, while lamb gets coldish,
A goose that is oldish—
At carving not clever—
You’re begged to dissever,
And when you thus treat it,
Find no one will eat it.
So, hungry as glutton,
You turn to your mutton,
But—no sight for laughter—
The dinner is over—

One soup it's gone after.
Mr. Green then is very
Disposed to take Sherry,
And then Mr. Nappy
Will feel very happy;
And then Mr. Conner
Requests the same honour;
Mr. Clarke, when at leisure,
Will really feel pleasure;
Then waiter leans over
To take off a cover
From fowls which all beg of,
A wing or a leg of;
And while they all peck bone,
You take to a neck bone,
But even your hunger
Declares for a younger.
A fresh plate you call for,
But vainly you bawl for:
Now taste disapproves it,
No waiter removes it.
Still hope, newly budding,
Relies on a pudding;
But critics each minute
Set fancy agin it—
“That’s queer Vermicelli.”
“I say, Vizetelly,
There’s glue in that jelly.”
“Tarts bad altogether;
That crust’s made of leather.”
“Some custard, friend Vesey?”
“No—batter made easy.”
“Some cheese, Mr. Foster?”
“—Don’t like single Glo’ster.”
Meanwhile, to top table,
Like fox in the fable,
You see silver dishes,
With those little fishes,

The whitebait delicious
Borne past you officious;
And hear rather plainish
A sound that's champaignish,
And glimpse certain bottles
Made long in the throttles:
And sniff—very pleasant!
Grouse, partridge, and pheasant,
And see mounds of ices
For patrons and vices,
Pine-apple, and bunches
Of grapes for sweet munches,
And fruits of all virtue
That really *desert* you.
You've nuts, but not crack ones,
Half empty, and black ones;
With oranges sallow—
They can't be called yellow—
Some pippins well wrinkled,
And plums almond sprinkled,
Some rout cakes, and so on,
Then with business to go on;
Long speeches are stutter'd,
And toasts are well buttered,
While dames in the gallery,
All dressed in fallallery,
Look on at the mummary:
And listen to flummery.
Hip, hip! and huzzaing,
And singing and saying,
Glees, catches, orations,
And lists of donations.
Hush! a song, Mr. Tinney—
“Mr. Benbow, one guinea;
Mr. Frederick Manual,
One guinea—and annual.”
Song—Jockey and Jenny—
“Mr. Markham one guinea.”

III. MARKHAM ONE GUINEA.

“Have you all filled your glasses?”

Here’s a health to good lasses.

The subscription still skinny—

“Mr. Franklin—one guinea.”

Franklin looks like a ninny;

“Mr. Boreham, one guinea—

Mr. Blogg, Mr. Finney,

Mr. Tempest—one guinea,

Mr. Merrington—twenty,”

Rough music, in plenty.

Away toddles Chairman,

The little dark spare man,

Not sorry at ending,

With white sticks attending,

And some vain Tomnoddy

Votes in his own body

To fill the void seat up,

And get on his feet up,

To say, with voice squeaking,

“Unaccustomed to speaking,”

Which sends you off seeking

Your hat, number thirty—

No coach—very dirty.

So, hungry and fevered,

Wet-footed, spoilt beavered,

Eyes aching in socket,

Ten pounds out of pocket,

To Brook-street the Upper

You haste home to supper.

A CHARITY SERMON.

“ ‘I would have walked many a mile to have communed with you; and, believe me, I will shortly pay thee another visit; but my friends, I fancy, wonder at my stay; so let me have the money immediately.’ Trulliber then put on a stern look, and cried out, ‘Thou dost not intend to rob me?’

* * * * *

‘I would have thee know, friend,’ addressing himself to Adams, ‘I shall not learn my duty from such as thee. I know what charity is, better than to give to vagabonds.’ ”—JOSEPH ANDREWS.

I'm an extremely charitable man—no collar and long hair, though a little
 carrotty;
Demure, half-inclined to the unknown tongues, but I never gain'd anything
 by Charity.
I got a little boy into the Foundling, but his unfortunate mother was traced
 and baited,
And the overseers found *her* out—and she found *me* out—and the child was
 affiliated.

Oh, Charity will come home to roost—
Like curses and chickens is Charity.

I once, near Whitehall's very old wall, when ballads danced over the whole
 of it,
Put a bad five-shilling-piece into a beggar's hat, but the old hat had got a
 hole in it;
And a little boy caught it in his little hat, and an officer's eye seem'd to care
 for it,
As my bad crown piece went through *his* bad crown piece, and they took
 me up to Queen's Square for it.

Oh, Charity, &c.

I let my very old (condemn'd) old house to a man, at a rent that was
 shockingly low,
So I found a roof for his ten motherless babes—all defunct and fatherless
 now;
For the plaguy one-sided party wall fell in, so did the roof, on son and
 daughter,
And twelve jurymen sat on eleven bodies, and brought in a very personal
 verdict of Manslaughter.

Oh, Charity, &c.

I pick'd up a young well-dress'd gentleman, who had fallen in a fit in St.
 Martin's Court,
And charitably offer'd to see him home—for charity always seem'd to be
 my forte,
And I've had presents for seeing fallen gentlemen home, but this was a very
 unlucky job—

Do you know, he got my watch—my purse—and my handkerchief—for it
was one of the swell mob.

Oh, Charity, &c.

Being four miles from Town, I stopt a horse that had run away with a man,
when it seem'd that they must be dash'd to pieces,

Though several kind people were following him with all their might—but
such following a horse his speed increases;

I held the horse while he went to recruit his strength; and I meant to ride it
home, of course;

But the crowd came up and took me up—for it turn'd out the man had run
away with the horse.

Oh, Charity, &c.

I watch'd last month all the drovers and drivers about the suburbs, for it's a
positive fact,

That I think the utmost penalty ought always to be enforced against
everybody under Mr. Martin's act;

But I couldn't catch one hit over the horns, or over the shins, or on the ears,
or over the head;

And I caught a rheumatism from early wet hours, and got five weeks of ten
swell'd fingers in bed.

Oh, Charity, &c.

Well, I've utterly done with Charity, though I used so to preach about its
finest fount;

Charity may do for some that are more lucky, but *I* can't turn it to any
account—

It goes so the very reverse way—even if one chirrup it up with a dust of
piety;

That henceforth let it be understood, I take my name entirely out of the List
of Subscribers to the Humane Society.

Oh, Charity, &c.

THE CHINA MENDER.



GOOD morning, Mr. What-d'ye-call! Well! here's another pretty job!
Lord help my Lady!—what a smash!—if you had only heard her sob!
It was all through Mr. Lambert: but for certain he was winey,
To think for to go to sit down on a table full of Chiney.
“Deuce take your stupid head!” says my Lady to his very face;
But politeness, you know, is nothing, when there's Chiney in the case;
And if ever a woman was fond of Chiney to a passion
It's my mistress, and all sorts of it, whether new or old fashion.
Her brother's a sea-captain, and brings her home shiploads—
Such bonzes, and such dragons, and nasty, squatting things like toads;
And great nidnoddin' mandarins, with palsies in the head:
I declare I've often dreamt of them, and had nightmares in my bed.
But the frightfuller they are—lawk! she loves them all the better:
She'd have Old Nick himself made of Chiney if they'd let her.

Lawk-a-mercy! break her Chiney, and it's breaking her very heart;
If I touch'd it, she would very soon say, “Mary, we must part.”
To be sure she *is* unlucky: only Friday comes Master Randall,
And breaks a broken spout, and fresh chips a tea-cup handle:
He's a dear, sweet little child, but he will so finger and touch,
And that's why my Lady doesn't take to children much.
Well! there's stupid Mr. Lambert, with his two great coat flaps,
Must go and sit down on the Dresden shepherdesses' laps,
As if there was no such things as rosewood chairs in the room;
I couldn't have made a greater sweep with the handle of the broom.
Mercy on us! how my mistress began to rave and tear!
Well! after all, there's nothing like good ironstone ware for wear.
If ever I marry, that's flat, I'm sure it won't be John Dockery,—
I should be a wretched woman in a shop full of crockery.
I should never like to wipe it, though I love to be neat and tidy,
And afraid of mad bulls on market-days every Monday and Friday.
I'm very much mistook if Mr. Lambert's will be a catch;
The breaking the Chiney will be the breaking-off of his own match.
Missis wouldn't have an angel, if he was careless about Chiney;
She never forgives a chip, if it's ever so small and tiny.
Lawk! I never saw a man in all my life in such a taking;
I could find in my heart to pity him for all his mischief-making.

To see him stand a-hammering and stammering, like a zany;
But what signifies apologies, if they won't mend old Chaney!
If he sent her up whole crates full, from Wedgwood's and Mr. Spode's,
He couldn't make amends for the crack'd mandarins and smash'd toads.
Well! every one has their tastes, but, for my part, my own self,
I'd rather have the figures on my poor dear grandmother's old shelf:
A nice pea-green poll-parrot, and two reapers with brown ears of corns,
And a shepherd with a crook after a lamb with two gilt horns,
And such a Jemmy Jessamy in top boots and sky-blue vest,
And a frill and flower'd waistcoat, with a fine bowpot at the breast.
God help her, poor old soul! I shall come into 'em at her death,
Though she's a hearty woman for her years, except her shortness of breath.
Well! you think the things will mend—if they won't, Lord mend us all!
My Lady will go in fits, and Mr. Lambert won't need to call:
I'll be bound in any money, if I had a guinea to give,
He won't sit down again on Chiney the longest day he has to live.
Poor soul! I only hope it won't forbid his bans of marriage,
Or he'd better have sat behind on the spikes of my Lady's carriage.
But you'll join 'em all of course, and stand poor Mr. Lambert's friend;
I'll look in twice a day, just to see, like, how they mend.
To be sure it is a sight that might draw tears from dogs and cats;
Here's this pretty little pagoda, now, has lost four of its cocked hats:
Be particular with the pagoda: and then here's this pretty bowl—
The Chinese Prince is making love to nothing because of this hole;
And here's another Chinese man, with a face just like a doll—
Do stick his pigtail on again, and just mend his parasol.
But I needn't tell you what to do; only do it out of hand,
And charge whatever you like to charge—my Lady won't make a stand.
Well! good morning, Mr. What-d'ye-call; for it's time our gossip ended:
And you know the proverb, the less as is said, the sooner the Chiney's
mended.

ON A PICTURE OF HERO AND LEANDER.



WHY, Lover, why
Such a water rover?
Would she love thee more
For coming *half seas over*?

Why, Lady, why,
So in love with dipping?
Must a lad of *Greece*
Come all over *dripping*?

Why, Cupid, why
Make the passage brighter?
Were not any boat
Better than a *lighter*?

Why, Madam, why
So intrusive standing?
Must thou be on the stair
When he's on the *landing*?

MISS FANNY'S FAREWELL FLOWERS.

Not "the posie of a ring."

SHAKESPEARE (all but the *not*).



T'S very hard! oh, Dick, my boy,
It's very hard one can't enjoy
A little private spouting;
But sure as Lear or Hamlet lives,
Up comes our master, bounce! and gives
The tragic muse a routing!

Ay, there he comes again! be quick!
And hide the book—a playbook, Dick,
He must not set his eyes on!
It's very hard, the churlish elf
Will never let one stab one's self
Or take a bowl of p'ison!

It's very hard, but when I want
To die—as Cato did—I can't,
Or go *non compos mentis*—
But up he comes, all fire and flame;—
No doubt he'd do the very same
With Kemble for a 'prentice!

Oh, Dick! Oh, Dick! it was not so
Some half a dozen years ago!
Melpomene was no sneaker,
When, under Reverend Mister Poole,
Each little boy at Enfield School
Became an Enfield speaker!

No cruel master-tailor's cane
Then thwarted the theatric vein;
The tragic soil had tillage.
O dear dramatic days gone by!
You, Dick, were Richard then—and I
Play'd Hamlet to the village,

Or, as Macbeth, the dagger clutch'd,
Till all the servant-maids were touch'd—

Macbeth, I think, my pet is;
Lord, how we spouted Shakespeare's works—
Dick, we had twenty little Burkes,
And fifty Master Betties!

Why, there was Julius Cæsar Dunn,
And Norval, Sandy Philip,—one
Of Elocution's champions—
Genteelly taught by his mamma
To say, not father, but papa,
Kept sheep upon the Grampians!

Coriolanus Crumpe—and Fig
In Brutus, with brown-paper wig,
And Huggins great in Cato;
Only he broke so often off,
To have a fit of whooping-cough,
While reasoning with Plato.

And Zangra too,—but I shall weep,
If longer on this theme I keep,
And let remembrance loose, Dick;
Now forced to act—it's very hard—
“Measure for Measure” with a yard—
You Richard, with a goose, Dick!

Zounds! Dick, it's very odd our dads
Should send us there when we were lads
To learn to talk like Tullies;
And now, if one should just break out,
Perchance, into a little spout,
A stick about the skull is.

Why should stage-learning form a part
Of schooling for the tailor's art?
Alas! dramatic notes, Dick,
So well record the sad mistake
Of him who tried at once to make
Both *Romeo* and *Coates*, Dick!

BOTH ROMEO AND JULIET, DICK:

YE TOURISTS AND TRAVELLERS.



THE Tourists and Travellers, bound to the Rhine,
Provided with passport, that requisite docket,
First listen to one little whisper of mine—
Take care of your pocket!—take care of your pocket!

Don't wash or be shaved—go like hairy wild men,
Play dominoes, smoke, wear a cap, and smock-frock it,
But if you speak English, or look it, why then—
Take care of your pocket!—take care of your pocket!

You'll sleep at great inns, in the smallest of beds,
Find charges as apt to mount up as a rocket,
With thirty per cent. as a tax on your heads,—
Take care of your pocket!—take care of your pocket!

You'll see old Cologne,—not the sweetest of towns,—
Wherever you follow your nose you will shock it;
And you'll pay your three dollars to look at three crowns,—
Take care of your pocket!—take care of your pocket!

You'll count seven Mountains, and see Roland's Eck,
Hear legends veracious as any by Crockett;
But oh! to the tone of romance what a check,—
Take care of your pocket!—take care of your pocket!

Old Castles you'll see on the vine-covered hill,—
Fine ruins to rivet the eye in its socket—
Once haunts of Baronial Banditti, and still—
Take care of your pocket!—take care of your pocket!

You'll stop at Coblenz, with its beautiful views,
But make no long stay with your money to stock it,
Where Jews are all Germans, and Germans all Jews,—
Take care of your pocket!—take care of your pocket!—

A Fortress you'll see, which, as people report,
Can never be captured, save famine should block it—
Ascend Ehrenbreitstein—but that's not their *forte* —

ASCEND EICHENBACHSTEIN — but that's not their job it,
Take care of your pocket!—take care of your pocket!

You'll see an old man who'll let off an old gun,
And Lurley, with her hurly-burly, will mock it;
But think that the words of the echo thus run,—
Take care of your pocket!—take care of your pocket!

You'll gaze on the Rheingau, the soil of the Vine!
Of course you will freely Moselle it and Hock it—
P'raps purchase some pieces of Humbugheim wine—
Take care of your pocket!—take care of your pocket!

Perchance you will take a frisk off to the Baths—
Where some to their heads hold a pistol and cock it;
But still mind the warning, wherever your paths—
Take care of your pocket!—take care of your pocket!

And Friendships you'll swear, most eternal of pacts,
Change rings, and give hair to be put in a locket;
But still, in the most sentimental of acts—
Take care of your pocket!—take care of your pocket!

In short, if you visit that stream or its shore,
Still keep at your elbow one caution to knock it,
And where Schinderhannes was Robber of yore,—
Take care of your pocket!—take care of your pocket!

RURAL FELICITY.



WELL, the country's a pleasant place, sure enough, for people that's
country born,

And useful, no doubt, in a natural way, for growing our grass and our
corn.

It was kindly meant of my cousin Giles, to write and invite me down.
Tho' as yet all I've seen of a pastoral life only makes me more partial to
town.

At first I thought I was really come down into all sorts of rural bliss,
For Porkington Place, with its cows and its pigs, and its poultry, looks not
much amiss;

There's something about a dairy farm, with its different kinds of live stock,
That puts one in mind of Paradise, and Adam, and his innocent flock;
But somehow the good old Elysium fields have not been well handed down,
And as yet I have found no fields to prefer to dear Leicester Fields up in
town.

To be sure it is pleasant to walk in the meads, and so I should like for miles,
If it wasn't for clodpoles of carpenters that put up such crooked stiles;
For the bars jut out, and you must jut out, till you're almost broken in two,
If you clamber you're certain sure of a fall, and you stick if you try to creep
through.

Of course, in the end, one learns how to climb without constant tumbles-
down,

But still as to walking so stylishly, it's pleasanter done about town.

There's a way, I know, to avoid the stiles, and that's by a walk in a lane,
And I did find a very nice shady one, but I never dared go again;
For who should I meet but a rampaging bull, that wouldn't be kept in the
pound,

A trying to toss the whole world at once, by sticking his horns in the
ground?

And that, by-the-bye, is another thing, that pulls rural pleasures down,
Ev'ry day in the country is cattle-day, and there's only two up in town.

Then I've rose with the sun, to go brushing away at the first early pearly
dew,

And to meet Aurory, or whatever's her name, and I always got wetted

through;
My shoes are like sops, and I caught a bad cold, and a nice draggle-tail to
my gown,
That's not the way that we bathe our feet, or wear our pearls, up in town!
As for picking flowers, I have tried at a hedge, sweet eglantine roses to
snatch,
But, mercy on us! how nettles will sting, and how the long brambles do
scratch;
Beside hitching my hat on a nasty thorn that tore all the bows from the
crown,
One may walk long enough without hats branching off, or losing one's
bows about town.
But worse than that, in a long rural walk, suppose that it blows up for rain,
And all at once you discover yourself in a real St. Swithin's Lane;
And while you're running all duck'd and drown'd, and pelted with
sixpenny drops,
"Fine weather," you hear the farmers say; "a nice growing shower for the
crops!"
But who's to crop me another new hat, or grow me another new gown?
For you can't take a shilling fare with a plough as you do with the hackneys
in town.

Then my nevys too, they must drag me off to go with them gathering nuts,
And we always set out by the longest way and return by the shortest cuts.
Short cuts, indeed! But it's nuts to them, to get a poor lustyish aunt
To scramble through gaps, or jump over a ditch, when they're morally
certain she can't,—
For whenever I get in some awkward scrape, and it's almost daily the case,
Tho' they don't laugh out, the mischievous brats, I see the "hooray!" in
their face.
There's the other day, for my sight is short, and I saw what was green
beyond,
And thought it was all terry firmer and grass, till I walked in the duckweed
pond:
Or perhaps when I've pully-hauled up a bank they see me come launching
down,
As none but a stout London female can do as is come a first time out of
town.

Then how sweet, some say, on a mossy bank a verdurous seat to find,
But for my part I always found it a joy that brought a repentance behind;
For the juicy grass with its nasty green has stained a whole breadth of my
gown—

And when gowns are dyed, I needn't say, it's much better done up in town.
As for country fare, the first morning I came I heard such a shrill piece of
work!

And ever since—and it's ten days ago—we've lived upon nothing but pork;
One Sunday except, and then I turn'd sick, a plague take all countrified
cooks!

Why didn't they tell me, *before* I had dined, they made pigeon pies of the
rooks?

Then the gooseberry wine, tho' it's pleasant when up, it doesn't agree when
it's down,

But it served me right, like a gooseberry, fool to look for champagne out of
town?

To be sure cousin G. meant it all for the best when he started this pastoral
plan,

And his wife is a worthy domestical soul and she teaches me all that she
can,

Such as making of cheese, and curing of hams, but I'm sure that I never
shall learn,

And I've fetch'd more back-ache than butter as yet by chumping away at
the churn;

But in making hay, tho' it's tanning work, I found it more easy to make,
But it tries one's legs, and no great relief when you're tired to sit down on
the rake.

I'd a country dance, too, at harvest home, with a regular country clown,
But, Lord! they don't hug one round the waist and give one such smacks in
town:

Then I've tried to make friends with the birds and the beasts, but they take
to such curious rigs,

I'm always at odds with the turkey-cock, and I can't even please the pigs.

The very hens pick holes in my hand when I grope for the new-laid eggs,

And the gander comes hissing out of the pond on purpose to flap at my legs.

I've been bump'd in a ditch by the cow without horns, and the old sow
trampled me down,

~~~~~

The beasts are as vicious as any wild beasts—but they're kept in cages in town!

Another thing is the nasty dogs—thro' the village I hardly can stir  
Since giving a bumpkin a pint of beer just to call off a barking cur;  
And now you would swear all the dogs in the place were set on to hunt me  
down,

But neither the brutes nor the people I think are as civilly bred as in town.  
Last night about twelve I was scared broad awake, and all in a tremble of  
fright,

But instead of a family murder it proved an owl, that flies screeching at  
night.

Then there's plenty of ricks and stalks all about, and I can't help dreaming  
of Swing—

In short, I think that a pastoral life is not the most happiest thing;  
For, besides all the troubles I've mentioned before, as endured for rurality's  
sake,

I've been stung by the bees, and I've set among ants, and once—ugh! I trod  
on a snake!

And as to mosquitoes, they tortured me so, for I've got a particular skin,  
I do think it's the gnats coming out of the ponds, that drives the poor  
suicides in!

And after all an't there new-laid eggs to be had upon Holborn Hill?  
And dairy-fed pork in Broad St. Giles, and fresh butter wherever you will?  
And a covered cart that brings Cottage Bread quite rustical-like and brown?  
So one isn't so very uncountrified in the very heart of the town.

Howsomever my mind's made up, and although I'm sure cousin Giles will  
be vexed,

I mean to book me an inside place up to town upon Saturday next,  
And if nothing happens, soon after ten, I shall be at the Old Bell and  
Crown,

And perhaps I may come to the country again, when London is all burnt  
down.

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# THE DOCTOR.

A SKETCH.

“Whatever is, is right.”—POPE.

 HERE once was a Doctor,  
(No foe to the proctor,)  
A physic concocter,  
Whose dose was so pat,  
However it acted,  
One speech it extracted,—  
“Yes, yes,” said the doctor,  
“I meant it for that!”

And first, all “unaisy,”  
Like woman that’s crazy,  
In flies Mistress Casey,  
“Do come to poor Pat  
The blood’s running faster!  
He’s torn off the plaster—”  
“Yes, yes,” said the Doctor,  
“I meant it for that!”

Anon, with an antic,  
Quite strange and romantic,  
A woman comes frantic—  
“What could you be at?  
My darling dear Aleck,  
You’ve sent him oxalic!”  
“Yes, yes,” said the Doctor,  
“I meant it for that!”

Then in comes another,  
Dispatch’d by his mother,  
A blubbering brother,  
Who gives a rat-tat—  
“Oh, poor little sister  
Has lick’d off a blister!”  
“Yes, yes,” said the Doctor,  
“I meant it for that!”

Now home comes the flunkey,

His own powder-monkey,  
But dull as a donkey—  
With basket and that—  
“The draught for the Squire, Sir,  
He chuck’d in the fire, Sir—”  
“Yes, yes,” said the Doctor,  
“I meant it for that!”

The next is the pompous  
Head Beadle, old Bumpus—  
“Lord! here is a rumpus:  
That pauper, Old Nat,  
In some drunken notion  
Has drunk up his lotion—”  
“Yes, yes,” said the Doctor,  
“I meant it for that!”

At last comes a servant,  
In grief very fervent:  
“Alas! Doctor Derwent,  
Poor Master is flat!  
He’s drawn his last breath, Sir—  
That dose was his death, Sir.”  
“Yes, yes,” said the Doctor,  
“I meant it for that!”

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## LAYING DOWN THE LAW.

——“I am Sir Oracle,  
And when I ope my lips let no dog bark.”  
MERCHANT OF VENICE.

“If thou wert born a Dog, remain so; but if thou wert born a Man, resume thy former shape.”—  
ARABIAN NIGHTS.



POODLE, Judge-like, with emphatic paw,  
Dogmatically laying down the law,—  
A batch of canine Counsel round the table,  
Keen-eyed, and sharp of nose, and long of jaw,  
At sight, at scent, at giving tongue, right able:  
O, Edwin Landseer, Esquire, and R.A.,  
Thou great Pictorial Æsop, say,  
What is the moral of this painted fable?  
O, say, accomplished artist!  
Was it thy purpose, by a scene so quizzical,  
To read a wholesome lesson to the Chartist,  
So over partial to the means called Physical,  
Sticks, staves, and swords, and guns, the tools of treason?  
To show, illustrating the better course,  
The very Brutes abandoning Brute Force,  
The worry and the fight,  
The bark and bite,  
In which, says Doctor Watts, the dogs delight,  
And lending shaggy ears to Law and Reason,  
As uttered in that Court of high antiquity  
Where sits the Chancellor, supreme as Pope,  
But works—so let us hope—  
In equity, not iniquity?  
  
Or was it but a speculation  
On transmigration,  
How certain of our most distinguished Daniels,  
Interpreters of Law's bewildering book,  
Would look  
Transformed to mastiffs, setters, hounds, and spaniels  
(As Brahmins in their Hindoo code advance)  
With that great lawyer of the Upper House  
Who rules all suits by equitable *nous*,  
Become—like vile Armina's spouse—  
A Dog, called Chance?<sup>[4]</sup>  
Methinks, indeed, I recognise  
In those deep-set and meditative eyes

Engaged in mental puzzle,  
And that portentous muzzle,  
A celebrated judge, too prone to tarry  
To hesitate on devious ins and outs,  
And, on preceding doubts, to build *re-doubts*  
That regiments could not carry—  
Prolonging even Law's delays, and still  
Putting a skid upon the wheel up-hill,  
Meanwhile the weary and desponding client  
Seem'd—in the agonies of indecision—  
In Doubting Castle, with that dreadful Giant  
Described in Bunyan's Vision!

So slow, indeed, was justice in its ways,  
Beset by more than customary clogs,  
Going to law in those expensive days  
Was much the same as going to the Dogs!  
But possibly I err,  
And that sagacious and judicial creature,  
So Chancellor-like in feature,  
With ears so wig-like, and a cap of fur,  
Looking as grave, responsible, and sage,  
As if he had the guardianship, in fact,  
Of all poor dogs, or crackt,  
And puppies under age—  
It may be that the Creature was not meant  
Any especial Lord to represent,  
Eldon or Erskine, Cottenham or Thurlow,  
Or Brougham (more like him whose potent jaw  
Is holding forth the letter of the law),  
Or Lyndhurst, after the vacation's furlough,  
Presently sitting in the House of Peers,  
On wool he sometimes wishes in his ears,  
When touching Corn Laws, Taxes, or Tithe-piggery,  
He hears a fierce attack,  
And, sitting on his sack,  
Listens in his great wig to greater Whiggery!

So, possibly, those others,  
In coats so various, or sleek, or rough,  
Aim not at any of the legal brothers,  
Who wear the silken robe, or gown of stuff.  
Yet who that ever heard or saw  
The Counsel sitting in that solemn Court,  
Who, having passed the Bar, are safe in port,  
Or those great Sergeants, learned in the Law,—  
Who but must trace a feature now and then  
Of those forensic men,  
As good at finding heirs as any harrier,  
Renown'd like greyhounds for long tales—indeed,  
At worrying the ear as apt as terriers,—  
Good at conveyance as the hairy carriers  
That bear our gloves, umbrellas, hats, and sticks,  
Books, baskets, bones, or bricks,  
In Deeds of Trust as sure as Tray the trusty,—  
Acute at sniffing flaws on legal grounds,—  
And lastly—well the catalogue it closes!—  
Still following their predecessors' noses,  
Through ways however dull or dusty,  
As fond of hunting precedents, as hounds  
Of running after foxes more than musty.

However slow or fast,  
Full of urbanity, or supercilious,  
In temper wild, serene, or atrabilious,  
Fluent of tongue, or prone to legal saw,  
The Dogs have got a Chancellor, at last,  
For Laying down the Law!  
And never may the canine race regret it,  
With whinings and repinings loud or deep,—  
Ragged in coat, and shortened in their keep,  
Worried by day, and troubled in their sleep,  
With cares that prey upon the heart and fret it—  
As human suitors have had cause to weep—  
For what is Law, unless poor Dogs can get it

Dog-cheap?

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## A BLACK JOB.

“No doubt the pleasure is as great,  
Of being cheated as to cheat.”—HUDIBRAS.



THE history of human-kind to trace,  
Since Eve—the first of dupes—our doom unriddled,  
A certain portion of the human race  
Has certainly a taste for being diddled.

Witness the famous Mississippi dreams!  
A rage that time seems only to redouble—  
The Banks, Joint-Stocks, and all the flimsy schemes,  
For rolling in Pactolian streams,  
That cost our modern rogues so little trouble.  
No matter what,—to pasture cows on stubble,  
To twist sea-sand into a solid rope,  
To make French bricks and fancy bread of rubble,  
Or light with gas the whole celestial cope—  
Only propose to blow a bubble,  
And Lord! what hundreds will subscribe for soap!

Soap!—it reminds me of a little tale,  
Tho' not a pig's, the hawbuck's glory,  
When rustic games and merriment prevail—  
But here's my story:  
Once on a time—no matter when—  
A knot of very charitable men  
Set up a Philanthropical Society,  
Professing on a certain plan,  
To benefit the race of man,  
And in particular that dark variety,  
Which some suppose inferior—as in vermin,  
The sable is to ermine,  
As smut to flour, as coal to alabaster,  
As crows to swans, as soot to driven snow,  
As blacking, or as ink to “milk below,”  
Or yet a better simile, to show,  
As ragman's dolls to images in plaster!

However, as is usual in our city,  
They had a sort of managing Committee



A board of grave responsible Directors—  
A Secretary, good at pen and ink—  
A Treasurer, of course, to keep the chink,  
And quite an army of collectors!  
Not merely male, but female duns,  
Young, old, and middle-aged—of all degrees—  
With many of those persevering ones,  
Who mite by mite would beg a cheese!

And what might be their aim?  
To rescue Afric's sable sons from fetters—  
To save their bodies from the burning shame  
Of branding with hot letters—  
Their shoulders from the cowhide's bloody strokes,  
Their necks from iron yokes?  
To end or mitigate the ills of slavery,  
The Planter's avarice, the Driver's knavery?  
To school the heathen Negroes and enlighten 'em,  
To polish up and brighten 'em,  
And make them worthy of eternal bliss?  
Why, no—the simple end and aim was this—  
Reading a well-known proverb much amiss—  
To wash and whiten 'em!

They look'd so ugly in their sable hides:  
So dark, so dingy, like a grubby lot  
Of sooty sweeps, or colliers, and besides,  
However the poor elves  
Might wash themselves,  
Nobody knew if they were clean or not—  
On Nature's fairness they were quite a blot!  
Not to forget more serious complaints  
That even while they join'd in pious hymn,  
So black they were and grim,  
In face and limb,  
They look'd like Devils, though they sang like Saints!

The thing was undeniable!

They wanted washing! not that slight ablution  
To which the skin of the White Man is liable,  
Merely removing transient pollution—  
But good, hard, honest, energetic rubbing  
And scrubbing,  
Sousing each sooty frame from heels to head  
With stiff, strong, saponaceous lather,  
And pails of water—hottish rather,  
But not so boiling as to turn 'em red!

So spoke the philanthropic man  
Who laid, and hatch'd, and nursed the plan—  
And oh! to view its glorious consummation!  
The brooms and mops,  
The tubs and slops,  
The baths and brushes in full operation!  
To see each Crow, or Jim, or John,  
Go in a raven and come out a swan!  
While fair as Cavendishes, Vanes, and Russels,  
Black Venus rises from the soapy surge,  
And all the little Niggerlings emerge  
As lily-white as mussels.

Sweet was the vision—but alas!  
However in prospectus bright and sunny,  
To bring such visionary scenes to pass  
One thing was requisite, and that was—money;  
Money, that pays the laundress and her bills,  
For socks and collars, shirts and frills,  
Cravats and kerchiefs—money, without which  
The negroes must remain as dark as pitch;  
A thing to make all Christians sad and shivery,  
To think of millions of immortal souls  
Dwelling in bodies black as coals,  
And living—so to speak—in Satan's livery!

Money—the root of evil,—dross, and stuff!  
But oh! how happy ought the rich to feel,

Whose means enable them to give enough  
To blanch an African from head to heel!  
How blessed—yea, thrice blessed—to subscribe  
Enough to scour a tribe!

While he whose fortune was at best a brittle one,  
Although he gave but pence, how sweet to know  
He helped to bleach a Hottentot's great toe,  
Or little one!

Moved by this logic (or appall'd)  
To persons of a certain turn so proper,  
The money came when call'd,  
In silver, gold, and copper,  
Presents from "Friends to blacks," or foes to whites,  
"Trifles," and "offerings," and "widow's mites,"  
Plump legacies, and yearly benefactions,  
With other gifts  
And charitable lifts,  
Printed in lists and quarterly transactions.

As thus—Elisha Brettel,  
An iron kettle.  
The Dowager Lady Scannel,  
A piece of flannel.  
Rebecca Pope,  
A bar of soap.  
The Misses Howels,  
Half-a-dozen towels.  
The Master Rush's,  
Two scrubbing-brushes.  
Mr. T. Groom,  
A stable broom,  
And Mrs. Grubb,  
A tub.

Great were the sums collected!  
And great results in consequence expected.  
But somehow, in the teeth of all endeavour,  
According to reports  
At yearly courts.

the yearly coats,  
The blacks, confound them! were as black as ever!

Yes! spite of all the water sous'd aloft,  
Soap, plain and mottled, hard and soft,  
Soda and pearlash, huckaback and sand,  
Brooms, brushes, palm of hand,  
And scourers in the office strong and clever,  
In spite of all the tubbing, rubbing, scrubbing,  
The routing and the grubbing,  
The blacks, confound them! were as black as ever!

In fact in his perennial speech,  
The Chairman own'd the niggers did not bleach,  
As he had hoped,  
From being washed and soaped,  
A circumstance he named with grief and pity;  
But still he had the happiness to say,  
For self and the Committee,  
By persevering in the present way  
And scrubbing at the Blacks from day to day,  
Although he could not promise perfect white,  
From certain symptoms that had come to light,  
He hoped in time to get them gray!

Lull'd by this vague assurance,  
The friends and patrons of the sable tribe  
Continued to subscribe,  
And waited, waited on with much endurance—  
Many a frugal sister, thrifty daughter—  
Many a stinted widow, pinching mother—  
With income by the tax made somewhat shorter,  
Still paid implicitly her crown per quarter,  
Only to hear as ev'ry year came round,  
That Mr. Treasurer had spent her pound;  
And as she loved her sable brother,  
That Mr. Treasurer must have another!

But, spite of pounds or guineas.

Instead of giving any hint  
Of turning to a neutral tint,  
The plaguy negroes and their piccaninnies  
Were still the colour of the bird that caws—  
Only some very aged souls  
Showing a little gray upon their polls,  
Like daws!

However, nothing dashed  
By such repeated failures, or abashed,  
The Court still met;—the Chairman and Directors,  
The Secretary, good at pen and ink,  
The worthy Treasurer, who kept the chink,  
And all the cash Collectors;  
With hundreds of that class, so kindly credulous,  
Without whose help, no charlatan alive,  
Or Bubble Company could hope to thrive,  
Or busy Chevalier, however sedulous—  
Those good and easy innocents in fact,  
Who willingly receiving chaff for corn,  
As pointed out by Butler's tact,  
Still find a secret pleasure in the act  
Of being pluck'd and shorn!

However, in long hundreds there they were,  
Thronging the hot, and close, and dusty court,  
To hear once more addresses from the Chair,  
And regular Report.

Alas! concluding in the usual strain,  
That what with everlasting wear and tear,  
The scrubbing-brushes hadn't got a hair—  
The brooms—mere stumps—would never serve again—  
The soap was gone, the flannels all in shreds,  
The towels worn to threads,  
The tubs and pails too shatter'd to be mended—  
And what was added with a deal of pain,  
But as accounts correctly would explain.

~~—as accounts correctly would explain,~~  
Tho' thirty thousand pounds had been expended—  
The Blackamoors had still been wash'd in vain!

“In fact, the negroes were as black as ink,  
Yet, still as the Committee dared to think,  
And hoped the proposition was not rash,  
A rather free expenditure of cash—”  
But ere the prospect could be made more sunny—  
Up jump'd a little, lemon-coloured man,  
And with an eager stammer, thus began,  
In angry earnest, though it sounded funny:  
“What! More subscriptions! No—no—no,—not I!  
You have had time—time—time enough to try!  
They WON'T come white! then why—why—why—why—why  
More money?”

“Why!” said the Chairman, with an accent bland,  
And gentle waving of his dexter hand,  
“Why must we have more dross, and dirt, and dust,  
More filthy lucre, in a word, more gold—  
The why, sir, very easily is told,  
Because Humanity declares we must!  
We've scrubb'd the negroes till we've nearly killed 'em,  
And finding that we cannot wash them white,  
But still their nigritude offends the sight,  
*We mean to gild 'em?*”

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## A DISCOVERY IN ASTRONOMY.



NE day—I had it from a hasty mouth,  
Accustom'd to make many blunders  
daily,  
And therefore will not name, precisely, South,  
Herschell, or Baily—  
But one of those great men who watch the skies,  
With all their rolling, winking eyes,  
Was looking at that Orb whose ancient God  
Was patron of the Ode, and Song, and Sonnet,  
When thus he musing cried—"It's very odd  
That no Astronomer of all the squad  
Can tell the nature of those spots upon it!

"Lord, master!" muttered John, a liveried elf,  
"To wonder so at spots upon the sun!  
I'll tell you what he's done—  
*Freckled himself!*"

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# THE SAUSAGE MAKER'S GHOST.

A LONDON LEGEND.



OMEWHERE in Leather Lane—  
I wonder that it was not Mincing,  
And for this reason most convincing,

That Mr. Brain

Dealt in those well-minced cartridges of meat  
Some people like to eat—

However, all such quibbles overstepping,  
In Leather Lane he lived; and drove a trade  
In porcine sausages, though London made,  
Call'd "Epping."

Right brisk was the demand,  
Seldom his goods stay'd long on hand,  
For out of all adjacent courts and lanes,  
Young Irish ladies and their swains—  
Such soups of girls and broths of boys!—  
Sought his delicious chains,  
Preferr'd to all polonies, saveloys,  
And other foreign toys—  
The mere chance passengers  
Who saw his "sassengers,"  
Of sweetness undeniable,  
So sleek, so mottled, and so "friable,"  
Stepp'd in, forgetting ev'ry other thought,  
And bought.

Meanwhile a constant thumping  
Was heard, a sort of subterranean chumping—  
Incessant was the noise!

But though he had a foreman and assistant,  
With all the tools consistent,  
(Besides a wife and two fine chopping boys)  
His means were not yet vast enough  
For chopping fast enough  
To meet the call from streets, and lanes, and passages,  
For first-chop "sassages."

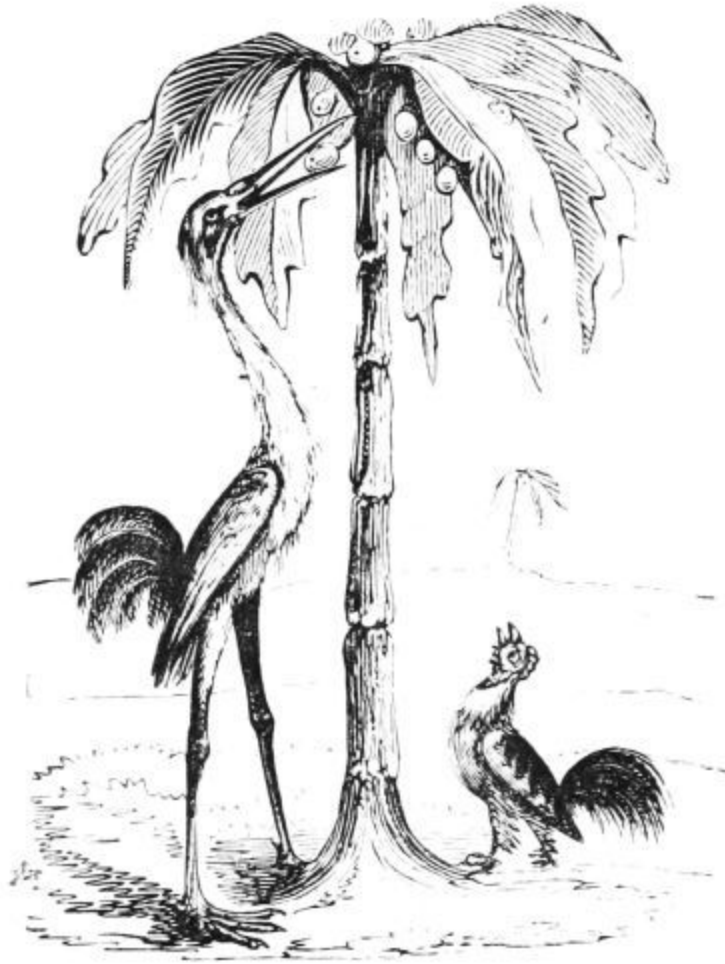
However, Mr. Brain

Was none of those dull men and slow,  
Who, flying bird-like by a railway train,  
Sigh for the heavy mails of long ago;  
He did not set his face 'gainst innovations  
For rapid operations,  
And therefore in a kind of waking dream  
Listen'd to some hot-water sprite that hinted  
To have his meat chopp'd, as the Times was printed,  
By steam!

Accordingly in happy hour,  
A bran-new Engine went to work  
Chopping up pounds on pounds of pork  
With all the energy of Two-Horse-Power,  
And wonderful celerity—



**THE JUDGES OF A-SIZE.**



**LONG COMMONS AND SHORT COMMONS.**

When lo! when ev'rything to hope responded,  
Whether his head was turn'd by his prosperity,  
Whether he had some sly intrigue, in verity,  
The man absconded!

His anxious Wife in vain  
Placarded Leather Lane,  
And all the suburbs with descriptive bills,  
Such as are issued when from homes and tills  
Clerks, dogs, cats, lunatics, and children roam;  
Besides advertisements in all the journals,  
Or weeklies or diurnals,  
Beginning "LEFT HIS HOME"—  
The sausage-maker, spite of white and black,  
Never came back.

Never, alive!—But on the seventh night,  
Just when the yawning grave its dead releases,  
Filling his bedded wife with sore affright  
In walk'd his grisly Sprite,  
In fifty thousand pieces!  
"O Mary!" so it seem'd  
In hollow melancholy tone to say,  
Whilst thro' its airy shape the moonlight gleam'd  
With scarcely dimmer ray—  
"O Mary! let your hopes no longer flatter,  
Prepare at once to drink of sorrow's cup—  
It ain't no use to mince the matter—  
The Engine's chopp'd me up!"

---

TO JOSEPH HUME, ESQ., M.P.

“I lisped in numbers, for the numbers came.”



Mr. Hume, thy name  
Is travelling post upon the road to fame,  
With four fast horses and two sharp postilions;  
Thy reputation  
Has friends by numeration,  
Units, Tens, Hundreds, Thousands, Millions.  
Whenever public men together dine,  
They drink to thee  
With three times three—  
That's nine.  
And oft a votary proposes then  
To add unto the cheering one cheer more—  
Nine and One are Ten;  
Or somebody, for thy honour still more keen,  
Insists on four times four—  
Sixteen!

In Parliament no star shines more or bigger,  
And yet thou dost not care to cut a figure;  
Equally art thou eloquent and able,  
Whether in showing how to serve the nation  
Or laying its petitions on the Table  
Of Multiplication.

In motion thou art second unto none,  
Though fortune on thy motions seems to frown,  
For though you set a number down  
You seldom carry one.  
Great at speech thou art, though some folks cough,  
But thou art greatest at a *paring* off.

But never blench,  
Although in stirring up corruption's worms  
You make some factions  
Vulgar as certain fractions,  
Almost reduced unto their lowest terms.  
Go on, reform, diminish, and retrench;  
Go on, for ridicule not caring;

Sift on from one to nine with all their noughts,  
And make state cyphers eat up their own orts,  
And only in thy saving be unsparing;  
At soldiers' uniforms make awful rackets,  
Don't trim though, but untrim their jackets.  
Allow the tin mines no tin tax,  
Cut off the Great Seal's wax!

Dock all the dock-yards, lower masts and sails,  
Search foot by foot the Infantry's amounts,  
Look into all the Cavalry's accounts,  
And crop their horses' tails.  
Look well to Woolwich and each Money-vote,  
Examine all the cannons' charges well,  
And those who found th' Artillery compel  
To forge twelve-pounders for a five-pound note.  
Watch Sandhurst too, its debts and its Cadets—  
Those Military pets.  
Take army—no, take Leggy Tailors  
Down to the Fleet, for no one but a nincum  
Out of our nation's narrow income  
Would furnish such wide trousers to the Sailors.  
Next take, to wonder him,  
The Master of the Horse's horse from under him;  
Retrench from those who tend on Royal ills  
Wherewith to gild their pills.  
And tell the Stag-hound's Master he must keep  
The deer, &c., cheap.  
Close as new brooms  
Scrub the Bed Chamber Grooms;  
Abridge the Master of the Ceremonies  
Of his very monies;  
In short, at every salary have a pull,  
And when folks come for pay  
On quarter-day,  
Stop half and make them give receipts in full.

Oh. Mr. Hume. don't drink.



Or eat, or sleep, a wink,  
Till you have argued over each reduction:  
Let it be food to you, repose and suction;  
    Though you should make more motions by one half  
    Than any telegraph,  
Item by item all these things enforce,  
Be on your legs till lame, and talk till hoarse;  
Have lozenges—mind, Dawson's—in your pocket,  
And swing your arms till aching in their socket;  
    Or if awake you cannot keep,  
Talk of retrenchment in your sleep;  
Expose each Peachum, and show up each Lockit—  
Go down to the M.P.'s before you sup,  
And while they're sitting blow them up,  
As Guy Fawkes could not do with all his nous;  
    But now we live in different Novembers,  
    And safely you may walk into the House,  
First split its ears and then divide its members!

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## TO ADMIRAL GAMBIER, G.C.B.

“Well, if you reclaim such as Hood, your Society will deserve the thanks of the country.”—  
*Temperance Society’s Herald*, vol. 1, No. 1, p. 8.

“My father, when last I from Guinea  
Came home with abundance of wealth,  
Said, ‘Jack, never be such a ninny  
As to drink—’ says I, ‘Father, your health?’ ”  
*Nothing like Grog.*



H! Admiral Gam—I dare not mention *bier*  
In such a temperate ear—

Oh! Admiral Gam—an admiral of the Blue,  
Of course to read the Navy List aright,  
For strictly shunning wine of either hue,  
You can't be Admiral of the Red or White:—  
Oh, Admiral Gam! consider ere you call  
On merry Englishmen to wash their throattles  
With water only; and to break their bottles,  
To stick, for fear of trespass, on the wall  
Of Exeter Hall!

Consider, I beseech, the contrariety  
Of cutting off our brandy, gin, and rum,  
And then, by tracts, inviting us to come  
And “*mix* in your society!”  
In giving rules to dine, or sup, or lunch,  
Consider Nature's ends before you league us  
To strip the Isle of Rum of all its punch—  
To dock the Isle of Mull of all its negus—  
Or doom—to suit your milk and water view—  
The Isle of Skye to nothing but sky-blue!

Consider—for appearance' sake—consider  
The sorry figure of a spirit-ridder,  
Going on this crusade against the suttler;  
A sort of Hudibras—without a Butler!

Consider—ere you break the ardent spirits  
Of father, mother, brother, sister, daughter;  
What are your beverage's washy merits?  
Gin may be low—but I have known low-water!

Consider well, before you thus deliver,  
With such authority, your sloppy cannon;  
Should British tars taste nothing but the *river*,  
Because the *Chesapeake* once fought the *Shannon*!

Consider, too—before all Eau-de-vie,  
Schiedam, or other drinkers, you rebut—  
To bite a bitten dog all curs agree;  
But who would cut a man because he's *cut*?

Consider—ere you bid the poor to fill  
Their murmuring stomach with the “murmuring rill”—  
Consider that their streams are not like ours,  
Reflecting heaven, and margined by sweet flowers;  
On their dark pools by day no sun reclines,  
By night no Jupiter, no Venus shines;  
Consider life's sour taste, that bids them mix  
Their rum with Acheron, or Gin with Styx;  
If you must pour out water to the poor, oh!  
Let it be *aqua d'oro*!

Consider—ere as furious as a griffin,  
Against a glass of grog you make such work,  
A man may like a stiff'un,  
And yet not be a Burke!

Consider, too, before you bid all skinkers  
Turn water-drinkers,  
What sort of fluid fills their native rivers;  
Their Mudiboos, and Niles, and Guadalquivirs.  
How should you like, yourself, in glass or mug,  
The Bog—the Bug—  
The Maine—the Weser—or that freezer, Neva?  
Nay, take the very rill of classic ground—  
Lord Byron found  
Even Castaly better for Geneva.

Consider—if, to vote Reform's arrears,  
His Majesty should please to make you peers,  
Your titles would be very far from trumps,  
To figure in a book of blue and red:—  
The Duke of Draw-well—what a name to dread!  
*Marginal of Main rinal Earl New River Head!*

marquis of Main-pipe! Earl New-River-Head!  
And Temperance's chief, the Prince of Pumps!

---

TO SPENCER PERCEVAL, ESQ., M.P.



Oh, Mr. Spencer!  
I mean no offence, sir—  
Retrencher of each trencher—man or woman's;  
    Maker of days of ember,  
    Eloquent Member  
Of the House of Com—I mean to say short commons—  
Thou Long Tom Coffin singing out, "Hold Fast"—  
    Avast!

Oh, Mr. Perceval! I'll bet a dollar, a  
    Great growth of Cholera,  
    And new deaths reckon'd,  
Will mark thy Lenten twenty-first and second.  
The best of our physicians, when they con it,  
Depose the malady is in the air:  
Oh, Mr. Spencer! if the ill *is* there,  
Why should you bid the people live upon it?

Why should you make discourses against courses,  
While doctors, though they bid us rub and chafe,  
    Declare, of all resources,  
The man is safest who gets in the safe?  
And yet you bid poor suicidal sinners  
    Discard their dinners,  
Thoughtless how Heaven above will look upon't,  
For man to die so wantonly of want!

    By way of a variety,  
Think of the ineffectual piety  
Of London's Bishop, at St. Faith's or Bride's,  
    Lecturing such chameleon insides,  
        Only to find  
    He's preaching to the wind.

Whatever others do,—or don't,  
I cannot—dare not—must not fast, and won't,  
Unless by night your day you let me keep,



And *fast* asleep;  
My constitution can't obey such censors:  
I must have meat  
Three times a-day to eat;  
My health's of such a sort,—  
To say the truth, in short,  
The *coats* of my stomach are not *Spencers*!

---

TO MISS KELLY.

ON HER OPENING THE STRAND THEATRE.



BETTY—I beg pardon—Fanny K.  
(I was just thinking of your Betty Finnikin)

---

Permit me this to say,  
In quite a friendly way—  
I like your theatre, though but a minnikin;  
For though small stages Kean dislikes to spout on,  
Renounce me if I don't agree with Dowton,  
The Minors are the Passions' proper schools  
For me, I never can  
Find wisdom in the plan  
That keeps large reservoirs for little Pooles.

I like your boxes where the audience sit  
A family circle; and your little pit;  
I like your little stage, where you discuss  
Your pleasant bill of fare,  
And show us passengers so rich and rare,  
Your little stage seems quite an omnibus.

I like exceedingly your Parthian dame,  
Dimly remembering dramatic codgers,  
The ghost of Memory—the shade of Fame!—  
Lord! what a housekeeper for Mr. Rogers!  
I like your savage, of a one-horse power;  
And Terence, done in Irish from the Latin;  
And Sally—quite a kitchen-garden flower;  
And Mrs. Drake, serene in sky-blue satin!  
I like your girl as speechless as a mummy—  
It shows you can play dummy!—  
I like your boy, deprived of every gleam  
Of light for ever—a benighted being!  
And really think—though Irish it may seem—  
Your blindness is worth seeing.

I like your Governess; and there's a striking  
Tale of Two Brothers, that sets tears a-flowing—

But I'm not going  
All through the bill to tell you of my liking.  
Suffice it, Fanny Kelly! with your art  
So much in love, like others I have grown,  
I really mean myself to take a part  
In "Free and Easy"—at my own bespeak—  
And shall three times a week  
Drop in and make your pretty house my own!

---

TO DOCTOR HAHNEMANN.

THE HOMŒOPATHIST.



ELL, Doctor,  
Great concoctor

Of medicines to help in man's distress;  
Diluting down the strong to meek,  
And making even the weak more weak,  
"Fine by degrees, and beautifully less"—  
Founder of a new system economic,  
To druggists anything but comic;  
Framed the whole race of Ollapods to fret,  
At profits, like thy doses, very small;  
To put all Doctors' Boys in evil case,  
Thrown out of bread, of physic, and of place,—  
And show us old Apothecaries' Hall  
"To Let."

How fare thy Patients? are they dead or living,  
Or, well as can expected be, with such  
A style of practice, liberally giving  
"A sum of more to that which had too much?"  
Dost thou preserve the human frame, or turf it?  
Do thorough draughts cure thorough colds or not?  
Do fevers yield to anything that's hot?  
Or hearty dinners neutralise a surfeit?  
Is't good advice for gastronomic ills,  
When Indigestion's face with pain is crumpling,  
To cry "Discard those Peristaltic Pills,  
Take a hard dumpling!"

Tell me, thou German Cousin,  
And tell me honestly without a diddle,  
Does an attenuated dose of rosin  
Act as a *tonic* on the old *Scotch fiddle*?  
Tell me, when Anhalt-Coethen babies wriggle,  
Like eels just caught by sniggle,  
Martyrs to some acidity internal,  
That gives them pangs infernal,  
Meanwhile the lip grows black, the eye enlarges;

Say, comes there all at once a cherub-calm,  
Thanks to that soothing homœopathic balm,  
The half of half, of half, a drop of “*varges?*”

Suppose, for instance, upon Leipzig’s plain,  
A soldier pillowed on a heap of slain,  
In urgent want both of a priest and proctor;  
When lo! there comes a man in green and red,  
A featherless cocked-hat adorns his head,  
In short a Saxon military doctor—  
Would he, indeed, on the right treatment fix,  
                    To cure a horrid gaping wound,  
                    Made by a ball that weighed a pound,  
If he well peppered it with number six?

Suppose a felon doomed to swing  
                    Within a *rope*,  
                    Might friends not hope  
To cure him with a *string*?  
Suppose his breath arrived at a full stop,  
The shades of death in a black cloud before him,  
Would a quintillionth dose of the New Drop  
                    Restore him?

Fancy a man gone rabid from a bite,  
                    Snapping to left and right,  
And giving tongue like one of Sebright’s hounds,  
                    Terrific sounds,  
The pallid neighbourhood with horror cowing,  
To hit the proper homœopathic mark;  
Now, might not “the last taste in life” of *bark*,  
                    Stop his *bow-wow-ing*?  
Nay, with a well-known remedy to fit him,  
Would he not mend, if with all proper care,  
                    He took “*a hair*  
*Of the dog that bit him?*”

Picture a man—we’ll say a Dutch Meinheer—

In evident emotion,  
Bent o'er the bulwark of the Batavier,  
Owning those symptoms queer—  
Some feel in a *Sick Transit* o'er the ocean,  
Can anything in life be more pathetic  
Than when he turns to us his wretched face?—  
But would it mend his case  
To be decillionth-dosed  
With something like the ghost  
Of an emetic?

Lo! now a darkened room!  
Look through the dreary gloom,  
And see that coverlet of wildest form,  
Tost like the billows in a storm,  
Where ever and anon, with groans, emerges  
A ghastly head!  
While two impatient arms still beat the bed,  
Like a strong swimmer's struggling with the surges;  
There Life and Death are on their battle-plain,  
With many a mortal ecstasy of pain—  
What shall support the body in its trial,  
Cool the hot blood, wild dream, and parching skin,  
And tame the raging malady within—  
A sniff of Next-to-Nothing in a phial?

Oh! Doctor Hahnemann, if here I laugh,  
And cry together, half and half,  
Excuse me, 'tis a mood the subject brings,  
To think, whilst I have crowed like chanticleer,  
Perchance, from some dull eye the hopeless tear  
Hath gushed, with my light levity at schism,  
To mourn some Martyr of Empiricism!  
Perchance, on thy own system, I have given  
A pang superfluous to the pains of Sorrow,  
Who weeps with Memory from morn till even;  
Where comfort there is none to lend or borrow,  
Sighing to one sad strain,



“She will not come again,  
To-morrow, nor to-morrow, nor to-morrow!”

Doctor, forgive me, if I dare prescribe  
A rule for thee thyself, and all thy tribe,  
Inserting a few serious words by stealth;  
*Above all price of wealth  
The Body’s Jewel,—not for minds profane,  
Or hands, to tamper with in practice vain—  
Like to a Woman’s Virtue is Man’s Health.  
A heavenly gift within a holy shrine!  
To be approached and touched with serious fear,  
By hands made pure, and hearts of faith severe,  
Even as the priesthood of the ONE divine!*

But, zounds! each fellow with a suit of black,  
And, strange to fame,  
With a diploma’d name,  
That carries two more letters pick-a-back,  
With cane, and snuff-box, powdered wig, and block,  
Invents *his* dose, as if it were a chrism,  
And dares to treat our wondrous mechanism,  
Familiar as the works of old Dutch clock;  
Yet, how would common sense esteem the man,  
Oh how, my unrelated German cousin,  
Who having some such time-keeper on trial,  
And finding it too fast, enforced the dial  
To strike upon the Homœopathic plan  
Of fourteen to the dozen?  
Take my advice, ’tis given without a fee,  
Drown, drown your book ten thousand fathoms deep  
Like Prospero’s beneath the briny sea,  
For spells of magic have all gone to sleep!  
Leave no decillionth fragment of your works,  
To help the interests of quacking Burkes;  
Aid not in murdering even widow’s mites,—  
And now forgive me for my candid zeal,  
I had not said so much but that I feel

I had not said so much, but that I feel

Should you *take ill* what here my Muse indites,  
An Ode-ling more will set you all to rights.

---

TO THE ADVOCATES FOR THE REMOVAL OF SMITHFIELD  
MARKET.

“Sweeping our flocks and herds.”—DOUGLAS.



PHILANTHROPIC men!—

For this address I need not make apology—  
Who aim at clearing out the Smithfield pen,  
And planting further off its vile Zoology—  
Permit me thus to tell,  
I like your efforts well,  
For routing that great nest of Hornithology!

Be not dismay'd although repulsed at first,  
And driven from their Horse, and Pig, and Lamb parts,  
Charge on!—you shall upon their hornworks burst,  
And carry all their *Bull*-warks and their *Ram*-parts.

Go on, ye wholesale drovers!  
And drive away the Smithfield flocks and herds!  
As wild as Tartar-Curds,  
That come so fat, and kicking, from their clovers,  
Off with them all!—those restive brutes, that vex  
Our streets, and plunge, and lunge, and butt, and battle;  
And save the female sex  
From being cow'd—like Iö—by the cattle!

Fancy,—when droves appear on  
The hill of Holborn, roaring from its top,—  
Your ladies—ready, as they own, to drop,  
Taking themselves to Thomson's with a *Fear-on*!

Or, in St. Martin's Lane,  
Scared by a Bullock, in a frisky vein,—  
Fancy the terror of your timid daughters  
While rushing souse  
Into a coffee-house,  
To find it—Slaughter's.

Or fancy this:—  
Walking along the street, some stranger Miss,  
Her head with no such thought of danger laden,

When suddenly 'tis "Aries laurus Virgo!"  
You don't know Latin, I translate it ergo,  
Into your Areas a Bull throws the Maiden!  
Think of some poor old crone  
Treated, just like a penny, with a toss!  
At that vile spot now grown  
So generally known  
For making a Cow Cross!

Nay, fancy your own selves far off from stall,  
Or shed, or shop—and that an Ox infuriate  
Just pins you to the wall,  
Giving you a strong dose of *Oxy-Muriate*!

Methinks I hear the neighbours that live round  
The Market-ground  
Thus make appeal unto their civic fellows—  
“ 'Tis well for you that live apart—unable  
To hear this brutal Babel,  
But our *firesides* are troubled with their *bellows*.

“Folks that too freely sup  
Must e'en put up  
With their own troubles if they can't digest;  
But we must needs regard  
The case as hard  
The *others'* victuals should disturb our rest,  
That from our sleep *your* food should start and jump us!  
We like, ourselves, a steak,  
But, Sirs, for pity's sake!  
We don't want oxen at our doors to *rump-us*!

“If we *do* doze—it really is too bad!  
We constantly are roar'd awake or rung,  
Through bullocks mad  
That run in all the 'Night Thoughts' of our Young!”

Such are the woes of sleepers—now let's take  
The woes of those that wish to keep a *Wake*

THE WOES OF THOSE THAT WISH TO KEEP A WARE.

Oh think! when Wombell gives his annual feasts,  
Think of these “Bulls of Basan,” far from mild ones;  
Such fierce tame beasts,  
That nobody much cares to see the Wild ones!

Think of the Show woman, “what shows a Dwarf,”  
Seeing a red Cow come  
To swallow her Tom Thumb,  
And forc’d with broom of birch to keep her off!

Think, too, of Messrs. Richardson and Co.,  
When looking at their public private boxes,  
To see in the back row  
Three live sheep’s heads, a porker’s and an Ox’s!  
Think of their Orchestra, when two horns come  
Through, to accompany the double drum!

Or, in the midst of murder and remorse,  
Just when the Ghost is certain,  
A great rent in the curtain,  
And enter two tall skeletons—of Horses!

Great philanthropics! pray urge these topics!  
Upon the solemn Councils of the Nation,  
Get a Bill soon, and give, some noon,  
The Bulls, a Bull of Excommunication!

Let the old Fair have fair-play as its right,  
And to each show and sight  
Ye shall be treated with a Free List latitude;  
To Richardson’s Stage Dramas,  
Dio—and Cosmo—ramas,  
Giants and Indians wild,  
Dwarf, Sea Bear, and Fat Child,  
And that most rare of Shows—a Show of gratitude!

---



TO MARY

AT NO. 1, NEWGATE.

*Favoured by Mr. Wontner.*





MARY, I believ'd you true,  
And I was blest in so believing;  
But till this hour I never knew—  
That you were taken up for thieving!

Oh! when I snatch'd a tender kiss  
Or some such trifle when I courted,  
You said, indeed, that love was bliss,  
But never owned you were transported!

But then to gaze on that fair face—  
It would have been an unfair feeling,  
To dream that you had pilfered lace—  
And Flints had suffered from your stealing!

Or when my suit I first preferr'd,  
To bring your coldness to repentance,  
Before I hammer'd out a word,  
How could I dream you'd heard a sentence!

Or when with all the warmth of youth  
I strove to prove my love no fiction,  
How could I guess I urged a truth  
On one already past conviction!

How could I dream that ivory part,  
Your hand—where I have look'd and linger'd,  
Altho' it stole away my heart,  
Had been held up as one light-finger'd!

In melting verse your charms I drew,  
The charms in which my muse delighted—  
Alas! the lay I thought was new,  
Spoke only what had been *indicted*!

Oh! when that form, a lovely one,  
Hung on the neck its arms had flown to,  
I little thought that you had run

I had thought that you had run  
A chance of hanging on your own too.

You said you pick'd me from the world,  
My vanity it now must shock it—  
And down at once my pride is hurl'd,  
You've pick'd me—and you've pick'd a pocket.

Oh! when our love had got so far,  
The bans were read by Dr. Daley,  
Who asked if there was any *bar*—  
Why did not some one shout “Old Bailey?”

But when you rob'd your flesh and bones  
In that pure white that angel garb is,  
Who could have thought you, Mary Jones,  
Among the Joans that link with *Darbies*?

And when the parson came to say,  
My goods were yours, if I had got any,  
And you should honour and obey,  
Who could have thought—“O Bay of Botany.”

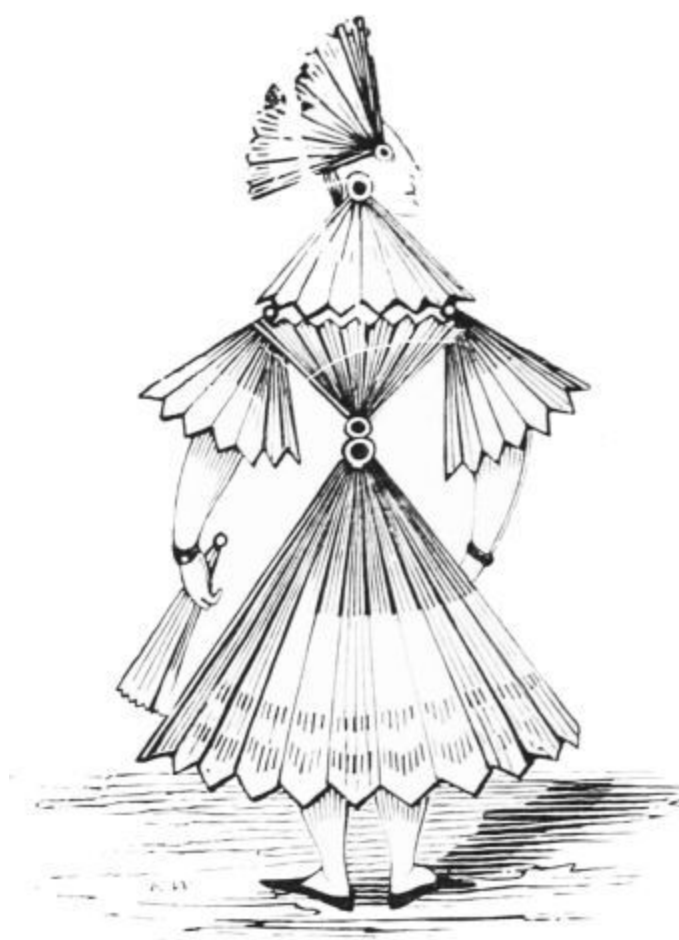
But, oh,—the worst of all your slips  
I did not till this day discover—  
That down in Deptford's prison ships,  
Oh, Mary! you've a hulking lover!

No. II.

“Love, with a witness.”

He has shaved off his whiskers and blacken'd his brows,  
Wears a patch and a wig of false hair,—  
But it's him—Oh it's him!—we exchanged lovers' vows,  
When I lived up in Cavendish Square.

He had beautiful eyes, and his lips were the same,  
And his voice was as soft as a flute—



FANNY.



FINDING A MAY'R'S NEST.

Like a Lord or a Marquis he look'd when he came,  
To make love in his master's best suit.

If I lived for a thousand long years from my birth,  
I shall never forget what he told;  
How he lov'd me beyond the rich women of earth,  
With their jewels and silver and gold!

When he kissed me and bade me adieu with a sigh,  
By the light of the sweetest of moons,  
Oh how little I dreamt I was bidding good-bye  
To my Missis's tea-pot and spoons!

No. III.

"I'd be a Parody."—BAILEY.

We met—'twas in a mob—and I thought he had done me—  
I felt—I could not feel—for no watch was upon me;  
He ran—the night was cold—and his pace was unalter'd,  
I too longed much to pelt—but my small-boned legs falter'd.  
I wore my bran new boots—and unrivall'd their brightness,  
They fit me to a hair—how I hated their tightness!  
I call'd, but no one came, and my stride had a tether;  
Oh *thou* hast been the cause of this anguish, my leather!

And once again we met—and an old pal was near him,  
He swore a something low—but 'twas no use to fear him;  
I seized upon his arm, he was mine and mine only,  
And stept—as he deserv'd—to cells wretched and lonely;  
And there he will be tried—but I shall ne'er receive her,  
The watch that went too sure for an artful deceiver;  
The world may think me gay,—heart and feet ache together,  
Oh *thou* hast been the cause of this anguish, my leather.

---

TO FANNY.

“Gay being, born to flutter!”—SALE’S GLEE.



S this your faith, then, Fanny!  
What, to chat with every Dun?  
I'm the one, then, but of many,  
Not of many, but the *One*!

Last night you smil'd on all, Ma'am,  
That appear'd in scarlet dress;  
And your Regimental Ball, Ma'am,  
Look'd a little like a *Mess*.

I thought that of the Sogers  
(As the Scotch say) one might do;  
And that I, slight Ensign Rogers,  
Was the chosen man and true.

But 'Sblood! your eye was busy  
With that ragamuffin mob;—  
Colonel Buddell—Colonel Dizzy—  
And Lieutenant-Colonel Cobb.

General Joblin, General Jodkin,  
Colonels—Kelly, Felly, with  
Majors—Sturgeon, Truffle, Bodkin  
And the Quarter-master Smith.

Major Powderum—Major Dowdrum—  
Major Chowdrum—Major Bye—  
Captain Tawney—Captain Fawney,  
Captain Any-one—but I!

Deuce take it! when the regiment  
You so praised, I only thought  
That you lov'd it in abridgement,  
But I now am better taught!

I went, as loving man goes,  
To admire thee in quadrilles;  
But Fan— you dance fandangoes

But Fan, you dance tangos  
With just any fop that wills!

I went with notes before us,  
On the lay of Love to touch;  
But with all the Corps in chorus,  
Oh! it is indeed too much!

You once—ere you contracted  
For the Army—seem'd my own;  
But now you laugh with all the Staff,  
And I may sigh alone!

I know not how it chances,  
When my passion ever dares,  
But the warmer my advances,  
Then the cooler are your airs.

I am, I don't conceal it,  
But I am a little hurt;  
You're a Fan, and I must feel it,  
Fit for nothing but a *Flirt*!

I dreamt thy smiles of beauty  
On myself alone did fall;  
But alas! "Cosi Fan Tutti!"  
It is thus, Fan, thus with all!

You have taken quite a mob in  
Of new military flames;—  
They would make a fine Round Robin  
If I gave you all their names!

---





TO MR. MALTHUS.



Y dear, do pull the bell,  
And pull it well,  
And send those noisy children all up stairs,  
Now playing here like bears—  
You George, and William, go into the grounds,  
Charles, James, and Bob are there,—and take your string,  
Drive horses, or fly kites, or anything,  
You're quite enough to play at hare and hounds,—  
You little May, and Caroline, and Poll,  
Take each your doll,  
And go, my dears, into the two-back pair,  
Your sister Margaret's there—  
Harriet and Grace, thank God, are both at school,  
At far off Ponty Pool—  
I want to read, but really can't get on—  
Let the four twins, Mark, Matthew, Luke, and John,  
Go—to their nursery—go—I never can  
Enjoy my Malthus among such a clan!

Oh Mr. Malthus, I agree  
In everything I read with thee!  
The world's too full, there is no doubt,  
And wants a deal of thinning out,—  
It's plain—as plain as Harrow Steeple—  
And I agree with some thus far,  
Who say the Queen's too popular,  
That is,—she has too many people.

There are too many of all trades,  
Too many bakers,  
Too many every-thing-makers,  
But not too many undertakers,—  
Too many boys,—  
Too many hobby-de-hoys,—  
Too many girls, men, widows, wives and maids,—  
There is a dreadful surplus to demolish,  
And yet some Wrongheads,

With thick not long heads,  
Poor Metaphysicians!  
Sign petitions  
Capital punishment to abolish;  
And in the face of censuses such vast ones  
New hospitals contrive,  
For keeping life alive,  
Laying first stones, the dolts! instead of last ones!  
Others, again, in the same contrariety,  
Deem that of all Humane Society  
They really deserve thanks,  
Because the two banks of the Serpentine,  
By their design,  
Are Saving Banks.  
Oh! were it given but to me to weed  
The human breed,  
And root out here and there some cumbering elf,  
I think I could go through it,  
And really do it  
With profit to the world and to myself,—  
For instance, the unkind among the Editors,  
My debtors, those I mean to say  
Who cannot or who will not pay  
And all my creditors.  
  
These, for my own sake, I'd destroy;  
But for the world's, and every one's,  
I'd hoe up Mrs. G—'s two sons,  
And Mrs. B—'s big little boy,  
Call'd only by herself an "only joy."  
As Mr. Irving's chapel's not too full,  
Himself alone I'd pull—  
But for the peace of years that have to run,  
I'd make the Lord Mayor's a perpetual station,  
And put a period to rotation,  
By rooting up all Aldermen but one,—  
These are but hints what good might thus be done!  
But ah! I fear the public good

But all I fear the public good  
Is little by the public understood,—  
For instance—if with flint, and steel, and tinder,  
Great Swing, for once a philanthropic man  
Proposed to throw a light upon thy plan,  
No doubt some busy fool would hinder  
His burning all the Foundling to a cinder.

Or, if the Lord Mayor, on an Easter Monday,  
That wine and bun-day,  
Proposed to poison all the little Blue-coats  
Before they died by bit or sup,  
Some meddling Marplot would blow up,  
Just at the moment critical,  
The economy political  
Of Saving their fresh yellow plush and new coats.  
Equally 'twould be undone,  
Suppose the Bishop of London,  
On that great day  
In June or May,  
When all the large small family of charity,  
Brown, black, or carroty,  
Walk in their dusty parish shoes  
In too, too many two-and-twos,  
To sing together till they scare the walls  
Of old St. Paul's,  
Sitting in red, grey, green, blue, drab, and white,  
Some say a gratifying sight,  
Tho' I think sad—but that's a schism—  
To witness so much pauperism—

Suppose, I say, the Bishop then, to make  
In this poor overcrowded world more room,  
Proposed to shake  
Down that immense extinguisher, the dome—  
Some humane Martin in the charity *Gal*-way  
I fear would come and interfere,  
Save beadle, brat, and overseer,  
To walk back in their parish shoes

to walk back in their parish shoes,  
In too, too many two-and-twos,  
Islington—Wapping—or Pall Mall way!

Thus people hatch'd from goose's egg,  
Foolishly think a pest a plague,  
And in its face their doors all shut,  
On hinges oil'd with cajeput—  
Drugging themselves with drams well spiced and cloven,  
And turning pale as linen rags,  
At hoisting up of yellow flags,  
While you and I are crying "Orange Boven!"  
Why should we let precautions so absorb us,  
Or trouble shipping with a quarantine—  
When if I understand the thing you mean,  
We ought to *import* the Cholera Morbus!

---

TO ST. SWITHIN.

“The rain it raineth every day.”



THE Dawn is overcast, the morning low'rs,  
On ev'ry window-frame hang beaded damps  
Like rows of small illumination lamps,  
To celebrate the Jubilee of Show'rs!  
A constant sprinkle patters from all leaves,  
The very Dryads are not dry, but soppers,  
And from the Houses' eaves  
Tumble eaves-droppers.

The hundred clerks that live along the street,  
Bondsmen to mercantile and City schemers,  
With squashing, sloshing and galoching feet,  
Go paddling, paddling, through the wet, like steamers,  
Each hurrying to earn the daily stipend—  
Umbrellas pass of every shade of green,  
And now and then a crimson one is seen,  
Like an Umbrella *ripen'd*.

Over the way a waggon  
Stands with six smoking horses, shrinking, blinking,  
While in the George and Dragon  
The man is keeping himself dry—and drinking!  
The Butcher's boy skulks underneath his tray,  
Hats shine—shoes don't—and down droop collars,  
And one blue Parasol cries all the way  
To school, in company with four small scholars!

Unhappy is the man to-day who rides,  
Making his journey sloppier, not shorter;  
Aye, there they go, a dozen of outsides,  
Performing on “a Stage with real water!”  
A dripping Pauper crawls along the way,  
The only real willing out-of-doorer  
And says, or seems to say,  
“Well, I am poor enough—but here's a *pourer!*”

The scene in water colours thus I paint,



Is your own Festival, you Sloppy Saint!  
Mother of all the Family of Rainers!  
Saint of the Soakers!  
Making all people croakers,  
Like frogs in swampy marshes, and complainers!  
And why you mizzle forty days together,  
Giving the earth your water-soup to sup,  
I marvel—Why such wet, mysterious weather?  
I wish you'd *clear it up*!  
Why cast such cruel dampers  
On pretty Pic Nics, and against all wishes  
Set the cold ducks a-swimming in the hampers,  
And volunteer, unask'd, to wash the dishes?  
Why drive the Nymphs from the selected spot,  
To cling like lady-birds around a tree—  
Why spoil a Gipsy party at their tea,  
By throwing your cold water upon hot?

Cannot a rural maiden, or a man,  
Seek Hornsey-Wood by invitation, sipping  
Their green with Pan,  
But souse you come, and show their Pan, all dripping!  
Why upon snow-white table-cloths and sheets,  
That do not wait, or want a second washing,  
Come squashing?  
Why task yourself to lay the dust in streets,  
As if there were no Water-Cart contractors,  
No pot-boys spilling beer, no shop-boys ruddy  
Spoonng out puddles muddy,  
Milkmaids, and other slopping benefactors!

A Queen you are, raining in your own right,  
Yet oh! how little flatter'd by report!  
Even by those that seek the Court,  
Pelted with every term of spleen and spite.  
Folks rail and swear at you in every place;  
They say you are a creature of no bowel;  
They say you're always washing Nature's face,

And that you then supply her,  
With nothing drier,  
Than some old wringing cloud by way of towel!  
The whole town wants you duck'd, just as you duck it,  
They wish you on your own mud porridge supper'd,  
They hope that you may kick your own big bucket,  
Or in your water-butt go sous! heels up'ard!  
They are, in short, so weary of your drizzle,  
They'd spill the water in your veins to stop it—  
Be warn'd! You are too partial to a mizzle—  
Pray *drop it!*

---

LINES TO A LADY ON HER DEPARTURE FOR INDIA.



O where the waves run rather Holborn-hilly,  
And tempests make a soda-water sea,  
Almost as rough as our rough Piccadilly,  
And think of me!

Go where the mild Madeira ripens *her* juice,—  
A wine more praised than it deserves to be!  
Go pass the Cape, just capable of ver-juice,  
And think of me!

Go where the Tiger in the darkness prowleth,  
Making a midnight meal of he and she;  
Go where the Lion in his hunger howleth,  
And think of me!

Go where the serpent dangerously coileth,  
Or lies along at full length like a tree,  
Go where the Suttee in her own soot broileth,  
And think of me!

Go where with human notes the Parrot dealeth  
In mono-*polly*-logue with tongue as free,  
And like a woman, all she can revealeth,  
And think of me!

Go to the land of muslin and nankeening,  
And parasols of straw where hats should be,  
Go to the land of slaves and palankeening,  
And think of me!

Go to the land of Jungles and of vast hills,  
And tall bamboos—may none *bamboozle* thee!  
Go gaze upon their Elephants and Castles,  
And think of me!

Go where a cook must always be a currier,  
And parch the pepper'd palate like a pea,  
Go where the fierce mosquito is a warrior

Go where the fierce musquito is a warrior,  
And think of me!

Go where the maiden on a marriage plan goes,  
Consign'd for wedlock to Calcutta's quay,  
Where woman goes for mart, the same as mangoes,  
And think of me!

Go where the sun is very hot and fervent,  
Go to the land of pagod and rupee,  
Where every black will be your slave and servant,  
And think of me!

---

SIR JOHN BOWRING.



O Bowring, man of many tongues,  
(All over tongues like rumour)  
This tributary verse belongs  
To paint his learned humour;  
All kinds of gabs he talks, I wis,  
From Latin down to Scottish;  
As fluent as a parrot is,  
But far more *Polly*-glottish!  
No grammar too abstruse he meets  
However dark and verby,—  
He gossips Greek about the streets,  
And often *Russ*—in urbe—:  
Strange tongues whate'er you do them call,  
In short the man is able  
To tell you what's *o'clock* in all  
The *dialects* of Babel.  
Take him on 'Change; try Portuguese,  
The Moorish and the Spanish,  
Polish, Hungarian, Tyrolese,  
The Swedish and the Danish;  
Try him with these and fifty such,  
His skill will ne'er diminish,  
Although you should begin in Dutch  
And end (like me) in *Finnish*.

---

TO MR. M'ADAM.

“Let us take to the road!”—*Beggar's Opera*.



ADAM, hail!  
Hail, Roadian! hail, Collossus! who dost stand  
Striding ten thousand turnpikes on the land!  
Oh universal Leveller! all hail!  
To thee, a good, yet stony-hearted man,  
The kindest one, and yet the flintiest going,—  
To thee,—how much for thy commodious plan,  
Lanark Reformer of the Ruts, is Owing!  
The Bristol mail  
Gliding o'er ways, hitherto deem'd invincible,  
When carrying Patriots, now shall never fail  
Those of the most "*unshaken* public principle."  
Hail to thee, Scot of Scots!  
Thou northern light, amid those heavy men!  
Foe to Stonehenge, yet friend to all beside,  
Thou scatter'st flints and favours far and wide,  
From palaces to cots;—  
Dispenser of coagulated good!  
Distributor of granite and of food!  
Long may thy fame its even path march on,  
E'en when thy sons are dead!  
Best benefactor! though thou giv'st a stone  
To those who ask for bread!

Thy first great trial in this mighty town  
Was, if I rightly recollect, upon  
That gentle hill which goeth  
Down from "the County" to the Palace gate,  
And, like a river, thanks to thee, now floweth  
Past the Old Horticultural Society,—  
The chemist Cobb's, the house of Howell and James,  
Where ladies play high shawl and satin games—  
A little *Hell* of lace!  
And past the Athenæum, made of late,  
Severs a sweet variety  
Of milliners and booksellers who grace  
Waterloo Place.



Making division, the Muse fears and guesses,  
'Twixt Mr. Rivington's and Mr Hessey's.  
Thou stood'st thy trial, Mac! and shaved the road  
From Barber Beaumont's to the King's abode  
So well, that pavours threw their rammers by,  
Let down their tuck'd shirt sleeves, and with a sigh  
Prepared themselves, poor souls, to chip or die!

Next, from the palace to the prison, thou  
Didst go, the highway's watchman, to thy beat,—  
Preventing though the *rattling* in the street,  
Yet kicking up a row,  
Upon the stones—ah! truly watchman-like,  
Encouraging thy victims all to strike,  
To further thy own purpose, Adam, daily;—  
Thou hast smoothed, alas, the path to the Old Bailey!  
And to the stony bowers  
Of Newgate, to encourage the approach,  
By caravan or coach,—  
Hast strewed the way with flints as soft as flowers.

Who shall dispute thy name!  
Insculpt in stone in every street,  
We soon shall greet  
Thy trodden down, yet all unconquered fame!  
Where'er we take, even at this time, our way,  
Nought see we, but mankind in open air,  
Hammering thy fame, as Chantrey would not dare;—  
And with a patient care  
Chipping thy immortality all day!  
Demosthenes, of old,—that rare old man,—  
Prophetically *followed*, Mac! thy plan:—  
For he, we know,  
(History says so,)  
Put *pebbles* in his mouth when he would speak  
The *smoothest* Greek!  
It is “impossible, and cannot be,”  
But that thy genius hath

But that thy genius hath,  
Besides the turnpike, many another path  
Trode, to arrive at popularity.  
O'er Pegasus, perchance, thou hast thrown a thigh,  
Nor ridden a roadster only;—mighty Mac!  
And 'faith I'd swear, when on that wingèd hack,  
Thou hast observed the highways in the sky!  
Is the path up Parnassus rough and steep,  
And "hard to climb," as Dr. B. would say?  
Dost think it best for Sons of Song to keep  
The noiseless *tenor* of their way? (see Gray.)  
What line of road *should* poets take to bring  
Themselves unto those waters, loved the first!—  
Those waters which can wet a man to sing!  
Which, like thy fame, "from *granite* basins burst,  
Leap into life, and, sparkling, woo the thirst?"

That thou'rt a proser, even thy birthplace might  
Vouchsafe;—and Mr. Cadell *may*, God wot,  
Have paid thee many a pound for many a blot,—  
Cadell's a wayward wight!  
Although no Walter, still thou art a Scot,  
And I can throw, I think, a little light  
Upon some works thou hast written for the town,—  
And published, like a Lilliput Unknown!  
"Highways and Byeways" is thy book, no doubt,  
(One whole edition's out,  
And next, for it is fair  
That Fame,  
Seeing her children, should confess she had 'em;—  
"Some *Passages* from the life of Adam Blair,"—  
(Blair is a Scottish name,)  
What are they, but thy own good roads, M'Adam?

O! indefatigable labourer  
In the paths of men! when thou shalt die, 'twill be  
A mark of thy surpassing industry,  
That of the monument, which men shall rear  
Over thy most inestimable bone

Over thy most measurable done,  
Thou didst thy very self lay the first stone!—  
Of a right ancient line thou comest,—through  
Each crook and turn we trace the unbroken clue,  
Until we see thy sire before our eyes,—  
Rolling his gravel walks in Paradise!  
But he, our great Mac Parent, erred, and ne'er  
    Have our walks since been fair?  
Yet Time, who, like the merchant, lives on 'Change,  
For ever varying, through his varying range,  
    Time maketh all things even!  
In this strange world, turning beneath high heaven,  
    He hath redeemed the Adams, and contrived,—  
        (How are time's wonders hived!)  
    In pity to mankind, and to befriend 'em,—  
        (Time is above all praise,)  
That he, who first did make our evil ways,  
Reborn in Scotland, should be first to mend 'em!

---

A *FRIENDLY* EPISTLE TO MRS. FRY, *IN* NEWGATE.

“Sermons in stones.”—*As You Like It*.

“Out! out! damned spot!”—*Macbeth*.



**“TO LADIES’ EYES A ROUND, BOYS!”**

I like to hear your sweet *Pandeans* play;  
I like the pity in your full-brimmed eye;  
I like your carriage, and your silken grey,  
Your dove-like habits, and your silent preaching;  
But I don't like your Newgatory teaching.

Come out of Newgate, Mrs. Fry! Repair  
Abroad, and find your pupils in the streets.  
O, come abroad into the wholesome air,  
And take your moral place, before Sin seats  
Her wicked self in the Professor's chair.  
Suppose some morals raw! the true receipt's  
To dress them in the pan, but do not try  
To cook them in the fire, good Mrs. Fry!

Put on your decent bonnet, and come out!  
Good lack! the ancients did not set up schools  
In jail—but at the *Porch!* hinting, no doubt,  
That Vice should have a lesson in the rules  
Before 'twas whipt by law.—O come about,  
Good Mrs. Fry! and set up forms and stools  
All down the Old Bailey, and thro' Newgate-street,  
But not in Mr. Wontner's proper seat!

Teach Lady Barrymore, if, teaching, you  
That peerless Peeress can absolve from dolour;  
Teach her it is not virtue to pursue  
Ruin of blue, or any other colour;  
Teach her it is not Virtue's crown to rue,  
Month after month, the unpaid drunken dollar;  
Teach her that “flooring Charleys” is a game  
Unworthy one that bears a Christian name.

O come and teach our children—that ar'n't *ours*—  
That heaven's straight pathway is a narrow way,  
Not Broad St. Giles's, where fierce Sin devours  
Children, like Time—or rather they both prey

On youth together—meanwhile Newgate low’rs  
Ev’n like a black cloud at the close of day,  
To shut them out from any more blue sky:  
Think of these hopeless wretches, Mrs. Fry!

You are not nice—go into their retreats,  
And make them Quakers, if you will.—’Twere best  
They wore straight collars, and their shirts sans *pleats*;  
That they had hats *with* brims,—that they were drest  
In garbs without *lappels*—than shame the streets  
With so much raggedness.—You may invest  
Much cash this way—but it will cost its price,  
To give a good, round, real *cheque* to Vice!

In brief,—Oh teach the child its moral rote,  
Not *in* the way from which ’twill not depart,—  
But *out*—out—out! Oh, bid it walk remote!  
And if the skies are closed against the smart,  
Ev’n let him wear the single-breasted coat,  
For that ensureth singleness of heart.—  
Do what you will, his every want supply,  
*Keep* him—but *out* of Newgate, Mrs. Fry!

---





TO MR. DYMOKE.

THE CHAMPION OF ENGLAND.

“—— Arma Virumque cano!”—VIRGIL.



R. DYMOKE! Sir Knight! if I may be so bold—  
(I'm a poor simple gentleman just come to town,)  
Is your armour put by, like the sheep in a fold?—  
Is your gauntlet ta'en up, which you lately flung down?

Are you—who *that* day rode so mail'd and admired,  
Now sitting at ease in a library chair?  
Have you sent back to Astley the war-horse you hired,  
With a cheque upon Chambers to settle the fare?

What's become of the cup? Great tin-plate worker! say!  
Cup and ball is a game which some people deem fun!  
Oh: *three golden balls* haven't lured you to play  
Rather false, Mr. D., to all pledges but one?

How defunct is the show that was chivalry's mimic!  
The breastplate—the feathers—the gallant array!  
So fades, so grows dim, and so dies, Mr. Dymoke!  
The day of brass breeches! as Wordsworth would say!

Perchance in some village remote, with a cot,  
And a cow, and a pig, and a barndoor, and all;—  
You show to the parish that peace is your lot,  
And plenty,—though absent from Westminster Hall!

And of course you turn every accoutrement now  
To its separate use, that your wants may be well-met;—  
You toss in your breastplate your pancakes, and grow  
A salad of mustard and cress in your helmet.

And you delve the fresh earth with your falchion, less bright  
Since hung up in sloth from its Westminster task;  
And you bake your own bread in your tin; and, Sir Knight,  
Instead of your brow, put your beer in the casque!

How delightful to sit by your beans and your peas,  
With a goblet of gooseberry gallantly clutched,  
And chat of the blood that had deluged the Pleas

And chat of the blood that had deluged the floors

And drenched the King's Bench,—if the glove had been touched!

If Sir Columbine Daniel, with knightly pretensions

Had snatched your “best doe,”—he'd have flooded the floor;—

Nor would even the best of his crafty inventions,

“Life Preservers,” have floated him out of his gore!

Oh, you and your horse! what a couple was there!

The man and his *backer*,—to win a great fight!

Though the trumpet was loud,—you'd an undisturbed air!

And the nag snuffed the feast and the fray *sans* affright!

Yet strange was the course which the good Cato bore

When he waddled tail-wise with the cup to his stall;—

For though his departure was at the front door,

Still he went the back way out of Westminster Hall.

He went,—and 'twould puzzle historians to say,

When they trust Time's conveyance to carry your *mail*,—

Whether caution or courage inspired him that day,

For though he retreated, he never turned tail.

By my life, he's a wonderful charger!—The best!

Though not for a Parthian corps!—yet for you!—

Distinguished alike at a fray and a feast,

What a horse for a grand Retrospective Review!

What a creature to keep a hot warrior cool

When the sun's in the face, and the shade's far aloof!—

What a *tailpiece* for Bewick!—or piebald for Poole,

To bear him in safety from Elliston's hoof!

Well! hail to old Cato! the hero of scenes

May Astley or age ne'er his comforts abridge;—

Oh, long may he munch Amphitheatre beans,

Well “pent up in Utica” over the Bridge!

And to you, Mr. Dymoke, Cribb's rival, I keep

Wishing all country pleasures, the bravest and best!  
And oh! when you come to the Hummums to sleep,  
May you lie “like a warrior taking his rest!”

---

TO JOSEPH GRIMALDI, SENIOR.

“This fellow’s wise enough to play the fool,  
And to do that well craves a kind of wit.”  
—*Twelfth Night*.



JOSEPH! they say thou'st left the stage,  
To toddle down the hill of life,  
And taste the flannell'd ease of age,  
Apart from pantomimic strife—  
“Retired—[for Young would call it so]—  
The world shut out”—in Pleasant Row!

And hast thou really wash'd at last  
From each white cheek the red half-moon!  
And all thy public Clownship cast,  
To play the private Pantaloon?  
All youth—all ages yet to be  
Shall have a heavy miss of thee!

Thou didst not preach to make us wise—  
Thou hadst no finger in our schooling—  
Thou didst not “lure us to the skies”—  
Thy simple, simple trade was—Fooling!  
And yet, Heav'n knows! we could—we can  
Much “better spare a better man!”

Oh, had it pleased the gout to take  
The reverend Croly from the stage,  
Or Southey, for our quiet's sake,  
Or Mr. Fletcher, Cupid's sage,  
Or, damme! namby pamby Poole,—  
Or any other clown or fool!

Go, Dibdin—all that bear the name,  
Go Byeway Highway man! go! go!  
Go, Skeffy—man of painted fame,  
But leave thy partner, painted Joe!  
I could bear Kirby on the wane,  
Or Signor Paulo with a sprain!

Had Joseph Wilfred Parkins made  
His grey hairs scarce in private peace—

Had Waithman sought a rural shade—  
Or Cobbett ta'en a turnpike lease—  
Or Lisle Bowles gone to *Balaam* Hill—  
I think I could be cheerful still!

Had Medwin left off, to his praise,  
Dead-lion-kicking, like—a friend!—  
Had long, long Irving gone his ways  
To muse on death at *Ponder's End*—  
Or Lady Morgan taken leave  
Of Letters—still I might not grieve!

But, Joseph—everybody's Joe!—  
Is gone—and grieve I will and must!  
As Hamlet did for Yorick, so  
Will I for thee (though not yet dust),  
And talk as he did when he miss'd  
The kissing-crust that he had kiss'd!

Ah, where is now thy rolling head!  
Thy winking, reeling, *drunken* eyes,  
(As old Catullus would have said,)  
Thy oven-mouth, that swallow'd pies—  
Enormous hunger—monstrous drouth!—  
Thy pockets greedy as thy mouth!

Ah, where thy ears, so often cuff'd!—  
Thy funny, flapping, filching hands!—  
Thy partridge body, always stuff'd  
With waifs, and strays, and contrabands!—  
Thy foot—like Berkeley's *Foote*—for why?  
'Twas often made to wipe an eye!

Ah, where thy legs—that witty pair!  
For “great wits jump”—and so did they!  
Lord! how they leap'd in lamplight air!  
Caper'd—and bounced—and strode away!—  
That years should tame the legs—alack!  
I've seen spring through an Almanack!

I've seen spring through an Almanack:

But bounds will have their bound—the shocks  
Of Time will cramp the nimblest toes;  
And those that frisk'd in silken clocks  
May look to limp in fleecy hose—  
One only—(Champion of the ring)  
Could ever make his Winter—Spring!

And gout, that owns no odds between  
The toe of Czar and toe of Clown,  
Will visit—but I did not mean  
To moralize, though I am grown  
Thus sad,—Thy going seem'd to beat  
A muffled drum for Fun's retreat!

And, may be—'tis no time to smother  
A sigh, when two prime wags of London  
Are gone—thou, Joseph, one,—the other,  
A Joe!—"sic transit gloria *Munden*!"  
A third departure some insist on,—  
Stage-apoplexy threatens Liston!—

Nay, then, let Sleeping Beauty sleep  
With ancient "*Dozey*" to the dregs,—  
Let Mother Goose wear mourning deep,  
And put a hatchment o'er her eggs!  
Let Farley weep—for Magic's man  
Is gone—his Christmas Caliban!

Let Kemble, Forbes, and Willet rain,  
As though they walk'd behind thy bier,—  
For since thou wilt not play again,  
What matters,—if in heav'n or here!  
Or in thy grave, or in thy bed!—  
There's *Quick* might just as well be dead!

Oh, how will thy departure cloud  
The lamplight of the little breast!



The Christmas child will grieve aloud  
To miss his broadest friend and best,—  
Poor urchin! what avails to him  
The cold New Monthly's *Ghost of Grimm*?

For who like thee could ever stride!  
Some dozen paces to the mile!  
The motley, medley coach provide—  
Or like Joe Frankenstein compile  
The *vegetable man* complete!—  
A proper *Covent Garden* feat!

Oh, who like thee could ever drink,  
Or eat,—swill—swallow—bolt—and choke!  
Nod, weep, and hiccup—sneeze and wink?—  
Thy very yawn was quite a joke!  
Though Joseph, Junior, acts not ill,  
“There's no Fool like the old Fool” still!

Joseph, farewell! dear funny Joe!  
We met with mirth,—we part in pain!  
For many a long, long year must go  
Ere Fun can see thy like again—  
For Nature does not keep great stores  
Of perfect Clowns—that are not *Boors*!

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TO SYLVANUS URBAN, ESQ.,

EDITOR OF THE "GENTLEMAN'S MAGAZINE."

"Dost thou not suspect my years?"—*Much Ado about Nothing*.



H! Mr. Urban! never must *thou* lurch  
A sober age made serious drunk by thee;  
Hop in thy pleasant way from church to church,  
And nurse thy little bald Biography.

Oh, my Sylvanus! what a heart is thine!  
And what a page attends thee! Long may I  
Hang in demure confusion o'er each line  
That asks thy little questions with a sigh!

Old tottering years have nodded to their falls,  
Like pensioners that creep about and die;—  
But thou, Old Parr of periodicals,  
Livest in monthly immortality!

How sweet!—as Byron of *his* infant said,—  
“Knowledge of objects” in thine eye to trace;  
To see the mild no-meanings of thy head,  
Taking a quiet nap upon thy face!

How dear through thy Obituary to roam,  
And not a name of any name to catch!  
To meet thy Criticism walking home  
Averse from rows, and never calling “Watch!”

Rich is thy page in soporific things,—  
Composing compositions,—lulling men,—  
Faded old posies of unburied rings,—  
Confessions dozing from an opiate pen:—

Lives of Right Reverends that have never lived,—  
Deaths of good people that have really died,—  
Parishioners,—hatched,—husbanded,—and wived,—  
Bankrupts and Abbots breaking side by side!

The sacred query,—the remote response,—  
The march of serious mind, extremely slow,—  
The graver's cut at some right aged scone

The graver's cut at some high aged scoundrel,  
Famous for nothing many years ago!

B. asks of C. if Milton e'er did write  
"Comus," obscured beneath some Ludlow lid;—  
And C., next month, an answer doth indite,  
Informing B. that Mr. Milton did!

X. sends the portrait of a genuine flea,  
Caught upon Martin Luther years ago;—  
And Mr. Parkes, of Shrewsbury, draws a bee,  
Long dead, that gathered honey for King John.

There is no end of thee,—there is no end,  
Sylvanus, of thy A, B, C, D-merits!  
Thou dost, with alphabets, old walls attend,  
And poke the letters into holes, like ferrets.

Go on, Sylvanus!—Bear a wary eye,  
The churches cannot yet be quite run out!  
Some parishes must yet have been passed by,—  
There's Bullock-Smithy has a church no doubt!

Go on—and close the eyes of distant ages!  
Nourish the names of the undoubted dead!  
So Epicures shall pick thy lobster-pages,  
Heavy and lively, though but seldom *red*.

Go on! and thrive! Demurest of odd fellows!  
Bottling up dulness in an ancient binn!  
Still live! still prose!—continue still to tell us  
Old truths! no strangers, though we take them in!

---



TO W. KITCHENER, M.D.,

AUTHOR OF "THE COOK'S ORACLE," "OBSERVATIONS ON VOCAL MUSIC," "THE ART OF INVIGORATING AND PROLONGING LIFE," "PRACTICAL OBSERVATIONS ON TELESCOPES, OPERA-GLASSES, AND SPECTACLES," "THE HOUSEKEEPER'S LEDGER," AND "THE PLEASURE OF MAKING A WILL."

"I rule the roast, as Milton says!"—CALEB QUOTEM.



AIL! multifarious man!  
Thou Wondrous, Admirable Kitchen Crichton!  
Born to enlighten  
The laws of Optics, Peptics, Music, Cooking—  
Master of the Piano—and the Pan—  
As busy with the kitchen as the skies!  
Now looking  
At some rich stew through Galileo's eyes,—  
Or boiling eggs—timed to a metronome—  
As much at home  
In spectacles as in mere isinglass—  
In the art of frying brown—as a digression  
On music and poetical expression,—  
Whereas, how few, of all our cooks, alas!  
Could tell Calliope from “Callipee!”  
How few there be  
Could cleave the lowest for the highest stories,  
(Observatories,)  
And turn, like thee, Diana's calculator,  
However *cook's* synonymous with *Kater*!<sup>[5]</sup>  
Alas! still let me say,  
How few could lay  
The carving knife beside the tuning fork,  
Like the proverbial *Jack* ready for any work!

Oh, to behold thy features in thy book!  
Thy proper head and shoulders in a plate,  
How it would look!  
With one raised eye watching the dial's date,  
And one upon the roast, gently cast down—  
Thy chops—done nicely brown—  
The garnish'd brow—with “a few leaves of bay”—  
The hair—“done Wiggy's way!”  
And still one studious finger near thy brains,  
As if thou wert just come  
From editing of some  
New soup—or hashing Dibdin's cold remains!



Or, Orpheus-like,—fresh from thy dying strains  
Of music,—Epping luxuries of sound,  
                    As Milton says, “in many a bout  
                    Of linkèd sweetness long drawn out,”  
While all thy tame stuff’d leopards listen’d round!

Oh, rather thy whole proper length reveal,  
Standing like Fortune,—on the jack—thy wheel.  
(Thou art, like Fortune, full of chops and changes,  
Thou hast a fillet too before thine eye!)  
Scanning our kitchen, and our vocal ranges,  
As though it were the same to sing or fry—  
Nay, so it is—hear how Miss Paton’s throat  
                    Makes “fritters” of a note!  
And how Tom Cook (Fryer and Singer born  
By name and nature) oh! how night and morn  
He for the nicest public taste doth dish up  
The good things from that Pan of music—Bishop!  
And is not reading near akin to feeding,  
    Or why should Oxford Sausages be fit  
                    Receptacles for wit?  
    Or why should Cambridge put its little, smart,  
                    Minced brains into a Tart?  
Nay, then, thou wert but wise to frame receipts,  
                    Book-treats,  
Equally to instruct the Cook and cram her—  
    Receipts to be devour’d, as well as read,  
                    The Culinary Art in gingerbread—  
                    The Kitchen’s *Eaten* Grammar!

Oh, very pleasant is thy motley page—  
    Aye, very pleasant in its chatty vein—  
    So—in a kitchen—would have talk’d Montaigne.  
That merry Gascon—humourist, and sage!  
Let slender minds with single themes engage,  
    Like Mr. Bowles with his eternal Pope,—  
                    Or Haydon on perpetual Haydon,—or  
                    Hume on—“Twice three make four”

ONE ON — TWICE THREE MAKE FOUR.  
Or Lovelass upon Wills,—Thou goest on  
Plaiting ten topics, like Tate Wilkinson!

Thy brain is like a rich Kaleidoscope,  
Stuff'd with a brilliant medley of odd bits,  
And ever shifting on from change to change,  
Saucepans—old Songs—Pills—Spectacles—and Spits!  
Thy range is wider than a Rumford range!

Thy grasp a miracle!—till I recall  
Th' indubitable cause of thy variety—  
Thou art, of course, th' Epitome of all  
That spying—frying—singing—mix'd Society  
Of Scientific Friends, who used to meet  
Welsh Rabbits—and thyself—in Warren Street!

Oh, hast thou still those *Conversazioni*,  
Where learn'd visitors discoursed—and fed?

There came Belzoni,  
Fresh from the ashes of Egyptian dead—  
And gentle Poki—and that Royal Pair,  
Of whom thou didst declare—  
“Thanks to the greatest *Cooke* we ever read—  
They were—what *Sandwiches* should be—half *bred*?”  
There famed M'Adam from his manual toil  
Relax'd—and freely own'd he took thy hints

On “making *Broth* with *Flints*”—  
There Parry came, and show'd thee polar oil  
For melted butter—Combe with his medullary  
Notions about the *Skullery*,  
And Mr. Poole, too partial to a broil—  
There witty Rogers came, that punning elf!

Who used to swear thy book  
Would really look  
A *Delphic* “Oracle,” if laid on *Delf*—  
There, once a month, came Campbell and discuss'd  
His own—and thy own—“*Magazine of Taste*”—

There Wilberforce the Just  
Came, in his old black suit, till once he traced

In y sly advice to *Poachers* of Black Folks,—  
That “do not break their yolks,”—  
Which huff’d him home, in grave disgust and haste!

There came John Clare, the poet, nor forbore  
Thy *Patties*—thou wert hand-and-glove with Moore,  
Who call’d thee “*Kitchen Addison*”—for why?  
Thou givest rules for Health and Peptic Pills,  
Forms for made dishes, and receipts for Wills,  
“*Teaching us how to live and how to die?*”

There came thy Cousin-Cook, good Mrs. Fry—  
There Trench, the Thames Projector, first brought on

His sine *Quay* non,—

There Martin would drop in on Monday eves,  
Or Fridays, from the pens, and raise his breath

‘Gainst cattle days and death,—

Answer’d by Mellish, feeder of fat beeves,

Who swore that Frenchmen never could be eager

For fighting on soup meagre—

“And yet (as thou wouldst add) the French have seen

A Marshal *Tureen?*”

Great was thy Evening Cluster!—often graced  
With Dollond—Burgess—and Sir Humphry Davy!

’Twas there M’Dermot first inclined to Taste,—

There Colburn learn’d the art of making paste

For puffs—and Accum analysed a gravy.

Colman—the Cutter of Coleman Street, ’tis said,

Came there,—and Parkins with his Ex-wise-head,

(His claim to letters)—Kater, too, the Moon’s

Crony,—and Graham, lofty on balloons,—

There Croly stalked with holy humour heated,

(Who wrote a light-horse play, which Yates completed)—

And Lady Morgan, that grinding organ,

And Brasbridge telling anecdotes of spoons,—

Madame Valbrèque thrice honour’d thee, and came

With great Rossini, his own bow and fiddle,—

The Dibdins,—Tom, Charles, Frognall, came with tuns

Of poor old books, old puns!

And even Irving spared a night from fame,  
 And talk'd—till thou didst stop him in the middle,  
                     To serve round *Tewah-diddle!* [6]  
 Then all the guests rose up, and sighed good-bye!  
 So let them:—thou thyself art still a *Host!*  
 Dibdin—Cornaro—Newton—Mrs. Fry!  
 Mrs. Glasse, Mr. Spec!—Lovell and Weber,  
 Mathews in Quot'em—Moore's fire-worshipping Gheber—  
 Thrice-worthy Worthy! seem by thee engross'd!  
 Howbeit the Peptic Cook still rules the roast,  
 Potent to hush all ventriloquial snarling,—  
 And ease the bosom pangs of indigestion!  
                     Thou art, sans question,  
 The Corporation's love—its Doctor *Darling!*  
 Look at the Civic Palate—nay, the Bed  
     Which set dear Mrs. Opie on supplying  
         “Illustrations of *Lying!*”  
 Ninety square feet of down from heel to head  
                     It measured, and I dread  
 Was haunted by a terrible night *Mare*,  
 A monstrous burthen on the corporation!—  
 Look at the Bill of Fare for one day's share,  
 Sea-turtles by the score—oxen by droves.  
 Geese, turkeys, by the flock—fishes and loaves  
     Countless, as when the Lilliputian nation  
 Was making up the huge man-mountain's ration!

Oh! worthy Doctor! surely thou hast driven  
 The squatting Demon from great Garratt's breast—  
                     (His honour seems to rest!—)  
 And what is thy reward?—Hath London given  
 Thee public thanks for thy important service?  
                     Alas! not even  
 The tokens it bestow'd on Howe and Jervis!—  
 Yet could I speak as Orators should speak  
 Before the Worshipful the Common Council  
 (Utter my bold bad grammar and pronounce ill,)  
 Thou shouldst not miss thy Freedom for a week.

~~And should not miss my reason for a penny,~~  
Richly engross'd on vellum:—Reason urges  
That he who rules our cookery—that he  
Who edits soups and gravies, ought to be  
A *Citizen*, where sauce can make a *Burgess*!

---

TO THE DEAN AND CHAPTER OF WESTMINSTER.

“Sure the Guardians of the Temple can never think they get enough.”—  
CITIZEN OF THE WORLD.



H, very reverend Dean and Chapter,  
Exhibitors of giant men,  
Hail to each surplice-back'd adapter  
Of England's dead, in her stone den!  
Ye teach us properly to prize  
Two-shilling Grays, and Gays, and Handels,  
And, to throw light upon our eyes,  
Deal in Wax Queens like old wax candles.

Oh, reverend showmen, rank and file,  
Call in your shillings, two and two;  
March with them up the middle aisle,  
And cloister them from public view.  
Yours surely are the dusty dead,  
Gladly ye look from bust to bust,  
And set a price on each great head,  
And make it come down with the dust.

Oh, as I see you walk along  
In ample sleeves and ample back,  
A pursy and well-order'd throng,  
Thoroughly fed, thoroughly black!  
In vain I strive me to be dumb,—  
You keep each bard like fatted kid,  
Grind bones for bread like Fee-faw-fum!  
And drink from skulls as Byron did!

The profitable Abbey is  
A sacred 'Change for stony stock,  
Not that a speculation 'tis—  
The profit's founded on a rock.  
Death and the Doctors in each nave  
Bony investments have inurn'd,  
And hard 'twould be to find a grave  
From which "no money is returned!"

Here many a pensive pilgrim, brought

By reverence for those learn'd bones,  
Shall often come and walk your short  
Two-shilling fare upon the stones—<sup>[7]</sup>  
Ye have that talisman of Wealth  
Which puddling chemists sought of old  
Till ruin'd out of hope and health—  
The Tomb's the stone that turns to gold!

Oh, licensed cannibals, ye eat  
Your dinners from your own dead race,  
Think Gray, preserved—a “funeral meat,”  
And Dryden, devil'd—after grace,  
A relish;—and you take your meal  
From Rare Ben Jonson underdone,  
Or, whet your holy knives on Steele,  
To cut away at Addison!

Oh say, of all this famous age,  
Whose learn'd bones your hopes expect,  
Oh have ye number'd Rydal's sage,  
Or Moore among your Ghosts elect?  
Lord Byron was not doom'd to make  
You richer by his final sleep—  
Why don't ye warn the Great to take  
Their ashes to no other heap!

Southey's reversion have ye got?  
With Coleridge, for his body, made  
A bargain?—has Sir Walter Scott,  
Like Peter Schlemihl, sold his shade?  
Has Rogers haggled hard, or sold  
His features for your marble shows,  
Or Campbell barter'd ere he's cold,  
All interest in his “*bone* repose?”

Rare is your show, ye righteous men!  
Priestly Politos,—rare, I ween;  
But should ye not outside the Den



Paint up what in it may be seen?  
A long green Shakspeare, with a deer  
Grasp'd in the many folds it died in,—  
A Butler stuff'd from ear to ear,  
Wet White Bears weeping o'er a Dryden!

Paint Garrick up like Mr. Paap,  
A Giant of some inches high;  
Paint Handel up, that organ chap,  
With you, as grinders, in his eye;  
Depict some plaintive antique thing,  
And say th' original may be seen;—  
Blind Milton with a dog and string  
May be the Beggar o' Bethnal Green!

Put up in Poet's Corner, near  
The little door, a platform small;  
Get there a monkey—never fear,  
You'll catch the gapers, one and all!  
Stand each of ye a Body Guard,  
A Trumpet under either fin,  
And yell away in Palace Yard  
“All dead! All dead! Walk in! Walk in!”

(But when the people are inside,  
Their money paid—I pray you, bid  
The keepers not to mount and ride  
A race around each coffin lid.—  
Poor Mrs. Bodkin thought, last year,  
That it was hard—the woman clacks—  
To have so little in her ear—  
And be so hurried through the Wax!—)

“Walk in! two shillings only! come!  
Be not by country grumblers funk'd!—  
Walk in, and see th' illustrious dumb,  
The Cheapest House for the defunct!”  
Write up, 'twill breed some just reflection,  
And a monument to the illustrious

And every rude surmise 'twill stop—  
Write up, that you have no connection  
(In large)—with any other shop!

And still, to catch the Clowns the more,  
With samples of your shows in Wax,  
Set some old Harry near the door  
To answer queries with his *axe*.—  
Put up some general begging-trunk—  
Since the last broke by some mishap,  
You've all a bit of General Monk,  
From the respect you bore his Cap!

---

## ON AN UNFAVOURABLE REVIEW.

“I’ll give him dash for dash.”



ERDAN, farewell! farewell to all  
Who ever praised me, great or  
small

Your poet's course is run!  
A weekly—no, an every-day  
Reviewer takes my fame away,  
And I am all undone!

I cannot live an author long!  
When I did write, O I did wrong  
To aim at being great;  
A Diamond Poet in a pin  
May twinkle on in peace, and win  
No diamond critic's hate!

No small inditer of reviews  
Will analyse his tiny muse,  
Or lay his sonnets waste;  
Who strives to prove that Richardson,  
That calls himself a diamond one,  
Is but a bard of paste?

The smallest bird that wings the sky  
May tempt some sparrow shot, and die;  
But midges still go free!  
The peace that shuns my board and bed  
May settle on a lowlier head,  
And dwell, "St. John, with thee!"

I aimed at higher growth; and now  
My leaves are withered on the bough,  
I'm choked by bitter shrubs!  
O Mr. F. C. W.!  
What can I christen thy review  
But one of "Wormwood Scrubs?"

The very man that sought me once—

(Can I so soon be grown a dunce?)  
    *He* now derides my verse;  
But who, save me, will fret to find  
The editor has changed his mind,—  
    He can't have got a worse.

---

TO PEACE.

WRITTEN ON THE NIGHT OF MY MISTRESS'S GRAND ROUT.



Oh Peace! oh come with me and dwell—  
But stop, for there's the bell.

Oh Peace! for thee I go and sit in churches,  
On Wednesday, when there's very few  
In loft or pew—

Another ring, the tarts are come from Birch's.  
Oh Peace! for thee I have avoided marriage—  
Hush! there's a carriage.

Oh Peace! thou art the best of earthly goods—  
The five Miss Woods.

Oh Peace! thou art the Goddess I adore—  
There come some more.

Oh Peace! thou child of solitude and quiet—  
That's Lord Drum's footman, for he loves a riot.

Oh Peace!

Knocks will not cease.

Oh Peace! thou wert for human comfort plann'd—  
That's Weippert's band.

Oh Peace! now glad I welcome thy approaches—  
I hear the sound of coaches.

Oh Peace! oh Peace!—another carriage stops—  
It's early for the Blenkinsops.

Oh Peace! with thee I love to wander,  
But wait till I have show'd up Lady Squander,  
And now I've seen her up the stair,  
Oh Peace!—but here comes Captain Hare.  
Oh Peace! thou art the slumber of the mind,  
Untroubled, calm and quiet, and unbroken,—  
If that is Alderman Guzzle from Portsoken,  
Alderman Gobble won't be far behind;  
Oh Peace! serene in worldly shyness,—  
Make way there for his Serene Highness!

Oh Peace! if you do not disdain  
To dwell amongst the menial train,

I have a silent place, and lone,  
That you and I may call our own;  
Where tumult never makes an entry—  
Susan, what business have you in my pantry?

Oh Peace! but there is Major Monk,  
At variance with his wife—Oh Peace!  
And that great German, Vander Trunk,  
And that great talker, Miss Apreece;  
Oh Peace! so dear to poets' quills—  
They're just beginning their quadrilles—  
Oh Peace! our greatest renovator;—  
I wonder where I put my waiter—  
Oh Peace!—but here my Ode I'll cease;  
I have no peace to write of Peace.

---



FOR THE NINTH OF NOVEMBER.



LUD! O Lud! O Lud!  
I mean of course that venerable town,  
Mention'd in stories of renown,  
Built formerly of mud;—  
O Lud, I say, why didst thou e'er  
Invent the office of a Mayor,  
An office that no useful purpose crowns,  
But to set Aldermen against each other,  
That should be Brother unto Brother,—  
Sisters at least, by virtue of their gowns?  
But still if one must have a Mayor  
To fill the Civic chair,  
O Lud, I say,  
Was there no better day  
To fix on, than November Ninth so shivery  
And dull for showing off the Livery's livery?  
Dimming, alas!  
The Brazier's brass,  
Soiling th' Embroiderers and all the Saddlers,  
Sopping the Furriers,  
Draggling the Curriers,  
And making Merchant Tailors dirty paddlers:  
Drenching the Skinners' Company to the skin,  
Making the crusty Vintner chiller,  
And turning the Distiller  
To cold without instead of warm within;—  
Spoiling the bran-new beavers  
Of Wax-chandlers and Weavers,  
Plastering the Plasterers and spotting Mercers,  
Hearty November-cursors—  
And showing Cordwainers and dapper Drapers  
Sadly in want of brushes and of scrapers;  
Making the Grocer's company not fit  
For Company a bit;  
Dying the Dyers with a dingy flood,  
Daubing incorporated Bakers,  
And leading the Patten-makers

And reading the Fatten markets,  
Over their very pattens in the mud,—  
O Lud! O Lud! O Lud!

“This is a sorry sight,”  
To quote Macbeth—but oh, it grieves me quite  
To see your Wives and Daughters in their plumes—  
White plumes not white—  
Sitting at open windows catching rheums,  
Not “Angels ever bright and fair,”  
But angels ever brown and fallow,  
With eyes—you cannot see above one pair,  
For city clouds of black and yellow—  
And artificial flowers, rose, leaf, and bud,  
Such sable lilies  
And grim daffodilies  
Drooping, but not for drought, O Lud! O Lud!

I may as well, while I’m inclined,  
Just go through all the faults I find:  
O Lud! then, with a bitter air, say June,  
Could’st thou not find a better tune  
To sound with trumpets, and with drums,  
Than “See the Conquering Hero comes,”  
When he who comes ne’er dealt in blood?  
Thy May’r is not a War Horse, Lud,  
That ever charged on Turk or Tartar,  
And yet upon a march you strike  
That treats him like—  
A little French if I may martyr—  
Lewis Cart-Horse or Henry Carter!  
O Lud! I say  
Do change your day  
To some time when your Show can really show;  
When silk can seem like silk, and gold can glow.  
Look at your Sweepers, how they shine in May  
Have it when there’s a sun to gild the coach,  
And sparkle in tiara—bracelet—brooch—  
Diamond—ornaments—of sister, mother, daughter.

Diamond—or paste—or sister, mother, daughter,  
When grandeur really may be grand—  
But if thy Pageant's thus obscured by land—  
O Lud! it's ten times worse upon the water!  
Suppose, O Lud, to show its plan,  
I call, like Blue Beard's wife, to sister Anne,  
Who's gone to Beaufort Wharf with niece and aunt  
To see what she can see—and what she can't;  
Chewing a saffron bun by way of cud,  
To keep the fog out of a tender lung,  
While perch'd in a verandah nicely hung  
Over a margin of thy own black mud,  
O Lud!

Now Sister Anne, I call to thee,  
Look out and see:  
Of course about the bridge you view them rally  
And sally,

With many a wherry, sculler, punt, and cutter;  
The Fishmongers' grand boat, but not for butter,  
The Goldsmiths' glorious galley,—  
Of course you see the Lord Mayor's coach aquatic,  
With silken banners that the breezes fan,  
In gold all glowing,  
And men in scarlet rowing,  
Like Doge of Venice to the Adriatic;  
Of course you see all this, O Sister Anne?  
“No, I see no such thing!

I only see the edge of Beaufort Wharf,  
With two coal lighters fasten'd to a ring:  
And, dim as ghosts,  
Two little boys are jumping over posts;  
And something farther off,  
That's rather like the shadow of a dog,  
And all beyond is fog.

If there be any thing so fine and bright,  
To see it I must see by second sight.

Call this a Show? It is not worth a pin!

I see no barges row,

No banners blow;

The show is merely a gallanty-show,

Without a lamp or any candle in."

But sister Anne, my dear,

Although you cannot see, you still may hear?

Of course you hear, I'm very sure of that,

The "Water parted from the Sea" in C,

Or "Where the Bee sucks," set in B;

Or Huntsman's chorus from the Freyschutz frightful,

Or Handel's Water Music in A flat.

Oh music from the water comes delightful!

It sounds as no where else it can:

You hear it first,

In some rich burst,

Then faintly sighing,

Tenderly dying

Away upon the breezes, Sister Anne.

"There is no breeze to die on;

And all their drums and trumpets, flutes and harps,

Could never cut their way with ev'n three sharps

Through such a fog as this, you may rely on.

I think, but am not sure, I hear a hum,

Like a very muffled double drum,

And then a something faintly shrill,

Like Bartlemy Fair's old buz at Pentonville.

And now and then hear a pop,

As if from Pedley's Soda Water shop.

I'm almost ill with the strong scent of mud,

And, not to mention sneezing,

My cough is, more than usual, teasing;

I really fear that I have chill'd my blood,

O Tudd! O Tudd! O Tudd! O Tudd! O Tudd!"

U Ldu: U Ldu: U Ldu: U Ldu: U Ldu:

---

ON THE CELEBRATION OF PEACE.

BY DORCAS DOVE.



AND is it thus ye welcome Peace,  
From Mouths of forty-pounding Bores?  
Oh cease, exploding Cannons, cease!  
Lest Peace, affrighted, shun our shores!

Not so the quiet Queen should come;  
But like a Nurse to still our Fears,  
With Shoes of List, demurely dumb,  
And Wool or Cotton in her Ears!

She asks for no triumphal Arch;  
No Steeples for their ropy Tongues;  
Down, Drumsticks, down, She needs no March,  
Or blasted Trumps from brazen Lungs.

She wants no Noise of mobbing Throats  
To tell that She is drawing nigh:  
Why this Parade of scarlet Coats,  
When War has closed his bloodshot Eye?

Returning to Domestic Loves,  
When War has ceased with all its Ills,  
Captains should come like sucking Doves,  
With Olive Branches in their Bills.

No need there is of vulgar Shout,  
Bells, Cannons, Trumpets, Fife, and Drum,  
And Soldiers marching all about,  
To let Us know that Peace is come.

Oh mild should be the Signs and meek,  
Sweet Peace's Advent to proclaim!  
Silence her noiseless Foot should speak,  
And Echo should repeat the same.

Lo! where the Soldier walks, alas!  
With Scars received on Foreign Grounds;  
Shall we consume in Coloured Glass



Shall we consume in Coloured Glass

The Oil that should be pour'd in Wounds?

The bleeding Gaps of War to close,

Will whizzing Rocket-Flight avail?

Will Squibs enliven Orphans' Woes?

Or Crackers cheer the Widow's Tale?

---

TO MR. ISAAK WALTON,

AT MR. MAJOR'S THE BOOKSELLER'S IN FLEET STREET.



R. WALTON, it's harsh to say it, but as a Parent I can't help wishing  
You'd been hung before you publish'd your book, to set all the young  
people a fishing!

There's my Robert, the trouble I've had with him it surpasses a mortal's  
bearing,

And all thro' those devilish angling works—the Lord forgive me for  
swearing!

I thought he were took with the Morbus one day, I did with his nasty angle!  
For “oh dear,” says he, and burst out in a cry, “oh my gut is all got of a  
tangle!”

It's a shame to teach a young boy such words—whose blood wouldn't chill  
in their veins

To hear him, as I overheard him one day, a-talking of blowing out brains?  
And didn't I quarrel with Sally the cook, and a precious scolding I give her,  
“How dare you,” says I, “for to stench the whole house by keeping that  
stinking liver?”

Twass enough to breed a fever, it was! they smelt it next door at the Bagots',  
—

But it wasn't breeding no fever—not it! 'twas my son a breeding of  
maggots!

I declare that I couldn't touch meat for a week, for it all seemed tainting and  
going,

And after turning my stomach so, they turned to blueflies, all buzzing and  
blowing;

Boys are nasty enough, goodness knows, of themselves, without putting  
live things in their craniums;

Well, what next? but he pots a whole cargo of worms along with my choice  
geraniums.

And another fine trick, tho' it wasn't found out, till the housemaid had  
given us warning,

He fished at the golden fish in the bowl, before we were up and down in the  
morning.

I'm sure it was lucky for Ellen, poor thing, that she'd got so attentive a  
lover,

As bring her fresh fish when the others deceas'd, which they did a dozen  
times over!

Then a whole new loaf was short! for I know of course when our bread

Then a whole new year was short. For I know, of course, when our bread  
goes faster,—  
And I made a stir with the bill in my hand, and the man was sent off by his  
master;  
But, oh dear, I thought I should sink thro' the earth, with the weight of my  
own reproaches,  
For my own pretty son had made away with the loaf, to make pastry to feed  
the roaches!  
I vow I've suffered a martyrdom—with all sorts of frights and terrors  
surrounded!  
For I never saw him go out of the doors but I thought he'd come home to be  
drowned.  
And, sure enough, I set out one fine Monday to visit my married daughter,  
And there he was standing at Sadler's Wells, a-performing with real water,  
It's well he was off on the further side, for I'd have brain'd him else with  
my patten,  
For I thought he was safe at school, the young wretch! a studying Greek and  
Latin,  
And my ridicule basket he had got on his back, to carry his fishes and  
gentles;  
With a belt I knew he'd made from the belt of his father's regimentals—  
Well, I poked his rods and lines in the fire, and his father gave him a  
birching,  
But he'd gone too far to be easy cured of his love for chubbing and  
perching.  
One night he never came home to tea, and altho' it was dark and dripping,  
His father set off to Wapping, poor man! for the boy had a turn for shipping;  
As for me I set up, and I sobbed and I cried for all the world like a babby,  
Till at twelve o'clock he rewards my fears with two gudging from Waltham  
Abbey!  
And a pretty sore throat and fever he caught, that brought me a fortnight's  
hard nussing,  
Till I thought I should go to my grey-hair'd grave, worn out with the  
fretting and fussing;  
But at last he was cur'd, and we did have hopes that the fishing was cured  
as well,  
But no such luck! not a week went by before we'd have another such spell.  
Tho' he never had got a penny to spend, for such was our strict intentions,

Yet he was soon set up in tackle agin, for all boys have such quick  
inventions:  
And I lost my Lady's Own Pocket Book, in spite of all my hunting and  
poking,  
Till I found it chuck full of tackles and hooks, and besides it had got a good  
soaking.  
Then one Friday morning, I gets a summoning note from a sort of a law  
attorney,  
For the boy had been trespassing people's grounds while his father was  
gone a journey,  
And I had to go and hush it all up by myself, in an office at Hatton Garden;  
And to pay for the damage he'd done, to boot, and to beg some strange  
gentleman's pardon.  
And wasn't he once fished out himself, and a man had to dive to find him,  
And I saw him brought home with my motherly eyes and a mob of people  
behind him?  
Yes, it took a full hour to rub him to life—whilst I was a-screaming and  
raving,  
And a couple of guineas it cost us besides, to reward the humane man for  
his saving,  
And didn't Miss Crump leave us out of her will, all along of her taking  
dudgeon?  
At her favourite cat being chok'd, poor Puss, with a hook sow'd up in a  
gudgeon?  
And old Brown complain'd that he pluck'd his live fowls, and not without  
show of reason,  
For the cocks looked naked about necks and tails, and it wasn't their  
moulting season;  
And sure and surely, when we came to enquire, there was cause for their  
screeching and cackles,  
For the mischief confess'd he had picked them a bit, for I think he called  
them the hackles.  
A pretty tussle we had about that! but as if it wasn't picking enough,  
When the winter comes on, to the muff-box I goes, just to shake out my  
sable muff—  
“O mercy!” thinks I, “there's the moth in the house!” for the fur was all  
gone in patches;  
And then at Ellen's chinchilly I look, and its state of destruction just

matches—

But it wasn't no moth, Mr. Walton, but flies—sham flies to go trolling and  
trouting,

For his father's great coat was all safe and sound, and that first set me a-  
doubting.

A plague, say I, on all rods and lines, and on young or old watery dangles!  
And after all that you'll talk of such stuff as no harm in the world about  
anglers!

And when all is done, all our worry and fuss, why, we've never had nothing  
worth dishing;

So you see, Mister Walton, no good comes at last of your famous book  
about fishing.

As for Robert's, I burnt it a twelvemonth ago; but it turned up too late to be  
lucky,

For he'd got it by heart, as I found to the cost of

Your servant,

JANE ELIZABETH STUCKEY.

---

TO MARY HOUSEMAID.

ON VALENTINE'S DAY.



MARY, you know I've no love-nonsense,  
And, though I pen on such a day,  
I don't mean flirting, on my conscience,  
Or writing in the courting way.

Though Beauty hasn't form'd your feature,  
It saves you, p'rhaps, from being vain,  
And many a poor unhappy creature  
May wish that she was half as plain.

Your virtues would not rise an inch,  
Although your shape was two foot taller,  
And wisely you let others pinch  
Great waists and feet to make them smaller.

You never try to spare your hands  
From getting red by household duty,  
But, doing all that it commands,  
Their coarseness is a moral beauty.

Let Susan flourish her fair arms  
And at your old legs sneer and scoff,  
But let her laugh, for you have charms  
That nobody knows nothing of.

---

## TO A BAD RIDER.

### I.



HY, Mr. Rider, why  
Your nag so ill indorse, man?  
To make observers cry,  
You're mounted, but no horseman?

### II.

With elbows out so far,  
This thought you can't debar me—  
Though no Dragoon—Hussar—  
You're surely of the army!

### III.

I hope to turn M.P.  
You have not any notion,  
So awkward you would be  
At "seconding a motion!"

---



TO A CRITIC.



CRUEL One! How littel dost thou knowe  
How manye poetes with Unhappyenesse  
Thou mayest have slaine; are they beganne to blowe  
Like to yonge Buddes in theyre firste sappyenesse!  
Even as Pinkes from littel Pipinges growe  
Great Poetes yet maye come of singinges smalle,  
Which, if an hungrede Worme doth gnawe belowe,  
Fold up theyre stryped leaves, and dye withalle.  
Alake, that pleasaunt Flowre must fayde and falle  
Because a Grubbe hath ete into yts Hede,—  
That els had growne soe fayre and eke soe talle  
To-wardes the Heaven, and opened forthe and sprede  
Its blossomes to the Sunne for Menne to rede  
In soe brighte hues of Lovelinessse indeede!

---

## THE SWEETS OF YOUTH.

“Sweets to the sweet—farewell.”—HAMLET.



TIME was I liked a cheesecake well enough—  
All human children have a sweetish taste;  
I used to revel in a pie, or puff;  
Or tart—we all were *Tartars* in our youth  
To meet with jam or jelly was good luck,  
All candies most complacently I crumped,  
A stick of liquorice was good to suck,  
And sugar was as often liked as lumped!  
On treacle's "linkèd sweetness long drawn out,"  
Or honey I could feast like any fly;  
I thrilled when lollipops were hawked about;  
How pleased to compass hard-bake or bull's-eye;  
How charmed if Fortune in my power cast  
Elecampane—but that campaign is past.

---

TO HENRIETTA,<sup>[8]</sup>

ON HER DEPARTURE FOR CALAIS.



WHEN little people go abroad, wherever they may roam,  
They will not just be treated as they used to be at home;  
So take a few promiscuous hints, to warn you in advance,  
Of how a little English girl will perhaps be served in France.

Of course you will be Frenchified; and first, it's my belief,  
They'll dress you in their foreign style as *à-la-mode* as beef,  
With a little row of beehives, as a border to your frock,  
And a pair of frilly trousers, like a little bantam cock.

But first they'll seize your bundle (if you have one) in a crack,  
And tie it with a tape by way of bustle on your back;  
And make your waist so high or low, your shape will be a riddle,  
For anyhow you'll never have your middle in the middle.

Your little English sandals for a while will hold together,  
But woe betide you when the stones have worn away the leather;  
For they'll poke your little pettitoes (and there will be a hobble!)  
In such a pair of shoes as none but carpenters can cobble!

What next?—to fill your head with French to match the native girls  
In scraps of *Galignani* they'll screw up your little curls;  
And they'll take their nouns and verbs, and some bits of verse and prose,  
And pour them in your ears that you may spout them through your nose.

You'll have to learn a *chou* is quite another sort of thing  
To that you put your foot in; that a *belle* is not to ring;  
That a *corne* is not the nubble that brings trouble to your toes;  
Nor *peut-être* a potato, as some Irish folks suppose.

No, no, they have no murphies there, for supper or for lunch,  
But you may get in course of time a *pomme de terre* to munch,  
With which, as you perforce must do as Calais folks are doing,  
You'll maybe have to gobble up the frog that went a wooing!

But pray at meals, remember this, the French are so polite,  
No matter what you eat or drink, "whatever is, is right!"  
So when you're told at dinner-time that some delicious stew

So when you're told at dinner-time that some delicious stew  
Is cat instead of rabbit, you must answer "*Tant mi—eux!*"

For little folks who go abroad, wherever they may roam,  
They cannot just be treated as they used to be at home;  
So take a few promiscuous hints, to warn you in advance,  
Of how a little English girl will perhaps be served in France!

---

HINTS TO PAUL PRY.



H, pleasing, teasing, Mr. Pry,  
Dear Paul—but not Virginia's Paul,  
As some might haply deem, to spy  
The umbrella thou art arm'd withal,  
Cool hat, and ample pantaloons,  
Proper for hot and tropic noons;—

Oh no! for thou wert never born  
To watch the barren sea and cloud  
In any desert isle forlorn—  
Thy home is always in a crowd  
Drawn nightly, such is thy stage luck,  
By Liston—that dramatic Buck.

True as the evening's primrose flower,  
True as the watchman to his beat,  
Thou dost attend upon the hour  
And house, in old Haymarket Street.  
Oh, surely thou art much miscall'd,  
Still Paul—yet we are never pall'd!

Friend of the keyhole and the crack,  
That lets thee pry within and pore,  
Thy very nose betrays the knack—  
Upturn'd through kissing with the door;  
A peeping trick that each dear friend  
Sends thee to Coventry, to mend!

Thy bended body shows thy bent,  
Inclined to news in every place;  
Thy gossip mouth and eyes intent,  
Stand each a query in thy face;  
Thy hat a curious hat appears,  
Pricking its brims up like thy ears;

Thy pace, it is an ambling trot,  
To post thee sooner here and there,

to every house where thou shouldst not;  
In gait, in garb, in face, and air,  
The true eavesdropper we perceive,  
Not merely dropping in at eve,—

But morn and noon, through all the span  
Of day,—to disconcert and fret,  
Unwelcome guest to every man,  
A kind of dun, without a debt,  
Well cursed by porter in the hall,  
For calling when there is no call.

Harm-watching, harm thou still dost catch—  
That rule should save thee many a sore;  
But watch thou wilt, and, like a watch,  
A box attends thee at the door—  
The household menials e'en begin  
To show thee out ere thou art in!

Old Grasp regards thee with a frown,  
Old Hardy marks thee for a shot,  
Young Stanley longs to knock thee down,  
And Subtle mourns her ruin'd plot,  
And bans thy bones—alas! for why!  
A tender curiosity!

Oh leave the Hardys to themselves—  
Leave Mrs. Subtle to her dreams—  
'Tis true that they were laid on shelves—  
Leave Stanley, junior, to his schemes;  
More things there are, the public sigh  
To know the rights of, Mr. Pry!

There's Lady L—— the late Miss P——,  
Miss P—— and lady both were late,  
And two in ten can scarce agree,  
For why the title had to wait;  
But thou mightst learn from her own lips  
What wind detain'd the ladyship?



What wind detain'd the lady-ship:

Or Mr. P.!—the sire that nursed  
Thy youth, and made thee what thou art,  
Who form'd thy prying genius first—  
(Thou wottest his untender part),  
'Twould be a friendly call and fit,  
To know “how soon he hopes to sit.”

Some people long to know the truth  
Whether Miss T. does mean to try  
For Gibbon once again—in sooth,  
Thou mightst indulge them, Mr. Pry;  
A verbal extract from the brief  
Would give some spinsters great relief!

Suppose, dear Pry, thou wert to dodge  
The porter's glance, and just drop in  
At Windsor's shy sequester'd lodge,  
(Thou wilt, if any man can win  
His way so far)—and kindly bring  
Poor Cob's petition to the king.

There's Mrs. Coutts—hath she outgrown  
The compass of a prying eye?  
And, ah! there is the Great Unknown,  
A man that makes the curious sigh;  
'Twere worthy of your genius quite  
To bring that lurking man to light.

O, come abroad, with curious hat,  
And patch'd umbrella, curious too—  
To poke with this, and pry with that—  
Search all our scandal through and through,  
And treat the whole world like a pie  
Made for thy finger, Mr. Pry!

---



## ON STEAM.

BY AN UNDER-HOSTLER.



WISH I livd a Thowsen year Ago  
Wurking for Sober six and Seven milers  
And dubble Stages runnen safe and slo  
The Orsis cum in Them days to the Bilers  
But Now by means of Powers of Steam forces  
A-turning Coches into Smoakey Kettels  
The Bilers seam a Cumming to the Orses  
And Helps and naggs Will sune be out of Vittels  
Poor Bruits I wunder How we bee to Liv  
When sutch a change of Orses is our Faits  
No nothink need Be sifted in a Siv  
May them Blowd ingins all Blow up their Grates  
And Theaves of Oslers crib the Coles and Giv  
Their blackgard Hannimuls a Feed of Slaits!

---

## ALLEGORY.

A MORAL VEHICLE.

HAD a Gig-Horse, and I called him Pleasure,  
Because on Sundays, for a little jaunt,  
He was so fast and showy, quite a treasure;  
Although he sometimes kicked, and shied aslant.  
I had a Chaise, and christened it Enjoyment,  
With yellow body, and the wheels of red,  
Because 'twas only used for one employment,  
Namely, to go wherever Pleasure led.  
I had a wife, her nickname was Delight;  
A son called Frolic, who was never still:  
Alas! how often dark succeeds to bright!  
Delight was thrown, and Frolic had a spill,  
Enjoyment was upset and shattered quite,  
And Pleasure fell a splitter on *Paine's Hill*!

---

## A SOMNAMBULIST.

“A change came o’er the spirit of my dream.”—BYRON.



METHOUGHT—for Fancy is the strangest gadder  
When sleep all homely Mundane ties hath riven—  
Methought that I ascended Jacob’s ladder,  
With heartfelt hope of getting up to Heaven:  
Some bell, I knew not whence, was sounding seven  
When I set foot upon that long one-pair;  
And still I climbed when it had chimed eleven,  
Nor yet of landing-place became aware;  
Step after step in endless flight seem’d there;  
But on, with steadfast hope, I struggled still,  
To gain that blessed haven from all care,  
Where tears are wiped, and hearts forget their ill,  
When, lo! I wakened on a sadder stair—  
Tramp—tramp—tramp—tramp—upon the Brixton Mill!

---

TO VAUXHALL.

“The English Garden.”—MASON.



THE cold transparent ham is on my fork—  
It hardly rains—and hark the bell!—ding-dingle—  
Away! Three thousand feet at gravel work,  
Mocking a Vauxhall shower!—Married and Single  
Crush—rush;—Soak'd Silks with wet white Satin mingle.  
Hengler! Madame! round whom all bright sparks lurk,  
Calls audibly on Mr. and Mrs. Pringle  
To study the Sublime, &c.—(vide Burke)  
All Noses are upturn'd!—Whish—ish—! On high  
The rocket rushes—trails—just steals in sight—  
Then droops and melts in bubbles of blue light—  
And Darkness reigns—Then balls flare up and die—  
Wheels whiz—smack crackers—serpents twist—and then  
Back to the cold transparent ham again!

---

TO A SCOTCH GIRL,

WASHING LINEN AFTER HER COUNTRY FASHION.



WELL done and wetly, thou Fair Maid of Perth,  
Thou mak'st a washing picture well deserving  
The pen and pencilling of Washington Irving:  
Like dripping Naiad, pearly from her birth,  
Dashing about the water of the Firth,  
To cleanse the calico of Mrs. Skirving,  
And never from thy dance of duty swerving  
As there were nothing else than dirt on earth!  
Yet what is thy reward? Nay, do not start!  
I do not mean to give thee a new damper,  
But while thou fillest this industrious part  
Of washer, wearer, mangler, presser, stamper,  
Deserving better character—thou art  
What Bodkin would but call—"a common tramper."

---

TO A DECAYED SEAMAN.



AIL! seventy-four cut down! Hail, Top and Lop!  
Unless I'm much mistaken in my notion,  
Thou wast a stirring Tar, before that hop  
Became so fatal to thy locomotion;—  
Now, thrown on shore, like a mere weed of ocean,  
Thou readest still to men a lesson good,  
To King and Country showing thy devotion,  
By kneeling thus upon a stump of wood!  
Still is thy spirit strong as alcohol;  
Spite of that limb, begot of acorn-egg,—  
Methinks,—thou Naval History in one Vol.—  
A virtue shines, e'en in that timber leg,  
For unlike others that desert their Poll,  
Thou walkest ever with thy "Constant Peg!"

---



TO LORD WHARNCLIFFE, ON HIS GAME-BILL.

I'm fond of partridges, I'm fond of snipes,  
I'm fond of black cocks, for they're very good cocks—  
I'm fond of wild ducks, and I'm fond of woodcocks—  
And grouse that set up such strange moorish pipes.  
I'm fond of pheasants with their splendid stripes—  
I'm fond of hares, whether from Whig or Tory—  
I'm fond of capercailzies in their glory,—  
Teal, widgeons, plovers, birds in all their types:  
All these are in your care, Law-giving Peer,  
And when you next address your Lordly Babel,  
Some clause put in your Bill, precise and clear,  
With due and fit provision to enable  
A man that holds all kinds of game so dear  
To keep, like Crockford, a good Gaming Table.



**THE TOP OF HIS PROFESSION.**



**JOINING IN A CATCH.**

---

LIEUTENANT LUFF.

A COMIC BALLAD.



ALL you that are too fond of wine,  
Or any other stuff,  
Take warning by the dismal fate  
Of one Lieutenant Luff.  
A sober man he might have been,  
Except in one regard,  
He did not like *soft* water,  
So he took to *drinking hard*!

Said he, "Let others fancy slops,  
And talk in praise of Tea,  
But I am no *Bohemian*,  
So do not like *Bohea*.  
If wine's a poison, so is Tea,  
Though in another shape;  
What matter whether one is kill'd  
By *canister* or *grape*!"

According to this kind of taste  
Did he indulge his drouth,  
And being fond of *Port*, he made  
A *port*-hole of his mouth!  
A single pint he might have sipp'd  
And not been out of sorts,  
In geologic phrase—the rock  
He split upon was *quarts*!

To "hold the mirror up to vice"  
With him was hard, alas!  
The worse for wine he often was,  
But not "before a glass."  
No kind and prudent friend had he  
To bid him drink no more,—  
The only *chequers* in his course  
Were at a tavern door!

Full soon the sad effects of this

His frame began to show,  
For that old enemy the gout  
Had taken him in *toe*!  
And join'd with this an evil came  
Of quite another sort,—  
For while he drank, himself, his purse  
Was getting “*something short*.”

For want of cash he soon had pawn'd  
One half that he possess'd,  
And drinking show'd him *duplicates*  
Beforehand of the rest!  
So now his creditors resolved  
To seize on his assets;  
For why,—they found that his *half-pay*  
Did not *half-pay* his debts.

But Luff contrived a novel mode  
His Creditors to chouse;  
For his own *execution* he  
Put into his own house!  
A pistol to the muzzle charged  
He took devoid of fear;  
Said he, “This *barrel* is my last,  
So now for my last *bier*!”

Against his lungs he aimed the slugs,  
And not against his brain,  
So he blew out his *lights*—and none  
Could blow them in again!  
A Jury for a Verdict met  
And gave it in these terms:—  
“We find as how as certain *slugs*  
Has sent him to the *worms*!”

---



LOVE HAS NOT EYES.



F all the poor old Tobits a-groping in the street,  
A Lover is the blindest that ever I did meet,  
For he's blind, he's blind, he's very blind,—  
He's as blind as any mole!

He thinks his love the fairest that ever yet was clasp'd,  
Though her clay is overbaked, and it never has been rasp'd.  
For he's blind, &c.

He thinks her face an angel's, although it's quite a frump's,  
Like a toad a-taking physic, or a monkey in the mumps.  
For he's blind, &c.

Upon her graceful figure then how he will insist,  
Though she's all so much awry, she can only eat a twist!  
For he's blind, &c.

He'll swear that in her dancing she cuts all others out,  
Though like a *Gal* that's galvanised, she throws her legs about.  
For he's blind, &c.

If he should have a letter in answer to his sighs,  
He'll put it to his lips up, instead of to his eyes.  
For he's blind, &c.

Then if he has a meeting the question for to put,  
In suing for her hand he'll be kneeling at her foot.  
For he's blind, &c.

Oh Love is like a furnace wherein a Lover lies,  
And like a pig before the fire, he scorches out his eyes.  
Till he's blind, &c.





A HAPPY NEW YEAR!

“If the affairs of this world did not make us so sad,  
'Twould be easy enough to be merry.”—OLD SONG.



HERE is nothing but plague in this house!  
There's the turbot is stole by the cat,  
The Newfoundland has eat up the grouse,  
And the haunch has been gnawed by a rat!  
It's the day of all days when I wish  
That our friends should enjoy our good cheer;  
Mr. Wiggins—our dinner is dished—  
But I wish you a happy New Year!

Mr. Fudge has not called, but he will,  
For his Rates, Church, and Highway, and Poor;  
And the butcher has brought in his bill—  
Twice as much as the quarter before.  
Little Charles is come home with the mumps,  
And Matilda with measles, I fear;  
And I've taken two sov'reigns like dumps—  
But I wish you a happy New Year!

Your poor brother is in the Gazette,  
And your banker is off to New York;  
Mr. Bigsby has died in your debt,  
And the "Wiggins" has foundered near Cork.  
Mr. Merrington's bill is come back;  
You are chosen to serve overseer;  
The new wall is beginning to crack—  
But I wish you a happy New Year!

The best dinner-set's fallen to the ground;  
The militia's called out, and you're drawn;  
Not a piece of our plate can be found,  
And there's marks of men's feet on the lawn:  
Two anonymous letters have come,  
That declare you shall die like a Weare;  
And it may—or may not—be a hum—  
But I wish you a happy New Year!

The old law-suit with Levy is lost;

You are fined for not cleansing the street;  
And the water-pipe's burst with the frost,  
And the roof lets the rain in and sleet.  
Your old tenant at seventy-four  
Has gone off in the night with his gear,  
And has taken the key of the door—  
But I wish you a happy New Year!

There's the "Sun" and the "Phoenix" to pay,  
For the chimney has blazed like Old Nick;  
The new gig has been jammed by a dray,  
And the old horse has taken to kick.  
We have hardly a bushel of small,  
And now coal is extravagant dear;  
Your great coat is stole out of the hall—  
But I wish you a happy New Year!

The whole greenhouse is smashed by the hail,  
And the plants have all died in the night;  
The magnolia's blown down by the gale,  
And the chimney looks far from upright;  
And—the deuce take the man from the shop,  
That hung up the new glass chandelier!—  
It has come, in the end, to one drop—  
But I wish you a happy New Year!

There's misfortune wherever we dodge—  
It's the same in the country and town;  
There's the porter has burned down his lodge,  
While he went off to smoke at the Crown.  
The fat butler makes free with your wine,  
And the footman has drunk the strong beer,  
And the coachman can't walk in a line—  
But I wish you a happy New Year!

I have doubts if your clerk is correct—  
There are hints of a mistress at Kew,  
And some day he'll abscond, I expect;

Mr. Brown has built out your back view;  
The new housemaid's the greatest of flirts—  
She has men in the house, that is clear;  
And the laundress has pawned all your shirts—  
But I wish you a happy New Year!

Your "Account of a Visit to Rome"  
Not a critic on earth seems to laud;  
And old Huggins has lately come home,  
And will swear that your Claude isn't Claude;  
Your election is far from secure,  
Though it's likely to cost very dear;  
You're come out in a caricature—  
But I wish you a happy New Year!

You've been christened an ass in the Times,  
And the Chronicle calls you a fool;  
And that dealer in boys, Dr. Ghrimes,  
Has engaged the next house for a school;  
And the playground will run by the bower  
Which you took so much trouble to rear;  
We shall never have one quiet hour—  
But I wish you a happy New Year!

Little John will not take to his book,  
He's come home black and blue from the cane;  
There's your uncle is courting his cook,  
And your mother has married again!  
Jacob Jones will be tried with his wife,  
And against them you'll have to appear;  
If they're hung you'll be wretched for life—  
But I wish you a happy New Year!

---



## SEA-SONG.

AFTER DIBDIN.

**P**URE water it plays a good part in  
The swabbing the decks and all that—  
And it finds its own level for sartin—  
For it sartinly drinks very flat:—  
For my part a drop of the creatur  
I never could think was a fault,  
For if Tars should swig water by nature  
The sea would have never been salt!—  
Then off with it into a jorum,  
And make it strong, sharpish, or sweet,  
For if I've any sense of decorum  
It never was meant to be neat!—

One day when I was but half sober,—  
Half measures I always disdain—  
I walk'd into a shop that sold Soda,  
And ax'd for some Water Champagne;—  
Well, the lubber he drew and he drew, boys,  
Till I'd shipped my six bottles or more,  
And blow off my last limb but it's true, boys,  
Why, I warn't half so drunk as afore!—  
Then off with it into a jorum,  
And make it strong, sharpish, or sweet,  
For if I've any sense of decorum  
It never was meant to be neat.

---

## REFLECTIONS ON A NEW YEAR'S DAY.



ES, yes, it's very true, and very clear!  
By way of compliment and common chat,  
It's very well to wish me a New Year;  
But wish me a new hat!

Although not spent in luxury and ease,  
In course a longer life I won't refuse;  
But while you're wishing, wish me, if you please,  
A newer pair of shoes!

Nay, while new things and wishes are afloat,  
I own to one that I should not rebut—  
Instead of this old rent, to have a coat  
With more of the New Cut!

O yes, 'tis very pleasant, though I'm poor,  
To hear the steeple make that merry din;  
Except I wish one bell was at the door,  
To ring new trousers in.

To be alive is very nice indeed,  
Although another year at last departs;  
Only with twelve new months I rather need  
A dozen of new shirts.

Yes, yes, it's very true, and very clear,  
By way of compliment and common chat,  
It's very well to wish me a New Year,  
But wish me a new hat!



WRITTEN UNDER THE FEAR OF BAILIFFS.



LAS! of all the noxious things  
That wait upon the poor,  
Most cruel is that Felon-Fear  
That haunts the “Debtor’s Door!”

Saint Sepulchre’s begins to toll,  
The Sheriffs seek the cell—  
So I expect their officers,  
And tremble at the bell!

I look for *beer*, and yet I quake  
With fright at every *tap*;  
And dread a *double-knock*, for oh!  
I’ve not a *single rap*!

---

A FEW LINES ON COMPLETING FORTY-SEVEN.



WHEN I reflect with serious sense,  
While years and years run on,  
How soon I may be summon'd hence—  
There's cook a-calling John.

Our lives are built so frail and poor,  
On sand and not on rocks,  
We're hourly standing at Death's door—  
There's some one double-knocks.

All human days have settled terms,  
Our fates we cannot force;  
This flesh of mine will feed the worms—  
They're come to lunch of course.

And when my body's turn'd to clay  
And dear friends hear my knell,  
O let them give a sigh and say—  
I hear the up-stairs bell.

---

A BULL.



ONE day, no matter where or when,  
Except 'twas after some Hibernian revel,  
For why? an Irishman is ready then  
    “To play the Devil”—  
A Pat, whose surname has escaped the Bards,  
Agreed to play with Nick a game at cards.  
The stake, the same that the old Source of Sin  
From German Faustus and his German Cousins  
    Had won by dozens;  
The only one in fact he cares a pin  
    To win.

By luck or roguery of course Old Nick  
    Won ev'ry trick:  
The score was full, the last turn-up had done it—  
    “Your soul—I've won it!”

“It's true for you I've lost that same,”  
Said Pat a little hazy in his wits—  
“My soul is yours—but come, another game—  
    *Double, or quits!*”

---

## ON THE DEATH OF THE GIRAFFE.

They say, God wot!  
She died upon the spot:  
But then in spots she was so rich,—  
I wonder which?

---

## ON THE REMOVAL OF A MENAGERIE.

Let Exeter Change lament its change,  
Its beasts and other losses—  
Another place thrives by its case,  
Now *Charing* has two *Crosses*.

---

ON HER MAJESTY'S VISIT TO THE CITY, 1844.

We've heard of comets, blazing things,  
With "fear of change" perplexing Kings;  
But, lo! a novel sight and strange,  
A Queen who does not fear a 'Change!

---

ON THE QUEEN'S VISIT TO THE CITY,

BY A CORNHILL TRADESMAN.

Sure the measure is strange  
And all Commerce so stops,  
And, to open a 'Change,  
Make us shut up our shops.

---

ON THE STATUES IN TRAFALGAR SQUARE.

If Nelson looks down on a couple of Kings,  
However it pleases the Loyals;  
'Tis after the fashion of nautical things,  
A sky-scraper over the Royals.

---



ON A PICTURE (407) IN THE BRITISH INSTITUTION, 1843.

Sir, let me just your tasteful eye enveigle  
To yonder Painting, of the Madman Eagle.<sup>[9]</sup>  
Which, *that* by Poole? Excuse me, sir, I beg,  
I really have no wish to catch “The Plague.”

---

## HEART-SPRINGS.

My heart's wound up just like a watch,  
As far as springs will take—  
It wants but one more evil turn,  
And then the cords will break.

---

## CHANGE OF MINISTRY.

As human fashions change about,  
The reign of Fools should now begin,  
For when the *Wigs* are going out  
The *Naturals* are coming in.

---

## A PIG IN A POKE.

A Lord bought of late an outlandish estate,  
At its Wild Boars to Chevy and dig;  
So some people purchase a pig in a poke,  
And others, a poke in a pig.

---

COMPOSED ON READING A DIARY.

That flesh is grass is now as clear as day,  
To any but the merest purblind pup;  
Death cuts it down, and then, to make her hay,  
My Lady B—— comes and rakes it up.

---

## THE PURSUIT OF LETTERS.

The Germans for Learning enjoy great repute;  
But the English make *Letters* still more a pursuit;  
For a Cockney will go from the banks of the Thames  
To Cologne for an *O*, and to Nassau for *M*'s.

---

## A REFLECTION.

When Eve upon the first of Men  
The apple press'd with specious cant,  
Oh! what a thousand pities then  
That Adam was not Adamant!

---

## LAYING THE DUST.

After such years of dissension and strife,  
Some wonder that Peter should weep for his wife:  
But his tears on her grave was nothing surprising,—  
He's laying her dust, for fear of its rising.

---



ON LIEUTENANT EYRE'S NARRATIVE OF THE DISASTERS AT  
CABUL.

A sorry tale, of sorry plans,  
Which this conclusion grants,  
That Affghan clans had all the *Khans*  
And we had all the *cant's*.

---

## THE SUPERIORITY OF MACHINERY.

A Mechanic his labour will often discard  
If the rate of his pay he dislikes;  
But a clock—and its case is uncommonly hard—  
Will continue to work, tho' it *strikes*!

---

## PARTY SPIRIT.

“Why did you not dine,” said a Lord to a Wit,  
“With the Whigs, you political sinner?”  
“Why really I meant, but had doubts how the *Pit*  
Of my stomach would bear a Fox Dinner.”

---

LORD B——.

'Tis said of Lord B., none is keener than he  
To spit a Wild Boar with éclât;  
But he never gets near to the Brute with his spear,  
He gives it so very much *law*.

---

## TRAITORS' AIMS.

Three traitors, Oxford—Francis—Bean,  
Have missed their wicked aim;  
And may all shots against the Queen,  
In future do the same:  
For why, I mean no turn of wit,  
But seriously insist,  
That if Her Majesty were *hit*,  
No one would be so *miss'd*.

---

ON A CERTAIN LOCALITY.

Of public changes, good or ill,  
I seldom lead the mooters,  
But really Constitution Hill  
Should change its name with Shooter's!

---

## ON THE ART-UNIONS.

That Picture-Raffles will conduce to nourish  
Design, or cause good colouring to flourish,  
Admits of logic-chopping and wise sawing,  
But surely Lotteries encourage Drawing!

---

## A MORNING THOUGHT.

No more, no more will I resign  
My couch so warm and soft,  
To trouble trout with hook and line,  
That will not spring aloft.

With larks appointments one may fix  
To greet the dawning skies,  
But hang the getting up at six,  
For fish that will not *rise*!

---



ON A CERTAIN EQUESTRIAN STATUE AT THE ROYAL EXCHANGE.

Whoever has looked upon Wellington's breast,  
Knows well that he's not so full in the chest;  
But the sculptor, to humour the Londoners partial,  
Has turn'd the lean Duke to a plump City Marshal.

---

ON A DAGUERREOTYPE PORTRAIT OF A LADY.

Yes, there are her features! her brow, and her hair,  
And her eyes, with a look so seraphic,  
Her nose, and her mouth, with the smile that is there,  
Truly caught by the Art Photographic!

Yet why should she borrow such aid of the skies,  
When by many a bosom's confession,  
Her own lovely face, and the light of her eyes,  
Are sufficient to *make an impression?*

---

## SUGGESTIONS BY STEAM.

When Woman is in rags and poor,  
And sorrow, cold, and hunger tease her,  
If man would only listen more  
To that small voice that crieth—"Ease her!"

Without the guidance of a friend,  
Though legal sharks and screws attack her,  
If man would only more attend  
To that small voice that crieth—"Back her!"

So oft it would not be his fate  
To witness some despairing dropper  
In Thames's tide, and run too late  
To that small voice that crieth—"Stop her!"

---

Such strictures as these  
Could a learned Chinese  
Only read on some fine afternoon,  
He would cry with pale lips,  
“We shall have an Eclipse,  
For a Dragon has seized on the Moon!”

---

## AN EXPLANATION

BY ONE OF THE LIVERY.

Says Blue-and-Buff, to Drab-and-Pink,  
“I’ve heard the hardest word I think,  
That ever posed me since my teens,  
I wonder what As-best-os means!”

Says Drab-and-Pink, to Blue-and-Buff,  
“The word is clear, and plain enough.  
It means a Nag wot goes the pace,  
And so *as best os* wins the race.”

---

## ON THE NEW HALF-FARTHINGS.

“Too small for any marketable shift,  
What purpose can there be for coins like these?”  
Hush, hush, good Sir!—Thus charitable Thrift  
May give a *Mite* to him who wants a cheese!

---

## THE SURPLICE QUESTION.

BY A BENEDICT.

A very pretty public stir  
Is making, down at Exeter,  
About the surplice fashion:  
And many bitter words and rude  
Have been bestowed upon the feud,  
And much unchristian passion.

For me, I neither know nor care  
Whether a Parson ought to wear  
A black dress or a white dress;  
Fill'd with a trouble of my own,—  
A Wife who preaches in her gown,  
And lectures in her night-dress!

---

## THE EPPING HUNT.

“HUNT’S ROASTED——”

“On Monday they began to hunt.”—*Chevy Chase.*





JOHN HUGGINS was as bold a man  
As trade did ever know,  
A warehouse good he had, that stood  
Hard by the church of Bow.

There people bought Dutch cheeses round  
And single Glos'ter flat;  
And English butter in a lump,  
And Irish—in a *pat*.

Six days a week beheld him stand,  
His business next his heart,  
At *counter*, with his apron tied  
About his *counter-part*.

The seventh, in a Sluice-house box  
He took his pipe and pot;  
On Sundays, for *eel-piety*,  
A very noted spot.

Ah, blest if he had never gone  
Beyond its rural shed!  
One Easter-tide, some evil guide  
Put Epping in his head!

Epping, for butter justly famed,  
And pork in sausage popp'd;  
Where, winter time or summer time,  
Pig's flesh is always *chopp'd*.

But famous more as annals tell,  
Because of Easter chase;  
There every year, 'twixt dog and deer,  
There is a gallant race.

With Monday's sun John Huggins rose,  
And slapped his leather thigh,  
And sang the burden of the song

And sang the burden of the song,  
“This day a stag must die.”

For all the live-long day before,  
And all the night in bed,  
Like Beckford, he had nourished “Thoughts  
On Hunting” in his head.

Of horn and morn, and hark and bark,  
And echo’s answering sounds,  
All poets’ wit hath ever writ  
In *dog-rel* verse of *hounds*.

Alas! there was no warning voice  
To whisper in his ear,  
Thou art a fool in leaving *Cheap*  
To go and hunt the *dear*.

No thought he had of twisted spine,  
Or broken arms or legs;  
Not *chicken-hearted* he, although  
’Twas whispered of his *eggs*!

Ride out he would, and hunt he would,  
Nor dreamt of ending ill;  
Mayhap with Dr. *Ridout*’s fee,  
And Surgeon *Hunter*’s bill.

So he drew on his Sunday boots,  
Of lustre superfine;  
The liquid black they wore that day  
Was *Warren*-ted to shine.

His yellow buckskins fitted close,  
As erst upon a stag;  
Thus well equipped he gayly skipped,  
At once upon his nag.

But first to him that held the rein

A crown he nimbly flung;  
For holding of the horse!—why, no,  
For holding of his tongue.

To say the horse was Huggins' own  
Would only be a brag;  
His neighbour Fig and he went halves,  
Like Centaurs, in a nag.

And he that day had got the gray,  
Unknown to brother cit;  
The horse he knew would never tell,  
Although it was a *tit*.

A well-bred horse he was, I wis,  
As he began to show,  
By quickly “rearing up within  
The way he ought to go.”

But Huggins, like a wary man,  
Was ne'er from saddle cast;  
Resolved, by going very slow,  
On sitting very fast.

And so he jogged to Tot'n'am Cross,  
An ancient town well known,  
Where Edward wept for Eleanor  
In mortar and in stone.

A royal game of fox and goose,  
To play on such a loss;  
Wherever she set down her *orts*  
Thereby he put a *cross*.

Now Huggins had a crony here,  
That lived beside the way;  
One that had promised sure to be  
His comrade for the day.

Whereas the man had changed his mind  
    Meanwhile upon the case!  
And meaning not to hunt at all,  
    Had gone to Enfield Chase!

For why, his spouse had made him vow  
    To let a game alone,  
Where folks that ride a bit of blood,  
    May break a bit of bone.

“Now, be his wife a plague for life!  
    A coward sure is he!”  
Then Huggins turned his horse’s head,  
    And crossed the bridge of Lea.

Thence slowly on through Laytonstone,  
    Past many a Quaker’s box—  
No Friends to hunters after deer,  
    Though followers of a *Fox*.

And many a score behind—before—  
    The self-same rout inclined;  
And, minded all to march one way,  
    Made one great march of mind.

Gentle and simple, he and she,  
    And swell, and blood, and prig;  
And some had carts, and some a chaise,  
    According to their gig.

Some long-eared jacks, some knacker’s hacks  
    (However odd it sounds),  
Let out that day to *hunt*, instead  
    *Of going to the hounds!*

And some had horses of their own,  
    And some were forced to job it;  
And some, while they inclined to *Hunt*,

Betook themselves to *Cob-it*.

All sorts of vehicles and vans,  
Bad, middling, and the smart;  
Here rolled along the gay barouche,  
And there a dirty cart!

And lo! a cart that held a squad  
Of costermonger line;  
With one poor hack, like Pegasus,  
That slaved for all the Nine!

Yet marvel not at any load  
That any horse might drag;  
When all, that morn, at once were drawn  
Together by a stag.

Now when they saw John Huggins go  
At such a sober pace;  
“Hallo!” cried they; “come trot away,  
You’ll never see the chase!”

But John, as grave as any judge,  
Made answer quite as blunt;  
“It will be time enough to trot,  
When I begin to hunt!”

And so he paced to Woodford Wells,  
Where many a horseman met,  
And letting go the *reins* of course,  
Prepared for *heavy wet*.

And lo! within the crowded door,  
Stood Rounding, jovial elf;  
Here shall the Muse frame no excuse,  
But frame the man himself.

A snow-white head, a merry eye,  
A cheek of jolly blush;

A claret tint laid on by health,  
With master Reynard's brush;

A hearty frame, a courteous bow,  
The prince he learned it from;  
His age about threescore and ten,  
And there you have Old Tom.

In merriest key I trow was he,  
So many guests to boast;  
So certain congregations meet,  
And elevate the host.

"Now welcome lads," quoth he, "and prads,  
You're all in glorious luck:  
Old Robin has a run to-day,  
A noted forest buck.

"Fair Mead's the place, where Bob and Tom,  
In red already ride;  
'Tis but a *step*, and on a horse,  
You soon may go *a-stride*."

So off they scampered, man and horse,  
As time and temper pressed—  
But Huggins, hitching on a tree,  
*Branched* off from all the rest.

Howbeit he tumbled down in time  
To join with Tom and Bob,  
All in Fair Mead, which held that day  
Its own fair meed of mob.

Idlers to wit—no Guardians some,  
Of Tattlers in a squeeze;  
Ramblers in heavy carts and vans,  
Spectators up in trees.

Butchers on backs of butchers' backs

BUTCHERS ON BACKS OF BUTCHERS' BACKS,  
That *shambled* to and fro!  
Bakers intent upon a buck,  
Neglectful of the *dough*!

Change Alley Bears to speculate,  
As usual for a fall;  
And green and scarlet runners, such  
As never climbed a wall!

'Twas strange to think what difference  
A single creature made;  
A single stag had caused a whole  
*Stagnation* in their trade.

Now Huggins from his saddle rose,  
And in the stirrups stood;  
And lo! a little cart that came  
Hard by a little wood.

In shape like half a hearse—though not  
For corpses in the least;  
For this contained the *deer alive*,  
And not the *dear deceased*!

And now began a sudden stir,  
And then a sudden shout,  
The prison doors were opened wide,  
And Robin bounded out!

His antlered head shone blue and red,  
Bedecked with ribbons fine;  
Like other bucks that come to 'list  
The hawbucks in the line.

One curious gaze of wild amaze,  
He turned and shortly took:  
Then gently ran adown the mead,  
And bounded o'er the brook.

Now Huggins, standing far aloof,  
Had never seen the deer,  
Till all at once he saw the beast  
Come charging in his rear.

Away he went, and many a score  
Of riders did the same,  
On horse and ass—like High and Low  
And Jack pursuing game!

Good Lord! to see the riders now,  
Thrown off with sudden whirl,  
A score within the purling brook,  
Enjoyed their “early purl.”

A score were sprawling on the grass,  
And beavers fell in showers;  
There was another *Floorer* there,  
Beside the Queen of Flowers!

Some lost their stirrups, some their whips,  
Some had no caps to show:  
But few, like Charles at Charing Cross  
Rode on in *Statue* quo.

“O dear! O dear!” now might you hear,  
“I’ve surely broke a bone;”  
“My head is sore”—with many more  
Such Speeches from the *Thrown*.

Howbeit their wailings never moved  
The wide Satanic clan,  
Who grinned, as once the Devil grinned,  
To see the fall of Man.

And hunters good that understood,  
Their laughter knew no bounds,  
To see the horses “throwing off”



TO SEE THE HORSES—THROWING ON  
So long before the hounds.

For deer must have due course of law,  
Like men the Courts among;  
Before those Barristers the dogs  
Proceed to “giving tongue.”

But now Old Robin’s foes were set  
That fatal taint to find,  
That always is scent after him,  
Yet always left behind.

And here observe how dog and man  
A different temper shows:  
What hound resents that he is sent  
To follow his own nose?

Towler and Jowler—howlers all,  
No single tongue was mute;  
The stag had led a hart, and lo!  
The whole pack followed suit.

No spur he lacked; fear stuck a knife  
And fork in either haunch;  
And every dog he knew had got  
An eye-tooth to his paunch!

Away, away! he scudded like  
A ship before the gale;  
Now flew to *hills* we know not of,  
Now, nun-like, took the vale.

Another squadron charging now,  
Went off at furious pitch;—  
A perfect Tam O’Shanter mob,  
Without a single witch.

But who was he with flying skirts,

A hunter did endorse,  
And, like a poet, seemed to ride  
Upon a wingèd horse?

A whipper-in? no whipper-in:  
A huntsman? no such soul:  
A connoisseur, or amateur?  
Why, yes—a horse patrol.

A member of police, for whom  
The county found a nag,  
And, like Actæon in the tale,  
He found himself in stag!

Away they went, then, dog and deer,  
And hunters all away;  
The maddest horses never knew  
*Mad staggers* such as they!

Some gave a shout, some rolled about,  
And anticked as they rode;  
And butchers whistled on their curs,  
And milkmen *Tally-ho'd!*

About two score there were, or more,  
That galloped in the race;  
The rest, alas! lay on the grass,  
As once in Chevy Chase!

But even those that galloped on  
Were fewer every minute;  
The field kept getting more select,  
Each thicket served to thin it.

For some pulled up, and left the hunt,  
Some fell in miry bogs,  
And vainly rose and “ran a muck,”  
To overtake the dogs.

And some, in charging hurdle stakes,  
Were left bereft of sense;  
What else could be premised of blades  
That never learned to fence?

But Roundings, Tom and Bob, no gate,  
Nor hedge, nor ditch could stay;  
O'er all they went, and did the work  
Of leap-years in a day!

And by their side see Huggins ride,  
As fast as he could speed;  
For, like Mazeppa, he was quite  
At mercy of his steed.

No means he had, by timely check,  
The gallop to remit,  
For firm and fast, between his teeth,  
The biter held the bit.

Trees raced along, all Essex fled  
Beneath him as he sate;  
He never saw a county go  
At such a county rate!

“Hold hard! hold hard! you'll lame the dogs!”  
Quoth Huggins, “so I do;  
I've got the saddle well in hand,  
And hold as hard as you!”

Good Lord! to see him ride along,  
And throw his arms about,  
As if with stitches in the side  
That he was drawing out!

And now he bounded up and down,  
Now like a jelly shook;  
Till bumped and galled—yet not where Gall

For bumps did ever look!

And rowing with his legs the while,  
As tars are apt to ride;  
With every kick he gave a prick  
Deep in the horse's side!

But soon the horse was well avenged  
For cruel smart of spurs,  
For, riding through a moor, he pitched  
His master in a furze!

Where, sharper set than hunger is,  
He squatted all forlorn;  
And, like a bird, was singing out  
While sitting on a thorn!

Right glad was he, as well might be,  
Such cushion to resign;  
"Possession is nine points," but his  
Seems more than ninety-nine.

Yet worse than all the prickly points  
That entered in his skin,  
His nag was running off the while  
The thorns were running in!

Now had a Papist seen his sport,  
Thus laid upon the shelf,  
Although no horse he had to cross,  
He might have crossed himself.

Yet surely still the wind is ill  
That none can say is fair;  
A jolly wight there was, that rode  
Upon a sorry mare!

A sorry mare, that surely came  
Of pagan blood and bone;

For down upon her knees she went  
To many a stock and stone!

Now seeing Huggins' nag adrift,  
This farmer, shrewd and sage,  
Resolved, by changing horses here,  
To hunt another stage!

Though felony, yet who would let  
Another's horse alone,  
Whose neck is placed in jeopardy  
By riding on his own?

And yet the conduct of the man  
Seemed honest-like and fair;  
For he seemed willing, horse and all,  
To go before the *mare*!

So up on Huggins' horse he got,  
And swiftly rode away,  
While Huggins mounted on the mare  
Done brown upon a bay!

And off they set in double chase,  
For such was fortune's whim,  
The farmer rode to hunt the stag,  
And Huggins hunted him!

Alas! with one that rode so well  
In vain it was to strive;  
A dab was he, as dabs should be—  
All leaping and alive.

And here of Nature's kindly care  
Behold a curious proof,  
As nags are meant to leap, she puts  
A frog in every hoof!

Whereas the mare, although her share

whereas the mare, although her share  
She had of hoof and frog,  
On coming to a gate stopped short  
As stiff as any log;

While Huggins in the stirrup stood  
With neck like neck of crane,  
As sings the Scottish song—"to see  
The *gate* his *hart* had gane."

And, lo! the dim and distant hunt  
Diminished in a trice:  
The steeds, like Cinderella's team,  
Seemed dwindling into mice;

And, far remote, each scarlet coat  
Soon flitted like a spark—  
Though still the forest murmured back  
An echo of the bark!

But sad at soul John Huggins turned:  
No comfort could he find;  
While thus the "Hunting Chorus" sped,  
To stay five bars behind.

For though by dint of spur he got  
A leap in spite of fate—  
Howbeit there was no toll at all—  
They could not clear the gate.

And, like Fitzjames, he cursed the hunt,  
And sorely cursed the day,  
And mused a New Gray's elegy  
On his departed gray.

Now many a sign at Woodford town  
Its Inn-vitation tells:  
But Huggins, full of ills, of course  
Betook him to the Wells,

Where Rounding tried to cheer him up  
With many a merry laugh:  
But Huggins thought of neighbour Fig,  
And called for half-and-half.

Yet, spite of drink, he could not blink  
Remembrance of his loss;  
To drown a care like his, required  
Enough to drown a horse.

When thus forlorn, a merry horn  
Struck up without the door—  
The mounted mob were all returned;  
The Epping Hunt was o'er!

And many a horse was taken out  
Of saddle, and of shaft;  
And men, by dint of drink, became  
The only "*beasts of draught*."

For now begun a harder run  
On wine, and gin, and beer;  
And overtaken men discussed  
The overtaken deer.

How far he ran, and eke how fast,  
And how at bay he stood,  
Deerlike, resolved to sell his life  
As dearly as he could:—

And how the hunters stood aloof,  
Regardful of their lives,  
And shunned a beast, whose very horns  
They knew could *handle* knives!

How Huggins stood when he was rubbed  
By help and ostler kind,  
And when they cleaned the clay before

And when they cleaned the clay before,  
How worse “remained behind.”

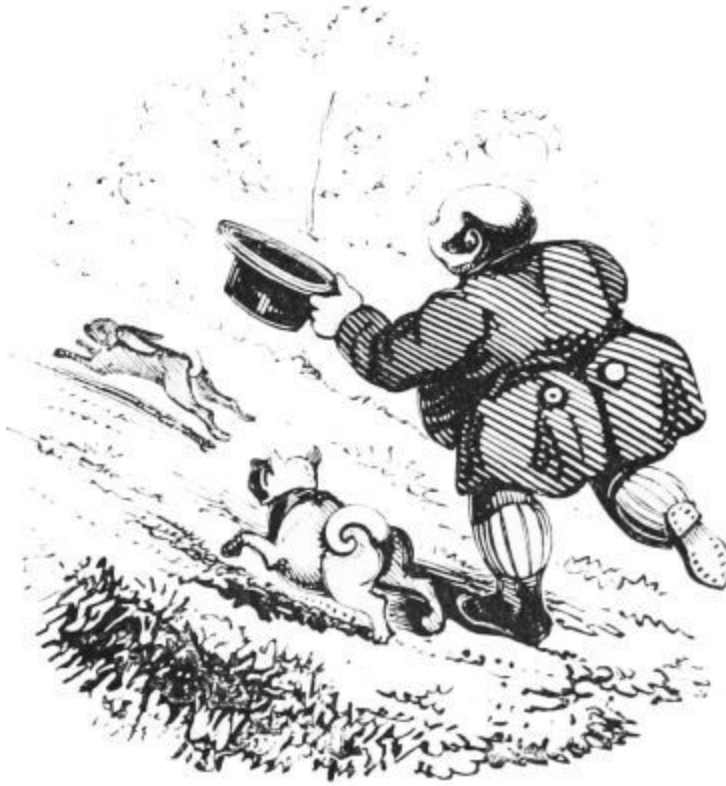
And one, how he had found a horse  
Adrift—a goodly gray!  
And kindly rode the nag, for fear  
The nag should go astray;

Now Huggins, when he heard the tale,  
Jumped up with sudden glee;



**THE JUDGMENT OF SOLOMON.**





“I WISH YOU MAY GET IT.”

“A goodly gray! why, then, I say,  
That gray belongs to me!

“Let me endorse again my horse,  
Delivered safe and sound;  
And gladly I will give the man  
A bottle and a pound!”

The wine was drunk—the money paid,  
Though not without remorse,  
To pay another man so much  
For riding on his horse;—

And let the chase again take place  
For many a long, long year—  
John Huggins will not ride again  
To hunt the Epping Deer!

MORAL.

Thus pleasure oft eludes our grasp  
Just when we think to grip her:  
And hunting after Happiness,  
We only hunt the slipper.

---

JACK HALL.

'Tis very hard when men forsake  
This melancholy world, and make  
A bed of turf, they cannot take  
A quiet doze,  
But certain rogues will come and break  
Their "bone" repose.

'Tis hard we can't give up our breath,  
And to the earth our earth bequeath,  
Without Death-Fetches after death,  
Who thus exhume us;  
And snatch us from our homes beneath,  
And hearths posthumous.

The tender lover comes to rear  
The mournful urn, and shed his tear—  
Her glorious dust, he cries, is here!  
Alack! alack!  
The while his Sacharissa dear  
Is in a sack!

'Tis hard one cannot lie amid  
The mould, beneath a coffin-lid,  
But thus the Faculty will bid  
Their rogues break through it,  
If they don't want us there, why did  
They send us to it?

One of these sacrilegious knaves,  
Who crave as hungry vulture craves,  
Behaving as the ghoul behaves,  
'Neath church-yard wall—  
Mayhap because he fed on graves,  
Was named Jack Hall.

By day it was his trade to go  
Tending the black coach to and fro;

And sometimes at the door of woe,  
With emblems suitable,  
He stood with brother Mute, to show  
That life is mutable.

But long before they pass'd the ferry,  
The dead that he had help'd to bury,  
He sack'd—(he had a sack to carry  
The bodies off in)  
In fact, he let them have a very  
Short fit of coffin.

Night after night, with crow and spade,  
He drove this dead but thriving trade,  
Meanwhile his conscience never weigh'd  
A single horsehair;  
On corses of all kinds he prey'd,  
A perfect corsair!

At last—it may be, Death took spite,  
Or, jesting only, meant to fright—  
He sought for Jack night after night  
The churchyards round;  
And soon they met, the man and sprite,  
In Pancras' ground.

Jack, by the glimpses of the moon,  
Perceiv'd the bony knacker soon,  
An awful shape to meet at noon  
Of night and lonely;  
But Jack's tough courage did but swoon  
A minute only.

Anon he gave his spade a swing  
Aloft, and kept it brandishing,  
Ready for what mishaps might spring  
From this conjunction;  
Funking indeed was quite a thing  
Beside his function

DESIRE HIS FULFILLMENT.

“Hollo!” cried Death, “d’ye wish your sands  
Run out? the stoutest never stands  
A chance with me,—to my commands  
The strongest truckles;  
But I’m your friend—so let’s shake hands,  
I should say—knuckles.”

Jack, glad to see th’ old sprite so sprightly  
And meaning nothing but uprightly,  
Shook hands at once, and, bowing slightly,  
His mull did proffer:  
But Death, who had no nose, politely  
Declin’d the offer.

Then sitting down upon a bank,  
Leg over leg, shank over shank,  
Like friends for conversation frank,  
That had no check on:  
Quoth Jack unto the Lean and Lank,  
“You’re Death, I reckon.”

The Jaw-bone grinn’d:—“I am that same,  
You’ve hit exactly on my name;  
In truth it has some little fame  
Where burial sod is.”  
Quoth Jack (and wink’d), “of course ye came  
Here after bodies.”

Death grinn’d again and shook his head:—  
“I’ve little business with the dead;  
When they are fairly sent to bed  
I’ve done my turn:  
Whether or not the worms are fed  
Is your concern.

“My errand here, in meeting you,  
Is nothing but a ‘how-d’ye-do;’

I've done what jobs I had—a few  
Along this way;  
If I can serve a crony too,  
I beg you'll say."

Quoth Jack, "Your Honour's very kind:  
And now I call the thing to mind,  
This parish very strict I find;  
But in the next 'un  
There lives a very well-inclined  
Old sort of sexton."

Death took the hint, and gave a wink  
As well as eyelet holes can blink;  
Then stretching out his arm to link  
The other's arm,—  
"Suppose," says he, "we have a drink  
Of something warm."

Jack nothing loth, with friendly ease  
Spoke up at once:—"Why, what ye please,  
Hard by there is the Cheshire Cheese,  
A famous tap."  
But this suggestion seem'd to tease  
The bony chap.

"No, no—your mortal drinks are heady,  
And only make my hand unsteady;  
I do not even care for Deady,  
And loathe your rum;  
But I've some glorious brewage ready,  
My drink is—Mum!"

And off they set, each right content—  
Who knows the dreary way they went?  
But Jack felt rather faint and spent,  
And out of breath;  
At last he saw, quite evident,

## The Door of Death.

All other men had been unmann'd  
To see a coffin on each hand,  
That served a skeleton to stand  
By way of sentry;  
In fact, Death has a very grand  
And awful entry.

Throughout his dismal sign prevails,  
His name is writ in coffin nails;  
The mortal darts make area rails;  
A skull that mocketh,  
Grins on the gloomy gate, and quails  
Whoever knocketh.

And lo! on either side, arise  
Two monstrous pillars—bones of thighs;  
A monumental slab supplies  
The step of stone,  
Where waiting for his master lies  
A dog of bone.

The dog leapt up, but gave no yell,  
The wire was pull'd, but woke no bell,  
The ghastly knocker rose and fell,  
But caused no riot;  
The ways of Death, we all know well,  
Are very quiet.

Old Bones stept in; Jack stepp'd behind;  
Quoth Death, I really hope you'll find  
The entertainment to your mind,  
As I shall treat ye—  
A friend or two of goblin kind,  
I've asked to meet ye.

And lo! a crowd of spectres tall,  
Like jack-a-lanterns on a wall



Like jack-a-lanterns on a wall,  
Were standing—every ghastly ball—  
An eager watcher.  
“My friend,” says Death—“friends, Mr. Hall,  
The body-snatcher.”

Lord, what a tumult it produced,  
When Mr. Hall was introduced!  
Jack even, who had long been used  
To frightful things,  
Felt just as if his back was sluic’d  
With freezing springs!

Each goblin face began to make  
Some horrid mouth—ape—gorgon—snake;  
And then a spectre-hag would shake  
An airy thigh-bone;  
And cried, (or seem’d to cry,) I’ll break  
Your bone, with my bone!

Some ground their teeth—some seem’d to spit—  
(Nothing, but nothing came of it,)  
A hundred awful brows were knit  
In dreadful spite.  
Thought Jack—“I’m sure I’d better quit  
Without good-night.”

One skip and hop and he was clear,  
And running like a hunted deer,  
As fleet as people run by fear  
Well spurr’d and whipp’d,  
Death, ghosts, and all in that career  
Were quite outstripp’d.

But those who live by death must die;  
Jack’s soul at last prepared to fly;  
And when his latter end drew nigh,  
Oh! what a swarm  
Of doctors came—but not to try

Of doctors came, but not to try  
To keep him warm.

No ravens ever scented prey  
So early where a dead horse lay,  
Nor vulture sniff'd so far away  
A last convulse:  
A dozen "guests" day after day  
Were "at his pulse."

'Twas strange, altho' they got no fees,  
How still they watch'd by twos and threes,  
But Jack a very little ease  
Obtain'd from them;  
In fact he did not find M. D.'s  
Worth one D——M.

The passing bell with hollow toll  
Was in his thought—the dreary hole!  
Jack gave his eyes a horrid roll,  
And then a cough:—  
"There's something weighing on my soul  
I wish was off;

"All night it roves about my brains,  
All day it adds to all my pains,  
It is concerning my remains  
When I am dead:"  
Twelve wigs and twelve gold-headed canes  
Drew near his bed.

"Alas!" he sigh'd, "I'm sore afraid  
A dozen pangs my heart invade;  
But when I drove a certain trade  
In flesh and bone,  
There was a little bargain made  
About my own."

Twelve suits of black began to close,

Twelve pair of sleek and sable hose,  
Twelve flowing cambric frills in rows,  
At once drew round;  
Twelve noses turn'd against his nose,  
Twelve snubs profound.

“Ten guineas did not quite suffice,  
And so I sold my body twice;  
Twice did not do—I sold it thrice,  
Forgive my crimes!  
In short I have received its price  
A dozen times!”

Twelve brows got very grim and black,  
Twelve wishes stretched him on the rack,  
Twelve pair of hands for fierce attack  
Took up position,  
Ready to share the dying Jack  
By long division.

Twelve angry doctors wrangled so,  
That twelve had struck an hour ago,  
Before they had an eye to throw  
On the departed;  
Twelve heads turn'd round at once, and lo!  
Twelve doctors started.

Whether some comrade of the dead,  
Or Satan took it in his head  
To steal the corpse—the corpse had fled!  
'Tis only written,  
That “*there was nothing in the bed,*  
*But twelve were bitten!*”

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MISS KILMANSEGG AND HER PRECIOUS LEG.

A GOLDEN LEGEND.

HER PEDIGREE.



O trace the Kilmansegg pedigree  
To the very root of the family tree  
Were a task as rash as ridiculous:  
Through antediluvian mists as thick  
As London fog such a line to pick  
Were enough, in truth, to puzzle old Nick,—  
Not to name Sir Harris Nicolas.

It wouldn't require much verbal strain  
To trace the Kil-man, perchance, to Cain,  
But, waiving all such digressions,  
Suffice it, according to family lore,  
A Patriarch Kilmansegg lived of yore,  
Who was famed for his great possessions.

Tradition said he feather'd his nest  
Through an Agricultural Interest  
In the Golden Age of farming;  
When golden eggs were laid by the geese,  
And Colchian sheep wore a golden fleece,  
And golden pippins—the sterling kind  
Of Hesperus—now so hard to find—  
Made Horticulture quite charming!

A Lord of Land, on his own estate,  
He lived at a very lively rate,  
But his income would bear carousing;  
Such acres he had of pasture and heath,  
With herbage so rich from the ore beneath,  
The very ewe's and lambkin's teeth  
Were turn'd into gold by browsing.

He gave, without any extra thrift,  
A flock of sheep for a birthday gift  
To each son of his loins, or daughter:  
And his debts—if debts he had—at will  
He liquidated by giving each bill

A dip in Pactolian water.

'Twas said that even his pigs of lead,  
By crossing with some by Midas bred,  
Made a perfect mine of his piggery.  
And as for cattle, one yearling bull  
Was worth all Smithfield-market full  
Of the Golden Bulls of Pope Gregory.

The high-bred horses within his stud,  
Like human creatures of birth and blood,  
Had their Golden Cups and flagons:  
And as for the common husbandry nags,  
Their noses were tied in money-bags,  
When they stopp'd with the carts and waggons.

Moreover, he had a Golden Ass,  
Sometimes at stall, and sometimes at grass,  
That was worth his own weight in money—  
And a golden hive, on a Golden Bank,  
Where golden bees, by alchemical prank,  
Gather'd gold instead of honey.

Gold! and gold! and gold without end!  
He had gold to lay by, and gold to spend,  
Gold to give, and gold to lend,  
And reversions of gold *in futuro*.  
In wealth the family revell'd and roll'd,  
Himself and wife and sons so bold;—  
And his daughters sang to their harps of gold  
“O bella eta del' oro!”

Such was the tale of the Kilmansegg Kin,  
In golden text on a vellum skin,  
Though certain people would wink and grin,  
And declare the whole story a parable—  
That the Ancestor rich was one Jacob Ghrimes,  
Who held a long lease, in prosperous times,  
Of acres, pastures and arable

Of acres, pasture and arable.

That as money makes money, his golden bees  
Were the Five per Cents, or which you please  
When his cash was more than plenty—  
That the golden cups were racing affairs;  
And his daughters, who sang Italian airs,  
Had their golden harps of Clementi.

That the Golden Ass, or Golden Bull,  
Was English John, with his pockets full,  
Then at war by land and water:  
While beef, and mutton, and other meat,  
Were almost as dear as money to eat,  
And Farmers reaped Golden Harvests of wheat  
At the Lord knows what per quarter!

HER BIRTH.



What different dooms our birthdays bring  
For instance, one little manikin thing  
Survives to wear many a wrinkle;  
While Death forbids another to wake,  
And a son that it took nine moons to make  
Expires without even a twinkle!

Into this world we come like ships,  
Launch'd from the docks, and stocks, and slips,  
For fortune fair or fatal;  
And one little craft is cast away  
In its very first trip in Babbicome Bay,  
While another rides safe at Port Natal.

What different lots our stars accord!  
This babe to be hail'd and woo'd as a Lord!  
And that to be shunn'd like a leper!  
One, to the world's wine, honey, and corn,  
Another, like Colchester native, born  
To its vinegar, only, and pepper.

One is litter'd under a roof  
Neither wind nor waterproof—  
That's the prose of Love in a Cottage—  
A puny, naked, shivering wretch,  
The whole of whose birthright would not fetch,  
Though Robins himself drew up the sketch,  
The bid of "a mess of pottage."

Born of Fortunatus's kin,  
Another comes tenderly ushered in  
To a prospect all bright and burnish'd:  
No tenant he for life's back slums—  
He comes to the world, as a gentleman comes  
To a lodging ready furnish'd.

And the other sex—the tender—the fair—  
And the other sex—the tender—the fair—

What wide reverses of fate are there!  
Whilst Margaret, charm'd by the Bulbul rare,  
In a garden of Gul reposes—  
Poor Peggy hawks nosegays from street to street  
Till—think of that, who find life so sweet!—  
She hates the smell of roses!

Not so with the infant Kilmansegg!  
She was not born to steal or beg,  
Or gather cresses in ditches;  
To plait the straw, or bind the shoe,  
Or sit all day to hem and sew,  
As females must—and not a few—  
To fill their insides with stitches!

She was not doom'd, for bread to eat,  
To be put to her hands as well as her feet—  
To carry home linen from mangles—  
Or heavy-hearted, and weary-limb'd,  
To dance on a rope in a jacket trimm'd  
With as many blows as spangles.

She was one of those who by Fortune's boon  
Are born, as they say, with a silver spoon  
In her mouth, not a wooden ladle:  
To speak according to poet's wont,  
Plutus as sponsor stood at her font,  
And Midas rock'd the cradle.



DUE AT MICHAELMAS.



**CRANE-IOLOGY.**

At her first *debut* she found her head  
On a pillow of down, in a downy bed,  
With a damask canopy over.  
For although, by the vulgar popular saw,  
All mothers are said to be “in the straw,”  
Some children are born in clover.

Her very first draught of vital air,  
It was not the common chameleon fare  
Of plebeian lungs and noses,—  
No—her earliest sniff  
Of this world was a whiff  
Of the genuine Otto of Roses!

When she saw the light, it was no mere ray  
Of that light so common—so everyday—  
That the sun each morning launches—  
But six wax tapers dazzled her eyes,  
From a thing—a gooseberry bush for size—  
With a golden stem and branches.

She was born exactly at half-past two,  
As witnessed a time-piece in or-molu  
That stood on a marble table—  
Showing at once the time of day,  
And a team of *Gildings* running away  
As fast as they were able,  
With a golden God, with a golden Star,  
And a golden Spear, in a golden Car,  
According to Grecian fable.

Like other babes, at her birth she cried;  
Which made a sensation far and wide—  
Ay, for twenty miles around her:  
For though to the ear ’twas nothing more  
Than an infant’s squall, it was really the roar  
Of a Fifty-thousand Pounder!

It shook the next heir  
In his library chair,  
And made him cry, "Confound her!"

Of signs and omens there was no dearth,  
Any more than at Owen Glendower's birth,  
Or the advent of other great people:  
Two bullocks dropp'd dead,  
As if knock'd on the head,  
And barrels of stout  
And ale ran about,  
And the village-bells such a peal rang out,  
That they crack'd the village-steeple.

In no time at all, like mushroom spawn,  
Tables sprang up all over the lawn;  
Not furnish'd scantily or shabbily,  
But on scale as vast  
As that huge repast,  
With its loads and cargoes  
Of drink and botargoes,  
At the birth of the Babe in Rabelais.

Hundreds of men were turn'd into beasts,  
Like the guests at Circe's horrible feasts,  
By the magic of ale and cider:  
And each country lass, and each country lad,  
Began to caper and dance like mad,  
And ev'n some old ones appear'd to have had  
A bite from the Naples Spider.

Then as night came on,  
It had scared King John  
Who considered such signs not risible,  
To have seen the maroons,  
And the whirling moons,  
And the serpents of flame,  
And wheels of the same,

That according to some were “whizzable.”

Oh, happy Hope of the Kilmanseggs!  
Thrice happy in head, and body, and legs,  
That her parents had such full pockets!  
For had she been born of Want and Thrift,  
For care and nursing all adrift,  
It’s ten to one she had had to make shift  
With rickets instead of rockets!

And how was the precious baby drest?  
In a robe of the East, with lace of the West,  
Like one of Cræsus’ issue—  
Her best bibs were made  
Of rich gold brocade,  
And the others of silver tissue.

And when the Baby inclined to nap  
She was lull’d on a Gros de Naples lap,  
By a nurse in a modish Paris cap,  
Of notions so exalted,  
She drank nothing lower than Curaçoa,  
Maraschino, or pink Noyau,  
And on principle never malted.

From a golden boat, with a golden spoon,  
The babe was fed night, morning, and noon;  
And although the tale seems fabulous,  
’Tis said her tops and bottoms were gilt,  
Like the oats in that Stable-yard Palace built  
For the Horse of Heliogabalus.

And when she took to squall and kick—  
For pain will ring, and pins will prick,  
E’en the wealthiest nabob’s daughter—  
They gave her no vulgar Dalby or gin,  
But a liquor with leaf of gold therein,  
Videlicet,—Dantzic Water.

In short, she was born, and bred, and nurst,  
And drest in the best from the very first,  
    To please the genteelest censor—  
And then, as soon as strength would allow  
Was vaccinated, as babes are now,  
With virus ta'en from the best-bred cow  
    Of Lord Althorpe's—now Earl Spencer.

HER CHRISTENING.



Though Shakespeare asks us, “What’s in a name?”  
(As if cognomens were much the same),  
    There’s really a very great scope in it.  
A name?—why, wasn’t there Doctor Dodd,  
That servant at once of Mammon and God,  
Who found four thousand pounds and odd,  
    A prison—a cart—and a rope in it?

A name?—if the party had a voice,  
What mortal would be a Bugg by choice?  
As a Hogg, a Grubb, or a Chubb rejoice?  
    Or any such nauseous blazon?  
Not to mention many a vulgar name,  
That would make a door-plate blush for shame,  
    If door-plates were not so brazen!

A name?—it has more than nominal worth,  
And belongs to good or bad luck at birth—  
    As dames of a certain degree know.  
In spite of his Page’s hat and hose,  
His Page’s jacket, and buttons in rows,  
Bob only sounds like a page in prose  
    Till turned into Rupertino.

Now to christen the infant Kilmansegg,  
For days and days it was quite a plague,  
    To hunt the list in the Lexicon:  
And scores were tried, like coin, by the ring,  
Ere names were found just the proper thing  
    For a minor rich as a Mexican.

Then cards were sent the presence to beg  
Of all the kin of Kilmansegg,  
    White, yellow, and brown relations:  
Brothers, Wardens of City Halls,  
And Uncles—rich as three Golden Balls  
    From taking pledges of nations.

Nephews, whom Fortune seem'd to bewitch,  
Rising in life like rockets—  
Nieces, whose doweries knew no hitch—  
Aunts, as certain of dying rich  
As candles in golden sockets—  
Cousins German and Cousins' sons,  
All thriving and opulent—some had tons  
Of Kentish hops in their pockets!

For money had stuck to the race through life  
(As it did to the bushel when cash so rife  
Posed Ali Baba's brother's wife)—  
And down to the Cousins and Coz-lings,  
The fortunate brood of the Kilmanseggs,  
As if they had come out of golden eggs,  
Were all as wealthy as "Goslings."

It would fill a Court Gazette to name  
What East and West End people came  
To the rite of Christianity:  
The lofty Lord, and the titled Dame,  
All di'monds, plumes, and urbanity:  
His Lordship the May'r with his golden chain,  
And two Gold Sticks, and the Sheriffs twain,  
Nine foreign Counts, and other great men  
With their orders and stars, to help "M. or N."  
To renounce all pomp and vanity.

To paint the maternal Kilmansegg  
The pen of an Eastern Poet would beg,  
And need an elaborate sonnet;  
How she sparkled with gems whenever she stirr'd,  
And her head niddle-noddled at every word,  
And seem'd so happy, a Paradise Bird  
Had nidificated upon it.

And Sir Jacob the Father strutted and bow'd,  
And smiled to himself, and laugh'd aloud

And smiled to himself, and laugh'd aloud,  
To think of his heiress and daughter—  
And then in his pockets he made a grope,  
And then, in the fulness of joy and hope,  
Seem'd washing his hands with invisible soap  
In imperceptible water.

He had roll'd in money like pigs in mud,  
Till it seem'd to have entered into his blood  
By some occult projection:  
And his cheeks instead of a healthy hue  
As yellow as any guinea grew,  
Making the common phrase seem true,  
About a rich complexion.

And now came the nurse, and during a pause,  
Her dead-leaf satin would fitly cause  
A very autumnal rustle—  
So full of figure, so full of fuss,  
As she carried about the babe to buss,  
She seem'd to be nothing but bustle.

A wealthy Nabob was Godpapa,  
And an Indian Begum was Godmamma,  
Whose jewels a Queen might covet—  
And the Priest was a Vicar, and Dean withal  
Of that Temple we see with a Golden Ball,  
And a Golden Cross above it.

The Font was a bowl of American gold,  
Won by Raleigh in days of old,  
In spite of Spanish bravado;  
And the Book of Pray'r was so overrun  
With gilt devices, it shone in the sun  
Like a copy—a presentation one—  
Of Humboldt's "El Dorado."

Gold! and gold! and nothing but gold!  
The same auiferous shine behold

THE SAME GORGEOUS SHINE BELOW

Wherever the eye could settle!  
On the walls—the sideboard—the ceiling-sky—  
On the gorgeous footmen standing by,  
In coats to delight a miner's eye  
With seams of the precious metal.

Gold! and gold! and besides the gold,  
The very robe of the infant told  
A tale of wealth in every fold,  
It lapp'd her like a vapour!  
So fine! so thin! the mind at a loss  
Could compare it to nothing except a cross  
Of cobweb with bank-note paper.

Then her pearls—'twas a perfect sight, forsooth,  
To see them, like "the dew of her youth,"  
In such a plentiful sprinkle.  
Meanwhile, the Vicar read through the form,  
And gave her another, not overwarm,  
That made her little eyes twinkle.

Then the babe was cross'd and bless'd amain!  
But instead of the Kate, or Ann, or Jane,  
Which the humbler female endorses—  
Instead of one name, as some people prefix,  
Kilmansegg went at the tails of six,  
Like a carriage of state with its horses.

Oh, then the kisses she got and hugs!  
The golden mugs and the golden jugs  
That lent fresh rays to the midges!  
The golden knives, and the golden spoons,  
The gems that sparkled like fairy boons,  
It was one of the Kilmansegg's own saloons,  
But look'd like Rundell and Bridge's!

Gold! and gold! the new and the old,  
The company ate and drank from gold,

They revell'd, they sang, and were merry;  
And one of the Gold Sticks rose from his chair,  
And toasted "the Lass with the golden hair"  
In a bumper of Golden Sherry.

Gold! still gold! it rain'd on the nurse,  
Who—un-like Danäe—was none the worse!  
There was nothing but guineas glistening!  
Fifty were given to Doctor James,  
For calling the little Baby names,  
And for saying, Amen!  
The Clerk had ten,  
And that was the end of the Christening.

HER CHILDHOOD.

Our youth! our childhood! that spring of springs!  
'Tis surely one of the blessedest things  
That nature ever invented!  
When the rich are wealthy beyond their wealth,  
And the poor are rich in spirits and health,  
And all with their lots contented!

There's little Phelim, he sings like a thrush,  
In the selfsame pair of patchwork plush,  
With the selfsame empty pockets,  
That tempted his daddy so often to cut  
His throat, or jump in the water-butt—  
But what cares Phelim? an empty nut  
Would sooner bring tears to their sockets.

Give him a collar without a skirt,  
(That's the Irish linen for shirt)  
And a slice of bread with a taste of dirt,  
(That's Poverty's Irish butter),  
And what does he lack to make him blest?  
Some oyster-shells, or a sparrow's nest,  
A candle-end, and a gutter.

But to leave the happy Phelim alone,  
Gnawing, perchance, a marrowless bone,  
For which no dog would quarrel—  
Turn we to little Miss Kilmansegg  
Cutting her first little toothy-peg  
With a fifty-guinea coral—  
A peg upon which  
About poor and rich  
Reflection might hang a moral.

Born in wealth, and wealthily nursed,  
Capp'd, papp'd, napp'd, and lapp'd from the first  
On the knees of Prodigality,  
Her childhood was one eternal round

Of the game of going on Tickler's ground  
Picking up gold—in reality.

With extempore cartes she never play'd,  
Or the odds and ends of a Tinker's trade,  
Or little dirt pies and puddings made,  
Like children happy and squalid;  
The very puppet she had to pet,  
Like a bait for the "Nix my Dolly" set,  
Was a Dolly of gold—and solid!

Gold! and gold! 'twas the burden still!  
To gain the Heiress's early goodwill  
There was much corruption and bribery—  
The yearly cost of her golden toys  
Would have given half London's Charity Boys  
And Charity Girls the annual joys  
Of a holiday dinner at Highbury.

Bon-bons she ate from the gilt *cornet*;  
And gilded queens on St. Bartlemy's day;  
Till her fancy was tinged by her presents—  
And first a Goldfinch excited her wish,  
Then a spherical bowl with its Golden fish,  
And then two Golden Pheasants.

Nay, once she squall'd and scream'd like wild—  
And it shows how the bias we give to a child  
Is a thing most weighty and solemn:—  
But whence was wonder or blame to spring  
If little Miss K.—after such a swing—  
Made a dust for the flaming gilded thing  
On the top of the Fish Street column?

HER EDUCATION.





According to metaphysical creed,  
To the earliest books that children read  
    For much good or much bad they are debtors—  
But before with their A B C they start,  
There are things in morals, as well as art,  
That play a very important part—  
    “Impressions before the letters.”

Dame Education begins the pile,  
Mayhap in the graceful Corinthian style,  
    But alas for the elevation!  
If the Lady’s maid or Gossip the Nurse  
With a load of rubbish, or something worse,  
    Have made a rotten foundation.

Even thus with little Miss Kilmansegg,  
Before she learned her E for egg,  
    Ere her Governess came, or her masters—  
Teachers of quite a different kind  
Had “cramm’d” her beforehand, and put her mind  
    In a go-cart on golden castors.

Long before her A B and C,  
They had taught her by heart her L. S. D.  
    And as how she was born a great Heiress;  
And as sure as London is built of bricks,  
My Lord would ask her the day to fix,  
To ride in a fine gilt coach and six,  
    Like Her Worship the Lady May’ress.

Instead of stories from Edgeworth’s page,  
The true golden lore for our golden age,  
    Or lessons from Barbauld and Trimmer,  
Teaching the worth of Virtue and Health,  
All that she knew was the Virtue of Wealth,  
Provided by vulgar nursery stealth  
    With a Book of Leaf Gold for a Primer.

The very metal of merit they told,  
And praised her for being as “good as gold!”  
Till she grew as a peacock haughty;  
Of money they talk’d the whole day round,  
And weigh’d desert, like grapes, by the pound,  
Till she had an idea from the very sound  
That people with nought were naughty.

They praised—poor children with nothing at all!  
Lord! how you twaddle and waddle and squall  
Like common-bred geese and ganders!  
What sad little bad little figures you make  
To the rich Miss K., whose plainest seed-cake  
Was stuff’d with corianders!

They praised her falls, as well as her walk,  
Flatterers made cream cheese of chalk,  
They praised—how they praised—her very small talk,  
As if it fell from a Solon;  
Or the girl who at each pretty phrase let drop  
A ruby comma, or pearl full-stop,  
Or an emerald semi-colon.

They praised her spirit, and now and then  
The Nurse brought her own little “nevy” Ben,  
To play with the future May’ress,  
And when he got raps, and taps, and slaps,  
Scratches, and pinches, snips, and snaps,  
As if from a Tigress, or Bearess,  
They told him how Lords would court that hand,  
And always gave him to understand  
While he rubb’d, poor soul,  
His carrotty poll,  
That his hair had been pull’d by “a *Hairess*.”

Such were the lessons from maid and nurse,  
A Governess help’d to make still worse,  
Giving an appetite as powerful

Giving an appetite so perverse  
Fresh diet whereon to batten—  
Beginning with A B C to hold  
Like a royal playbill printed in gold  
On a square of pearl-white satin.

The books to teach the verbs and nouns,  
And those about countries, cities, and towns,  
Instead of their sober drabs and browns,  
Were in crimson silk, with gilt edges;—  
Her Butler, and Enfield, and Entick—in short  
Her “Early Lessons” of every sort,  
Look’d like Souvenirs, Keepsakes, and Pledges.

Old Johnson shone out in as fine array  
As he did one night when he went to the play;  
Chambaud like a beau of King Charles’s day—  
Lindley Murray in like conditions—  
Each weary, unwelcome, irksome task,  
Appear’d in a fancy dress and a mask;—  
If you wish for similar copies, ask  
For Howell and James’s Editions.

Novels she read to amuse her mind,  
But always the affluent match-making kind  
That ends with Promessi Sposi,  
And a father-in-law so wealthy and grand,  
He could give cheque-mate to Coutts in the Strand;  
So, along with a ring and posy,  
He endows the Bride with Golconda off-hand,  
And gives the Groom Potosi.

Plays she perused—but she liked the best  
Those comedy gentlefolks always possess’d  
Of fortunes so truly romantic—  
Of money so ready that right or wrong  
It always is ready to go for a song,  
Throwing it, going it, pitching it strong—  
They ought to have purses as green and long

They ought to have purses as green and long  
As the cucumber call'd the Gigantic.

Then Eastern Tales she loved for the sake  
Of the Purse of Oriental make,  
And the thousand pieces they put in it—  
But Pastoral scenes on her heart fell cold,  
For Nature with her had lost its hold,  
No field but the Field of the Cloth of Gold  
Would ever have caught her foot in it.

What more? She learnt to sing, and dance,  
To sit on a horse, although he should prance,  
And to speak a French not spoken in France  
Any more than at Babel's building—  
And she painted shells, and flowers, and Turks,  
But her great delight was in Fancy Works  
That are done with gold or gilding.

Gold! still gold!—the bright and the dead,  
With golden beads, and gold lace, and gold thread  
She work'd in gold, as if for her bread;  
The metal had so undermined her,  
Gold ran in her thoughts and fill'd her brain,  
She was golden-headed as Peter's cane  
With which he walk'd behind her.

HER ACCIDENT.



The horse that carried Miss Kilmansegg,  
And a better never lifted leg,  
    Was a very rich bay, call'd Banker—  
A horse of a breed and a mettle so rare,—  
By Bullion out of an Ingot mare,—  
That for action, the best of figures, and air,  
    It made many good judges hanker.

And when she took a ride in the Park,  
Equestrian Lord, or pedestrian Clerk,  
    Was thrown in an amorous fever,  
To see the Heiress how well she sat,  
With her groom behind her, Bob or Nat,  
In green, half smother'd with gold, and a hat  
    With more gold lace than beaver.

And then when Banker obtain'd a pat,  
To see how he arch'd his neck at that!  
    He snorted with pride and pleasure!  
Like the Steed in the fable so lofty and grand,  
Who gave the poor Ass to understand,  
That *he* didn't carry a bag of sand,  
    But a burden of golden treasure.

A load of treasure?—alas! alas!  
Had her horse but been fed upon English grass,  
    And shelter'd in Yorkshire spinneys,  
Had he scour'd the sand with the Desert Ass,  
    Or where the American whinnies—  
But a hunter from Erin's turf and gorse,  
A regular thorough-bred Irish horse,  
Why, he ran away, as a matter of course,  
    With a girl worth her weight in guineas!

Mayhap 'tis the trick of such pampered nags,—  
To shy at the sight of a beggar in rags,  
    But away, like the bolt of a rabbit,—

Away went the horse in the madness of fright,  
And away went the horsewoman mocking the sight—  
Was yonder blue flash a flash of blue light,  
Or only the skirt of her habit?

Away she flies, with the groom behind,—  
It looks like a race of the Calmuck kind,  
When Hymen himself is the starter,  
And the Maid rides first in the four-footed strife,  
Riding, striding, as if for her life,  
While the Lover rides after to catch him a wife,  
Although it's catching a Tartar.

But the Groom has lost his glittering hat!  
Though he does not sigh and pull up for that—  
Alas! his horse is a tit for Tat  
To sell to a very low bidder—  
His wind is ruin'd, his shoulder is sprung,  
Things, though a horse be handsome and young,  
A purchaser *will* consider.

But still flies the Heiress through stones and dust,  
Oh, for a fall, if fall she must,  
On the gentle lap of Flora!  
But still, thank Heaven! she clings to her seat—  
Away! away! she could ride a dead heat  
With the Dead who ride so fast and fleet,  
In the Ballad of Leonora!

Away she gallops,—it's awful work!  
It's faster than Turpin's ride to York,  
On Bess that notable clipper!  
She has circled the Ring!—she crosses the Park!  
Mazeppa, although he was stripp'd so stark,  
Mazeppa couldn't outstrip her!

The fields seem running away with the folks!  
The Elms are having a race for the Oaks  
At a pace that all lookers-on

At a pace that all jockeys disparages!  
All, all is racing! the Serpentine  
Seems rushing past like the “arrowy Rhine,”  
The houses have got on a railway line,  
And are off like the first-class carriages!

She’ll lose her life! she is losing her breath!  
A cruel chase, she is chasing Death,  
As female shriekings forewarn her:  
And now—as gratis as blood of Guelph—  
She clears that gate, which has clear’d itself  
Since then, at Hyde Park Corner!

Alas! for the hope of the Kilmanseggs!  
For her head, her brains, her body, and legs,  
Her life’s not worth a copper!  
Willy-nilly,  
In Piccadilly,  
A hundred hearts turn sick and chilly,  
A hundred voices cry, “Stop her!”  
And one old gentleman stares and stands,  
Shakes his head and lifts his hands,  
And says, “How very improper!”

On and on!—what a perilous run!  
The iron rails seem all mingling in one,  
To shut out the Green Park scenery!  
And now the Cellar its dangers reveals.  
She shudders—she shrieks—she’s doom’d, she feels,  
To be torn by powers of horses and wheels,  
Like a spinner by steam machinery!

Sick with horror she shuts her eyes,  
But the very stones seem uttering cries,  
As they did to that Persian daughter,  
When she climb’d up the steep vociferous hill,  
Her little silver flagon to fill  
With the magical Golden Water!



“Batter her! shatter her!  
Throw and scatter her!”  
Shouts each stony-hearted chatterer!  
“Dash at the heavy Dover!  
Spill her! kill her! tear and tatter her!  
Smash her! crash her!” (the stones didn’t flatter her!)  
“Kick her brains out! let her blood spatter her!  
Roll on her over and over!”

For so she gather’d the awful sense  
Of the street in its past unmacadamized tense,  
As the wild horse overran it,—  
His four heels making the clatter of six,  
Like a Devil’s tattoo, play’d with iron sticks  
On a kettle-drum of granite!

On! still on! she’s dazzled with hints  
Of oranges, ribbons, and colour’d prints,  
A Kaleidoscope jumble of shapes and tints,  
And human faces all flashing,  
Bright and brief as the sparks from the flints,  
That the desperate hoof keeps dashing!

On and on! still frightfully fast!  
Dover-street, Bond-street, all are past!  
But—yes—no—yes!—they’re down at last!  
The Furies and Fates have found them!  
Down they go with sparkle and crash,  
Like a Bark that’s struck by the lightning flash—  
There’s a shriek—and a sob—  
And the dense dark mob  
Like a billow closes around them!

\* \* \* \* \*

“She breathes!”  
“She don’t!”  
“She’ll recover!”  
“She won’t!”

SHE WENT.

“She’s stirring! she’s living, by Nemesis!”  
Gold, still gold! on counter and shelf!  
Golden dishes as plenty as delf;  
Miss Kilmansegg’s coming again to herself  
On an opulent Goldsmith’s premises!

Gold! fine gold!—both yellow and red,  
Beaten, and molten—polish’d, and dead—



DEATH'S DOOR.



**BARRISTER ON CIRCUIT.**

To see the gold with profusion spread  
In all forms of its manufacture!  
But what avails gold to Miss Kilmansegg,  
When the femoral bone of her dexter leg  
Has met with a compound fracture?

Gold may soothe Adversity's smart;  
Nay, help to bind up a broken heart;  
But to try it on any other part  
Were as certain a disappointment,  
As if one should rub the dish and plate,  
Taken out of a Staffordshire crate—  
In the hope of a Golden Service of State—  
With Singleton's "Golden Ointment."

HER PRECIOUS LEG.

“As the twig is bent, the tree’s inclined,”  
Is an adage often recall’d to mind,  
Referring to juvenile bias:  
And never so well is the verity seen,  
As when to the weak, warp’d side we lean,  
While Life’s tempests and hurricanes try us.

Even thus with Miss K. and her broken limb:  
By a very, very remarkable whim,  
She show’d her early tuition:  
While the buds of character came into blow  
With a certain tinge that served to show  
The nursery culture long ago,  
As the graft is known by fruition!

For the King’s Physician, who nursed the case,  
His verdict gave with an awful face,  
And three others concurr’d to egg it;  
That the Patient to give old Death the slip,  
Like the Pope, instead of a personal trip,  
Must send her Leg as a Legate.

The limb was doom’d—it couldn’t be saved!  
And like other people the patient behaved,  
Nay, bravely that cruel parting braved,  
Which makes some persons so falter,  
They rather would part, without a groan,  
With the flesh of their flesh, and bone of their bone,  
They obtain’d at St. George’s altar.

But when it came to fitting the stump  
With a proxy limb—then flatly and plump  
She spoke, in the spirit olden;  
She couldn’t—she shouldn’t—she wouldn’t have wood  
Nor a leg of cork, if she never stood,  
And she swore an oath, or something as good,  
The proxy limb should be golden!

A wooden leg! what, a sort of peg,  
For your common Jockeys and Jennies!  
No, no, her mother might worry and plague—  
Weep, go down on her knees, and beg,  
But nothing would move Miss Kilmansegg!  
She could—she would have a Golden Leg,  
If it cost ten thousand guineas!

Wood indeed, in Forest or Park,  
With its sylvan honours and feudal bark,  
Is an aristocratic article:  
But split and sawn, and hack'd about town,  
Serving all needs of pauper or clown,  
Trod on! stagger'd on! Wood cut down  
Is vulgar—fibre and particle.

And Cork!—when the noble Cork Tree shades  
A lovely group of Castilian maids,  
'Tis a thing for a song or sonnet!—  
But cork, as it stops the bottle of gin,  
Or bungs the beer—the *small* beer—in,  
It pierced her heart like a corking-pin,  
To think of standing upon it!

A Leg of Gold—solid gold throughout,  
Nothing else, whether slim or stout,  
Should ever support her, God willing!  
She must—she could—she would have her whim,  
Her father, she turn'd a deaf ear to him—  
He might kill her—she didn't mind killing!  
He was welcome to cut off her other limb—  
He might cut her all off with a shilling!

All other promised gifts were in vain,  
Golden Girdle, or Golden Chain,  
She writhed with impatience more than pain,  
And utter'd “pshaws!” and “pishes!”  
But a Leg of Gold as she lay in bed

BUT a Leg of Gold as she lay in bed,  
It danced before her—it ran in her head!  
It jump'd with her dearest wishes!

“Gold—gold—gold! Oh, let it be gold!”  
Asleep or awake that tale she told,  
And when she grew delirious;  
Till her parents resolved to grant her wish,  
If they melted down plate, and goblet, and dish,  
The case was getting so serious.

So a Leg was made in a comely mould,  
Of Gold, fine virgin glittering gold,  
As solid as man could made it—  
Solid in foot, and calf, and shank,  
A prodigious sum of money it sank;  
In fact 'twas a Branch of the family Bank,  
And no easy matter to break it.

All sterling metal—not half-and-half,  
The Goldsmith's mark was stamp'd on the calf—  
'Twas pure as from Mexican barter!  
And to make it more costly, just over the knee,  
Where another ligature used to be,  
Was a circle of jewels, worth shillings to see,  
A new-fangled Badge of the Garter!

'Twas a splendid, brilliant, beautiful Leg,  
Fit for the Court of Scander-Beg,  
That Precious Leg of Miss Kilmansegg!  
For, thanks to parental bounty,  
Secure from Mortification's touch,  
She stood on a Member that cost as much  
As a Member for all the County!

HER FAME.





To gratify stern ambition's whims,  
What hundreds and thousands of precious limbs  
    On a field of battle we scatter!  
Sever'd by sword, or bullet, or saw,  
Off they go, all bleeding and raw,—  
But the public seems to get the lock-jaw  
    So little is said on the matter!

Legs, the tightest that ever were seen,  
The tightest, the lightest, that danced on the green,  
    Cutting capers to sweet Kitty Clover;  
Shatter'd, scatter'd, cut, and bowl'd down,  
Off they go, worse off for renown,  
A line in the *Times*, or a talk about town,  
    Than the leg that a fly runs over!

But the Precious Leg of Miss Kilmansegg,  
That goowden, goowden, golden leg,  
    Was the theme of all conversation!  
Had it been a Pillar of Church and State,  
Or a prop to support the whole Dead Weight,  
It could not have furnish'd more debate  
    To the heads and tails of the nation!

East and west, and north and south,  
Though useless for either hunger or drouth,—  
The Leg was in everybody's mouth,  
    To use a poetical figure,  
Rumour, in taking her ravenous swim,  
Saw, and seized on the tempting limb,  
    Like a shark on the leg of a nigger.

Wilful murder fell very dead;  
Debates in the House were hardly read;  
In vain the Police Reports were fed  
    With Irish riots and *rumpuses*—  
The Leg! the Leg! was the great event,

Through every circle in life it went,  
Like the leg of a pair of compasses.

The last new Novel seem'd tame and flat,  
The Leg, a novelty newer than that,  
Had tripp'd up the heels of Fiction!  
It Burked the very essays of Burke,  
And, alas! how Wealth over Wit play's the Turk!  
As a regular piece of goldsmith's work,  
Got the better of Goldsmith's diction.

"A leg of gold! what of solid gold!"  
Cried rich and poor, and young and old,—  
And Master and Miss and Madam—  
'Twas the talk of 'Change—the Alley—the Bank—  
And with men of scientific rank,  
It made as much stir as the fossil shank  
Of a Lizard coeval with Adam!

Of course with Greenwich and Chelsea elves,  
Men who had lost a limb themselves,  
Its interest did not dwindle—  
But Bill, and Ben, and Jack, and Tom  
Could hardly have spun more yarns therefrom  
If the leg had been a spindle.

Meanwhile the story went to and fro,  
Till, gathering like the ball of snow,  
By the time it got to Stratford-le-Bow,  
Through Exaggeration's touches,  
The Heiress and Hope of the Kilmanseggs  
Was propp'd on two fine Golden Legs,  
And a pair of Golden Crutches!

Never had a Leg so great a run!  
'Twas the "go" and the "Kick" thrown into one!  
The mode—the new thing under the sun,  
The rage—the fancy—the passion!  
Bonnets were named, and hats were worn

Bonnets were named, and hats were worn,  
A *la* Golden Leg instead of Leghorn,  
And stockings and shoes,  
Of golden hues,  
Took the lead in the walks of fashion!

The Golden Leg had a vast career,  
It was sung and danced—and to show how near  
Low folly to lofty approaches,  
Down to society's very dregs,  
The Belles of Wapping wore "Kilmanseggs,"  
And St. Giles's Beaux sported Golden Legs  
In their pinchbeck pins and brooches!

HER FIRST STEP.

Supposing the Trunk and Limbs of Man  
Shared, on the allegorical plan,  
By the Passions that mark Humanity,  
Whichever might claim the head, or heart,  
The stomach, or any other part,  
The Legs would be seized by Vanity.

There's Bardus, a six-foot column of fop,  
A lighthouse without any light atop,  
Whose height would attract beholders  
If he had not lost some inches clear  
By looking down at his kerseymere,  
Ogling the limbs he holds so dear,  
Till he got a stoop in his shoulders.

Talk of Art, of Science, or Books,  
And down go the everlasting looks,  
To his crural beauties so wedded!  
Try him, wherever you will, you find  
His mind in his legs, and his legs in his mind,  
All prongs and folly—in short a kind  
Of fork—that is fiddle-headed.

What wonder, then, if Miss Kilmansegg,  
With a splendid, brilliant, beautiful leg,  
Fit for the court of Scander-Beg,  
Disdain'd to hide it like Joan or Meg,  
In petticoats stuff'd or quilted?  
Not she! 'twas her convalescent whim  
To dazzle the world with her precious limb,—  
Nay, to go a little high-kilted.

So cards were sent for that sort of mob  
Where Tartars and Africans hob-and-nob,  
And the Cherokee talks of his cab and cob  
To Polish or Lapland lovers—  
Cards like that hieroglyphical call

---

To a geographical Fancy Ball  
On the recent Post-Office covers.

For if Lion-hunters—and great ones too—  
Would mob a savage from Latakoo,  
Or squeeze for a glimpse of Prince Lee Boo,  
That unfortunate Sandwich scion—  
Hundreds of first-rate people, no doubt,  
Would gladly, madly, rush to a rout,  
That promised a Golden Lion!

HER FANCY BALL.

Of all the spirits of evil fame,  
That hurt the soul or injure the frame,  
And poison what's honest and hearty,  
There's none more needs a Matthew to preach  
A cooling antiphlogistic speech,  
To praise and enforce  
A temperate course,  
Than the Evil Spirit of Party.

Go to the House of Commons, or Lords,  
And they seem to be busy with simple words  
In their popular sense or pedantic—  
But, alas! with their cheers, and sneers, and jeers,  
They're really busy, whatever appears,  
Putting peas in each other's ears,  
To drive their enemies frantic!

Thus Tories like to worry the Whigs,  
Who treat them in turn like Schwalbach pigs,  
Giving them lashes, thrashes, and digs,  
With their writhing and pain delighted—  
But after all that's said, and more,  
The malice and spite of Party are poor  
To the malice and spite of a party next door,  
To a party not invited.

On with the cap and out with the light,  
Weariness bids the world good night,  
At least for the usual season;  
But hark! a clatter of horses' heels!  
And Sleep and Silence are broken on wheels,  
Like Wilful Murder and Treason!

Another crash—and the carriage goes—  
Again poor Weariness seeks the repose  
That Nature demands, imperious;  
But Echo takes up the burden now,

With a rattling chorus of row-de-dow-dow,  
Till Silence herself seems making a row,  
Like a Quaker gone delirious!

'Tis night—a winter night—and the stars  
Are shining like winkin'—Venus and Mars  
Are rolling along in their golden cars  
Through the sky's serene expansion—  
But vainly the stars dispense their rays,  
Venus and Mars are lost in the blaze  
Of the Kilmanseggs' luminous mansion!

Up jumps Fear in a terrible fright!  
His bedchamber windows look so bright,—  
With light all the Square is glutted!  
Up he jumps, like a sole from the pan,  
And a tremor sickens his inward man,  
For he feels as only a gentleman can,  
Who thinks he's being "guttled."

Again Fear settles, all snug and warm,  
But only to dream of a dreadful storm  
From Autumn's sulphurous locker;  
But the only electrical body that falls,  
Wears a negative coat, and positive smalls,  
And draws the peal that so appals  
From the Kilmanseggs' brazen knocker!

'Tis Curiosity's Benefit night—  
And perchance 'tis the English-Second-Sight,  
But whatever it be, so be it—  
As the friends and guests of Miss Kilmansegg  
Crowd in to look at her Golden Leg,  
As many more  
Mob round the door,  
To see them going to see it!

In they go—in jackets, and cloaks,  
Plumes, and bonnets, turbans, and toques

Plumes, and bonnets, turbans, and toques,  
As if to a Congress of Nations:  
Greeks and Malays, with daggers and dirks,  
Spaniards, Jews, Chinese, and Turks—  
Some like original foreign works,  
But mostly like bad translations.

In they go, and to work like a pack,  
Juan, Moses, and Shacabac—  
Tom, and Jerry, and Springheel'd Jack,—  
For some of low Fancy are lovers—  
Skirting, zigzagging, casting about,  
Here and there, and in and out,  
With a crush, and a rush, for a full-bodied rout  
In one of the stiffest of covers.

In they went, and hunted about,  
Open-mouth'd like chub and trout,  
And some with the upper lip thrust out,  
Like that fish for routing, a barbel—  
While Sir Jacob stood to welcome the crowd,  
And rubb'd his hands, and smiled aloud,  
And bow'd, and bow'd, and bow'd, and bow'd,  
Like a man who is sawing marble.

For Princes were there, and Noble Peers;  
Dukes descended from Norman spears;  
Earls that dated from early years;  
And Lords in vast variety—  
Besides the Gentry both new and old—  
For people who stand on legs of gold,  
Are sure to stand well with society.

“But where—where—where?” with one accord  
Cried Moses and Mufti, Jack and my Lord,  
Wang-Fong and Il Bondocani—  
When slow, and heavy, and dead as a dump,  
They heard a foot begin to stump,  
Thump! bump!



rump: rump:  
    Lump! thump!  
Like the Spectre in “Don Giovanni!”

And lo! the Heiress, Miss Kilmansegg,  
With her splendid, brilliant, beautiful leg,  
    In the garb of a Goddess olden—  
Like chaste Diana going to hunt,  
With a golden spear—which of course was blunt,  
And a tunic loop’d up to a gem in front,  
    To show the Leg that was Golden!

Gold! still gold; her Crescent behold,  
That should be silver, but would be gold;  
    And her robe’s auriferous spangles!  
Her golden stomacher—how she would melt!  
Her golden quiver, and golden belt,  
    Where a golden bugle dangles!

And her jewell’d Garter! Oh, Sin, oh, Shame!  
Let Pride and Vanity bear the blame,  
That bring such blots on female fame!  
    But to be a true recorder,  
Besides its thin transparent stuff,  
The tunic was loop’d quite high enough  
    To give a glimpse of the Order!

But what have sin or shame to do  
With a Golden Leg—and a stout one too?  
    Away with all Prudery’s panics!  
That the precious metal, by thick and thin,  
Will cover square acres of land or sin,  
    Is a fact made plain  
    Again and again,  
In Morals as well as Mechanics.

A few, indeed, of her proper sex,  
Who seem’d to feel her foot on their necks,  
And fear’d their charms would meet with checks

From so rare and splendid a blazon—  
A few cried “fie!—and “forward”—and “bold!”  
And said of the Leg it might be gold,  
But to them it look’d like brazen!

’Twas hard they hinted for flesh and blood,  
Virtue and Beauty, and all that’s good,  
To strike to mere dross their topgallants—  
But what were Beauty, or Virtue, or Worth,  
Gentle manners, or gentle birth,  
Nay, what the most talented head on earth  
To a Leg worth fifty Talents!

But the men sang quite another hymn  
Of glory and praise to the precious Limb—  
Age, sordid Age, admired the whim,  
And its indecorum pardon’d—  
While half of the young—ay, more than half—  
Bow’d down and worshipp’d the Golden Calf,  
Like the Jews when their hearts were harden’d.

A Golden Leg!—what fancies it fired!  
What golden wishes and hopes inspired!  
To give but a mere abridgment—  
What a leg to leg-bail Embarrassment’s serf  
What a leg for a Leg to take on the turf!  
What a leg for a marching regiment!

A golden Leg!—whatever Love sings,  
’Twas worth a bushel of “Plain Gold Rings”  
With which the Romantic wheedles.  
’Twas worth all the legs in stockings and socks—  
’Twas a leg that might be put in the Stocks,  
N.B.—Not the parish beadle’s!

And Lady K. nid-nodded her head,  
Lapp’d in a turban fancy-bred,  
Just like a love-apple, huge and red,

Miss Kilmansegg took off her leg,  
And laid it down like a cribbage-peg,  
For the Rout was done and the riot:  
The Square was hush'd; not a sound was heard;  
The sky was gray, and no creature stirr'd,  
Except one little precocious bird,  
That chirp'd—and then was quiet.

So still without,—so still within;—  
It had been a sin  
To drop a pin—  
So intense is silence after a din,  
It seem'd like Death's rehearsal!  
To stir the air no eddy came;  
And the taper burnt with as still a flame,  
As to flicker had been a burning shame,  
In a calm so universal.

The time for sleep had come at last;  
And there was the bed, so soft, so vast,  
Quite a field of Bedfordshire clover;  
Softer, cooler, and calmer, no doubt,  
From the piece of work just ravell'd out,  
For one of the pleasures of having a rout  
Is the pleasure of having it over.

No sordid pallet, or truckle mean,  
Of straw, and rug, and tatters unclean;  
But a splendid, gilded, carved machine,  
That was fit for a Royal Chamber.  
On the top was a gorgeous golden wreath;  
And the damask curtains hung beneath,  
Like clouds of crimson and amber;

Curtains, held up by two little plump things,  
With golden bodies and golden wings,—  
Mere fins for such solidities—

Two Cupids, in short,  
Of the regular sort,  
But the housemaid call'd them "Cupidities."

No patchwork quilt, all seams and scars,  
But velvet, powder'd with golden stars,  
A fit mantle for *Night-Commanders*!  
And the pillow, as white as snow undimm'd  
And as cool as the pool that the breeze has skimm'd,  
Was cased in the finest cambric, and trimm'd  
With the costliest lace of Flanders.

And the bed—of the Eider's softest down,  
'Twas a place to revel, to smother, to drown  
In a bliss inferr'd by the Poet;  
For if Ignorance be indeed a bliss,  
What blessed ignoance equals this,  
To sleep—and not to know it?

Oh, bed! oh, bed! delicious bed!  
That heaven upon earth to the weary head;  
But a place that to name would be ill-bred,  
To the head with a wakeful trouble—  
'Tis held by such a different lease!  
To one, a place of comfort and peace,  
All stuff'd with the down of stubble geese,  
To another with only the stubble!

To one, a perfect Halcyon nest,  
All calm, and balm and quiet, and rest,  
And soft as the fur of the cony—  
To another, so restless for body and head,  
That the bed seems borrow'd from Nettlebed,  
And the pillow from Stratford the Stony!

To the happy, a first-class carriage of ease,  
To the Land of Nod, or where you please;  
But alas! for the watchers and weepers,  
Who turn, and turn, and turn again

who turn, and turn, and turn again,  
But turn, and turn, and turn in vain,  
    With an anxious brain,  
    And thoughts in a train,  
That does not run upon *sleepers*!

Wide awake as the mousing owl,  
Night-hawk, or other nocturnal fowl,—  
    But more profitless vigils keeping,—  
Wide awake in the dark they stare,  
Filling with phantoms the vacant air,  
As if that Crook-back'd Tyrant Care  
    Had plotted to kill them sleeping.

And oh! when the blessed diurnal light  
Is quench'd by the providential night,  
    To render our slumber more certain!  
Pity, pity the wretches that weep,  
For they must be wretched, who cannot sleep  
    When God himself draws the curtain!

The careful Betty the pillow beats,  
And airs the blankets, and smooths the sheets,  
    And gives the mattress a shaking—  
But vainly Betty performs her part,  
If a ruffled head and a rumpled heart,  
    As well as the couch, want making.

There's Morbid, all bile, and verjuice, and nerves,  
Where other people would make preserves,  
    He turns his fruits into pickles:  
Jealous, envious, and fretful by day,  
At night, to his own sharp fancies a prey,  
He lies like a hedgehog roll'd up the wrong way,  
    Tormenting himself with his prickles.

But a child—that bids the world good night,  
In downright earnest and cuts it quite—  
    A *Cherub no Art can copy*—

A cherub no art can copy,  
'Tis a perfect picture to see him lie  
As if he had supp'd on a dormouse pie,  
(An ancient classical dish, by the by)  
With a sauce of syrup of poppy.

Oh, bed! bed! bed! delicious bed!  
That heaven upon earth to the weary head,  
Whether lofty or low its condition!  
But instead of putting our plagues on shelves,  
In our blankets how often we toss ourselves,  
Or are toss'd by such allegorical elves  
As Pride, Hate, Greed, and Ambition!

The independent Miss Kilmansegg  
Took off her independent Leg  
And laid it beneath her pillow,  
And then on the bed her frame she cast,  
The time for repose had come at last,  
But long, long, after the storm is past  
Rolls the turbid, turbulent billow.

No part she had in vulgar cares  
That belong to common household affairs—  
Nocturnal annoyances such as theirs,  
Who lie with a shrewd surmising,  
That while they are couchant (a bitter cup!)  
Their bread and butter are getting up,  
And the coals, confound them, are rising.

No fear she had her sleep to postpone,  
Like the crippled Widow who weeps alone  
And cannot make a doze her own,  
For the dread that mayhap on the morrow,  
The true and Christian reading to baulk,  
A broker will take up her bed and walk  
By way of curing her sorrow.

No cause like these she had to bewail,

But the breath of applause had blown a gale,  
And winds from that quarter seldom fail  
    To cause some human commotion;  
But whenever such breezes coincide  
        With the very spring-tide  
        Of human pride,  
There's no such swell on the ocean!

Peace, and ease, and slumber lost,  
She turn'd, and roll'd, and tumbled and toss'd  
    With a tumult that would not settle:  
A common case, indeed, with such  
As have too little, or think too much,  
    Of the precious and glittering metal.

Gold!—she saw at her golden foot  
The Peer whose tree had an olden root,  
The Proud, the Great, the Learned to boot,  
    The handsome, the gay, and the witty—  
The Man of Science—of Arms—of Art,  
The man who deals but at Pleasure's mart,  
    And the man who deals in the City.

Gold, still gold—and true to the mould!  
In the very scheme of her dream it told;  
    For, by magical transmutation,  
From her Leg through her body it seem'd to go,  
Till, gold above, and gold below,  
She was gold, all gold, from her little gold toe  
    To her organ of Veneration!

And still she retain'd through Fancy's art,  
The Golden Bow and Golden Dart,  
With which she had play'd a Goddess's part,  
    In her recent glorification:  
And still, like one of the self-same brood,  
On a Plinth of the self-same metal she stood  
    For the whole world's adoration.

And hymns and incense around her roll'd,  
From Golden Harps and Censers of Gold,—  
For Fancy in dreams is as uncontroll'd

As a horse without a bridle:  
What wonder, then, from all checks exempt,  
If, inspired by the Golden Leg, she dreamt  
She was turn'd to a Golden Idol?

HER COURTSHIP.



When leaving Eden's happy land  
The grieving Angel led by the hand  
    Our banish'd Father and Mother,  
Forgotten amid their awful doom,  
The tears, the fears, and the future's gloom,  
On each brow was a wreath of Paradise bloom,  
    That our Parents had twined for each other.

It was only while sitting like figures of stone,  
For the grieving angel had skyward flown,  
As they sat, those Two in the world alone,  
    With disconsolate hearts nigh cloven,  
That scenting the gust of happier hours,  
They look'd around for the precious flow'rs,  
And lo!—a last relic of Eden's dear bow'rs—  
    The chaplet that Love had woven!

And still, when a pair of Lovers meet,  
There's a sweetness in air, unearthly sweet,  
That savours still of that happy retreat  
    Where Eve by Adam was courted:  
Whilst the joyous Thrush, and the gentle Dove,  
Woo'd their mates in the boughs above,  
    And the Serpent, as yet, only sported.

Who hath not felt that breath in the air,  
A perfume and freshness strange and rare,  
A warmth in the light, and a bliss everywhere,  
    When young hearts yearn together?  
All sweets below, and all sunny above,  
Oh! there's nothing in life like making love,  
    Save making hay in fine weather!

Who hath not found amongst his flow'rs  
A blossom too bright for this world of ours,  
    Like a rose among snows of Sweden?  
But to turn again to Miss Kilmansegg,

Where must Love have gone to beg,  
If such a thing as a Golden Leg  
Had put its foot in Eden!

And yet—to tell the rigid truth—  
Her favour was sought by Age and Youth—  
For the prey will find a prowler!  
She was follow'd, flatter'd, courted, address'd,  
Woo'd, and coo'd, and wheedled, and press'd,  
By suitors from North, South, East, and West,  
Like that Heiress, in song, Tibbie Fowler!

But, alas! alas! for the Woman's fate,  
Who has from a mob to choose a mate!  
'Tis a strange and painful mystery!  
But the more the eggs, the worse the hatch;  
The more the fish, the worse the catch;  
The more the sparks, the worse the match;  
Is a fact in Woman's history.

Give her between a brace to pick,  
And mayhap, with luck to help the trick,  
She will take the Faustus, and leave the Old Nick—  
But her future bliss to baffle,  
Amongst a score let her have a voice,  
And she'll have as little cause to rejoice,  
As if she had won the "Man of her choice"  
In a matrimonial raffle!

Thus, even thus, with the Heiress and Hope,  
Fulfilling the adage of too much rope,  
With so ample a competition,  
She chose the least worthy of all the group,  
Just as the vulture makes a stoop,  
And singles out from the herd or troop  
The beast of the worst condition.

A Foreign Count—who came incog.,  
Not under a cloud, but under a fog

NOT under a cloud, but under a fog,  
In a Calais packet's fore-cabin,  
To charm some lady British-born,  
With his eyes as black as the fruit of the thorn,  
And his hooky nose, and his beard half-shorn,  
Like a half-converted Rabbin.

And because the Sex confess a charm  
In the man who has slash'd a head or arm,  
Or has been a throat's undoing,  
He was dress'd like one of the glorious trade,  
At least when Glory is off parade,  
With a stock, and a frock, well trimm'd with braid  
And frogs—that went a-wooing.

Moreover, as Counts are apt to do,  
On the left-hand side of his dark surtout,  
At one of those holes that buttons go through,  
(To be a precise recorder,)  
A ribbon he wore, or rather a scrap,  
About an inch of ribbon mayhap,  
That one of his rivals, whimsical chap,  
Described as his "Retail Order."

And then—and much it help'd his chance—  
He could sing, and play first fiddle, and dance,  
Perform charades, and Proverbs of France—  
Act the tender, and do the cruel;  
For amongst his other killing parts,  
He had broken a brace of female hearts,  
And murder'd three men in duel!

Savage at heart, and false of tongue,  
Subtle with age, and smooth to the young,  
Like a snake in his coiling and curling—  
Such was the Count—to give him a niche—  
Who came to court that Heiress rich,  
And knelt at her foot—one needn't say which—  
Residing her castle of *Sterling*

besieging her castle of sterling.

With pray'rs and vows he open'd his trench,  
And plied her with English, Spanish, and French,  
In phrases the most sentimental:  
And quoted poems in High and Low Dutch,  
With now and then an Italian touch,  
Till she yielded, without resisting much,  
To homage so continental.

And then—the sordid bargain to close—  
With a miniature sketch of his hooky nose,  
And his dear dark eyes, as black as sloes,  
And his beard and whiskers as black as those,  
The lady's consent he requited—  
And instead of the lock that lovers beg,  
The count received from Miss Kilmansegg  
A model, in small, of her Precious leg—  
And so the couple were plighted!

But, oh! the love that gold must crown!  
Better—better, the love of the clown,  
Who admires his lass in her Sunday gown,  
As if all the fairies had dress'd her!  
Whose brain to no crooked thought gives birth,  
Except that he never will part on earth  
With his true love's crooked tester!

Alas! for the love that's linked with gold!  
Better—better a thousand times told—  
More honest, happy, and laudable,  
The downright loving of pretty Cis,  
Who wipes her lips, though there's nothing amiss,  
And takes a kiss, and gives a kiss,  
In which her heart is audible!

Pretty Cis, so smiling and bright,  
Who loves—as she labours—with all her might,  
And without any sordid leaven!

~~And when my countenance~~  
Who blushes as red as haws and hips,  
Down to her very finger-tips,  
For Roger's blue ribbons—to her, like strips  
Cut out of the azure of Heaven!

HER MARRIAGE.

'Twas morn—a most auspicious one!  
From the Golden East, the Golden Sun  
Came forth his glorious race to run,  
    Through clouds of most splendid tinges;  
Clouds that lately slept in shade,  
    But now seem'd made  
    Of gold brocade,  
    With magnificent golden fringes.

Gold above, and gold below,  
The earth reflected the golden glow,  
    From river, and hill, and valley  
Gilt by the golden light of morn,  
The Thames—it look'd like the Golden Horn,  
And the Barge, that carried coal or corn,  
    Like Cleopatra's Galley!

Bright as clusters of Golden-rod,  
Suburban poplars began to nod,  
    With extempore splendour furnish'd;  
While London was bright with glittering clocks,  
Golden dragons, and Golden cocks,  
    And above them all,  
    The dome of St. Paul,  
With its Golden Cross and its Golden Ball,  
    Shone out as if newly burnish'd!

And lo! for Golden Hours and Joys,  
Troops of glittering Golden Boys  
Danced along with a jocund noise,  
    And their gilded emblems carried!  
In short, 'twas the year's most Golden Day,  
By mortals call'd the First of May,  
    When Miss Kilmansegg,  
    Of the Golden Leg,  
    With a Golden Ring was married!

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And thousands of children, women, and men,  
Counted the clock from eight till ten,  
    From St. James's sonorous steeple;  
For next to that interesting job,  
The hanging of Jack, or Bill, or Bob,  
There's nothing so draws a London mob  
    As the noosing of very rich people.

And a treat it was for the mob to behold  
The Bridal Carriage that blazed with gold!  
And the Footman tall and the Coachman bold,  
    In liveries so resplendent—  
Coats you wonder'd to see in place,  
They seem'd so rich with golden lace,  
    That they might have been independent.

Coats, that made those menials proud  
Gaze with scorn on the dingy crowd,  
    From their gilded elevations:  
Not to forget that saucy lad  
(Ostentation's favourite cad),  
The Page, who look'd so splendidly clad,  
    Like a Page of the "Wealth of Nations."

But the Coachman carried off the state,  
With what was a Lancashire body of late  
    Turn'd into a Dresden Figure;  
With a bridal Nosegay of early bloom,  
About the size of a birchen broom,  
And so huge a White Favour, had Gog been Groom,  
    He need not have worn a bigger.

And then to see the Groom! the Count!  
With Foreign Orders to such an amount,  
    And whiskers so wild—nay, bestial;  
He seem'd to have borrow'd the shaggy hair  
As well as the Stars of the Polar Bear,  
    To make him look celestial!

And then—Great Jove!—the struggle, the crush,  
The screams, the heaving, the awful rush,  
    The swearing, the tearing, the fighting,—  
The hats and bonnets smash'd like an egg—  
To catch a glimpse of the Golden Leg,  
Which between the steps and Miss Kilmansegg  
    Was fully display'd in alighting!

From the Golden Ankle up to the Knee  
There it was for the mob to see!  
A shocking act had it chanced to be  
    A crooked leg or a skinny:  
But although a magnificent veil she wore,  
Such as never was seen before,  
In case of blushes, she blush'd no more  
    Than George the First on a guinea!

Another step, and lo! she was launched!  
All in white, as Brides are *blanched*  
    With a wreath of most wonderful splendour—  
Diamonds, and pearls, so rich in device,  
That, according to calculation nice,  
Her head was worth as royal a price,  
    As the head of the Young Pretender.

Bravely she shone—and shone the more  
As she sail'd through the crowd of squalid and poor,  
    Thief, beggar, and tatterdemalion—  
Led by the Count, with his sloe-black eyes  
Bright with triumph, and some surprise,  
Like Anson on making sure of his prize  
    The famous Mexican Galleon!

Anon came Lady K., with her face  
Quite made up to act with grace,  
    But she cut the performance shorter;  
For instead of pacing stately and stiff,  
At the stare of the vulgar she took a miff



At the state of the vulgar she took a hint,  
And ran, full speed, into Church, as if  
To get married before her daughter.

But Sir Jacob walk'd more slowly, and bow'd  
Right and left to the gaping crowd,  
Wherever a glance was seizable:  
For Sir Jacob thought he bow'd like a Guelph,  
And therefore bow'd to imp and elf,  
And would gladly have made a bow to himself,  
Had such a bow been feasible.

And last—and not the least of the sight,  
Six “Handsome Fortunes,” all in white,  
Came to help in the marriage rite,—  
And rehearse their own hymneals;  
And then the bright procession to close,  
They were followed by just as many Beaux  
Quite fine enough for Ideals.

Glittering men, and splendid dames,  
Thus they enter'd the porch of St. James',  
Pursued by a thunder of laughter;  
For the Beadle was forced to intervene,  
For Jim the Crow, and his Mayday Queen,  
With her gilded ladle, and Jack i' the Green,  
Would fain have follow'd after!

Beadle-like he hush'd the shout;  
But the temple was full “inside and out,”  
And a buzz kept buzzing all round about  
Like bees when the day is sunny—  
A buzz universal, that interfered  
With the right that ought to have been revered,  
As if the couple already were smear'd  
With Wedlock's treacle and honey!

Yet Wedlock's a very awful thing!  
'Tis something like that feat in the ring.

~~... something else that he was doing,~~  
Which requires good nerve to do it—  
When one of a “Grand Equestrian Troop”  
Makes a jump at a gilded hoop,  
Not certain at all  
Of what may befall  
After his getting through it!

But the count he felt the nervous work  
No more than any polygamous Turk,  
Or bold piratical skipper,  
Who, during his buccaneering search,  
Would as soon engage a hand in church  
As a hand on board his clipper!

And how did the Bride perform her part?  
Like any bride who is cold at heart,  
Mere snow with the ice’s glitter;  
What but a life of winter for her!  
Bright but chilly, alive without stir,  
So splendidly comfortless,—just like a Fir  
When the frost is severe and bitter.

Such were the future man and wife!  
Whose bale or bliss to the end of life  
A few short words were to settle—  
“Wilt thou have this woman?”  
“I will”—and then,  
“Wilt thou have this man?”  
“I will,” and “Amen”—  
And those Two were one Flesh, in the Angels’ ken,  
Except one Leg—that was metal.

Then the names were sign’d—and kiss’d the kiss:  
And the Bride, who came from her coach a Miss,  
As a Countess walk’d to her carriage—  
Whilst Hymen preen’d his plumes like a dove,  
And Cupid flutter’d his wings above,  
In the shape of a fly—as little a Love

As ever look'd in at a marriage!

Another crash—and away they dash'd,  
And the gilded carriage and footman flash'd  
From the eyes of the gaping people—  
Who turn'd to gaze at the toe-and-heel  
Of the Golden Boys beginning a reel,  
To the merry sound of a wedding-peal  
From St. James's musical steeple.

Those wedding-bells! those wedding-bells!  
How sweetly they sound in pastoral dells  
From a tow'r in an ivy-green jacket!  
But town-made joys how dearly they cost;  
And after all are tumbled and tost,  
Like a peal from a London steeple, and lost  
In town-made riot and racket.

The wedding-peal, how sweetly it peals  
With grass or heather beneath our heels,—  
For bells are Music's laughter!  
But a London peal, well mingled, be sure,  
With vulgar noises and voices impure,—  
What a harsh and discordant overture  
To the Harmony meant to come after!

But hence with Discord—perchance, too soon  
To cloud the face of the honeymoon  
With a dismal occultation!—  
Whatever Fate's concerted trick,  
The Countess and Count, at the present nick,  
Have a chicken, and not a crow, to pick  
At a sumptuous Cold Collation.

A Breakfast—no unsubstantial mess,  
But one in the style of Good Queen Bess,  
Who,—hearty as hippocampus,—  
Broke her fast with ale and beef,

Instead of toast and the Chinese leaf,  
And—in lieu of anchovy—grampus.

A breakfast of fowl, and fish, and flesh,  
Whatever was sweet, or salt, or fresh;  
With wines the most rare and curious—  
Wines, of the richest flavour and hue;  
With fruits from the worlds both Old and New;  
And fruits obtain'd before they were due  
At a discount most usurious.

For wealthy palates there be, that scout  
What is *in* season, for what is *out*,  
And prefer all precocious savour:  
For instance, early green peas, of the sort  
That costs some four or five guineas a quart;  
Where the *Mint* is the principal flavour.

And many a wealthy man was there,  
Such as the wealthy City could spare,  
To put in a portly appearance—  
Men, whom their fathers had help'd to gild:  
And men, who had had their fortunes to build,  
And—much to their credit—had richly fill'd  
Their purses by *pursy-verance*.

Men, by popular rumour at least,  
Not the last to enjoy a feast!  
And truly they were not idle!  
Luckier far than the chestnut tits,  
Which, down at the door, stood champing their bits,  
At a different sort of bridle.

For the time was come—and the whisker'd Count  
Help'd his Bride in the carriage to mount,  
And fain would the Muse deny it,  
But the crowd, including two butchers in blue,  
(The regular killing Whitechapel hue,)

Ot her Precious Calf had as ample a view  
As if they had come to buy it!

Then away! away! with all the speed  
That golden spurs can give to the steed,—  
Both Yellow Boys and Guineas, indeed,  
Concurr'd to urge the cattle—  
Away they went, with favours white,  
Yellow jackets, and panels bright,  
And left the mob, like a mob at night,  
Agape at the sound of a rattle.

Away! away! they rattled and roll'd,  
The Count, and his Bride, and her Leg of Gold—  
That faded charm to the charmer!  
Away, through old Brentford rang the din,  
Of wheels and heels, on their way to win  
That hill, named after one of her kin,  
The Hill of the Golden Farmer!

Gold, still gold—it flew like dust!  
It tipp'd the post-boy, and paid the trust;  
In each open palm it was freely thrust;  
There was nothing but giving and taking!  
And if gold could ensure the future hour,  
What hopes attended that Bride to her bow'r,  
But alas! even hearts with a four-horse pow'r  
Of opulence end in breaking!

HER HONEYMOON.



The moon—the moon, so silver and cold,  
Her fickle temper has oft been told,  
    Now shady—now bright and sunny—  
But of all the lunar things that change,  
The one that shows most fickle and strange,  
And takes the most eccentric range  
    Is the moon—so call'd—of honey!

To some a full-grown orb reveal'd,  
As big and as round as Norval's shield,  
    And as bright as a burner Bude-lighted;  
To others as dull, and dingy, and damp,  
As any oleaginous lamp,  
Of the regular old parochial stamp,  
    In a London fog benighted.

To the loving, a bright and constant sphere,  
That makes earth's commonest things appear  
    All poetic, romantic, and tender:  
Hanging with jewels a cabbage-stump,  
And investing a common post, or a pump,  
A currant-bush or a gooseberry-clump,  
    With a halo of dreamlike splendour.

A sphere such as shone from Italian skies,  
In Juliet's dear, dark liquid eyes,  
    Tipping trees, with its argent braveries—  
And to couples not favour'd with Fortune's boons  
One of the most delightful of moons,  
For it brightens their pewter platters and spoons  
    Like a silver service of Savory's!

For all is bright, and beauteous, and clear,  
And the meanest thing most precious and dear  
    When the magic of love is present:  
Love, that lends a sweetness and grace,  
To the humblest spot and the plainest face—  
— — — — —

That turns Wilderness Row into Paradise Place,  
And Garlic Hill to Mount Pleasant!

Love that sweetens sugarless tea,  
And makes contentment and joy agree  
With the coarsest boarding and bedding:  
Love, that no golden ties can attach,  
But nestles under the humblest thatch,  
And will fly away from an Emperor's match  
To dance at a Penny Wedding!

Oh, happy, happy, thrice happy state,  
When such a bright Planet governs the fate  
Of a pair of united lovers!  
'Tis theirs, in spite of the Serpent's hiss,  
To enjoy the pure primeval kiss,  
With as much of the old original bliss  
As mortality ever recovers!

There's strength in double joints, no doubt,  
In double X Ale, and Dublin Stout,  
That the single sorts know nothing about—  
And the fist is strongest when doubled—  
And double aqua-fortis of course,  
And double soda-water, perforce,  
Are the strongest that ever bubbled!

There's double beauty whenever a Swan  
Swims on a Lake with a double thereon;  
And ask the gardener, Luke or John,  
Of the beauty of double-blowing—  
A double dahlia delights the eye;  
And it's far the loveliest sight in the sky  
When a double rainbow is glowing!

There's warmth in a pair of double soles;  
As well as a double allowance of coals—  
In a coat that is double-breasted—  
In double windows and double doors—



in double windows and double doors;  
And a double U wind is blest by scores  
For its warmth to the tender-chested.

There's a twofold sweetness in double pipes;  
And a double barrel and double snipes  
Give the sportsman a duplicate pleasure:  
There's double safety in double locks;  
And double letters bring cash for the box;  
And all the world knows that double knocks  
Are gentility's double measure.

There's double sweetness in double rhymes,  
And a double at Whist and a double Times  
In profit are certainly double—  
By doubling, the Hare contrives to escape;  
And all seamen delight in a doubled Cape,  
And a double-reef'd topsail in trouble.

There's a double chuck at a double chin,  
And of course there's a double pleasure therein,  
If the parties were brought to telling:  
And however our Dennises take offence,  
A double meaning shows double sense;  
And if proverbs tell truth,  
A double tooth  
Is Wisdom's adopted dwelling!

But double wisdom, and pleasure, and sense,  
Beauty, respect, strength, comfort and thence  
Through whatever the list discovers,  
They are all in the double blessedness summ'd,  
Of what was formerly double-drumm'd,  
The Marriage of two true Lovers!

Now the Kilmansegg Moon, it must be told—  
Though instead of silver it tipp'd with gold—  
Shone rather wan, and distant, and cold,  
And before its days were at thirty

And before its days were at unity,  
Such gloomy clouds began to collect,  
With an ominous ring of ill effect,  
As gave but too much cause to expect  
Such weather as seamen call dirty!

And yet the moon was the “Young May Moon,”  
And the scented hawthorn had blossom’d soon,  
And the thrush and the blackbird were singing—  
The snow-white lambs were skipping in play,  
And the bee was humming a tune all day  
To flowers, as welcome as flowers in May,  
And the trout in the stream was springing!

But what were the hues of the blooming earth,  
Its scents—its sounds—or the music and mirth  
Of its furr’d or its feather’d creatures,  
To a Pair in the world’s last sordid stage,  
Who had never look’d into Nature’s page,  
And had strange ideas of a Golden Age,  
Without any Arcadian features?

And what were joys of the pastoral kind  
To a Bride—town-made—with a heart and a mind  
With simplicity ever at battle?  
A bride of an ostentatious race,  
Who, thrown in the Golden Farmer’s place,  
Would have trimm’d her shepherds with golden lace,  
And gilt the horns of her cattle.

She could not please the pigs with her whim,  
And the sheep wouldn’t cast their eyes at a limb  
For which she had been such a martyr:  
The deer in the park, and the colts at grass,  
And the cows unheeded let it pass;  
And the ass on the common was such an ass,  
That he wouldn’t have swapp’d  
The thistle he cropp’d  
For her Leg. including the Garter!

She hated lanes and she hated fields—  
She hated all that the country yields—  
And barely knew turnips from clover;  
She hated walking in any shape,  
And a country stile was an awkward scrape,  
Without the bribe of a mob to gape  
At the Leg in clambering over!

O blessed nature, “O rus! O rus!”  
Who cannot sigh for the country thus,  
Absorb’d in a worldly torpor—  
Who does not yearn for its meadow-sweet breath,  
Untainted by care, and crime, and death,  
And to stand sometimes upon grass or heath—  
That soul, spite of gold, is a pauper!

But to hail the pearly advent of morn,  
And relish the odour fresh from the thorn,  
She was far too pamper’d a madam,  
Or to joy in the daylight waxing strong,  
While, after ages of sorrow and wrong,  
The scorn of the proud, the misrule of the strong,  
And all the woes that to man belong,  
The Lark still carols the self-same song  
That he did to the uncurs’d Adam!

The Lark! she had given all Leipsic’s flocks  
For a Vauxhall tune in a musical box;  
And as for the birds in the thicket,  
Thrush or ousel in leafy niche,  
The linnet or finch, she was far too rich  
To care for a Morning Concert, to which  
She was welcome without any ticket.

Gold, still gold, her standard of old,  
All pastoral joys were tried by gold,  
Or by fancies golden and crural—

Till ere she had pass'd one week unblest,  
As her agricultural Uncle's guest,  
Her mind was made up, and fully imprest,  
That felicity could not be rural!

And the Count?—to the snow-white lambs at play  
And all the scents and the sights of May,  
And the birds that warbled their passion,  
His ears and dark eyes, and decided nose,  
Were as deaf and as blind and as dull as those  
That overlooked the Bouquet de Rose,  
The Huille Antique,  
And Parfum Unique,  
In a Barber's Temple of Fashion.

To tell, indeed, the true extent  
Of his rural bias so far it went  
As to covet estates in ring fences—  
And for rural lore he had learn'd in town  
That the country was green, turn'd up with brown,  
And garnish'd with trees that a man might cut down  
Instead of his own expenses.

And yet had that fault been his only one,  
The Pair might have had few quarrels or none,  
For their tastes thus far were in common;  
But faults he had that a haughty bride  
With a Golden Leg could hardly abide—  
Faults that would even have roused the pride  
Of a far less metalsome woman!

It was early days indeed for a wife,  
In the very spring of her married life,  
To be chill'd by its wintry weather—  
But instead of sitting as Love-Birds do,  
On Hymen's turtles that bill and coo—  
Enjoying their "moon and honey for two"  
They were scarcely seen together!

In vain she sat with her Precious Leg  
A little exposed, *à la* Kilmansegg,  
And roll'd her eyes in their sockets!  
He left her in spite of her tender regards,  
And those loving murmurs described by bards,  
For the rattling of dice and the shuffling of cards,  
And the poking of balls into pockets!

Moreover he loved the deepest stake  
And the heaviest bets the players would make;  
And he drank—the reverse of sparely,—  
And he used strange curses that made her fret;  
And when he played with herself at piquet,  
She found, to her cost,  
For she always lost,  
That the Count did not count quite fairly.

And then came dark mistrust and doubt,  
Gather'd by worming his secrets out,  
And slips in his conversations—  
Fears, which all her peace destroy'd,  
That his title was null—his coffers were void—  
And his French Château was in Spain, or enjoy'd  
The most airy of situations.

But still his heart—if he had such a part—  
She—only she—might possess his heart,  
And hold his affections in fetters—  
Alas! that hope, like a crazy ship,  
Was forced its anchor and cable to slip  
When, seduced by her fears, she took a dip  
In his private papers and letters.

Letters that told of dangerous leagues;  
And notes that hinted as many intrigues  
As the Count's in the "Barber of Seville"—  
In short such mysteries came to light,

'That the Countess-Bride, on the thirtieth night,  
Woke and started up in affright,  
And kick'd and scream'd with all her might,  
And finally fainted away outright,  
For she dreamt she had married the Devil!

HER MISERY.

Who hath not met with home-made bread,  
A heavy compound of putty and lead—  
And home-made wines that rack the head,  
And home-made liqueurs and waters?  
Home-made pop that will not foam,  
And home-made dishes that drive one from home,  
Not to name each mess,  
For the face or dress,  
Home-made by the homely daughters?

Home-made physic that sickens the sick;  
Thick for thin and thin for thick;  
In short each homogeneous trick  
For poisoning domesticity?  
And since our Parents, call'd the First,  
A little family squabble nurst,  
Of all our evils the worst of the worst  
Is home-made infelicity.

There's a Golden Bird that claps its wings,  
And dances for joy on its perch, and sings  
With a Persian exultation:  
For the Sun is shining into the room,  
And brightens up the carpet-bloom,  
As if it were new, bran new, from the loom,  
Or the lone Nun's fabrication.

And thence the glorious radiance flames  
On pictures in massy gilded frames—  
Enshrining, however, no painted Dames,  
But portraits of colts and fillies—  
Pictures hanging on walls, which shine,  
In spite of the bard's familiar line,  
With clusters of "Gilded lilies."

And still the flooding sunlight shares  
Its lustre with gilded sofas and chairs,

That shine as if freshly burnish'd—  
And gilded tables, with glittering stocks  
Of gilded china, and golden clocks,  
Toy, and trinket, and musical box,  
That Peace and Paris have furnish'd.

And lo! with the brightest gleam of all  
The glowing sunbeam is seen to fall  
On an object as rare as splendid—  
The golden foot of the Golden Leg  
Of the Countess—once Miss Kilmansegg—  
But there all sunshine is ended.

Her cheek is pale, and her eye is dim,  
And downward cast, yet not at the limb,  
Once the centre of all speculation;  
But downward drooping in comfort's dearth,  
As gloomy thoughts are drawn to the earth—  
Whence human sorrows derive their birth—  
By a moral gravitation.

Her golden hair is out of its braids,  
And her sighs betray the gloomy shades  
That her evil planet revolves in—  
And tears are falling that catch a gleam  
So bright as they drop in the sunny beam,  
That tears of *aqua regia* they seem,  
The water that gold dissolves in;

Yet, not filial grief were shed  
Those tears for a mother's insanity;  
Nor yet because her father was dead,  
For the bowing Sir Jacob had bow'd his head  
To Death—with his usual urbanity;  
The waters that down her visage rill'd  
Were drops of unrectified spirit distill'd  
From the limbeck of Pride and Vanity.

Tears that fell alone and unheeded



tears that fell alone and unchecked,  
Without relief, and without respect,  
Like the fabled pearls that the pigs neglect,  
    When pigs have that opportunity—  
And of all the griefs that mortals share,  
The one that seems the hardest to bear  
    Is the grief without community.

How bless'd the heart that has a friend  
A sympathising ear to lend  
    To troubles too great to smother!  
For as ale and porter, when flat, are restored  
Till a sparkling bubbling head they afford,  
So sorrow is cheer'd by being pour'd  
    From one vessel into another.

But friend or gossip she had not one  
To hear the vile deeds that the Count had done,  
    How night after night he rambled;  
And how she had learnt by sad degrees  
That he drank, and smoked, and worse than these,  
    That he "swindled, intrigued, and gambled."

How he kiss'd the maids, and sparr'd with John!  
And came to bed with his garments on;  
    With other offences as heinous—  
And brought *strange* gentlemen home to dine,  
That he said were in the Fancy Line,  
And they fancied spirits instead of wine,  
    And call'd her lap-dog "Wenus."

Of "making a book" how he made a stir  
But never had written a line to her,  
    Once his idol and Cara Sposa;  
And how he had storm'd, and treated her ill,  
Because she refused to go down to a mill,  
She didn't know where, but remember'd still  
    That the Miller's name was Mendoza.

How often he waked her up at night,  
And oftener still by the morning light,  
    Reeling home from his haunts unlawful;  
Singing songs that shouldn't be sung,  
Except by beggars and thieves unhung—  
Or volleying oaths that a foreign tongue  
    Made still more horrid and awful!

How oft, instead of otto of rose,  
With vulgar smells he offended her nose,  
    From gin, tobacco, and onion!  
And then how wildly he used to stare!  
And shake his fist at nothing, and swear,—  
And pluck by the handful his shaggy hair,  
Till he look'd like a study of Giant Despair  
    For a new Edition of Bunyan!

For dice will run the contrary way,  
As well is known to all who play,  
    And cards will conspire as in treason;  
And what with keeping a hunting-box,  
    Following fox—  
    Friends in flocks,  
    Burgundies, Hocks,  
    From London Docks;  
    Stultz's frocks,  
    Manton and Nock's  
    Barrels and locks,  
    Shooting blue rocks,  
    Trainers and jocks,  
    Buskins and socks,  
    Pugilistical knocks,  
    And fighting cocks,  
If he found himself short in funds and stocks  
    These rhymes will furnish the reason!

His friends, indeed, were falling away—  
Friends who insist on play or nay—

FRIENDS WHO INSIST ON PAY OR PAY  
And he fear'd at no very distant day  
To be cut by Lord and by cadger,  
As one, who has gone, or is going, to smash,  
For his checks no longer drew the cash,  
Because, as his comrades explain'd in flash,  
"He had overdrawn his badger."

Gold, gold—alas! for the gold  
Spent where souls are bought and sold,  
In Vice's Walpurgis revel!  
Alas! for muffles, and bulldogs, and guns,  
The leg that walks, and the leg that runs,—  
All real evils, though Fancy ones,  
When they lead to debt, dishonour, and duns,  
Nay, to death, and perchance the devil!

Alas! for the last of a Golden race!  
Had she cried her wrongs in the market-place,  
She had warrant for all her clamour—  
For the worst of rogues, and brutes, and rakes,  
Was breaking her heart by constant aches,  
With as little remorse as the Pauper, who breaks  
A flint with a parish hammer!

HER LAST WILL.



Now the Precious Leg while cash was flush,  
Or the Count's acceptance worth a rush,  
    Had never excited dissension;  
But no sooner the stocks began to fall,  
Than, without any ossification at all,  
The limb became what people call  
    A perfect bone of contention.

For alter'd days brought alter'd ways,  
And instead of the complimentary phrase,  
    So current before her bridal—  
The Countess heard, in language low,  
That her Precious Leg was precious slow,  
A good 'un to look at but bad to go,  
    And kept quite a sum lying idle.

That instead of playing musical airs,  
Like Colin's foot in going up-stairs—  
As the wife in the Scottish ballad declares—  
    It made an infernal stumping.  
Whereas a member of cork, or wood,  
Would be lighter and cheaper and quite as good,  
    Without the unbearable thumping.

P'rhaps she thought it a decent thing  
To show her calf to cobbler and king,  
    But nothing could be absurder—  
While none but the crazy would advertise  
Their gold before their servants' eyes,  
Who of course some night would make it a prize,  
    By a Shocking and Barbarous Murder.

But spite of hint, and threat, and scoff,  
    The Leg kept its situation.  
For legs are not to be taken off,  
    By a verbal amputation.  
And mortals when they take a whim,

The greater the folly the stiffer the limb  
That stand upon it or by it—  
So the Countess, then Miss Kilmansegg,  
At her marriage refused to stir a peg,  
Till the Lawyers had fasten'd on her Leg  
As fast as the Law could tie it.

Firmly then—and more firmly yet—  
With scorn for scorn, and with threat for threat,  
The Proud One confronted the Cruel:  
And loud and bitter the quarrel arose  
Fierce and merciless—one of those,  
With spoken daggers, and looks like blows,  
In all but the bloodshed a duel!

Rash, and wild, and wretched, and wrong,  
Were the works that came from Weak and Strong,  
Till madden'd for desperate matters,  
Fierce as tigress escaped from her den,  
She flew to her desk—'twas open'd—and then,  
In the time it takes to try a pen,  
Or the clerk to utter his slow Amen,  
Her Will was in fifty tatters!

But the Count, instead of curses wild,  
Only nodded his head and smiled,  
As if at the spleen of an angry child;  
But the calm was deceitful and sinister!  
A lull like the lull of the treacherous sea—  
For Hate in that moment had sworn to be  
The Golden Leg's sole Legatee,  
And that very night to administer!

HER DEATH.



'Tis a stern and startling thing to think  
How often mortality stands on the brink  
    Of its grave without any misgiving;  
And yet in this slippery world of strife,  
In the stir of human bustle so rife,  
There are daily sounds to tell us that Life  
    Is dying, and Death is living!

Ay, Beauty the Girl, and Love the Boy,  
Bright as they are with hope and joy,  
    How their souls would sadden instanter,  
To remember that one of those wedding bells,  
Which ring so merrily through the dells,  
        Is the same that knells  
        Our last farewells,  
    Only broken into a canter!

But breath and blood set doom at nought—  
How little the wretched Countess thought,  
    When at night she unloosed her sandal,  
That the Fates had woven her burial-cloth,  
And that Death, in the shape of a Death's Head Moth,  
    Was fluttering round her candle!

As she look'd at her clock of or-molu,  
For the hours she had gone so wearily through,  
    At the end of a day of trial—  
How little she saw in her pride of prime  
The dart of Death in the Hand of Time—  
    That hand which moved on the dial!

As she went with her taper up the stair,  
How little her swollen eye was aware  
    That the Shadow which follow'd was double!  
Or when she closed her chamber door,  
It was shutting out, and for evermore,  
    The world—and its worldly trouble.



Little she dreamt, as she laid aside  
Her jewels—after one glance of pride—  
    They were solemn bequests to Vanity—  
Or when her robes she began to doff,  
That she stood so near to the putting off  
    Of the flesh that clothes humanity.

And when she quench'd the taper's light,  
How little she thought as the smoke took flight,  
That her day was done—and merged in a night  
    Of dreams and duration uncertain—  
        Or along with her own,  
        That a Hand of Bone  
Was closing mortality's curtain!

But life is sweet, and mortality blind,  
And youth is hopeful, and Fate is kind  
    In concealing the day of sorrow;  
And enough is the present tense of toil—  
For this world is, to all, a stiffish soil—  
And the mind flies back with a glad recoil  
    From the debts not due till to-morrow.

Wherefore else does the Spirit fly  
And bid its daily cares good-bye,  
    Along with its daily clothing?  
Just as the felon condemn'd to die—  
    With a very natural loathing—  
Leaving the Sheriff to dream of ropes,  
From his gloomy cell in a vision elopes  
To a caper on sunny gleams and slopes,  
    Instead of the dance upon nothing.

Thus, even thus, the Countess slept,  
While Death still nearer and nearer crept,  
    Like the Thane who smote the sleeping—  
But her mind was busy with early joys,  
Her golden treasures and golden towers

her golden treasures and golden toys:

That flash'd a bright

And golden light

Under lids still red with weeping.

The golden doll that she used to hug!

Her coral of gold, and the golden mug!

Her godfather's golden presents!

The golden service she had at her meals,

The golden watch, and chain, and seals,

Her golden scissors, and thread, and reels,

And her golden fishes and pheasants!

The golden guineas in silken purse—

And the Golden Legends she heard from her nurse

Of the Mayor in his gilded carriage—

And London streets that were paved with gold—

And the Golden Eggs that were laid of old—

With each golden thing

To the golden ring

At her own auriferous Marriage?

And still the golden light of the sun

Through her golden dreams appear'd to run,

Though the night, that roared without, was one

To terrify seamen or gipsies—

While the moon, as if in malicious mirth,

Kept peeping down at the ruffled earth,

As though she enjoy'd the tempest's birth,

In revenge of her old eclipses.

But vainly, vainly, the thunder fell,

For the soul of the Sleeper was under a spell

That time had lately embitter'd—

The Count, as once at her foot he knelt—

That foot, which now he wanted to melt!

But—hush!—'twas a stir at her pillow she felt—

And some object before her glitter'd.

'Twas the Golden Leg!—she knew its gleam!  
And up she started and tried to scream,—  
But ev'n in the moment she started—  
Down came the limb with a frightful smash,  
And lost, in the universal flash  
That her eyeballs made at so mortal a crash,  
The Spark, call'd Vital, departed!

\* \* \* \* \*

Gold, still gold! hard, hard yellow, and cold,  
For gold she had lived, and she died for gold—  
By a golden weapon—not oaken;  
In the morning they found her all alone—  
Stiff, and bloody, and cold as stone—  
But her Leg, the Golden Leg, was gone,  
And the “Golden Bowl was broken!”

Gold—still gold! it haunted her yet—  
At the Golden Lion the Inquest met—  
Its foreman a carver and gilder—  
And the Jury debated from twelve till three  
What the Verdict ought to be,  
And they brought it in as Felo de Se,  
“Because her own Leg had kill'd her!”

HER MORAL.

Gold! Gold! Gold! Gold!  
Bright and yellow, hard and cold,  
Molten, graven, hammer'd and roll'd;  
Heavy to get, and light to hold;  
Hoarded, barter'd, bought, and sold,  
Stolen, borrow'd, squander'd, doled:  
Spurn'd by the young, but hugg'd by the old  
To the very verge of the churchyard mould;  
Price of many a crime untold;  
Gold! Gold! Gold! Gold!  
Good or bad a thousand-fold!  
How widely its agencies vary—  
To save—to ruin—to curse—to bless—  
As even its minted coins express,  
Now stamp'd by the image of Good Queen Bess,  
And now of a Bloody Mary.

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# JOHN TROT.

A BALLAD.

I.

OHN TROT he was as tall a lad  
As York did ever rear—  
As his dear Granny used to say,  
He'd make a grenadier.

II.

A serjeant soon came down to York,  
With ribbons and a frill;  
My lads, said he, let broadcast be,  
And come away to drill.



HIGH AND LOW BORN.



THE WIDOW'S MITE.

III.

But when he wanted John to 'list,  
In war he saw no fun,  
Where what is call'd a raw recruit,  
Gets often over-done.

IV.

Let others carry guns, said he,  
And go to war's alarms,  
But I have got a shoulder-knot  
Impos'd upon my arms.

V.

For John he had a footman's place  
To wait on Lady Wye—  
She was a dumpy woman, tho'  
Her family was high.

VI.

Now when two years had past away,  
Her Lord took very ill,  
And left her to her widowhood,  
Of course more dumpy still.

VII.

Said John, I am a proper man,  
And very tall to see;  
Who knows, but now her Lord is low,  
She may look up to me?

VIII.

A cunning woman told me once,  
Such fortune would turn up;  
She was a kind of sorceress,  
But studied in a cup!

IX.

So he walk'd up to Lady Wye,  
And took her quite amazed,—  
She thought, tho' John was tall enough,  
He wanted to be raised.

X.

But John—for why? she was a dame  
Of such a dwarfish sort—  
Had only come to bid her make  
Her mourning very short.

XI.

Said he, your Lord is dead and cold,  
You only cry in vain;  
Not all the Cries of London now,  
Could call him back again!

XII.

You'll soon have many a noble beau,  
To dry your noble tears—  
But just consider this, that I  
Have follow'd you for years.

XIII.

And tho' you are above me far,  
What matters high degree,  
When you are only four feet nine  
And I am six foot three.

XIV.



For tho' you are of lofty race,  
And I'm a low-born elf;  
Yet none among your friends could say  
You matched beneath yourself.

XV.

Said she, such insolence as this  
Can be no common case;  
Though you are in my service, sir,  
Your love is out of place.

XVI.

O Lady Wye! O Lady Wye!  
Consider what you do;  
How can you be so short with me,  
I am not so with you?

XVII.

Then ringing for her serving men,  
They show'd him to the door:  
Said they, you turn out better now,  
Why didn't you before?

XVIII.

They stripp'd his coat, and gave him kicks  
For all his wages due;  
And off, instead of green and gold,  
He went in black and blue.

XIX.

No family would take him in,  
Because of this discharge;  
So he made up his mind to serve  
The country all at large.

XX.

Huzza! the Serjeant cried, and put  
The money in his hand,  
And with a shilling cut him off  
From his paternal land.

XXI.

For when his regiment went to fight  
At Saragossa town,  
A Frenchman thought he look'd too tall  
And so he cut him down!

---

THE WIDOW.



ONE widow at a grave will sob  
A little while, and weep, and sigh!  
If two should meet on such a job,  
They'll have a gossip by and by.  
If three should come together—why,  
Three widows are good company!  
If four should meet by any chance,  
Four is a number very nice,  
To have a rubber in a trice—  
But five will up and have a dance!

Poor Mrs. C—— (why should I not  
Declare her name!—her name was Cross)  
Was one of those the “common lot”  
Had left to weep “no common loss;”—  
For she had lately buried then  
A man, the “very best of men,”  
A lingering truth, discover'd first  
Whenever men “are at the worst.”  
To take the measure of her woe,  
It was some dozen inches deep—  
I mean in crape, and hung so low,  
It hid the drops she did *not* weep:  
In fact, what human life appears,  
It was a perfect “veil of tears.”  
Though ever since she lost “her prop  
And stay,”—alas! he wouldn't stay—  
She never had a tear to mop,  
Except one little angry drop,  
From Passion's eye, as Moore would say;  
Because, when Mister Cross took flight,  
It looked so very like a spite—  
He died upon a washing-day!

Still Widow Cross went twice a week,  
As if “to wet a widow's cheek,”  
And soothe his grave with sorrow's gravy,—

'Twas nothing but a make-believe,  
She might as well have hoped to grieve  
Enough of brine to float a navy;  
And yet she often seem'd to raise  
A cambric kerchief to her eye—  
A *duster* ought to be the phrase,  
Its work was all so very dry.  
The springs were lock'd that ought to flow—  
In England or in widow-woman—  
As those that watch the weather know,  
Such "backward Springs" are not uncommon.

But why did Widow Cross take pains,  
To call upon the "dear remains,"—  
Remains that could not tell a jot,  
Whether she ever wept or not,  
Or how his relict took her losses?  
Oh! my black ink turns red for shame—  
But still the naughty world must learn,  
There was a little German came  
To shed a tear in "Anna's Urn,"  
At the next grave to Mr. Cross's!  
For there an angel's virtues slept,  
"Too soon did Heaven assert its claim!"  
But still her painted face he kept,  
"Encompass'd in an angel's frame."

He look'd quite sad and quite deprived,  
His head was nothing but a hat-band;  
He look'd so lone, and so *unwived*,  
That soon the Widow Cross contrived  
To fall in love with even *that* band;  
And all at once the brackish juices  
Came gushing out thro' sorrow's sluices—  
Tear after tear too fast to wipe,  
Tho' sopp'd, and sopp'd, and sopp'd again—  
No leak in sorrow's private pipe,  
But like a bursting on the main!

Whoe'er has watch'd the window-pane—  
I mean to say in showery weather—  
Has seen two little drops of rain,  
Like lovers very fond and fain,  
At one another creeping, creeping,  
Till both, at last, embrace together:  
So far'd it with that couple's weeping!  
The principle was quite as active—  
    Tear unto tear,  
    Kept drawing near,  
Their very blacks became attractive.  
To cut a shortish story shorter,  
Conceive them sitting tête à tête—  
Two cups,—hot muffins on a plate,—  
With “Anna's Urn” to hold hot water!

The brazen vessel for a while,  
Had lectured in an easy song,  
Like Abernethy—on the bile—  
The scalded herb was getting strong;  
All seem'd as smooth as smooth could be,  
To have a cosey cup of tea;  
Alas! how often human sippers  
With unexpected bitters meet,  
And buds, the sweetest of the sweet,  
Like sugar, only meet the nippers!

The Widow Cross, I should have told,  
Had seen three husbands to the mould;  
She never sought an Indian pyre,  
Like Hindoo wives that lose their loves,  
But with a proper sense of fire,  
Put up, instead, with “three removes:”  
Thus, when with any tender words  
Or tears she spoke about her loss,  
The dear departed, Mr. Cross,  
Came in for nothing but his thirds;  
For as all widows love too well

For, as all widows love too well,  
She liked upon the list to dwell,  
And oft ripp'd up the old disasters—  
She might, indeed, have been supposed  
A great *ship* owner, for she prosed  
Eternally of her Three Masters!

Thus, foolish woman! while she nursed  
Her mild souchong, she talk'd and reckon'd  
What had been left her by her first,  
And by her last, and by her second.  
Alas! not all her annual rents  
Could then entice the little German,—  
Not Mr. Cross's Three Per Cents,  
Or Consols, ever make him *her* man;  
He liked her cash, he liked her houses,  
But not that dismal bit of land  
She always settled on her spouses.  
So taking up his hat and band,  
Said he "You'll think my conduct odd—  
But here my hopes no more may linger;  
I thought you had a wedding-finger,  
But oh!—it is a curtain-rod!"

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“DON’T YOU SMELL FIRE?”

I.

UN!—run for St. Clement’s engine!  
For the Pawnbroker’s all in a blaze,  
And the pledges are frying and singing—  
Oh! how the poor pawners will craze!  
Now where can the turncock be drinking?  
Was there ever so thirsty an elf?—  
But he still may tope on, for I’m thinking  
That the plugs are as dry as himself.

II.

The engines!—I hear them come rumbling;  
There’s the Phœnix! the Globe! and the Sun!  
What a row there will be, and a grumbling  
When the water don’t start for a run!  
See! there they come racing and tearing,  
All the street with loud voices is fill’d;  
Oh! its only the firemen a-swearing  
At a man they’ve run over and kill’d!

III.

How sweetly the sparks fly away now,  
And twinkle like stars in the sky;  
It’s a wonder the engines don’t play now,  
But I never saw water so shy!  
Why there isn’t enough for a snipe,  
And the fire is fiercer, alas!  
Oh! instead of the New River pipe,  
They have gone—that they have—to the gas!

IV.

Only look at the poor little P——'s  
On the roof—is there anything sadder?  
My dears, keep fast hold, if you please,  
And they won't be an hour with the ladder!  
But if any one's hot in their feet,  
And in very great haste to be saved,  
Here's a nice easy bit in the street,  
That M'Adam has lately unpaved!

V.

There is some one—I see a dark shape  
At that window, the hottest of all,—  
My good woman, why don't you escape?  
Never think of your bonnet and shawl:  
If your dress isn't perfect, what is it  
For once in a way to your hurt?  
When your husband is paying a visit  
There, at Number Fourteen, in his shirt!

VI.

Only see how she throws out her *chaney*!  
Her basons, and teapots, and all  
The most brittle of *her* goods—or any,  
But they all break in breaking their fall:  
Such things are not surely the best  
From a two-story window to throw—  
She might save a good iron-bound chest,  
For there's plenty of people below!

VII.

O dear! what a beautiful flash!  
How it shone thro' the window and door;  
We shall soon hear a scream and a crash,  
When the woman falls thro' with the floor!  
There! there! what a volley of flame,  
And then suddenly all is obscured!—  
Well—I'm glad in my heart that I came;—  
But I hope the poor man is insured!



**A HARD ROE.**

DOES YOUR MOTHER KNOW YOU'RE OUT



**“DOES YOUR MOTHER KNOW YOU’RE OUT?”**

---

# THE WEE MAN.

A ROMANCE.

It was a merry company,  
And they were just afloat,  
When lo! a man, of dwarfish span,  
Came up and hail'd the boat.

“Good morrow to ye, gentle folks,  
And will you let me in?—  
A slender space will serve my case,  
For I am small and thin.”  
They saw he was a dwarfish man,  
And very small and thin;  
Not seven such would matter much,  
And so they took him in.

They laugh'd to see his little hat,  
With such a narrow brim;  
They laugh'd to note his dapper coat  
With skirts so scant and trim.

But barely had they gone a mile,  
When, gravely, one and all,  
At once began to think the man  
Was not so very small.

His coat had got a broader skirt,  
His hat a broader brim,  
His leg grew stout, and soon plump'd out  
A very proper limb.

Still on they went, and as they went,  
More rough the billows grew,—  
And rose and fell, a greater swell,  
And he was swelling too!

And lo! where room had been for seven,  
For six there scarce was space!  
For five!—for four!—for three!—not more  
Then two could find a place!

than two could find a place!

There was not even room for one!  
They crowded by degrees—  
Aye—closer yet, till elbows met,  
And knees were jogging knees.

“Good sir, you must not sit a-stern,  
The wave will else come in!”  
Without a word he gravely stirr’d,  
Another seat to win.

“Good sir, the boat has lost her trim,  
You must not sit a-lee!”  
With smiling face, and courteous grace,  
The middle seat took he.

But still, by constant quiet growth,  
His back became so wide,  
Each neighbour wight, to left and right,  
Was thrust against the side.

Lord! how they chided with themselves,  
That they had let him in;  
To see him grow so monstrous now,  
That came so small and thin.

On every brow a dew-drop stood,  
They grew so scared and hot,—  
“I’ the name of all that’s great and tall,  
Who are ye, sir, and what?”

Loud laugh’d the Gogmagog, a laugh  
As loud as giant’s roar—  
“When first I came, my proper name  
Was Little—now I’m *Moore*!”

---





“THE LAST MAN.”

'Twas in the year two thousand and one,  
A pleasant morning of May,  
I sat on the gallows-tree all alone,  
A-chanting a merry lay,—  
To think how the pest had spared my life,  
To sing with the larks that day!

When up the heath came a jolly knave,  
Like a scarecrow, all in rags:  
It made me crow to see his old duds  
All abroad in the wind, like flags:—  
So up he came to the timbers' foot  
And pitch'd down his greasy bags.—

Good Lord! how blithe the old beggar was!  
At pulling out his scraps,—  
The very sight of his broken orts  
Made a work in his wrinkled chaps:  
“Come down,” says he, “you Newgate-bird,  
And have a taste of my snaps!”——

Then down the rope, like a tar from the mast,  
I slided, and by him stood;  
But I wished myself on the gallows again  
When I smelt that beggar's food,  
A foul beef-bone and a mouldy crust;  
“Oh!” quoth he, “the heavens are good!”

Then after this grace he cast him down:  
Says I, “You'll get sweeter air  
A pace or two off, on the windward side,”  
For the felons' bones lay there.  
But he only laugh'd at the empty skulls,  
And offered them part of his fare.

“I never harm'd *them*, and they won't harm me:  
Let the proud and the rich be cravens!”

I did not like that strange beggar man,  
He look'd so up at the heavens.  
Anon he shook out his empty old poke;  
“There's the crumbs,” saith he, “for the ravens!”

It made me angry to see his face,  
It had such a jesting look;  
But while I made up my mind to speak,  
A small case-bottle he took:  
Quoth he, “though I gather the green water-cress  
My drink is not of the brook!”

Full manners-like he tender'd the dram;  
Oh, it came of a dainty cask!  
But, whenever it came to his turn to pull,  
“Your leave, good Sir, I must ask;  
But I always wipe the brim with my sleeve,  
When a hangman sups at my flask!”

And then he laugh'd so loudly and long,  
The churl was quite out of breath;  
I thought the very Old One was come  
To mock me before my death,  
And wish'd I had buried the dead men's bones  
That were lying about the heath!

But the beggar gave me a jolly clap—  
“Come, let us pledge each other,  
For all the wide world is dead beside,  
And we are brother and brother—  
I've a yearning for thee in my heart,  
As if we had come of one mother.

“I've a yearning for thee in my heart  
That almost makes me weep,  
For as I pass'd from town to town  
The folks were all stone-asleep,—  
But when I saw thee sitting aloft,  
It made me both laugh and leap!”

it made me both laugh and weep:

Now a curse (I thought) be on his love,  
And a curse upon his mirth,—  
An' it were not for that beggar man  
I'd be the King of the earth,—  
But I promis'd myself an hour should come  
To make him rue his birth—

So down we sat and bous'd again  
Till the sun was in mid-sky,  
When, just as the gentle west-wind came,  
We hearken'd a dismal cry;  
“Up, up, on the tree,” quoth the beggar man,  
“Till these horrible dogs go by!”

And, lo! from the forest's far off skirts,  
They came all yelling for gore,  
A hundred hounds pursuing at once,  
And a panting hart before,  
Till he sunk adown at the gallows' foot,  
And there his haunches they tore!

His haunches they tore, without a horn  
To tell when the chase was done;  
And there was not a single scarlet coat  
To flaunt it in the sun!—  
I turn'd, and look'd at the beggar man,  
And his tears dropt one by one!

And with curses sore he chid at the hounds  
Till the last dropt out of sight,  
Anon, saith he, “let's down again,  
And ramble for our delight,  
For the world's all free, and we may choose  
A right cozie barn for to-night!”

With that, he set up his staff on end,  
And it fell with the point due West;

So we far'd that way to a city great,  
Where the folks had died of the pest—  
It was fine to enter in house and hall,  
Wherever it liked me best;

For the porters all were stiff and cold,  
And could not lift their heads;  
And when we came where their masters lay,  
The rats leapt out of the beds;  
The grandest palaces in the land  
Were as free as workhouse sheds.

But the beggar man made a mumping face,  
And knock'd at every gate:  
It made me curse to hear how he whin'd,  
So our fellowship turn'd to hate,  
And I bade him walk the world by himself,  
For I scorn'd so humble a mate!

So *he* turn'd right and *I* turn'd left,  
As if we had never met;  
And I chose a fair stone house for myself,  
For the city was all to let;  
And for three brave holydays drank my fill  
Of the choicest that I could get.

And because my jerkin was coarse and worn,  
I got me a properer vest;  
It was purple velvet, stitch'd o'er with gold,  
And a shining star at the breast!—  
'Twas enough to fetch old Joan from her grave  
To see me so purely drest!—

But Joan was dead and under the mould,  
And every buxom lass;  
In vain I watch'd, at the window pane,  
For a Christian soul to pass!  
But sheep and kine wander'd up the street,

And browz'd on the new-come grass.—

When lo! I spied the old beggar man,  
And lustily he did sing!—  
His rags were lapp'd in a scarlet cloak,  
And a crown he had like a King;  
So he stept right up before my gate  
And danc'd me a saucy fling!

Heaven mend us all!—but, within my mind,  
I had kill'd him then and there;  
To see him lording so braggart-like  
That was born to his beggar's fare;  
And how he had stol'n the royal crown  
His betters were meant to wear.

But God forbid that a thief should die  
Without his share of the laws!  
So I nimbly whipt my tackle out,  
And soon tied up his claws,—  
I was judge myself, and jury, and all,  
And solemnly tried the cause.

But the beggar man would not plead, but cried  
Like a babe without its corals,  
For he knew how hard it is apt to go,  
When the law and a thief have quarrels,—  
There was not a Christian soul alive  
To speak a word for his morals.

Oh, how gaily I doff'd my costly gear,  
And put on my work-day clothes;  
I was tired of such a long Sunday life,—  
And never was one of the sloths;  
But the beggar man grumbled a weary deal,  
And made many crooked mouths.

So I haul'd him off to the gallows' foot,  
And blinded him in his beggar's

And divided him in his bags,  
'Twas a weary job to heave him up,  
For a doom'd man always lags;  
But by ten of the clock he was off his legs  
In the wind, and airing his rags!

So there he hung, and there I stood,  
The LAST MAN left alive,  
To have my own will of all the earth:  
Quoth I, now I shall thrive!  
But when was ever honey made  
With one bee in a hive!

My conscience began to gnaw my heart,  
Before the day was done,  
For other men's lives had all gone out,  
Like candles in the sun!—  
But it seem'd as if I had broke, at last,  
A thousand necks in one!

So I went and cut his body down  
To bury it decentlie;  
God send there were any good soul alive  
To do the like by me!  
But the wild dogs came with terrible speed,  
And bay'd me up the tree!

My sight was like a drunkard's sight,  
And my head began to swim,  
To see their jaws all white with foam,  
Like the ravenous ocean brim;—  
But when the wild dogs trotted away  
Their jaws were bloody and grim!

Their jaws were bloody and grim, good Lord!  
But the beggar man, where was he?—  
There was nought of him but some ribbons of rags  
Below the gallow's tree!—  
I know the Devil when I am dead.

I know the devil, when I am dead,  
Will send his hounds for me!—

I've buried my babies one by one,  
And dug the deep hole for Joan,  
And cover'd the faces of kith and kin,  
And felt the old churchyard stone  
Go cold to my heart, full many a time,  
But I never felt so lone!

For the lion and Adam were company,  
And the tiger him beguil'd;  
But the simple kine are foes to my life,  
And the household brutes are wild.  
If the veriest cur would lick my hand,  
I could love it like a child!

And the beggar man's ghost besets my dream,  
At night to make me madder,—  
And my wretched conscience within my breast,  
Is like a stinging adder:—  
I sigh when I pass the gallows' foot,  
And look at the rope and ladder!—

For hanging looks sweet,—but alas! in vain  
My desperate fancy begs,—  
I must turn my cup of sorrows quite up,  
And drink it to the dregs,—  
For there's not another man alive,  
In the world, to pull my legs!

---





BACKING THE FAVOURITE.



Oh a pistol, or a knife!  
For I'm weary of my life,—  
My cup has nothing sweet left to flavour it;  
My estate is out at nurse,  
And my heart is like my purse—  
And all through backing of the Favourite!

At dear O'Neil's first start,  
I sported all my heart,—  
Oh, Becher, he never marr'd a braver hit!  
For he cross'd her in her race,  
And made her lose her place,  
And there was an end of that Favourite!

Anon, to mend my chance,  
For the Goddess of the Dance<sup>[10]</sup>  
I pin'd and told my enslaver it;  
But she wedded in a canter,  
And made me a Levanter,  
In foreign lands to sigh for the Favourite!

Then next Miss M. A. Tree  
I adored, so sweetly she  
Could warble like a nightingale and quaver it;  
But she left that course of life  
To be Mr. Bradshaw's wife,  
And all the world lost on the Favourite!

But out of sorrow's surf  
Soon I leap'd upon the turf,  
Where fortune loves to wanton it and waver it;  
But standing on the pet,  
"Oh my bonny, bonny Bet!"  
Black and yellow pull'd short up with the Favourite!

Thus flung by all the crack,  
I resolved to cut the pack,—

The second-raters seem'd then a safer hit!  
So I laid my little odds  
Against Memnon! Oh, ye Gods!  
Am I always to be floored by the Favourite!

---

## THE BALLAD OF

### “SALLY BROWN AND BEN THE CARPENTER.”

I HAVE never been vainer of any verses than of my part in the following Ballad. Dr. Watts, amongst evangelical nurses, has an enviable renown—and Campbell’s Ballads enjoy a snug genteel popularity. “Sally Brown” has been favoured, perhaps, with as wide a patronage as the Moral Songs, though its circle may not have been of so select a class as the friends of “Hohenlinden.” But I do not desire to see it amongst what are called Elegant Extracts. The lamented Emery, drest as Tom Tug, sang it at his last mortal Benefit at Covent Garden;—and, ever since, it has been a great favourite with the watermen of Thames, who time their oars to it, as the wherry-men of Venice time theirs to the lines of Tasso. With the watermen, it went naturally to Vauxhall:—and, over land, to Sadler’s Wells. The Guards, not the mail coach, but the Life Guards,—picked it out from a fluttering hundred of others—all going to one air—against the dead wall at Knightsbridge. Cheap Printers of Shoe Lane, and Cowcross, (all pirates!) disputed about the Copyright, and published their own editions,—and, in the meantime, the Authors, to have made bread of their song, (it was poor old Homer’s hard ancient case!) must have sung it about the streets. Such is the lot of Literature! the profits of “Sally Brown” were divided by the Ballad Mongers:—it has cost, but has never brought me, a half-penny.

FAITHLESS SALLY BROWN.

AN OLD BALLAD.

I.

OUNG BEN he was a nice young man,  
A carpenter by trade;  
And he fell in love with Sally Brown,  
That was a lady's maid.

II.

But as they fetch'd a walk one day,  
They met a press-gang crew;  
And Sally she did faint away,  
While Ben he was brought to.

III.

The Boatswain swore with wicked words,  
Enough to shock a saint,  
That though she did seem in a fit,  
'Twas nothing but a feint.

IV.

“Come, girl,” said he, “hold up your head,  
He'll be as good as me;  
For when your swain is in our boat,  
A boatswain he will be.”

V.

So when they'd made their game of her,  
And taken off her elf,  
She rous'd, and found she only was  
A coming to herself.

VI.

“And is he gone, and is he gone?”  
She cried, and wept outright:  
“Then I will to the water side,  
And see him out of sight.”

VII.

A waterman came up to her,—  
“Now, young woman,” said he,  
“If you weep on so, you will make  
Eye-water in the sea.”

VIII.

“Alas! they've taken my beau Ben  
To sail with old Benbow;”  
And her woe began to run afresh,  
As if she'd said, Gee woe!

IX.

Says he, “They've only taken him  
To the Tender-ship, you see;”  
“The Tender-ship,” cried Sally Brown,  
“What a hard-ship that must be!

X.

“Oh! would I were a mermaid now,  
For then I’d follow him;  
But oh!—I’m not a fish-woman,  
And so I cannot swim.

XI.

“Alas! I was not born beneath  
The virgin and the scales,  
So I must curse my cruel stars,  
And walk about in Wales.”

XII.

Now Ben had sail’d to many a place  
That’s underneath the world;  
But in two years the ship came home  
And all her sails were furl’d.

XIII.

But when he call’d on Sally Brown,  
To see how she got on,  
He found she’d got another Ben,  
Whose Christian-name was John.

XIV.

“O Sally Brown, O Sally Brown,  
How could you serve me so?  
I’ve met with many a breeze before,  
But never such a blow!”

XV.





ON Hounslow heath—and close beside the road,  
As western travellers may oft have seen,—  
A little house some years ago there stood,  
    A minikin abode;  
And built like Mr. Birkbeck's, all of wood:  
The walls of white, the window shutters green;—  
Four wheels it had at North, South, East, and West.  
    (Tho' now at rest)  
On which it used to wander to and fro',  
Because its master ne'er maintain'd a rider,  
    Like those who trade in Paternoster Row;  
But made his business travel for itself,  
    Till he had made his pelf,  
And then retired—if one may call it so,  
    Of a roadsider.

Perchance, the very race and constant riot  
Of stages, long and short, which thereby ran,  
Made him more relish the repose and quiet  
    Of his now sedentary caravan;  
Perchance, he lov'd the ground because 'twas common,  
    And so he might impale a strip of soil,  
    That furnish'd, by his toil,  
Some dusty greens, for him and his old woman;—  
And five tall hollyhocks, in dingy flower:  
Howbeit, the thoroughfare did no ways spoil  
His peace, unless, in some unlucky hour,  
A stray horse came and gobbled up his bow'r!

But tired of always looking at the coaches,  
The same to come,—when they had seen them one day!  
    And, used to brisker life, both man and wife  
Began to suffer N U E's approaches,  
And feel retirement like a long wet Sunday:—  
So, having had some quarters of school breeding,  
They turn'd themselves, like other folks, to reading;  
But setting out where others nigh have done,

And being ripen'd in the seventh stage,  
The childhood of old age,  
Began, as other children have begun,—  
Not with the pastorals of Mr. Pope,  
Or Bard of Hope,  
Or Paley ethical, or learned Porson,—  
But spelt, on Sabbaths, in St. Mark, or John,  
And then relax'd themselves with Whittington,  
Or Valentine and Orson—  
But chiefly fairy tales they loved to con,  
And being easily melted in their dotage,  
Slobber'd,—and kept  
Reading,—and wept  
Over the white Cat, in their wooden cottage.

Thus reading on—the longer  
They read, of course, their childish faith grew stronger  
In Gnomes, and Hags, and Elves, and Giants grim,—  
If talking Trees and Birds reveal'd to him,  
She saw the flight of Fairyland's fly-waggons,  
And magic-fishes swim  
In puddle ponds, and took old crows for dragons.—  
Both were quite drunk from the enchanted flagons;  
When, as it fell upon a summer's day,  
As the old man sat a feeding  
On the old babe-reading,  
Beside his open street-and-parlour door,  
A hideous roar  
Proclaim'd a drove of beasts was coming by the way.

Long-horn'd, and short, of many a different breed,  
Tall, tawny brutes, from famous Lincoln-levels  
Or Durham feed;  
With some of those unquiet black dwarf devils  
From neither side of Tweed,  
Or Firth of Forth;  
Looking half wild with joy to leave the North,—  
With dusty hides. all mobbing on together.—

When,—whether from a fly’s malicious comment  
Upon his tender flank, from which he shrank;

Or whether

Only in some enthusiastic moment,—  
However, one brown monster, in a frisk,  
Giving his tail a perpendicular whisk,  
Kick’d out a passage thro’ the beastly rabble;  
And after a pas seul,—or, if you will, a  
Hornpipe before the Basket-maker’s villa,

Leapt o’er the tiny pale,—

Back’d his beef-steaks against the wooden gable,  
And thrust his brawny bell-rope of a tail

Right o’er the page,

Wherein the sage

Just then was spelling some romantic fable.

The old man, half a scholar, half a dunce,  
Could not peruse,—who could?—two tales at once;

And being huff’d

At what he knew was none of Riquet’s Tuft,

Bang’d-to the door,

But most unluckily enclosed a morsel  
Of the intruding tail, and all the tassel:—

The monster gave a roar,

And bolting off with speed, increased by pain,

The little house became a coach once more,

And, like Macheath, “took to the road” again!

Just then, by fortune’s whimsical decree,  
The ancient woman stooping with her crupper  
Towards sweet home, or where sweet home should be,  
Was getting up some household herbs for supper;

Thoughtful of Cinderella, in the tale,  
And quaintly wondering if magic shifts  
Could o’er a common pumpkin so prevail,

To turn it to a coach;—what pretty gifts  
Might come of cabbages, and curly kale;

Meanwhile she never heard her old man’s wail

MEANWHILE SHE NEVER HEARD HER OLD MAN'S WAIL,  
Nor turn'd, till home had turn'd a corner, quite  
Gone out of sight!

At last, conceive her, rising from the ground,  
Weary of sitting on her russet clothing;  
And looking round  
Where rest was to be found,  
There was no house—no villa there—no nothing!  
No house!

The change was quite amazing;  
It made her senses stagger for a minute,  
The riddle's explication seem'd to harden;  
But soon her superannuated *nous*  
Explained the horrid mystery;—and raising  
Her hand to heaven, with the cabbage in it,  
On which she meant to sup,—  
“Well! this *is* Fairy Work! I'll bet a farden,  
Little Prince Silverwings has ketch'd me up,  
And set me down in some one else's garden!”

---



# THE FALL OF THE DEER.

[FROM AN OLD MS.]



OW the loud Crye is up, and harke!  
The barkye Trees give back the  
Bark;

The House Wife heares the merrie rout,  
And runnes,—and lets the beere run out,  
Leaving her Babes to weepe,—for why?  
She likes to heare the Deer Dogges crye,  
And see the wild Stag how he stretches  
The naturall Buck-skin of his Breeches,  
Running like one of Human kind  
Dogged by fleet Bailiffes close behind—  
As if he had not payde his Bill  
For Ven'son, or was owing still  
For his two Hornes, and soe did get  
Over his Head and Ears in Debt;—  
Wherefore he strives to paye his Waye  
With his long Legges the while he maye:—  
But he is chased, like Silver Dish,  
As well as anye Hart may wish  
Except that one whose Heart doth beat  
So faste it hasteneth his feet;—  
And runninge soe, he holdeth Death  
Four Feet from him,—till his Breath  
Faileth, and slacking Pace at last,  
From runninge slow he standeth faste,  
With hornie Bayonettes at baye,  
To Baying Dogges around, and they  
Pushing him sore, he pusheth sore,  
And goreth them that seeke his Gore,  
Whatever Dogge his Horne doth rive  
Is dead—as sure as he's alive!  
Soe that courageous Hart doth fight  
With Fate, and calleth up his might,  
And standeth stout that he maye fall  
Bravelye, and be avenged of all,  
Nor like a craven yeeld his Breath  
Under the Jawes of Dogges and Death!

Under the names of Dogges and Deane.

---



TIM TURPIN,

A PATHETIC BALLAD.

I.

IM TURPIN he was gravel blind,  
And ne'er had seen the skies:  
For Nature, when his head was made,  
Forgot to dot his eyes.

II.

So, like a Christmas pedagogue,  
Poor Tim was forced to do—  
Look out for pupils, for he had  
A vacancy for two.

III.

There's some have specs to help their sight  
Of objects dim and small:  
But Tim had *specs* within his eyes,  
And could not see at all.

IV.

Now Tim he woo'd a servant maid,  
And took her to his arms;  
For he, like Pyramus, had cast  
A wall-eye on her charms.

V.

By day she led him up and down  
Where'er he wish'd to jog,  
A happy wife, altho' she led  
The life of any dog.

VI.

But just when Tim had liv'd a month  
In honey with his wife,  
A surgeon ope'd his Milton eyes,  
Like oysters, with a knife.

VII.

But when his eyes were open'd thus,  
He wish'd them dark again:  
For when he look'd upon his wife,  
He saw her very plain.

VIII.

Her face was bad, her figure worse,  
He couldn't bear to eat:  
For she was any thing but like  
A Grace before his meat.

IX.

Now Tim he was a feeling man:  
For when his sight was thick,  
It made him feel for everything—  
But that was with a stick.

X.

So with a cudgel in his hand—  
It was not light or slim—  
He knock'd at his wife's head until  
It open'd unto him.

XI.

And when the corpse was stiff and cold  
He took his slaughter'd spouse,  
And laid her in a heap with all  
The ashes of her house.

XII.

But like a wicked murderer,  
He liv'd in constant fear  
From day to day, and so he cut  
His throat from ear to ear.

XIII.

The neighbours fetch'd a doctor in:  
Said he, this wound I dread  
Can hardly be sew'd up—his life  
Is hanging on a thread.

XIV.

But when another week was gone,  
He gave him stronger hope—  
Instead of hanging on a thread,  
Of hanging on a rope.

XV.

Ah! when he hid his bloody work,  
In ashes round about,  
How little he supposed the truth  
Would soon be sifted out.

XVI.

But when the parish dustman came,  
His rubbish to withdraw,  
He found more dust within the heap,  
Than he contracted for!

XVII.

A dozen men to try the fact,  
Were sworn that very day;  
But tho' they all were jurors, yet  
No conjurors were they.

XVIII.

Said Tim unto those jurymen,  
You need not waste your breath,  
For I confess myself at once,  
The author of her death.

XIX.

And oh! when I reflect upon  
The blood that I have spilt,  
Just like a button is my soul,  
Inscrib'd with double *guilt*!

XX.

Then turning round his head again,  
He saw before his eyes,  
A great judge, and a little judge,  
The judges of a-size!

XXI.

The great judge took his judgment cap,  
And put it on his head,  
And sentenc'd Tim by law to hang,  
Till he was three times dead.

XXII.

So he was tried, and he was hung  
(Fit punishment for such)  
On Horsham-drop, and none can say  
It was a drop too much.

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## THE MONKEY-MARTYR.

A FABLE.

“God help thee, said I, but I’ll let thee out, cost what it will: so I turned about the cage to get to the door.”—STERNE.

'Tis strange, what awkward figures and odd capers  
Folks cut, who seek their doctrine from the papers;  
But there are many shallow politicians,  
Who take their bias from bewilder'd journals,—

Turn state physicians,  
And make themselves fools'-caps of the diurnals.  
One of this kind, not human, but a monkey,  
Had read himself at last to this sour creed—  
That he was nothing but Oppression's flunkey,  
And man a tyrant over all his breed.

He could not read  
Of niggers whipt, or over-trampled weavers,  
But he applied their wrongs to his own seed,  
And nourish'd thoughts that threw him into fevers;  
His very dreams were full of martial beavers,  
And drilling Pugs, for liberty pugnacious,  
To sever chains vexatious:  
In fact, he thought that all his injur'd line  
Should take up pikes in hand, and never drop 'em  
Till they had cleared a road to Freedom's shrine,—  
Unless perchance the turnpike men should stop 'em.

Full of this rancour,  
Pacing one day beside St. Clement Danes,  
It came into his brains  
To give a look in at the Crown and Anchor;  
Where certain solemn sages of the nation  
Were at that moment in deliberation  
How to relieve the wide world of its chains,  
Pluck despots down,  
And thereby crown  
Whitee- as well as blackee-man-cipation.  
Pug heard the speeches with great approbation,  
And gaz'd with pride upon the Liberators;  
To see mere coal-heavers  
Such perfect Bolivars—  
Waiters of inns sublim'd to innovators.

And slaters dignified as legislators—  
Small publicans demanding (such their high sense  
Of liberty) an universal license—  
And pattern-makers easing Freedom's clogs—  
The whole thing seem'd  
So fine, he deem'd  
The smallest demagogues as great as Gogs!

Pug, with some curious notions in his noddle,  
Walk'd out at last, and turn'd into the Strand,  
To the left hand,  
Conning some portions of the previous twaddle,  
And striding with a step that seem'd design'd  
To represent the mighty March of Mind,  
Instead of that slow waddle  
Of thought, to which our ancestors inclin'd—  
No wonder, then, that he should quickly find  
He stood in front of that intrusive pile,  
Where Cross keeps many a kind  
Of bird confin'd,  
And free-born animal, in durance vile—  
A thought that stirr'd up all the monkey-bile!  
The window stood ajar—  
It was not far,  
Nor, like Parnassus, very hard to climb—  
The hour was verging on the supper-time,  
And many a growl was sent through many a bar.  
Meanwhile Pug scrambled upward like a tar,  
And soon crept in,  
Unnotic'd in the din  
Of tuneless throats, that made the attics ring  
With all the harshest notes that they could bring;  
For like the Jews,  
Wild beasts refuse,  
In midst of their captivity—to sing.

Lord! how it made him chafe,  
Full of his new emancipating zeal



Full of his new emancipating zeal,  
To look around upon this brute-bastille,  
And see the king of creatures in—a safe!  
The desert's denizen in one small den,  
Swallowing slavery's most bitter pills—  
A bear in bars unbearable. And then  
The fretful porcupine, with all its quills  
Imprison'd in a pen!  
A tiger limited to four feet ten;  
And, still worse lot,  
A leopard to one spot!  
An elephant enlarg'd,  
But not discharg'd;  
(It was before the elephant was shot;)  
A doleful wanderer, that wander'd not;  
An ounce much disproportion'd to his pound.  
Pug's wrath wax'd hot  
To gaze upon these captive creature's round;  
Whose claws—all scratching—gave him full assurance  
They found their durance vile of vile endurance.

He went above—a solitary mounter  
Up gloomy stairs—and saw a pensive group  
Of hapless fowls—  
Cranes, vultures, owls,  
In fact, it was a sort of Poultry-Compter,  
Where feather'd prisoners were doom'd to droop:  
Here sat an eagle, forc'd to make a stoop,  
Not from the skies, but his impending roof;  
And there aloof,  
A pining ostrich, moping in a coop;  
With other samples of the bird creation,  
All cag'd against their powers and their wills,  
And cramp'd in such a space, the longest bills  
Were plainly bills of least accommodation.  
In truth, it was a very ugly scene  
To fall to any liberator's share,  
To see those winged fowls, that once had been

Free as the wind, no freer than fixed air.

His temper little mended,  
Pug from this Bird-cage Walk at last descended  
Unto the lion and the elephant,  
His bosom in a pant  
To see all nature's Free List thus suspended,  
And beasts depriv'd of what she had intended.  
They could not even prey  
In their own way;  
A hardship always reckon'd quite prodigious.  
Thus he resolv'd—  
And soon resolv'd  
To give them freedom, civil and religious.

That night there was no country cousins, raw  
From Wales, to view the lion and his kin;  
The keeper's eyes were fix'd upon a saw;  
The saw was fix'd upon a bullock's shin:  
Meanwhile with stealthy paw,  
Pug hastened to withdraw  
The bolt that kept the king of brutes within.  
Now, monarch of the forest! thou shalt win  
Precious enfranchisement—thy bolts are undone;  
Thou art no longer a degraded creature,  
But loose to roam with liberty and nature;  
And free of all the jungles about London—  
All Hampstead's heathy desert lies before thee!  
Methinks I see thee bound from Cross's ark,  
Full of the native instinct that comes o'er thee,  
And turn a ranger  
Of Hounslow Forest, and the Regent's Park—  
Thin Rhodes's cows—the mail-coach steeds endanger,  
And gobble parish watchmen after dark:—  
Methinks I see thee, with the early lark,  
Stealing to Merlin's cave—(*thy* cave.)—Alas,  
That such bright visions should not come to pass!  
Alas, for freedom, and for freedom's hero!

Alas, for liberty of life and limb!  
For Pug had only half unbolted Nero,  
When Nero *bolted him!*

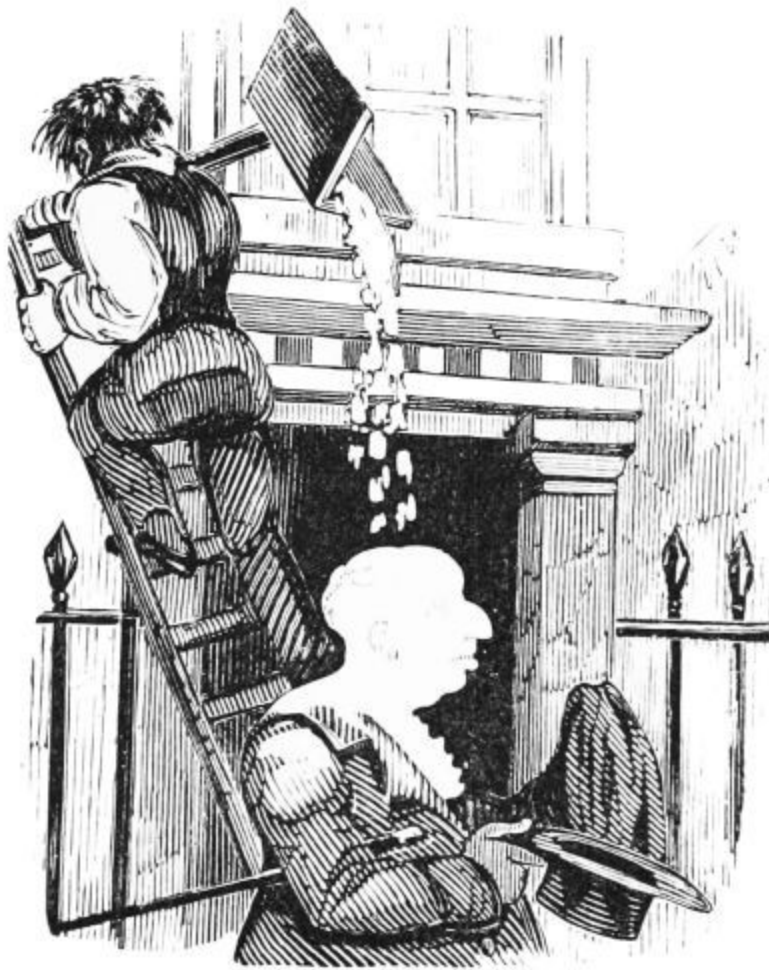
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## CRANIOLOGY.

'Tis strange how like a very dunce,  
Man—with his bumps upon his scone,  
Has lived so long, and yet no knowledge he  
Has had, till lately, of Phrenology—  
A science that by simple dint of  
Head-combing he should find a hint of,  
When scratching o'er those little pole-hills,  
The faculties throw up like mole-hills;  
A science that, in very spite  
Of all his teeth, ne'er came to light,  
For though he knew his skull had *grinders*,  
Still there turn'd up no *organ* finders,  
Still sages wrote, and ages fled,  
And no man's head came in his head—  
Not even the pate of Erra Pater,  
Knew aught about its pia mater.  
At last great Dr. Gall bestirs him—  
I don't know but it might be Spurzheim—  
Tho' native of a dull and slow land,  
And makes partition of our Poll-land,  
At our Acquisitiveness guesses,  
And all those necessary *nesses*



**VIOLINIST.**



A PLASTER CAST.

Indicative of human habits,  
All burrowing in the head like rabbits.  
Thus Veneration, he made known,  
Had got a lodging at the Crown:  
And Music (see Deville's example),  
A set of chambers in the Temple:  
That Language taught the tongues close by,  
And took in pupils thro' the eye,  
Close by his neighbour Computation,  
Who taught the eyebrows numeration.

The science thus—to speak in fit  
Terms—having struggled from its nit,  
Was seiz'd on by a swarm of Scotchmen,  
Those scientific hotch-potch men,  
Who have at least a penny dip  
And wallop in all doctorship,  
Just as in making broth they smatter  
By bobbing twenty things in water:  
These men, I say, make quick appliance  
And close, to phrenologic science;  
For of all learned themes whatever,  
That schools and colleges deliver,  
There's none they love so near the bodles,  
As analyzing their own noddles;  
Thus in a trice each northern blockhead  
Had got his fingers in his shock head,  
And of his bumps was babbling yet worse  
Than poor Miss Capulet's dry wet-nurse;  
Till having been sufficient rangers  
Of their own heads, they took to strangers',  
And found in Presbyterians' polls  
The things they hated in their souls;  
For Presbyterians hear with passion  
Of organs join'd with veneration.  
No kind there was of human pumpkin,  
But at its bumps it had a bumpkin;

Down to the very lowest gullion,  
 And oiliest scull of oily scullion.  
 No great man died but this they *did* do,  
 They begg'd his cranium of his widow;  
 No murderer died by law disaster,  
 But they took off his sconce in plaster;  
 For thereon they could show depending,  
 "The head and front of his offending,"  
 How that his philanthropic bump  
 Was master'd by a baser lump;  
 For every bump (these wags insist)  
 Has its direct antagonist,  
 Each striving stoutly to prevail,  
 Like horses knotted tail to tail;  
 And many a stiff and sturdy battle  
 Occurs between these adverse cattle,  
 The secret cause, beyond all question,  
 Of aches ascribed to indigestion,—  
 Whereas 'tis but two knobby rivals  
 Tugging together like sheer devils,  
 Till one gets mastery good or sinister,  
 And comes in like a new prime-minister.

Each bias in some master node is:—  
 What takes M'Adam where a road is,  
 To hammer little pebbles less?  
 His organ of destructiveness:  
 What makes great Joseph so encumber  
 Debate? a lumping lump of Number:  
 Or Malthus rail at babies so?  
 The smallness of his Philopro—  
 What severs man and wife? a simple  
 Defect of the Adhesive pimple:  
 Or makes weak women go astray?  
 Their bumps are more in fault than they.

These facts being found and set in order  
 By grave M.D.'s beyond the Border



By grave M.D.'s beyond the border,  
To make them for some months eternal,  
Were enter'd monthly in a journal,  
That many a northern sage still writes in,  
And throws his little Northern Lights in,  
And proves and proves about the phrenos,  
A great deal more than I or he knows.  
How Music suffers, *par exemple*,  
By wearing tight hats round the temple;  
What ills great boxers have to fear  
From blisters put behind the ear:  
And how a porter's Veneration  
Is hurt by porter's occupation:  
Whether shillelaghs in reality  
May deaden Individuality:  
Or tongs and poker be creative  
Of alterations in the Amative:  
If falls from scaffolds make us less  
Inclin'd to all Constructiveness:  
With more such matters, all applying  
To heads—and therefore *headifying*.

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A SAILOR'S APOLOGY FOR BOW-LEGS.

HERE'S some is born with their straight legs by natur—  
And some is born with bow-legs from the first—  
And some that should have grow'd a good deal straighter,  
But they were badly nurs'd,  
And set, you see, like Bacchus, with their pegs  
Astride of casks and kegs:  
I've got myself a sort of bow to larboard,  
And starboard,  
And this is what it was that warp'd my legs.—

'Twas all along of Poll, as I may say,  
That foul'd my cable when I ought to slip;  
But on the tenth of May,  
When I gets under weigh,  
Down there in Hartfordshire, to join my ship,  
I sees the mail  
Get under sail,  
The only one there was to make the trip.  
Well—I gives chase,  
But as she run  
Two knots to one,  
There warn't no use in keeping on the race!  
Well—casting round about, what next to try on,  
And how to spin,  
I spies an ensign with a Bloody Lion,  
And bears away to leeward for the inn,  
Beats round the gable,  
And fetches up before the coach-horse stable:  
Well—there they stand, four kickers in a row,  
And so  
I just makes free to cut a brown 'un's cable.  
But riding isn't in a seaman's natur—  
So I whips out a toughish end of yarn,  
And gets a kind of sort of a land-waiter  
To splice me, heel to heel,  
Under the she-mare's keel,  
And off I goes, and leaves the inn a-starn!

My eyes! how she did pitch!  
And wouldn't keep her own to go in no line,  
Tho' I kept bowsing, bowsing at her bow-line  
But always making leeway to the ditch,  
And yaw'd her head about all sorts of ways;  
The devil sink the craft!  
And wasn't she trimendus slack in stays!  
We couldn't, no how, keep the inn abaft!  
Well—I suppose  
We hadn't run a knot—or much beyond—  
(What will you have on it?)—but off she goes,  
Up to her bends in a fresh-water pond!  
There I am!—all a-back!  
So I looks forward for her bridle-gears,  
To heave her head round on the t'other track;  
But when I starts,  
The leather parts,  
And goes away right over by the ears!

What could a fellow do,  
Whose legs, like mine, you know, were in the bilboes,  
But trim myself upright for bringing-to,  
And square his yard-arms, and brace up his elbows,  
In rig all snug and clever,  
Just while his craft was taking in her water?  
I didn't like my burth tho', howsomdever,  
Because the yarn, you see, kept getting taughter,—  
Says I—I wish this job was rayther shorter!  
The chase had gain'd a mile  
A-head, and still the she-mare stood a-drinking:  
Now, all the while  
Her body didn't take of course to shrinking.  
Says I, she's letting out her reefs, I'm thinking,—  
And so she swell'd, and swell'd,  
And yet the tackle held,  
'Till both my legs began to bend like winkin.  
My eyes! but she took in enough to founder!

my eyes. But she took in enough to rounder.  
And there's my timbers straining every bit,  
Ready to split,  
And her tarnation hull a-growing rounder!

Well, there—off Hartford Ness,  
We lay both lash'd and water-logg'd together,  
And can't contrive a signal of distress;  
Thinks I, we must ride out this here foul weather,  
Tho' sick of riding out—and nothing less;  
When, looking round, I sees a man a-starn:—  
Hollo! says I, come underneath her quarter!—  
And hands him out my knife to cut the yarn.  
So I gets off, and lands upon the road,  
And leaves the she-mare to her own concarn,  
A-standing by the water.  
If I get on another, I'll be blowed!—  
And that's the way, you see, my legs got bow'd!

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# THE STAG-EYED LADY.

A MOORISH TALE.

Scheherazade immediately began the following story.



ALI BEN ALI (did you never read  
His wond'rous acts that chronicles relate,—  
How there was one in pity might exceed  
The sack of Troy?) Magnificent he sate  
Upon the throne of greatness—great indeed,  
For those that he had under him were great—  
The horse he rode on, shod with silver nails,  
Was a Bashaw—Bashaws have horses' tails.

Ali was cruel—a most cruel one!  
'Tis rumour'd he had strangled his own mother—  
Howbeit such deeds of darkness he had done,  
'Tis thought he would have slain his elder brother  
And sister too—but happily that none  
Did live within *harm's* length of one another,  
Else he had sent the Sun in all its blaze  
To endless night, and shorten'd the Moon's days.

Despotic power, that mars a weak man's wit,  
And makes a bad man—absolutely bad,  
Made Ali wicked—to a fault:—'tis fit  
Monarchs should have some check-strings; but he had  
No curb upon his will—no not a *bit*—  
Wherefore he did not reign well—and full glad  
His slaves had been to hang him—but they falter'd,  
And let him live unhang'd—and still unalter'd,

Until he got a sage-bush of a beard,  
Wherein an Attic owl might roost—a trail  
Of bristly hair—that, honour'd and unshear'd,  
Grew downward like old women and cow's tail:  
Being a sign of age—some gray appear'd,  
Mingling with duskier brown its warnings pale;  
But yet not so poetic as when Time  
Comes like Jack Frost, and whitens it in rime.

Ben Ali took the hint, and much did vex



His royal bosom that he had no son,  
No living child of the more noble sex,  
To stand in his Morocco shoes—not one  
To make a negro-pollard—or tread necks  
When he was gone—doom'd, when his days were done,  
To leave the very city of his fame  
Without an Ali to keep up his name.

Therefore he chose a lady for his love,  
Singling from out the herd one stag-eyed dear  
So call'd, because her lustrous eyes, above  
All eyes, were dark, and timorous, and clear;  
Then, through his Muftis piously he strove,  
And drumm'd with proxy-prayers Mohammed's ear,  
Knowing a boy for certain must come of it,  
Or else he was not praying to his *Profit*.

Beer will grow *mothery*, and ladies fair  
Will grow like beer; so did that stag-eyed dame:  
Ben Ali, hoping for a son and heir,  
Boy'd up his hopes, and even chose a name  
Of mighty hero that his child should bear;  
He made so certain ere his chicken came:  
But oh! all worldly wit is little worth,  
Nor knoweth what to-morrow will bring forth.

To-morrow came, and with to-morrow's sun  
A little daughter to this world of sins;—  
*Miss*-fortunes never come alone—so one  
Brought on another, like a pair of twins:  
Twins! female twins!—it was enough to stun  
Their little wits and scare them from their skins  
To hear their father stamp, and curse and swear,  
Pulling his beard because he had no heir.

Then strove their stag-eyed mother to calm down  
This his paternal rage, and thus addrest—  
“O! Most Serene! why dost thou stamp and frown,

And box the compass of the royal chest?  
Ah! thou wilt mar that portly trunk, I own  
I love to gaze on!—Pr’ythee, thou hadst best  
Pocket thy fists. Nay, love, if you so thin  
Your beard, you’ll want a wig upon your chin!”

But not her words, nor e’en her tears, could slack  
The quicklime of his rage, that hotter grew:  
He called his slaves to bring an ample sack  
Wherein a woman might be *poked*—a few  
Dark grimly men felt pity and look’d black  
At this sad order; but their slaveships knew  
When any dared demur, his sword so bending  
Cut off the “head and front of their offending.”

For Ali had a sword, much like himself,  
A crooked blade, guilty of human gore—  
The trophies it had lopp’d from many an elf  
Were stuck at his *head*-quarters by the score—  
Nor yet in peace he laid it on the shelf,  
But jested with it, and his wit cut sore;  
So that (as they of Public Houses speak)  
He often did his dozen *butts* a week.

Therefore his slaves, with most obedient fears,  
Came with the sack the lady to enclose;  
In vain from her stag-eyes “the big round tears  
Coursed one another down her innocent nose;”  
In vain her tongue wept sorrow in their ears;  
Though there were some felt willing to oppose,  
Yet when their heads came in their heads, that minute,  
Though ’twas a piteous *case*, they put her in it

And when the sack was tied, some two or three  
Of these black undertakers slowly brought her  
To a kind of Moorish Serpentine; for she  
Was doom’d to have *a winding sheet of water*.  
Then farewell, earth—farewell to the green tree—

Then farewell, the sun—the moon—the stars—the dew—the

Farewell, the sun—the moon—each little daughter!  
She's shot from off the shoulders of a black,  
Like a bag of Wall's-End from a coalman's back.

The waters oped, and the wide sack full-fill'd  
All that the waters oped, as down it fell;  
Then closed the wave, and then the surface rill'd  
A ring above her, like a water-knell;  
A moment more, and all its face was still'd,  
And not a guilty heave was left to tell  
That underneath its calm and blue transparency  
A dame lay drowned in her sack, like Clarence.

But Heaven beheld, and awful witness bore,  
The moon in black eclipse deceased that night,  
Like Desdemona smother'd by the Moor—  
The lady's natal star with pale affright  
Fainted and fell—and what were stars before,  
Turn'd comets as the tale was brought to light,  
And all look'd downward on the fatal wave,  
And made their own reflections on her grave.

Next night, a head—a little lady head,  
Push'd through the waters a most glassy face,  
With weedy tresses, thrown apart and spread,  
Comb'd by 'live ivory, to show the space  
Of a pale forehead, and two eyes that shed  
A soft blue mist, breathing a bloomy grace  
Over their sleepy lids—and so she rais'd  
Her *aqualine* nose above the stream, and gazed.

She oped her lips—lips of a gentle blush,  
So pale it seem'd near drowned to a white,—  
She oped her lips, and forth there sprang a gush  
Of music bubbling through the surface light;  
The leaves are motionless, the breezes hush  
To listen to the air—and through the night  
There come these words of a most plaintive ditty,  
Sobbing as they would break all hearts with pity.

sobbing as they would break all hearts with pity.

THE WATER PERI'S SONG.

Farewell, farewell, to my mother's own daughter,  
The child that she wet-nursed is lapp'd in the wave;  
The *Mussul*-man coming to fish in this water,  
Adds a tear to the flood that weeps over her grave.

This sack is her coffin, this water's her bier,  
This greyish *bath* cloak is her funeral pall;  
And, stranger, O stranger! this song that you hear  
Is her epitaph, elegy, dirges, and all!

Farewell, farewell, to the child of Al Hassan,  
My mother's own daughter—the last of her race—  
She's a corpse, the poor body! and lies in this basin,  
And sleeps in the water that washes her face.

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# FAITHLESS NELLY GRAY.

## A PATHETIC BALLAD.

### I.

EN BATTLE was a soldier bold,  
And used to war's alarms:  
But a cannon-ball took off his legs,  
So he laid down his arms!

### II.

Now as they bore him off the field,  
Said he, "Let others shoot,  
For here I leave my second leg,  
And the Forty-second Foot!"

### III.

The army-surgeons made him limbs:  
Said he,—“They’re only pegs:  
But there’s as wooden members quite,  
As represent my legs!”

### IV.

Now Ben he loved a pretty maid,  
Her name was Nelly Gray;  
So he went to pay her his devours,  
When he’d devoured his pay!

### V.

But when he called on Nelly Gray,  
She made him quite a scoff;  
And when she saw his wooden legs,  
Began to take them off!

VI.

“O, Nelly Gray! O, Nelly Gray!  
Is this your love so warm?  
The love that loves a scarlet coat,  
Should be more uniform!”

VII.

Said she, “I loved a soldier once,  
For he was blythe and brave;  
But I will never have a man  
With both legs in the grave!

VIII.

“Before you had those timber toes,  
Your love I did allow,  
But then, you know, you stand upon  
Another footing now!”

IX.

“O, Nelly Gray! O, Nelly Gray!  
For all your jeering speeches,  
At duty’s call, I left my legs  
In Badajos’s *breaches*!”

X.

“Why, then,” said she, “you’ve lost the feet  
Of legs in war’s alarms,  
And now you cannot wear your shoes  
Upon your feats of arms!”

XI.

“O, false and fickle Nelly Gray!  
I know why you refuse:  
Though I’ve no feet—some other man  
Is standing in my shoes!

XII.

“I wish I ne’er had seen your face;  
But, now, a long farewell!  
For you will be my death;—alas!  
You will not be my *Nell*!”

XIII.

Now when he went from Nelly Gray,  
His heart so heavy got—  
And life was such a burthen grown,  
It made him take a knot!

XIV.

So round his melancholy neck,  
A rope he did entwine,  
And, for his second time in life,  
Enlisted in the Line!

XV.

One end he tied around a beam,  
And then removed his pegs,  
And, as his legs were off,—of course,  
He soon was off his legs!

XVI.

And there he hung, till he was dead  
As any nail in town,—  
For though distress had cut him up,  
It could not cut him down!

XVII.

A dozen men sat on his corpse,  
To find out why he died—  
And they buried Ben in four cross-roads,  
With a *stake* in his inside!

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## THE SEA-SPELL.

*“Cauld, cauld, he lies beneath the deep.”  
Old Scotch Ballad.*

### I.

T was a jolly mariner!  
The tallest man of three,—  
He loosed his sail against the wind,  
And turned his boat to sea:  
The ink-black sky told every eye,  
A storm was soon to be!

### II.

But still that jolly mariner  
Took in no reef at all,  
For, in his pouch, confidingly,  
He wore a baby's caul;  
A thing, as gossip-nurses know,  
That always brings a squall!

### III.

His hat was new, or, newly glazed,  
Shone brightly in the sun;  
His jacket, like a mariner's,  
True blue as e'er was spun;  
His ample trowsers, like Saint Paul,  
Bore forty stripes save one.

### IV.

And now the fretting foaming tide  
He steer'd away to cross;  
The bounding pinnacle play'd a game  
Of dreary pitch and toss;  
A game that, on the good dry land,  
Is apt to bring a loss!

V.

Good Heaven befriend that little boat,  
And guide her on her way!  
A boat, they say, has canvas wings,  
But cannot fly away!  
Though, like a merry singing-bird,  
She sits upon the spray!

VI.

Still east by south the little boat,  
With tawny sail, kept beating:  
Now out of sight, between two waves,  
Now o'er th' horizon fleeting:  
Like greedy swine that feed on mast,—  
The waves her mast seem'd eating!

VII.

The sullen sky grew black above,  
The wave as black beneath;  
Each roaring billow show'd full soon  
A white and foamy wreath;  
Like angry dogs that snarl at first,  
And then display their teeth.

VIII.

The boatman looked against the wind,  
The mast began to creak,  
The wave, per saltum, came and dried,  
In salt, upon his cheek!  
The pointed wave against him rear'd,  
As if it own'd a pique!

IX.

Nor rushing wind, nor gushing wave,  
That boatman could alarm,  
But still he stood away to sea,  
And trusted in his charm;  
He thought by purchase he was safe,  
And arm'd against all harm!

X.

Now thick and fast and far aslant,  
The stormy rain came pouring,  
He heard, upon the sandy bank,  
The distant breakers roaring,—  
A groaning intermitting sound,  
Like Gog and Magog snoring!

XI.

The sea-fowl shriek'd around the mast,  
Ahead the grampus tumbled,  
And far off, from a copper cloud,  
The hollow thunder rumbled;  
It would have quail'd another heart,  
But his was never humbled.

XII.

For why? he had that infant's caul;  
And wherefore should he dread?  
Alas! alas! he little thought,  
Before the ebb-tide sped,—  
That like that infant, he should die,  
And with a watery head!

XIII.

The rushing brine flow'd in apace;  
His boat had ne'er a deck;  
Fate seem'd to call him on, and he  
Attended to her beck;  
And so he went, still trusting on,  
Though reckless—to his wreck!

XIV.

For as he left his helm, to heave  
The ballast-bags a-weather,  
Three monstrous seas came roaring on,  
Like lions leagued together.  
The two first waves the little boat  
Swam over like a feather.—

XV.

The two first waves were past and gone,  
And sinking in her wake;  
The hugest still came leaping on,  
And hissing like a snake;  
Now helm a-lee! for through the midst,  
The monster he must take!

XVI.

Ah, me! it was a dreary mount!  
Its base as black as night,  
Its top of pale and livid green,  
Its crest of awful white,  
Like Neptune with a leprosy,—  
And so it rear'd upright!

XVII.

With quaking sails, the little boat  
Climb'd up the foaming heap;  
With quaking sails it paused awhile;  
At balance on the steep;  
Then rushing down the nether slope,  
Plunged with a dizzy sweep!

XVIII.

Look, how a horse, made mad with fear,  
Disdains his careful guide;  
So now the headlong headstrong boat,  
Unmanaged, turns aside,  
And straight presents her reeling flank  
Against the swelling tide!

XIX.

The gusty wind assaults the sail;  
Her ballast lies a-lee!  
The sheet's to windward taught and stiff!  
Oh! the Lively—where is she?  
Her capsiz'd keel is in the foam,  
Her pennon's in the sea!

XX.

The wild gull, sailing overhead,  
Three times beheld emerge  
The head of that bold mariner,  
And then she screamed his dirge!  
For he had sunk within his grave,  
Lapp'd in a shroud of surge!

XXI.

The ensuing wave, with horrid foam,  
Rush'd o'er and cover'd all,—  
The jolly boatman's drowning scream  
Was smother'd by the squall,—  
Heaven never heard his cry, nor did  
The ocean heed his *caul*.

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## THE DEMON-SHIP.

'Twas off the Wash—the sun went down—the sea looked black and grim,  
For stormy clouds, with murky fleece, were mustering at the brim;  
Titanic shades! enormous gloom!—as if the solid night  
Of Erebus rose suddenly to seize upon the light!  
It was a time for mariners to bear a wary eye,  
With such a dark conspiracy between the sea and sky!

Down went my helm—close reef'd—the tack held freely in my hand—  
With ballast snug—I put about, and scudded for the land.  
Loud hiss'd the sea beneath her lee—my little boat flew fast,  
But faster still the rushing storm came borne upon the blast.  
Lord! what a roaring hurricane beset the straining sail!  
What furious sleet, with level drift, and fierce assaults of hail!  
What darksome caverns yawn'd before! what jagged steeps behind!  
Like battle-steeds, with foamy manes, wild tossing in the wind.  
Each after each sank down astern, exhausted in the chase,  
But where it sank another rose and gallop'd in its place;  
As black as night—they turned to white, and cast against the cloud  
A snowy sheet, as if each surge upturn'd a sailor's shroud:—  
Still flew my boat; alas! alas! her course was nearly run!  
Behold yon fatal billow rise—ten billows heap'd in one!  
With fearful speed the dreary mass came rolling, rolling, fast,  
As if the scooping sea contain'd one only wave at last!  
Still on it came, with horrid roar, a swift pursuing grave;  
It seem'd as though some cloud had turned its hugeness to a wave!  
Its briny sleet began to beat beforehand in my face—  
I felt the rearward keel begin to climb its swelling base!  
I saw its alpine hoary head impending over mine!  
Another pulse—and down it rush'd—an avalanche of brine!  
Brief pause had I, on God to cry, or think of wife and home;  
The waters closed—and when I shriek'd, I shriek'd below the  
foam!  
Beyond that rush I have no hint of any after deed—  
For I was tossing on the waste, as senseless as a weed.

\* \* \* \* \*

“Where am I? in the breathing world, or in the world of death?”  
With sharp and sudden pang I drew another birth of breath;



My eyes drank in a doubtful light, my ears a doubtful sound—  
And was that ship a *real* ship whose tackle seem'd around?  
A moon, as if the earthly moor, was shining up aloft;  
But were those beams the very beams that I had seen so oft?  
A face, that mock'd the human face, before me watch'd alone;  
But were those eyes the eyes of man that look'd against my own?

Oh! never may the moon again disclose me such a sight  
As met my gaze, when first I look'd, on that accursed night!  
I've seen a thousand horrid shapes begot of fierce extremes  
Of fever; and most frightful things have haunted in my dreams—  
Hyenas—cats—blood-loving bats and apes with hateful stare—  
Pernicious snakes, and shaggy bulls—the lion, and she-bear—  
Strong enemies, with Judas looks, of treachery and spite—  
Detested features, hardly dimm'd and banish'd by the light!  
Pale-sheeted ghosts, with gory locks, upstarting from their tombs—  
All phantasies and images that flit in midnight glooms—  
Hags, goblins, demons, lemures, have made me all aghast,—  
But nothing like that GRIMLY ONE who stood beside the mast!

His cheek was black—his brow was black—his eyes and hair as dark:  
His hand was black, and where it touch'd, it left a sable mark;  
His throat was black, his vest the same, and when I look'd beneath,  
His breast was black—all, all was black, except his grinning teeth.  
His sooty crew were like in hue, as black as Afric slaves!  
Oh, horror! e'en the ship was black that plough'd the inky waves!

“Alas!” I cried, “for love of truth and blessed mercy's sake,  
Where am I? in what dreadful ship? upon what dreadful lake?  
What shape is that, so very grim, and black as any coal?  
It is Mahound, the Evil One, and he has gained my soul!  
Oh, mother dear! my tender nurse! dear meadows that beguil'd  
My happy days, when I was yet a little sinless child,—  
My mother dear—my native fields, I never more shall see:  
I'm sailing in the Devil's Ship, upon the Devil's Sea!”

Loud laugh'd that SABLE MARINER, and loudly in return  
His sooty crew sent forth a laugh that rang from stem to stern—

A dozen pair of grimly cheeks were crumpled on the nonce—  
As many sets of grinning teeth came shining out at once:  
A dozen gloomy shapes at once enjoy'd the merry fit,  
With shriek and yell, and oaths as well, like Demons of the Pit.  
They crow'd their fill, and then the Chief made answer for the whole;—  
“Our skins,” said he, “are black ye see, because we carry coal;  
You'll find your mother sure enough, and see your native fields—  
For this here ship has pick'd you up—the Mary Ann of Shields!”

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# MARY'S GHOST.

## A PATHETIC BALLAD.

### I.

'Twas in the middle of the night,  
To sleep young William tried,—  
When Mary's ghost came stealing in,  
And stood at his bed-side.

### II.

O William dear! O William dear!  
My rest eternal ceases;  
Alas! my everlasting peace  
Is broken into pieces.

### III.

I thought the last of all my cares  
Would end with my last minute;  
But tho' I went to my long home,  
I didn't stay long in it.

### IV.

The body-snatchers they have come,  
And made a snatch at me;  
It's very hard them kind of men  
Won't let a body be!

### V.

You thought that I was buried deep,  
Quite decent like and chary,  
But from her grave in Mary-bone  
They've come and bon'd your Mary.

VI.

The arm that used to take your arm  
Is took to Dr. Vyse;  
And both my legs are gone to walk  
The hospital at Guy's.

VII.

I vow'd that you should have my hand,  
But fate gives us denial;  
You'll find it there, at Doctor Bell's,  
In spirits and a phial.

VIII.

As for my feet, the little feet  
You used to call so pretty,  
There's one, I know, in Bedford Row,  
The t'other's in the city.

IX.

I can't tell where my head is gone,  
But Dr. Carpuc can:  
As for my trunk, it's all pack'd up  
To go by Pickford's van.

X.

I wish you'd go to Mr. P.  
And save me such a ride;  
I don't half like the outside place,  
They've took for my inside.

XI.

The cock it crows—I must be gone!  
My William, we must part!  
But I'll be your's in death, altho'  
Sir Astley has my heart.

XII.

Don't go to weep upon my grave,  
And think that there I be;  
They haven't left an atom there  
Of my anatomie.

---

## ODE TO MR. BRUNEL.

“Well said, old Mole! canst work i’ the dark so fast? a worthy pioneer!”

HAMLET.



ELL!—--Monsieur Brunel,  
How prospers now thy mighty undertaking,  
To join by a hollow way the Bankside friends  
Of Rotherhithe, and Wapping,—  
                    Never be stopping,  
But poking, groping, in the dark keep making  
An archway, underneath the Dabs and Gudgeons,  
For Collier men and pitchy old Curmudgeons,  
To cross the water in inverse proportion,  
Walk under steam-boats under the keel's ridge,  
To keep down all extortion,  
And without sculls to diddle London Bridge!  
In a fresh hunt, a new Great Bore to worry,  
Thou didst to earth thy human terriers follow,  
Hopeful at last from Middlesex to Surrey,  
    To give us the "View hollow."  
In short it was thy aim, right north and south,  
To put a pipe into old Thames's mouth;  
Alas! half-way thou hadst proceeded, when  
Old Thames, through roof, not water-proof,  
Came, like "a tide in the affairs of men;"  
And with a mighty stormy kind of roar,  
                    Reproachful of thy wrong,  
                    Burst out in that old song  
Of Incledon's, beginning "Cease, rude Bore"—  
Sad is it, worthy of one's tears,  
    Just when one seems the most successful,  
To find one's self o'er head and ears  
    In difficulties most distressful!  
Other great speculations have been nursed,  
    Till want of proceeds laid them on a shelf;  
But thy concern was at the worst,  
    When it began to *liquidate* itself!  
But now Dame Fortune has her false face hidden,  
And languishes thy Tunnel,—so to paint,  
Under a slow incurable complaint,  
                    Red-ridden!

Why, when thus Thames—bed-bother'd—why repine!  
Do try a spare bed at the Serpentine!  
Yet let none think thee daz'd, or craz'd, or stupid;  
    And sunk beneath thy own and Thames's craft;  
Let them not style thee some Mechanic Cupid  
    Pining and pouting o'er a broken shaft!  
I'll tell thee with thy tunnel what to do;  
Light up thy boxes, build a bin or two,  
The wine does better than such water trades:  
    Stick up a sign—the sign of the Bore's Head;  
    I've drawn it ready for thee in black lead,  
And make thy cellar subterrane,—Thy Shades?

---



## ANACREONTIC.

FOR THE NEW YEAR.

OME, fill up the Bowl, for if ever the glass  
Found a proper excuse or fit season,  
For toasts to be honour'd, or pledges to pass,  
Sure, this hour brings an exquisite reason:  
For hark! the last chime of the dial has ceased,  
And Old Time, who his leisure to cozen,  
Had finish'd the Months, like the flasks at a feast,  
Is preparing to tap a fresh dozen!  
Hip! Hip! and Hurrah!

Then fill, all ye Happy and Free, unto whom  
The past Year has been pleasant and sunny;  
Its months each as sweet as if made of the bloom  
Of the *thyme* whence the bee gathers honey—  
Days usher'd by dew-drops, instead of the tears,  
May be wrung from some wretcheder cousin—  
Then fill, and with gratitude join in the cheers  
That triumphantly hail a fresh dozen!  
Hip! Hip! and Hurrah!

And ye, who have met with Adversity's blast,  
And been bow'd to the earth by its fury;



THE BOTTLE IMP.



**“THE IDES OF MARCH ARE COME!”**



O whom the Twelve Months, that have recently pass'd,  
Were as harsh as a prejudiced jury,—  
Still, fill to the Future! and join in our chime,  
The regrets of remembrance to cozen,  
And having obtained a New Trial of Time,  
Shout in hopes of a kindlier dozen!  
Hip! Hip! and Hurrah!

---

## A WATERLOO BALLAD.

 O Waterloo, with sad ado,  
And many a sigh and groan,  
Amongst the dead, came Patty Head,  
To look for Peter Stone.

“O prithee tell, good sentinel,  
If I shall find him here?  
I’m come to weep upon his corse,  
My Ninety-Second dear!

“Into our town a sergeant came  
With ribands all so fine,  
A-flaunting in his cap—alas,  
His bow enlisted mine!

“They taught him how to turn his toes,  
And stand as stiff as starch;  
I thought that it was love and May,  
But it was love and March!

“A sorry March indeed to leave  
The friends he might have kep’,—  
No March of Intellect it was,  
But quite a foolish step.

“O prithee tell, good sentinel,  
If hereabout he lies?  
I want a corpse with reddish hair,  
And very sweet blue eyes.”

Her sorrow on the sentinel  
Appear’d to deeply strike:—  
“Walk in,” he said, “among the dead,  
And pick out which you like.”

And soon she pick’d out Peter Stone,  
Half turn’d into a corse;  
A cannon was his holster and

A cannon was his bolster, and  
His mattress was a horse.

“O Peter Stone, O Peter Stone,  
Lord, here has been a skirmish!  
What have they done to your poor breast,  
That used to hold my image?”

“O Patty Head, O Patty Head,  
You’ve come to my last kissing,  
Before I’m set in the Gazette  
As wounded, dead, and missing!

“Alas! a splinter of a shell  
Right in my stomach sticks;  
French mortars don’t agree so well  
With stomachs as French bricks.

“This very night a merry dance  
At Brussels was to be;—  
Instead of opening a ball,  
A ball has opened me.

“Its billet every bullet has,  
And well it does fulfil it;—  
I wish mine hadn’t come so straight,  
But been a ‘crooked billet.’

“And then there came a cuirassier  
And cut me on the chest;—  
He had no pity in his heart,  
For he had *steel’d his breast*.

“Next thing a lancer, with his lance,  
Began to thrust away;  
I call’d for quarter, but, alas!  
It was not Quarter-day.

“He ran his spear right through my arm,

Just here above the joint:—  
O Patty dear, it was no joke,  
Although it had a point.

“With loss of blood I fainted off,  
As dead as women do—  
But soon by charging over me,  
The *Coldstream* brought me to.

With kicks and cuts, and batts and blows,  
I throb and ache all over;  
I’m quite convinc’d the field of Mars  
Is not a field of clover!

“O why did I a soldier turn  
For any royal Guelph?  
I might have been a butcher, and  
In business for myself!

“O why did I the bounty take  
(And here he gasp’d for breath)  
My shillingsworth of ‘list is nail’d  
Upon the door of death!

“Without a coffin I shall lie  
And sleep my sleep eternal:  
Not ev’n a *shell*—my only chance  
Of being made a *Kernel*!

“O Patty dear, our wedding bells  
Will never ring at Chester!  
Here I must lie in Honour’s bed,  
That isn’t worth a *tester*!

“Farewell, my regimental mates,  
With whom I used to dress!  
My corps is changed, and I am now  
In quite another mess.

“Farewell, my Patty dear, I have  
No dying consolations,  
Except, when I am dead, you’ll go  
And see th’ Illuminations.”

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COCKLE v. CACKLE.



HOSE who much read advertisements and bills  
Must have seen puffs of Cockle's Pills,  
Call'd Anti-bilious—  
Which some Physicians sneer at, supercilious,  
But which we are assured, if timely taken,  
May save your liver and bacon;  
Whether or not they really give one ease,  
I, who have never tried,  
Will not decide;  
But no two things in union go like these—  
Viz.—Quacks and Pills—save Ducks and Pease.  
Now Mrs. W. was getting sallow,  
Her lilies not of the white kind, but yellow,  
And friends portended was preparing for  
A human Pâté Périgord;  
She was, indeed, so very far from well,  
Her Son, in filial fear, procured a box  
Of those said pellets to resist Bile's shocks,  
And—tho' upon the ear it strangely knocks—  
To save her by a Cockle from a shell!  
But Mrs. W., just like Macbeth,  
Who very vehemently bids us “throw  
Bark to the Bow-wows,” hated physic so,  
It seem'd to share “the bitterness of Death:”  
Rhubarb—Magnesia—Jalap, and the kind—  
Senna—Steel—Assa-fœtida, and Squills—  
Powder or Draught—but least her throat inclined  
To give a course to Boluses or Pills;  
No—not to save her life, in lung or lobe,  
For all her lights' or all her liver's sake,  
Would her convulsive thorax undertake,  
Only one little uncelestial globe!  
'Tis not to wonder at, in such a case,  
If she put by the pill-box in a place  
For linen rather than for drugs intended—  
Yet for the credit of the pills let's say  
After they thus were stow'd away

After they had were stow'd away,  
Some of the linen mended;  
But Mrs. W. by disease's dint.  
Kept getting still more yellow in her tint,  
When lo! her second son, like elder brother,  
Marking the hue on the parental gills,  
Brought a new charge of Anti-tumeric Pills,  
To bleach the jaundiced visage of his Mother—  
Who took them—in her cupboard—like the other.

“Deeper and deeper, still,” of course,  
The fatal colour daily grew in force;  
Till daughter W. newly come from Rome,  
Acting the self-same filial, pillial, part,  
To cure Mamma, another dose brought home  
Of Cockle's;—not the Cockles of her heart!  
These going where the others went before,  
Of course she had a very pretty store;  
And then—some hue of health her cheek adorning,  
The Medicine so good must be,  
They brought her dose on dose, when she  
Gave to the up-stairs cupboard, “night and morning.”  
Till wanting room at last, for other stocks,  
Out of the window one fine day she pitch'd  
The pillage of each box, and quite enrich'd  
The feed of Mister Burrell's hens and cocks,—  
A little Barber of a by-gone day,  
Over the way,  
Whose stock in trade, to keep the least of shops,  
Was one great head of Kemble,—that is, John,  
Staring in plaster, with a *Brutus* on,  
And twenty little Bantam fowls—with *crops*.  
Little Dame W. thought when through the sash  
She gave the physic wings,  
To find the very things  
So good for bile, so bad for chicken rash,  
For thoughtless cock, and unreflecting pullet!  
But while they gather'd up the nauseous nubbles,  
Each and all of them—

Each peck'd itself into a peck of troubles,  
And brought the hand of Death upon its gullet.  
They might as well have addled been, or ratted,  
For long before the night—ah woe betide  
The Pills! each suicidal Bantam died  
Unfatted!

Think of poor Burrell's shock,  
Of Nature's debt to see his hens all payers,  
And laid in death as Everlasting Layers,  
With Bantam's small Ex-Emperor, the Cock,  
In ruffled plumage and funereal hackle,  
Giving, undone by Cockle, a last Cackle!  
To see as stiff as stone, his un'live stock,  
It really was enough to move his block.  
Down on the floor he dash'd, with horror big,  
Mr. Beh's third wife's mother's coachman's wig;  
And with a tragic stare like his own Kemble,  
Burst out with natural emphasis enough,  
And voice that grief made tremble,  
Into that very speech of sad Macduff—  
“What!—all my pretty chickens and their dam,  
At one fell swoop!—  
Just when I'd bought a coop  
To see the poor lamented creatures cram!

After a little of this mood,  
And brooding over the departed brood,  
With razor he began to ope each craw,  
Already turning black, as black as coals;  
When lo! the undigested cause he saw—  
“Pison'd by goles!”

To Mrs. W.'s luck a contradiction,  
Her window still stood open to conviction;  
And by short course of circumstantial labour,  
He fixed the guilt upon his adverse neighbour;—  
Lord! how he rail'd at her: declaring now,

He'd bring an action ere next term of Hilary,  
Then, in another moment, swore a vow,  
He'd make her do pill-penance in the pillory!  
She, meanwhile distant from the dimmest dream  
Of combating with guilt, yard-arm or arm-yard,  
Lapp'd in a paradise of tea and cream;  
When up ran Betty with a dismal scream—  
“Here's Mr. Burrell, ma'am, with all his farm-yard!”  
Straight in he came, unbowing and unbending,  
    With all the warmth that iron and a barber  
        Can harbour;  
To dress the head and front of her offending,  
The fuming phial of his wrath uncorking;  
In short, he made her pay him altogether,  
In hard cash, very *hard*, for ev'ry feather,  
Charging of course, each Bantam as a Dorking;  
Nothing could move him, nothing made him supple,  
So the sad dame unpocketing her loss,  
Had nothing left but to sit hands across,  
And see her poultry “going down ten couple.”

Now birds by poison slain,  
As venom'd dart from Indian's hollow cane,  
Are edible; and Mrs. W.'s thrift,—  
She had a thrifty vein—  
Destined one pair for supper to make shift,—  
Supper as usual at the hour of ten:  
But ten o'clock arrived and quickly pass'd,  
Eleven—twelve—and one o'clock at last,  
Without a sign of supper even then!  
At length the speed of cookery to quicken,  
Betty was call'd, and with reluctant feet,  
    Came up at a white heat—  
“Well, never I see chicken like them chickens!  
My saucepans, they have been a pretty while in 'em!  
Enough to stew them, if it comes to that,  
To flesh and bones, and perfect rags; but drat  
Those Anti-biling Pills! there is no bile in 'em!”



PLAYING AT SOLDIERS.

“WHO’LL SERVE THE KING?”

AN ILLUSTRATION.



HAT little urchin is there never  
Hath had that early scarlet fever,  
Of martial trappings caught?  
Trappings well call'd—because they trap  
And catch full many a country chap  
To go where fields are fought!

What little urchin with a rag  
Hath never made a little flag,  
(Our plate will show the manner,)  
And wooed each tiny neighbour still,  
Tommy or Harry, Dick or Will,  
To come beneath the banner!

Just like that ancient shape of mist,  
In Hamlet, crying, “ ’List, O ‘list!”  
Come, who will serve the king,  
And strike frog-eating Frenchmen dead,  
And cut off Boneyparty’s head?—  
And all that sort of thing.

So used I, when I was a boy,  
To march with military toy,  
And ape the soldier’s life;—  
And with a whistle or a hum,  
I thought myself a Duke of Drum  
At least, or Earl of Fife.

With gun of tin and sword of lath,  
Lord! how I walk’d in glory’s path  
With regimental mates,  
By sound of trump and rub-a-dubs—  
To ‘siege the washhouse—charge the tubs—  
Or storm the garden gates.

Ah me! my retrospective soul!  
As over memory’s muster-roll



I cast my eyes anew,  
My former comrades all the while  
Rise up before me, rank and file,  
And form in dim review.

Ay, there they stand, and dress in line,  
Lubbock, and Fenn, and David Vine,  
And dark “Jamaeky Forde!”  
And limping Wood, and “Cockey Hawes,”  
Our captain always made, because  
He had a *real* sword!

Long Lawrence, Natty Smart, and Soame,  
Who said he had a gun at home,  
But that was all a brag;  
Ned Ryder, too, that used to sham  
A prancing horse, and big Sam Lamb  
That *would* hold up the flag!

Tom Anderson, and “Dunny White,”  
Who never right-abouted right,  
For he was deaf and dumb;  
Jack Pike, Jem Crack, and Sandy Gray,  
And Dickey Bird, that wouldn’t play  
Unless he had the drum.

And Peter Holt, and Charley Jepp,  
A chap that never kept the step—  
No more did “Surly Hugh;”  
Bob Harrington, and “Fighting Jim”—  
We often had to halt for him,  
To let him tie his shoe.

“Quarrelsome Scott,” and Martin Dick,  
That kill’d the bantam cock, to stick  
The plumes within his hat;  
Bill Hook, and little Tommy Grout  
That got so thump’d for calling out  
“Eyes right!” to “Squinting Matt”

Eyes right: to Squinting Matt.

Dan Simpson, that, with Peter Dodd,  
Was always in the awkward squad,  
And those two greedy Blakes,  
That took our money to the fair  
To buy the corps a trumpet there,  
And laid it out in cakes.

Where are they now?—an open war  
With open mouth declaring for?—  
Or fall'n in bloody fray?  
Compell'd to tell the truth I am,  
Their fights all ended with the sham,—  
Their soldiership in play.

Brave Soame sends cheeses out in trucks,  
And Martin sells the cock he plucks,  
And Jepp now deals in wine;  
Harrington bears a lawyer's bag,  
And warlike Lamb retains his flag,  
But on a tavern sign.

They tell me Cocky Hawes's sword  
Is seen upon a broker's board:  
And as for "Fighting Jim,"  
In Bishopgate, last Whitsuntide,  
His unresisting cheek I spied  
Beneath a quaker brim!

Quarrelsome Scott is in the church,  
For Ryder now your eye must search  
The marts of silk and lace—  
Bird's drums are filled with figs, and mute,  
And I—I've got a substitute  
To Soldier in my place!

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## “NAPOLEON’S MIDNIGHT REVIEW.”

A NEW VERSION.

**I**N his bed, bolt upright,  
In the dead of the night,  
The French Emperor starts like a ghost!



**FANCY PORTRAIT: THE DUKE  
OF WELL—— AND PRINCE OF  
WATER—.**



WETHER WISE.

By a dream held in charm,  
He uplifts his right arm,  
For he dreams of reviewing his host.

To the stable he glides,  
For the charger he rides;  
And he mounts him, still under the spell;  
Then, with echoing tramp,  
They proceed through the camp,  
All intent on a task he loves well.

Such a sight soon alarms,  
And the guards present arms,  
As he glides to the posts that they keep;  
Then he gives the brief word,  
And the bugle is heard,  
Like a hound giving tongue in its sleep.

Next the drums they arouse,  
But with dull row-de-dows,  
And they give but a somnolent sound;  
Whilst the foot and horse, both,  
Very slowly and loth,  
Begin drowsily mustering round.

To the right and left hand,  
They fall in, by command,  
In a line that might better be dress'd;  
Whilst the steeds blink and nod,  
And the lancers think odd  
To be rous'd like the spears from their rest.

With their mouths of wide shape,  
Mortars seem all agape,  
Heavy guns look more heavy with sleep;  
And, whatever their bore,  
Seem to think it one more

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in the night such a field day to keep.

Then the arms, christened small
Fire no volley at all,
But go off, like the rest, in a doze;
And the eagles, poor things,
Tuck their heads 'neath their wings,
And the band ends in tunes through the nose.

Till each pupil of Mars
Takes a wink like the stars—
Open order no eye can obey!
If the plumes in their heads
Were the feathers of beds,
Never top could be sounder than they!

So, just wishing good night,
Bows Napoleon, polite;
But instead of a loyal endeavour
To reply with a cheer;
Not a sound met his ear,
Though each face seem'd to say, "*Nap* for ever!"

ODE TO DR. KITCHENER.

 Muses nine inspire
And stir up my poetic fire;
Teach my burning soul to speak
With a bubble and a squeak!
Of Dr. Kitchener I fain would sing,
Till pots, and pans, and mighty kettles ring.

O culinary sage!
(I do not mean the herb in use,
That always goes along with goose)
How have I feasted on thy page:
“When like a lobster boil’d the morn
From black to red began to turn,”
Till midnight, when I went to bed,
And clapt my tewah-diddle on my head.

Who is there cannot tell,
Thou ledest a life of living well?
“What baron, or squire, or knight of the shire
Lives half so well as a holy Fry—er?”
In doing well thou must be reckon’d
The first,—and Mrs. Fry the second;
And twice a Job,—for, in thy fev’rish toils,
Thou wast all over roasts—as well as boils.

Thou wast indeed no dunce,
To treat thy subjects and thyself at once:
Many a hungry poet eats
His brains like thee,
But few there be
Could live so long on their receipts.
What living soul or sinner
Would slight thy invitation to a dinner,
Ought with the Danaides to dwell,
Draw gravy in a cullender, and hear
For ever in his ear
The pleasant tinkling of thy dinner bell.

Immortal Kitchener! thy fame
Shall keep itself when Time makes game
Of other men's—yea, it shall keep, all weathers,
And thou shalt be upheld by thy pen feathers.
Yea, by the sauce of Michael Kelly!
Thy name shall perish never,
But be magnified for ever—
—By all whose eyes are bigger than their belly.
Yea, till the world is done—
—To a turn—and Time puts out the sun,
Shall live the endless echo of thy name.
But, as for thy more fleshy frame,
Ah! Death's carnivorous teeth will tittle
Thee out of breath, and eat it for cold victual;
But still thy fame shall be among the nations
Preserved to the last course of generations.

Ah me, my soul is touch'd with sorrow!
To think how flesh must pass away—
So mutton, that is warm to-day,
Is cold, and turn'd to hashes, on the morrow!
Farewell! I would say more, but I
Have other fish to fry.

THE CIGAR.

OME sigh for this and that;
My wishes don't go far;
The world may wag at will,
So I have my cigar.

Some fret themselves to death
With Whig and Tory jar,
I don't care which is in,
So I have my cigar.

Sir John requests my vote,
And so does Mr. Marr;
I don't care how it goes,
So I have my cigar.

Some want a German row,
Some wish a Russian war;
I care not—I'm at peace,
So I have my cigar.

I never see the Post,
I seldom read the Star;
The Globe I scarcely heed,
So I have my cigar.

They tell me that Bank Stock
Is sunk much under par;
It's all the same to me,
So I have my cigar.

Honours have come to men
My juniors at the Bar;
No matter—I can wait,
So I have my cigar.

Ambition frets me not;
A cab or glory's car
Are just the same to me

Are just the same to me,
So I have my cigar.

I worship no vain gods,
But serve the household Lar;
I'm sure to be at home,
So I have my cigar.

I do not seek for fame,
A General with a scar;
A private let me be,
So I have my cigar.

To have my choice among
The toys of life's bazaar,
The deuce may take them all
So I have my cigar.

Some minds are often tost
By tempests like a tar;
I always seem in port,
So I have my cigar.

The ardent flame of love
My bosom cannot char,
I smoke, but do not burn,
So I have my cigar.

They tell me Nancy Low
Has married Mr. R.;
The jilt! but I can live,
So I have my cigar.

AN ANCIENT CONCERT.

BY A VENERABLE DIRECTOR.

“Give me *old* music—let me hear
The songs of *days* gone by!”—H. F. CHORLEY.



H! come, all ye who love to hear
An ancient song in ancient taste,
To whom all by-gone Music's dear
As verdant spots in Memory's waste!
Its name "The Ancient Concert" wrongs,
And has not hit the proper clef,
To wit, Old Folks, to sing Old Songs,
To Old Subscribers rather deaf.

Away, then, Hawes! with all your band;
Ye beardless boys, this room desert!
One youthful voice, or youthful hand,
Our concert-pitch would disconcert!
No bird must join our "vocal throng,"
The present age beheld at font:
Away, then, all ye "Sons of Song,"
Your Fathers are the men we want!

Away, Miss Birch, you're in your prime!
Miss Romer, seek some other door!
Go, Mrs. Shaw! till, counting time,
You count you're nearly fifty-four!
Go, Miss Novello, sadly young!
Go, thou composing Chevalier,
And roam the county towns among,
No Newcome will be welcome here!

Our Concert aims to give at *night*
The music that has had its *day*!
So, Rooke, for us you cannot write
Till time has made you Raven gray.
Your score may charm a modern ear,
Nay, ours, when three or fourscore old,
But in this Ancient atmosphere,
Fresh airs like yours would give us cold!

Go, Hawes, and Cawse, and Woodyat, go!

Hence, Shirreff, with those native curls;
And Master Coward ought to know
This is no place for boys and girls!
No Massons here we wish to see;
Nor is it Mrs. Seguin's sphere,
And Mrs. B——! Oh! Mrs. B——,
Such Bishops are not reverend here!

What! Grisi, bright and beaming thus!
To sing the songs gone gray with age!
No, Grisi, no,—but come to us
And welcome, when you leave the stage!
Off, Ivanhoff!—till weak and harsh!—
Rubini, hence! with all the clan!
But come, Lablache, years hence, Lablache,
A little shrivell'd thin old man.

Go, Mr. Phillips, where you please!
Away, Tom Cooke, and all your batch;
You'd run us out of breath with Glees,
And Catches that we could not catch.
Away, ye Leaders all, who lead
With violins, quite modern things;
To guide our Ancient band we need
Old fiddles out of leading strings!

But come, ye Songsters, over ripe,
That into "childish trebles break!"
And bring, Miss Winter, bring the pipe
That cannot sing without a shake!
Nay, come, ye Spinsters all, that spin
A slender thread of ancient voice,
Old notes that almost seem call'd in;
At such as you we *shall* rejoice!

No thund'ring Thalbergs here shall balk,
Or ride your pet *D-cadence* o'er,
But fingers with a little chalk

Shall, moderato, keep the score!
No Broadwoods here, so full of tone,
But Harpsichords assist the strain:
No Lincoln's pipes, we have our own
Bird-Organ, built by Tubal-Cain.

And welcome! St. Cecilians, now
Ye willy-nilly, ex-good fellows,
Who will strike up, no matter how,
With organs that survive their bellows!
And bring, oh bring, your ancient styles
In which our elders lov'd to roam,
Those flourishes that strayed for miles,
Till some good fiddle led them home!
Oh come, ye ancient London Cries,
When Christmas Carols erst were sung!
Come, Nurse, who dron'd the lullabies,
"When Music, heavenly Maid, was young!"
No matter how the critics treat,
What modern sins and faults detect,
The Copy-Book shall still repeat,
These Concerts must "Command respect!"

“We was both, Ma’am, in the wash-house, Ma’am, a-standing at our tubs,
And Mrs. Round was seconding what little things I rubs;
‘Mary,’ says she to me, ‘I say’—and there she stops for coughin’,
‘That dratted copper flue has took to smokin’ very often,
But please the pigs,’—for that’s her way of swearing in a passion,
‘I’ll blow it up, and not be set a-coughin’ in this fashion!’
Well, down she takes my master’s horn—I mean his horn for loading,
And empties every grain alive for to set the flue exploding.
Lawk, Mrs. Round! says I, and stares, that quantum is improper.
I’m sartin sure it can’t not take a pound to sky a copper;
You’ll powder both our heads off, so I tells you, with its puff,
But she only dried her fingers, and she takes a pinch of snuff.
Well, when the pinch is over—‘Teach your grandmother to suck
A powder horn,’ says she—Well, says I, I wish you luck.
Them words sets up her back, so with her hands upon her hips,
‘Come,’ says she, quite in a huff, ‘come, keep your tongue inside your lips;
Afore ever you was born, I was well used to things like these
I shall put it in the grate, and let it burn up by degrees.
So in it goes, and Bounce—O Lord! it gives us such a rattle,
I thought we both were canonised, like Sogers in a battle!
Up goes the copper like a squib, and us on both our backs,
And bless the tubs, they bundled off, and split all into cracks.
Well, there I fainted dead away, and might have been cut shorter,
But Providence was kind, and brought me to with scalding water.
I first looks round for Mrs. Round, and sees her at a distance,
As stiff as starch, and looked as dead as any thing in existence;
All scorched and grimed, and more than that, I sees the copper slap
Right on her head, for all the world like a percussion copper cap.
Well, I crooks her little fingers, and crumps them well up together,
As humanity pints out, and burnt her nostrums with a feather;
But for all as I can do, to restore her to her mortality,
She never gives a sign of a return to sensuality,
Thinks I, well there she lies, as dead as my own late departed mother.
Well, she’ll wash no more in this world, whatever she does in t’other.
So I gives myself to scramble up the linens for a minute,
Lawk, sich a shirt! thinks I, it’s well my master wasn’t in it;
Oh! I never. never. never. never. never see a sight so shockin’:

Oh! I never, never, never, never, never see a sight so shocking,
Here lays a leg, and there a leg—I mean, you know, a stocking—
Bodies all slit and torn to rags, and many a tattered skirt,
And arms burnt off, and sides and backs all scotched and black with dirt;
But as nobody was in 'em—none but—nobody was hurt!
Well, there I am, a-scrambling up the things, all in a lump,
When, mercy on us! such a groan as makes my heart to jump.
And there she is, a-lying with a crazy sort of eye,
A-staring at the wash-house roof, laid open to the sky:
Then she beckons with her finger, and so down to her I reaches,
And puts my ear agin her mouth to hear her dying speeches,
For, poor soul! she has a husband and young orphans, as I knew;
Well, Ma'am, you won't believe it, but it's Gospel fact and true,
But these words is all she whispered—'Why, where *is* the powder blew!' ”

THE LAST WISH.



HEN I resign this world so briary,
To have across the Styx my ferrying,
Oh, may I die without a DIARY!
And be interr'd without a Bury-ing!

The poor dear dead have been laid out in vain,
Turn'd into cash, they are laid out again!

THE DEVIL'S ALBUM.

 will seem an odd whim
For a spirit so grim
As the Devil to take a delight in;
But by common renown
He has come up to town,
With an Album for people to write in!

On a handsomer book
Mortal never did look;
Of a flame-colour silk is the binding!
With a border superb,
Where through flow'ret and herb,
The old serpent goes brilliantly winding!

By gilded grotesques,
And emboss'd arabesques,
The whole cover, in fact, is pervaded;
But, alas! in a taste
That betrays they were traced
At the will of a Spirit degraded!

As for paper—the best,
But extremely hot-pressed,
Courts the pen to luxuriate upon it,
And against ev'ry blank
There's a note on the Bank,
As a bribe for a sketch or a sonnet.

Who will care to appear
In the Fiend's Souvenir,
Is a question to mortals most vital;
But the very first leaf,
It's the public belief,
Will be filled by a Lady of Title!

A VALENTINE.

THE WEATHER. TO P. MURPHY, ESQ., M.N.S.

These, properly speaking, being esteemed the three arms of Meteoric action.



DEAR Murphy, to improve her charms,
Your servant humbly begs;
She thanks you for her leash of arms,
But wants a brace of legs.

Moreover, as you promise folks
On certain days a drizzle;
She thinks, in case she cannot rain,
She should have means to *mizzle*.

Some lightning too may just fall due,
When woods begin to moult;
And if she cannot "fork it out,"
She'll wish to make a *bolt*!

CONVEYANCING.



O H, London is the place for all
In love with loco-motion!
Still to and fro the people go
Like billows of the ocean;
Machine or man, or caravan,
Can all be had for paying,
When great estates, or heavy weights,
Or bodies want conveying.

There's always hacks about in packs,
Wherein you may be shaken,
And Jarvis is not always *drunk*,
Tho' always *overtaken*;
In racing tricks he'll never mix,
His nags are in their last days,
And *slow* to go, altho' they show
As if they had their *fast days*!

Then if you like a single horse,
This age is quite a *cab-age*,
A car not quite so small and light
As those of our Queen *Mab* age;
The horses have been *broken well*,
All danger is rescinded,
For some have *broken both their knees*,
And some are *broken winded*.

If you've a friend at Chelsea end,
The stages are worth knowing—
There is a sort, we call 'em short,
Although the longest going—
For some will stop at Hatchett's shop
Till you grow faint and sicky,
Perched up behind, at last to find
Your dinner is all *dickey*!

Long stages run from every yard;

But if you're wise and frugal,
You'll never go with any Guard
That plays upon the bugle,
"Ye banks and braes," and other lays,
And ditties everlasting,
Like miners going all your way,
With *boring* and with *blasting*.

Instead of *journeys*, people now
May go upon a *Gurney*,
With steam to do the horses' work,
By *powers of attorney*;
Tho' with a load it may explode,
And you may all be *un-done*!
And find you're going *up to Heav'n*
Instead of *up to London*!

To speak of every kind of coach,
It is not my intention;
But there is still one vehicle
Deserves a little mention;
The world a sage has call'd a stage,
With all its living lumber,
And Malthus swears it always bears
Above the proper number.

The law will transfer house or land
For ever and a day hence,
For lighter things, watch, brooches, rings,
You'll never want conveyance:
Ho! stop the thief! my handkerchief!
It is no sight for laughter—
Away it goes, and leaves my nose
To join in running after.

THE ANGLER'S FAREWELL.

“Resign’d, I kissed the rod.”



WELL! I think it is time to put up!
For it does not accord with my notions,
Wrist, elbow, and chine,
Stiff from throwing the line,
To take nothing at last by my motions!

I ground-bait my way as I go,
And dip in at each watery dimple;
But however I wish
To inveigle the fish,
To my *gentle* they will not play *simple*!

Though my float goes so swimmingly on,
My bad luck never seems to diminish;
It would seem that the Bream
Must be scarce in the stream,
And the *Chub*, tho' it's chubby, be *thinnish*!

Not a Trout there can be in the place,
Not a Grayling or Rud worth the mention,
And although at my hook
With *attention* I look,
I can ne'er see my hook with a *Tench* on!

At a brandling once Gudgeon would gape,
But they seem upon different terms now;
Have they taken advice
Of the "*Council of Nice*,"
And rejected their "*Diet of Worms*," now?

In vain my live minnow I spin,
Not a Pike seems to think it worth snatching;
For the gut I have brought,
I had better have bought
A good *rope* that was used to *Jack-ketching*!

Not a nibble has ruffled my cork,
It is vain in this river to search there;

It is vain in this river to search them,
I may wait till it's night,
Without any bite,
And at *roost-time* have never a *Perch* then.

No Roach can I meet with—no Bleak,
Save what in the air is so sharp now;
Not a Dace have I got,
And I fear it is not
“Carpe diem,” a day for the Carp now!

Oh! there is not a one pound prize
To be got in this fresh-water lottery!
What then can I deem
Of so fishless a stream
But that 'tis—like St. Mary's—*Ottery*!

For an Eel I have learned how to try,
By a method of Walton's own showing,—
But a fisherman feels
Little prospect of Eels,
In a path that's devoted to towing!

I have tried all the water for miles,
Till I'm weary of dipping and casting!
And hungry and faint,—
Let the Fancy just paint
What it is *without Fish*, to be *Fasting*!

And the rain drizzles down very fast,
While my dinner-time sounds from a far bell,—
So, wet to the skin,
I'll e'en back to my Inn,
Where at least I am sure of a *Bar-bell*!

A BLOW UP.

“Here we go up, up, up.”—THE LAY OF THE FIRST MINSTREL.



NEAR Battle, Mr. Peter Baker
Was Powder-maker,

Not Alderman Flower's flour,—the white that puffs
And primes and loads heads bald, or gray, or chowder,
Figgins and Higgins, Fippins, Filby,—Crowder,
Not vile apothecary's pounded stuffs,
But something blacker, bloodier, and louder,
Gun-powder!

This stuff, as people know, is *semper*
Eadem; very hasty in its temper—
Like Honour that resents the gentlest taps,
Mere semblances of blows, however slight;
So powder fires, although you only p'rhaps
Strike light.

To make it therefore, is a ticklish business,
And sometimes gives both head and heart a dizziness,
For as all human flash and fancy minders,
Frequenting fights and Powder-works well know,
There seldom is a mill without a blow
Sometimes upon the grinders.

But then—the melancholy phrase to soften,
Mr. B.'s mill *transpir'd* so very often!
And advertised—than all Price Currents louder,
“Fragments look up—there is a rise in Powder,”
So frequently, it caused the neighbours' wonder,—
And certain people had the inhumanity
To lay it all to Mr. Baker's vanity,
That he might have to say—“That was *my* thunder!”

One day—so goes the tale,
Whether, with iron hoof,
Not sparkle-proof

Some ninny-hammer struck upon a nail,—
Whether some glow-worm of the Guy Faux stamp,
Crept in the building, with Unsafety Lamp—
One day this mill that had by water ground,
Became a sort of windmill and blew round.
With hounce that went in sound as far as Dover it

With sound that went as far as Dover, it
Sent half the workmen sprawling to the sky;
Besides some visitors who gained thereby,
What they had asked—permission “to go over it!”
Of course it was a very hard and high blow,
And somewhat differed from what’s called a flyblow.
At Cowes’ Regatta as I once observed,
A pistol-shot made twenty vessels start;
If such a sound could terrify oak’s heart,
Think how this crash the human nerve unnerved.
In fact, it was a very awful thing,—
As people know that have been used to battle,
In springing either mine or mill, you spring
A precious rattle!
The dunniest heard it—poor old Mr. F.
Doubted for once if he was ever deaf;
Through Tunbridge town it caused most strange alarms;
Mr. and Mrs. Fogg,
Who lived like cat and dog,
Were shocked for once into each other’s arms.
Miss M. the milliner—her fright so strong,
Made a great gobble-stitch six inches long;
The veriest quakers quaked against their wish;
The “Best of Sons” was taken unawares,
And kick’d the “Best of Parents” down the stairs;
The steadiest servant dropped the China dish;
A thousand started, though there was but one
Fated to win, and that was Mister Dunn,
Who struck convulsively, and hooked a fish!

Miss Wigings, with some grass upon her fork,
Toss’d it just like a hay-maker at work;
Her sister not in any better case,
For taking wine,
With nervous Mr. Pyne,
He jerked his glass of Sherry in her face.
Poor Mistress Davy,
Bobb’d off her bran-new turban in the gravy;
With Mr. D— at the bottom and

while Mr. Davy at the lower end,
Preparing for a Goose a carver's labour,
Darted his two-pronged weapon in his neighbour,
As if for once he meant to help a friend.

The nurse-maid telling little "Jack-a-Norey,"
"Bo-peep" and "Blue-cap" at the house's top,
Scream'd, and let Master Jeremiah drop

From a fourth story!

Nor yet did matters any better go
With Cook and Housemaid in the realms below;
As for the Laundress, timid Martha Gunning,
Expressing faintness and her fear by fits
And starts,—she came at last but to her wits,
By falling in the ale that John left running.

Grave Mr. Miles, the meekest of mankind,
Struck all at once deaf, stupid, dumb, and blind,
Sat in his chaise some moments like a corse,

Then coming to his mind,

Was shocked to find,

Only a pair of shafts without a horse.

Out scrambled all the Misses from Miss Joy's!

From Prospect House, for urchins small and big,

Hearing the awful noise,

Out rushed a flood of boys,

Floating a man in black, without a wig;—

Some carried out one treasure, some another,—

Some caught their tops and taws up in a hurry,

Some saved Chambaud, some rescued Lindley Murray,

But little Tiddy carried his big brother!

Sick of such terrors,

The Tunbridge folks resolv'd that truth should dwell

No longer secret in a Tunbridge Well,

But to warn Baker of his dangerous errors;

Accordingly to bring the point to pass,

They call'd a meeting of the broken glass,

And the broken glass was the broken glass.

The shattered chimney pots, and scattered tiles,
The damage of each part,
And packed it in a cart,
Drawn by the horse that ran from Mr. Miles;
While Doctor Babblethorpe, the worthy Rector,
And Mr. Gammage, cutler to George Rex,
And some few more, whose names would only vex,
Went as a deputation to the Ex-
Powder-proprietor and Mill-director.
Now Mr. Baker's dwelling-house had pleased
Along with mill-materials to roam,
And for a time the deputies were teased,
To find the noisy gentleman at home;
At last they found him with undamaged skin,
Safe at the Tunbridge Arms—not out—but Inn.

The worthy Rector, with uncommon zeal,
Soon put his spoke in for the common weal—
A grave old gentlemanly kind of Urban,—
The piteous tale of Jeremiah moulded,
And then unfolded,
By way of climax, Mrs. Davy's turban;
He told how auctioneering Mr. Pidding
Knock'd down a lot without a bidding,—
How Mr. Miles, in fright, had giv'n his mare
The whip she wouldn't bear,—
At Prospect House, how Doctor Oates, not Titus,
Danc'd like Saint Vitus,—
And Mr. Beak, thro' Powder's misbehaving,
Cut off his nose whilst shaving;—
When suddenly, with words that seem'd like swearing,
Beyond a Licenser's belief or bearing—
Broke in the stuttering, sputtering Mr. Gammage—
“Who is to pay us, Sir,”—he argued thus,
“For loss of cus-cus-cus-cus-cus-cus—
Cus-custom, and the dam-dam-dam-damage?

Now many a person had been fairly puzzled

By such assailants, and completely muzzled;
Baker, however, was not dash'd with ease—
But proved he practised after their own system,
And with small ceremony soon dismiss'd 'em,
Putting these words into their ears like fleas;
“If I do have a blow, well, where's the oddity?
I merely do as other tradesmen do,
 You, Sir,—and you—and you!
I'm only puffing off my own commodity!”

THE SCHOOLMASTER'S MOTTO.

“The Admiral compelled them all to strike.”—LIFE OF NELSON.



USH! silence in School—not a noise!
You shall soon see there's nothing to jeer at,
Master Marsh, most audacious of boys!
Come!—"Palmam qui meruit ferat!"

So this morn in the midst of the Psalm,
The Miss Siffkin's school you must leer at,
You're complained of—Sir! hold out your palm,—
There!—"Palmam qui meruit ferat!"

You wilful young rebel, and dunce!
This offence all your sins shall appear at,
You shall have a good caning at once—
There!—"Palmam qui meruit ferat!"

You are backward, you know, in each verb,
And your pronouns you are not more clear at,
But you're forward enough to disturb,—
There!—"Palmam qui meruit ferat!"

You said Master Twigg stole the plums,
When the orchard he never was near at,
I'll not punish wrong fingers or thumbs,—
There!—"Palmam qui meruit ferat!"

You make Master Taylor your butt,
And this morning his face you threw beer at,
And you struck him—do you like a cut?
There!—"Palmam qui meruit ferat!"

Little Biddle you likewise distress,
You are always his hair, or his ear at,—
He's my *Opt*, Sir, and you are my *Pess*:
There!—"Palmam qui meruit ferat!"

Then you had a pitcht fight with young Rous,
An offence I am always severe at!
You discredit to Cicero-House!

YOU DISCREET TO CECILIO-HOUSE.

There!—"Palmam qui meruit ferat!"

You have made too a plot in the night,
To run off from the school that you rear at!
Come, your other hand, now, Sir,—the right,
There!—"Palmam qui meruit ferat!"

I'll teach you to draw, you young dog!
Such pictures as I'm looking here at!
"Old Mounseer making soup of a frog,"
There!—"Palmam qui meruit ferat!"

You have run up a bill at a shop,
That in paying you'll be a whole year at,—
You've but twopence a week, Sir, to stop!
There!—"Palmam qui meruit ferat!"

Then at dinner you're quite cock-a-hoop,
And the soup you are certain to sneer at—
I have sipped it—it's very good soup,—
There!—"Palmam qui meruit ferat!"

T'other day when I fell o'er the form,
Was my tumble a thing, Sir, to cheer at?
Well for you that my temper's not warm,—
There!—"Palmam qui meruit ferat!"

Why, you rascal! you insolent brat!
All my talking you don't shed a tear at,
There—take that, Sir! and that! that! and that!
There!—"Palmam qui meruit ferat!"

THE KANGAROOS.

A FABLE.



PAIR of married kangaroos
(The case is oft a human one too)
Were greatly puzzled once to choose
A trade to put their eldest son to:
A little brisk and busy chap,
As all the little K.'s just then are—
About some two months off the lap,—
They're not so long in arms as men are.

A twist in each parental muzzle
Betray'd the hardship of the puzzle—
So much the flavour of life's cup
Is framed by early wrong or right,
And Kangaroos we know are quite
Dependent on their "rearing up."
The question, with its ins and outs,
Was intricate and full of doubts;
And yet they had no squeamish carings
For trades unfit or fit for gentry,
Such notion never had an entry,
For they had no armorial bearings.
Howbeit they're not the last on earth
That might indulge in pride of birth;
Whoe'er has seen their infant young
Bob in and out their mother's pokes,
Would own, with very ready tongue,
They are not born like common folks.
Well, thus the serious subject stood,
It kept the old pair watchful nightly,
Debating for young hopeful's good,
That he might earn his livelihood,
And go through life (like them) uprightly.
Arms would not do at all; no, marry,
In that line all his race miscarry;
And agriculture was not proper,
Unless they meant the lad to tarry
For ever as a mere clod-hopper.

He was not well cut out for preaching^{^ ^}
At least in any striking style;
And as for being mercantile—
He was not form'd for over-reaching.
The law—why there still fate ill-starr'd him,
And plainly from the bar debarr'd him:
A doctor—who would ever fee him?
In music he could scarce engage,
And as for going on the stage
In tragic socks I think I see him.

He would not make a rigging-mounter;
A haberdasher had some merit,
But there the counter still ran counter,
For just suppose
A lady chose
To ask him for a yard of ferret!

A gardener digging up his beds,
The puzzled parents shook their heads.

“A tailor would not do because—”
They paused and glanced upon his paws.

Some parish post, though fate should place it
Before him, how could he embrace it?

In short each anxious Kangaroo
Discuss'd the matter through and through
By day they seem'd to get no nearer,
'Twas posing quite—
And in the night
Of course they saw their way no clearer!
At last thus musing on their knees—
Or hinder elbows if you please—
It came—no thought was ever brighter!
In weighing every why and whether,
They jump'd upon it both together—

“Let’s make the imp a *short-hand writer*!”

MORAL.

I wish all human parents so

Would argue what their sons are fit for;

Some would-be critics that I know

Would be in trades they have more wit for.

I CANNOT BEAR A GUN.

“Timidity is generally reckoned an essential attribute of the fair sex, and this absurd notion gives rise to more false starts than a race for the Leger. Hence screams at mice, fits at spiders, faces at toads, jumps at lizards, flights from daddy longlegs, panics at wasps, *saue qui peut* at sight of a gun. Surely, when the military exercise is made a branch of education at so many ladies’ academies, the use of the musket would only be a judicious step further in the march of mind. I should not despair, in a month’s practice, of making the most timid British female fond of small-arms.”—HINTS BY A CORPORAL.



I can't be minced, I'm quite convinced
All girls are full of flam,
Their feelings fine and feminine
Are nothing else but sham.
On all their tricks I need not fix,
I'll only mention one,
How many a Miss will tell you this,
"I cannot bear a gun!"

There's cousin Bell can't 'bide the smell
Of powder—horrid stuff!
A single pop will make her drop,
She shudders at a puff.
My Manton near, with aspen fear
Will make her scream and run:
"It's always so, you brute, you know
I cannot bear a gun!"

About my flask I must not ask,
I must not wear a belt,
I must not take a punch to make
My pellets, card or felt;
And if I just allude to dust,
Or speak of number one,
"I beg you'll not—don't talk of shot,
I cannot bear a gun!"

Percussion cap I dare not snap,
I may not mention Hall,



A MINOR CANNON.



“JAMES’S POWDER.”

Or raise my voice for Mr. Joyce,
His wadding to recall;
At Hawker's book I must not look,
All shooting I must shun,
Or else—"It's hard, you've no regard,
I cannot bear a gun!"

The very dress I wear no less
Must suit her timid mind,
A blue or black must clothe my back,
With swallow-tails behind;
By fustian, jean, or velveteen,
Her nerves are overdone:
"Oh do not, John, put gaiters on,
I cannot bear a gun!"

E'en little James she snubs, and blames
His Liliputian train,
Two inches each from mouth to breach,
And charged with half a grain—
His crackers stopp'd, his squibbing dropp'd,
He has no fiery fun,
And all thro' her "How dare you, Sir?
I cannot bear a gun!"

Yet Major Flint,—the Devil's in't!
May talk from morn to night,
Of springing mines, and twelves and nines,
And volleys left and right,
Of voltigeurs and tirailleurs,
And bullets by the ton:
She never dies of fright, or cries
"I cannot bear a gun!"

It stirs my bile to see her smile
At all his bang and whiz,
But if I talk of morning walk,

And shots as good as his,
I must not name the fallen game:
As soon as I've begun,
She's in her pout, and crying out,
"I cannot bear a gun!"

Yet, underneath the rose, her teeth
Are false, to match her tongue:
Grouse, partridge, hares, she never spares,
Or pheasants, old or young—
On widgeon, teal, she makes a meal,
And yet objects to none:
"What have I got, it's full of shot!
I cannot bear a gun!"

At pigeon-pie she is not shy,
Her taste it never shocks,
Though they should be from Battersea,
So famous for blue rocks;
Yet when I bring the very thing
My marksmanship has won,
She cries "Lock up that horrid cup,
I cannot bear a gun!"

Like fool and dunce I got her once
A box at Drury Lane,
And by her side I felt a pride
I ne'er shall feel again:
To read the bill it made her ill,
And this excuse she spun,
"Der Freyschütz, oh, seven shots; you know,
I cannot bear a gun!"

Yet at a hint from Major Flint,
Her very hands she rubs,
And quickly drest in all her best,
Is off to Wormwood Scrubbs.
The whole review she sits it through,

With noise enough to stun,
And never winks, or even thinks,
“I cannot bear a gun!”

She thus may blind the Major’s mind
In mock-heroic strife,
But let a bout at war break out,
And where’s the soldier’s wife,
To take his kit and march a bit
Beneath a broiling sun?
Or will she cry, “My dear, good-bye,
I cannot bear a gun?”

If thus she doats on army coats,
And regimental cuffs,
The yeomanry might surely be
Secure from her rebuffs;
But when I don my trappings on,
To follow Captain Dunn,
My carbine’s gleam provokes a scream,
“I cannot bear a gun!”

It can’t be minced, I’m quite convinced,
All girls are full of flam,
Their feelings fine, and feminine,
Are nothing else but sham;
On all their tricks I need not fix,
I’ll only mention one,
How many a Miss will tell you this,
“I cannot bear a gun!”

TRIMMER'S EXERCISE,

FOR THE USE OF CHILDREN.



HERE, come, Master Timothy Todd,
Before we have done you'll look
grimmer,
You've been spelling some time for the rod,
And your jacket shall know I'm a Trimmer.

You don't know your A from your B,
So backward you are in your Primer;
Don't kneel—you shall go on *my* knee,
For I'll have you to know I'm a Trimmer.

This morning you hinder'd the cook,
By melting your dumps in the skimmer;
Instead of attending your book,—
But I'll have you to know I'm a Trimmer.

To-day, too, you went to the pond,
And bathed, though you are not a swimmer:
And with parents so doting and fond—
But I'll have you to know I'm a Trimmer.

After dinner you went to the wine,
And help'd yourself—yes, to a brimmer;
You couldn't walk straight in a line,
But I'll make you to know I'm a Trimmer.

You kick little Tomkins about,
Because he is slighter and slimmer;
Are the weak to be thump'd by the stout?
But I'll have you to know I'm a Trimmer.

Then you have a sly pilfering trick,
Your school-fellows call you the nimmer,—
I will cut to the bone if you kick!
For I'll have you to know I'm a Trimmer.

To-day you made game at my back:
You think that my eyes are grown dimmer

You think that my eyes are grown dimmer,
But I watch'd you, I've got a sly nack!
 And I'll have you to know I'm a Trimmer.

Don't think that my temper is hot,
 It's never beyond a slow simmer;
I'll teach you to call me Dame Trot
 But I'll have you to know I'm a Trimmer.

Miss Edgeworth, or Mrs. Chapone,
 Might melt to behold your tears glimmer;
Mrs. Barbauld would let you alone,
 But I'll have you to know I'm a Trimmer.

AN ADDRESS TO THE STEAM WASHING COMPANY.

“ARCHER. How many are there, *Scrub*?

SCRUB. Five-and-forty, sir.”—*Beaux Stratagem*.

“For shame—let the linen alone!”—*Merry Wives of Windsor*.



R. SCRUB—Mr. Slop—or whoever you be!
The Cock of Steam Laundries,—the head
Patentee
Of Associate Cleansers,—Chief founder and prime



FANCY PORTRAIT—MRS. TRIMMER.



PALMAM QUI MERUIT FERAT.

Of the firm for the wholesale distilling of grime—
Co-partners and dealers, in linen's propriety—
That make washing public—and wash in society—
O lend me your ear! if that ear can forego
For a moment the music that bubbles below,—
From your new Surrey Geysers^[11] all foaming and hot,—
That soft "*simmer's* sang" so endear'd to the Scot—
If your hands may stand still, or your steam without danger—
If your suds will not cool, and a mere simple stranger,
Both to you and to washing, may put in a rub,—
O wipe out your Amazon arms from the tub,—
And lend me your ear,—Let me modestly plead
For a race that your labours may soon supersede—
For a race that, now washing no living affords—
Like Grimaldi must leave their aquatic old boards,
Not with pence in their pockets to keep them at ease,
Not with bread in the funds—or investments of cheese,
But to droop like sad willows that lived by a stream,
Which the sun has suck'd up into vapour and steam.
All, look at the laundress, before you begrudge
Her hard daily bread to that laudable drudge—
When chanticler singeth his earliest matins,
She slips her amphibious feet in her pattens,
And beginneth her toil while the morn is still grey,
As if she was washing the night into day—
Not with sleeker or rosier fingers Aurora
Beginneth to scatter the dewdrops before her;
Not Venus that rose from the billow so early,
Look'd down on the foam with a forehead more *pearly*^[12]—
Her head is involved in an aërial mist,
And a bright-beaded bracelet encircles her wrist;
Her visage glows warm with the ardour of duty;
She's Industry's moral—she's all moral beauty!
Growing brighter and brighter at every rub—
Would any man ruin her?—No, Mr. Scrub!
No man that is manly would work her mishap—
No man that is manly would covet her can—

No man that is manly would cover her cap—
Nor her apron—her hose—nor her gown made of stuff—
Nor her gin—nor her tea—nor her wet pinch of snuff!
Alas! so *she* thought—but that slippery hope
Has betray'd her—as though she had trod on her soap!
And she,—whose support,—like the fishes that fly,
Was to have her fins wet, must now drop from her sky—
She whose living it was, and a part of her fare,
To be damp'd once a day, like the great white sea bear,
With her hands like a sponge, and her head like a mop—
Quite a living absorbent that revell'd in slop—
She that paddled in water, must walk upon sand,
And sigh for her deeps like a turtle on land!

Lo, then, the poor laundress, all wretched she stands,
Instead of a counterpane, wringing her hands!
All haggard and pinch'd, going down in life's vale,
With no faggot for burning, like Allan-a-Dale!
No smoke from her flue—and no steam from her pane,
Where once she watch'd heaven, fearing God and the rain—
Or gazed o'er her bleach-field so fairly engross'd,
Till the lines wander'd idle from pillar to post!
Ah, where are the playful young pinners—ah, where
The harlequin quilts that cut capers in air—
The brisk waltzing stockings—the white and the black,
That danced on the tight-rope, or swung on the slack—
The light sylph-like garments, so tenderly pinn'd,
That blew into shape, and embodied the wind!
There was white on the grass—there was white on the spray—
Her garden—it look'd like a garden of May!
But now all is dark—not a shirt's on a shrub—
You've ruined her prospects in life, Mr. Scrub!
You've ruin'd her custom—now families drop her—
From her silver reduced—nay, reduced from her *copper*!
The last of her washing is done at her eye,
One poor little kerchief that never gets dry!
From mere lack of linen she can't lay a cloth,
And boils neither barley nor alkaline broth,—

BUT ner children come round ner as victuals grow scant,
And recal, with foul faces, the source of their want—
When she thinks of their poor little mouths to be fed,
And then thinks of her trade that is utterly dead,
And even its pearlashes laid in the grave—
Whilst her tub is a-dry-rotting, stave after stave,
And the greatest of Coopers, ev'n he that they dub
Sir Astley, can't bind up her heart or her tub,—
Need you wonder she curses your bones, Mr. Scrub!
Need you wonder, when steam has deprived her of bread,
If she prays that the evil may visit *your* head—
Nay, scald all the heads of your Washing Committee,
If she wishes you all the soot blacks of the City—
In short, not to mention all plagues without number,
If she wishes you all in the *Wash* at the Humber!

Ah, perhaps, in some moment of drowth and despair,
When her linen got scarce, and her washing grew rare—
When the sum of her suds might be summ'd in a bowl,
And the rusty cold iron quite enter'd her soul—
When, perhaps, the last glance of her wandering eye
Had caught “the Cock Laundresses’ Coach” going by,
Or her lines that hung idle, to waste the fine weather,
And she thought of her wrongs and her rights both together,
In a lather of passion that froth'd as it rose,
Too angry for grammar, too lofty for prose,
On her sheet—if a sheet were still left her—to write,
Some remonstrance like this then, perchance, saw the light—

LETTER OF REMONSTRANCE

FROM BRIDGET JONES TO THE NOBLEMEN AND GENTLEMEN FORMING THE
WASHING COMMITTEE.

It's a shame, so it is—men can't Let alone
Jobs as is Woman's right to do—and go about there Own—
Theirs Reforms enuff Alreddy without your new schools
For washing to sit Up,—and push the Old Tubs from their stools!
But your just like the Raddicals,—for upsetting of the Sudds
When the world wagg'd well enuff—and Wommen wash'd your old dirty
duds,

I'm Certain sure Enuff your Ann Sisters had no steam Indins, that's Flat,—
But I Warrant your Four Fathers went as Tidy and gentlemanny for all that
—

I suppose your the Family as lived in the Great Kittle
I see on Clapham Commun, some times a very considerable period back
when I were little,
And they Said it went with Steem,—But that was a joke!
For I never see none come of it,—that's out of it—but only sum Smoak—
And for All your Power of Horses about your Indians you never had but
Two

In my time to draw you About to Fairs—and hang you, you know that's
true!

And for All your fine Perspectuses,—howsomever you bewhich 'em,
Theirs as Pretty ones off Primerows Hill, as ever a one at Mitchum,
Thof I cant sea What Prospectives and washing has with one another to Do
—

It ant as if a Bird'seye Hankicher can take a Birds-high view!
But Thats your look-out—I've not much to do with that—But pleas God to
hold up fine,

Id show you caps and pinner and small things as lillywhit as Ever crosst
the Line

Without going any Father off than Little Parodies Place,
And Thats more than you Can—and Ill say it behind your face—
But when Folks talks of washing, it ant for you too Speak,—
As kept Dockter Pattyson out of his Shirt for a Weak!

Thinks I, when I heard it—Well thear's a Pretty go!
That comes o' not marking of things or washing out the marks, and
Huddling 'em up so!

Till Their frends comes and owns them, like drowned corpeses in a Vault,
But mav Han you havint Larn'd to snel—and That ant your Fault.

But mayhap you havin' earn'd to spend — and that ain't your fault,
Only you ought to leave the Linnins to them as has Larn'd,—
For if it warnt for Washing,—and whare Bills is concern'd,
What's the Yuse, of all the world, for a Wommans Headication,
And Their Being maid Schollards of Sundays—fit for any Cityation?

Well, what I says is this—when every Kittle has its spout,
Theirs no need for Companys to puff steam about!
To be sure its very Well, when Their ant enuff Wind
For blowing up Boats with,—but not to hurt human kind,
Like that Pearkins with his Blunderbush, that's loaded with hot water,
Thof a xSherrif might know Better, than make things for slaughtter,
As if War warnt Cruel enuff—wherever it befalls,
Without shooting poor sogers, with sich scalding hot washing^[13] balls,—
But thats not so Bad as a Sett of Bear Faced Scrubbs
As joins their Sopes together, and sits up Steam rubbing Clubs,
For washing Dirt Cheap,—and eating other Peple's grubs!
Which is all verry Fine for you and your Patent Tea,
But I wonders How Poor Wommen is to get Their Beau-He!
They must drink Hunt wash (the only wash God nose there will be!)
And their Little drop of Somethings as they takes for their Goods,
When you and your Steam has ruined (G—d forgive mee) their lively
Hoods,

Poor Women as was born to Washing in their youth!
And now must go and Larn other Buisnesses Four Sooth!
But if so be They leave their Lines what are they to go at—
They won't do for Angell's—nor any Trade like That,
Nor we cant Sow Babby Work,—for that's all Bespoke,—
For the Queakers in Bridle! and a vast of the confind Folk
Do their own of Themselves—even the bettermost of em—aye, and evn
them of middling degrees—

Why—Lauk help you—Babby Linen and Bread ant Cheese!
Nor we can't go a hammering the roads into Dust,
But we must all go and be Bankers, Like Mr. Marshes and Mr. Chamber,
and that's what we must!

God nose you oght to have more Concern for our Sects,
When you nose you have suck'd us and hanged round our Mutherly necks,
And remembers what you Owes to Wommen Besides washing—

~~Now we'll have some more like Mr. Marshes and Mr. Chamber~~

you ant, diame you, like men to go a slusning and slosning
In mob caps, and pattins, adoin of Females Labers
And prettily jear'd At, you great Horse God-meril things, ant you now by
your next door nayhbours—
Lawk, I thinks I see you with your Sleeves tuckt up
No more like Washing than is drownding of a Pupp—
And for all Your Fine Water Works going round and round
They'll scruntch your Bones some day—I'll be bound
And no more nor be a gudgement,—for it cant come to good
To sit up agin Providence, which your a doing,—nor not fit It should,
For man warnt maid for Wommens starvation,
Nor to do away Laundrisses as is Links of Creation—
And cant be dun without in any Country But a naked Hottinpot Nation.
Ah, I wish our Minister would take one of your Tubbs
And preach a Sermon in it, and give you some good rubs—
But I warrants you reads (for you cant spel we nose) nyther Bybills or Good
Tracks,
Or youd no better than Taking the Close off one's Backs—
And let your neighbours Oxin an Asses alone,—
And every Thing thats hern,—and give every one their Hone!

Well, its God for us All, and every Washer Wommen for herself,
And so you might, without shoving any on us off the shelf,
But if you warnt Noddis youd Let wommen a-be
And pull off your Pattins,—and leave the washing to we
That nose what's what—Or mark what I say,
Youl make a fine Kittle of fish of Your Close some Day—
When the Aulder men wants Their Bibs and their ant nun at all,
And Crissmass cum—and never a Cloth to lay in Gild Hall,
Or send a damp shirt to his Woship the Mare
Till hes rumatiz Poor Man, and cant set uprite to do good in his Harm Chare

—
Besides Miss-Matching Larned Ladys Hose, as is sent for you not to wash
(for you dont wash) but to stew
And make Peples Stockins yellor as oght to be Blew,
With a vast more like That,—and all along of Steem
Which warnt meand by Nater for any sich skeam—
But thats your Losses and youl have to make It Good,

And I cant say I'm sorry, afore God, if you shoud,
For men mought Get their Bread a great many ways
Without taking ourn,—aye, and Moor to your Prays,
You might go and skim the creme off Mr. Mack-Adam's milky ways—
that's what you might,
Or bete Carpets—or get into Parleamint,—or drive crabrolays from
morning to night,
Or, if you must be of our sects, be Watchemen, and slepe upon a poste!
(Which is an od way of sleping I must say,—and a very hard pillow at
most,)
Or you might be any trade, as we are not on that I'm awares,
Or be Watermen now, (not Water wommen) and roe people up and down
Hungerford stares.
If You Was even to Turn Dust Men a dry sifting Dirt,
But you oughtint to Hurt Them as never Did You no Hurt!
Yourn with Anymocity,

BRIDGET JONES.

THE BLUE BOAR.

'Tis known to man, 'tis known to woman,
'Tis known to all the world in common,
How politics and party strife
Vex public, even private, life;
But, till some days ago, at least
They never worried brutal beast.

I wish you could have seen the creature,
A tame domestic boar by nature,
Gone wild as boar that ever grunted,
By Baron Hoggerhausen hunted.
His back was up, and on its ledge
The bristles rose like quickset hedge;
His eye was fierce and red as coal,
Like furnace, shining through a hole,
And restless turn'd for mischief seeking;
His very hide with rage was reeking;
And oft he gnash'd his crooked tusks,
Chewing his tongue instead of husks,
Till all his jaw was white and yesty,
Showing him savage, fierce, and resty.

And what had caused this mighty vapour?
A dirty fragment of a paper,
That in his rambles he had found,
Lying neglected on the ground;
A relic of the Morning Post,
Two tattered columns at the most,
But which our irritated swine
(Derived from Learned Toby's line)
Digested easy as his meals,
Like any quidnunc Cit at Peel's.

He read, and mused, and pored and read,
His shoulders shrugg'd, and shook his head;
Now at a line he gave a grunt,
Now at a phrase took sudden stunt,

And snorting turn'd his back upon it,
But always came again to con it;
In short he petted up his passion,
After a very human fashion,
When Temper's worried with a bone
She'll neither like nor let alone.
At last his fury reach'd the pitch
Of that most irritating itch,
When mind and will, in fever'd faction,
Prompt blood and body into action;
No matter what, so bone and muscle
May vent the frenzy in a bustle;
But whether by a fight or dance
Is left to impulse and to chance.
So stood the Boar, in furious mood
Made up for any thing but good;
He gave his tail a tighter twist,
As men in anger clench the fist,
And threw fresh sparkles in his eye
From the volcano in his fry—
Ready to raze the parish pound,
To pull the pigsty to the ground,
To lay Squire Giles, his master, level,
Ready, indeed, to play the devil.

So, stirr'd by raving demagogues,
I've seen men rush, like rabid dogs,
Stark staring from the Pig and Whistle,
And like his Boarship, in a bristle,
Resolved unanimous on rumpus
From any quarter of the compass;
But whether to duck Aldgate Pump,
(For wits in madness never jump)
To liberate the beasts from Cross's;
Or hiss at all the Wigs in Ross's;
On Waithman's column hang a weeper;
Or tar and feather the old sweeper;
Or break the panes of landlord scurv.

And turn the King's Head topsy-turvy;
Rebuild, or pull down, London Wall;
Or take his cross from old Saint Paul;
Or burn those wooden Highland fellows,
The snuff-men's idols, 'neath the gallows!
None fix'd or cared—but all were loyal
To one design—a battle royal.

Thus stood the Boar, athirst for blood,
Trampling the Morning Post to mud,
With tusks prepared to run a muck;—
And sorrow for the mortal's luck
That came across him Whig or Tory,
It would have been a tragic story—
But fortune interposing now,
Brought Bessy into play—a Sow;—
A fat, sleek, philosophic beast
That never fretted in the least,
Whether her grains were sour or sweet,
For grains are grains, and she could eat.
Absorb'd in two great schemes capacious,
The farrow and the farinaceous,
If cares she had, they could not stay,
She drank, and *wash'd* them all away.
In fact this philosophic sow
Was very like a German frow;
In brief—as wit should be and fun,—
If sows turn Quakers, she was one;
Clad from the duckpond, thick and slab,
In bran-new muddy suit of drab.
To still the storm of such a lubber,
She came like oil—at least like blubber—
Her pigtail of as passive shape
As ever droop'd o'er powder'd nape;
Her snout, scarce turning up—her deep
Small eyes half settled into sleep;
Her ample ears, dependent, meek,
Like fig leaves shading either cheek.

Like fig-leaves shading elder creek,
Whilst, from the corner of her jaw,
A sprout of cabbage, green and raw,
Protruded,—as the Dove, so stanch
For Peace, supports an olive branch,—
Her very grunt, so low and mild,
Like the soft snoring of a child,
Inquiring into his disquiets,
Served like the Riot Act, at riots,—
He laid his restive bristles flatter,
And took to arguefy the matter.

“O Bess, O Bess, here’s heavy news!
They mean to ‘mancipate the Jews!
Just as they turn’d the blacks to whites,
They want to give them equal rights,
And, in the twinkling of a steeple,
Make Hebrews quite like other people.
Here, read—but I forget your fetters,
You’ve studied litters more than letters.”

“Well,” quoth the Sow, “and no great miss,
I’m sure my ignorance is bliss;
Contentedly I bite and sup,
And never let my flare flare-up;
Whilst you get wild and fuming hot—
What matters Jews be Jews or not?
Whether they go with beards like Moses,
Or barbers take them by the noses,
Whether they live, permitted dwellers,
In Cheapside shops, or Rag Fair cellars,
Or climb their way to civic perches,
Or go to synagogues or churches?”
“Churches!—ay, there the question grapples,
No, Bess, the Jews will go to Chappell’s!”

“To chapel—well—what’s that to you?
A Berkshire Boar, and not a Jew?

“No pigs—remember the remark—

we pigs,—remember the remark
Of our old drover Samuel Slark,
When trying, but he tried in vain,
To coax me into Sermon Lane,
Or Paternoster's pious Row,—
But still I stood and grunted No!
Of Lane of Creed an equal scorner,
Till bolting off, at Amen Corner,
He cried, provoked at my evasion,
'Pigs, blow 'em! ar'n't of no persuasion!' ”

“The more's the pity, Bess—the more—”
Said, with sardonic grin, the Boar;
“If Pigs were Methodists and Bunyans,
They'd make a sin of sage and onions;
The curse of endless flames endorse
On every boat of apple-sauce;
Give brine to Satan, and assess
Blackpuddings with bloodguiltiness;
Yea, call down heavenly fire and smoke
To burn all Epping into coke!”

“Ay,” cried the Sow, extremely placid,
In utter contrast to his acid,
“Ay, that would be a Sect indeed!
And every swine would like the creed,
The sausage-making curse and all;
And should some brother have a call,
To thump a cushion to that measure,
I would sit under him with pleasure;
Nay, put down half my private fortune
T' endow a chapel at Hog's Norton.—
But what has this to do, my deary,
With their new Hebrew whigmaleery?”

“Sow that you are! this Bill, if current,
Would be as good as our death-warrant;—
And, with its legislative friskings,

Loose twelve new tribes upon our griskins!
Unjew the Jews, what follows then?
Why, they'll eat pork like other men,
And you shall see a Rabbi dish up
A chine as freely as a Bishop!
Thousands of years have pass'd, and pork
Was never stuck on Hebrew fork;
But now, suppose that relish rare
Fresh added to their bill of fare,
Fry, harslet, pettitoes, and chine,
Leg, choppers, bacon, ham, and loin,
And then, beyond all goose or duckling"—

"Yes, yes—a little tender suckling!
It must be held the aptest savour
To make the eager mouth to slaver!
Merely to look on such a gruntling,
A plump, white, sleek and sappy runtling,
It makes one—ah! remembrance bitter!
It made me eat my own dear litter!"

"Think, then, with this new waken'd fury,
How we should fare if tried by *Jewry*!
A pest upon the meddling Whigs!
There'll be a pretty run on pigs!
This very morn a Hebrew brother
With three hats stuck on one another,
And o'er his arm a bag, or poke,
A thing pigs never find a joke,
Stopp'd—rip the fellow!—though he knew
I've neither coat to sell nor shoe,
And cock'd his nose—right at me, lovey!
Just like a pointer at a covey!

To set our only friends agin us!
That neither care to fat nor thin us!
To boil, to broil, to roast, or fry us,
But act like real Christians by us!—

A

A murrain on all legislators!
Thin wash, sour grains, and rotten 'taters!
A bulldog at their ears and tails!
The curse of empty troughs and pails
Famish their flanks as thin as weasels!
May all their children have the measles;
Or in the straw untimely smother,
Or make a dinner for the mother!
A cartwhip for all law inventors!
And rubbing-posts stuck full of tenters!
Yokes, rusty rings, and gates, to hitch in
And parish pounds to pine the flitch in,
Cold, and high winds, the Devil send 'em—
And then may Sam the Sticker end 'em!”

'Twas strange to hear him how he swore!
A Boar will curse, though like a boar,
While Bess, like Pity, at his side
Her swine-subduing voice supplied!
She bade him such a rage discard;
That anger is a foe to lard;
'Tis bad for sugar to get wet,
And quite as bad for fat to fret;
“Besides,”—she argued thus at last—
“The Bill you fume at has not pass'd,
For why, the Commons and the Peers
Have come together by the ears:
Or rather, as we pigs repose,
One's tail beside the other's nose,
And thus, of course, take adverse views
Whether of Gentiles or of Jews.
Who knows? They say the Lords' ill-will
Has thrown out many a wholesome Bill,
And p'rhaps some Peer to Pigs propitious
May swamp a measure so *Jew-dish-us!*”

The Boar was conquer'd: at a glance,
He saw there really was a chance—

That as the Hebrew nose is hooked,
The Bill was equally as crooked;
And might outlast, thank party embers,
A dozen tribes of Christian members;—
So down he settled in the mud,
With smoother back, and cooler blood,
As mild, as quiet, a Blue Boar,
As any over tavern-door.

MORAL.

The chance is small that any measure
Will give all classes equal pleasure;
Since Tory Ministers or Whigs,
Sometimes can't even "please the Pigs."

A FLYING VISIT.

“A Calendar! a Calendar! look in the Almanac, find out moonshine—find out moonshine!”—
Midsummer Night's Dream.

 By-gone September,
As folks may remember,
At least if their memory saves but an ember,
One fine afternoon,
There went up a Balloon,
Which did not return to the Earth very soon.

For, nearing the sky,
At about a mile high,
The Aëronaut bold had resolved on a fly;
So cutting his string,
In a Parasol thing,
Down he came in a field like a lark from the wing.

Meanwhile, thus adrift,
The Balloon made a shift
To rise very fast, with no burden to lift;
It got very small,
Then to nothing at all;
And then rose the question of where it would fall?

Some thought that, for lack
Of the man and his pack,
'Twould rise to the Cherub that watches Poor Jack;
Some held, but in vain,
With the first heavy rain,
'Twould surely come down to the Gardens again!

But still not a word
For a month could be heard
Of what had become of the Wonderful Bird:
The firm Gye and Hughes,
Wore their boots out and shoes,
In running about and inquiring for news.

Some thought it must be
Tumbled into the Sea;
Some thought it had been blown into the Sea;
Some thought it had been blown into the Sea;
Some thought it had been blown into the Sea;

Some thought it had gone off to High Germanie:
For Germans, as shown
By their writings, 'tis known
Are always delighted with what is high-flown.

Some hinted a bilk,
And that maidens who milk,
In far distant Shires would be walking in silk:
Some swore that it must,
“As they said at the *fust*,
Have gone again’ flashes of lightning and *bust!*”

However, at last,
When six weeks had gone past,
Intelligence came of a plausible cast;
A wondering clown,
At a hamlet near town,
Had seen “like a moon of green cheese” coming down.

Soon spread the alarm,
And from cottage and farm,
The natives buzz’d out like the bees when they swarm;
And off ran the folk,—
It is such a good joke
To see the descent of a bagful of smoke.

And lo! the machine,
Dappled yellow and green,
Was plainly enough in the clouds to be seen:
“Yes, yes,” was the cry,
“It’s the old one, surely,
Where *can* it have been such a time in the sky?

“Lord! where will it fall?
It can’t find out Vauxhall,
Without any pilot to guide it at all!”
Some wager’d that Kent
Would behold the event,
Debrett had been posed to *predict* its “descent ”

Debris had been posed to predict its descent.

Some thought it would pitch
In the old Tower Ditch,
Some swore on the Cross of St. Paul's it would hitch,
And Farmers cried "Zounds!
If it drops on our grounds,
We'll try if Balloons can't be put into pounds!"

But still to and fro
It continued to go,
As if looking out for soft places below—
No difficult job,
It had only to bob
Slap-dash down at once on the heads of the mob:

Who, too apt to stare
At some castle in air,
Forget that the earth is their proper affair;
Till, watching the fall
Of some soap-bubble ball,
They tumble themselves with a terrible sprawl.

Meanwhile, from its height
Stooping downward in flight,
The Phenomenon came more distinctly in sight:
Still bigger and bigger,
And strike me a nigger
Unfreed, if there was not a live human figure!

Yes, plain to be seen,
Underneath the machine,
There dangled a mortal—some swore it was Green;
Some Mason could spy;
Others named Mr. Gye;
Or Hollond, compell'd by the Belgians to fly.

'Twas Graham the flighty,
Whom the Duke high and mighty,

Resign'd to take care of his own lignum-vitæ;
'Twas Hampton, whose whim
Was in Cloudland to swim,
Till e'en Little Hampton look'd little to him!

But all were at fault;
From the heavenly vault
The falling balloon came at last to a halt;
And bounce! with the jar
Of descending so far,
An outlandish Creature was thrown from the car!

At first with the jolt
All his wits made a bolt,
As if he'd been flung by a mettlesome colt;
And while in his faint,
To avoid all complaint,
The Muse shall endeavour his portrait to paint.

The face of this elf,
Round as platter of delf,
Was pale as if only a cast of itself:
His head had a rare
Fleece of silvery hair,
Just like the Albino at Bartlemy Fair.

His eyes they were odd,
Like the eyes of a cod,
And gave him the look of a watery God.
His nose was a snub;
Under which for his grub,
Was a round open mouth like to that of a chub.

His person was small,
Without figure at all,
A plump little body as round as a ball:
With two little fins,
And a couple of pins,

With what has been christen'd a bow in the shins.

His dress it was new,
A full suit of sky-blue—
With bright silver buckles in each little shoe—
Thus painted complete,
From his head to his feet,
Conceive him laid flat in Squire Hopkins's wheat.

Fine text for the crowd!
Who disputed aloud
What sort of a creature had dropp'd from the cloud—
"He's come from o'er seas,
He's a Cochin Chinese—
By jingo! he's one of the wild Cherookees!"

"Don't nobody know?"
"He's a young Esquimaux,
Turn'd white like the hares by the Arctical snow."
"Some angel, my dear,
Sent from some upper *spear*
For Plumtree or Agnew, too good for this-here!"

Meanwhile, with a sigh,
Having open'd one eye,
The Stranger rose up on his seat by and by;
And finding his tongue,
Thus he said, or he sung,
"*Mi criky bo biggamy kickery bung!*"

"Lord! what does he speak?"
"It's Dog-Latin—it's Greek!"
"It's some sort of slang for to puzzle a Beak!"
"It's no like the Scotch,"
Said a Scot on the watch,
"Phoo! it's nothing at all but a kind of hotch-potch!"

"It's not parly voo,"
Cried a schoolboy on time

Called a schoolboy or two,
“Nor Hebrew at all,” said a wandering Jew.
Some held it was sprung
From the Irvingite tongue,
The same that is used by a child very young.

Some guess’d it high Dutch,
Others thought it had much
In sound of the true Hoky-poky-ish touch;
But none could be poz,
What the Dickens (not Boz),
No mortal could tell what the Dickens it was!

When who should come pat,
In a moment like that,
But Bowring, to see what the people were at—
A Doctor well able,
Without any fable,
To talk and translate all the babble of Babel.

So just drawing near,
With a vigilant ear,
That took ev’ry syllable in, very clear,
Before one could sip
Up a tumbler of flip,
He knew the whole tongue from the root to the tip!

Then stretching his hand,
As you see Daniel stand,
In the Feast of Belshazzar, that picture so grand!
Without more delay,
In the Hamilton way
He English’d whatever the Elf had to say.

“*Krak kraziboo ban,*
I’m the Lunatic Man,
Confined in the Moon since creation began—
Sit muggy bigog,
Whom excent in a foor.

Whom, except in a fog,
You see with a Lantern, a Bush, and a Dog.

“Lang sinery lear,
For this many a year,
I’ve long’d to drop in at your own little sphere,—
 Och, pad-mad aroon,
Till one fine afternoon,
I found that Wind-Coach on the horns of the Moon.

“Cush quackery go,
But, besides you must know,
I’d heard of a profiting Prophet below;
 Big botherum blether,
Who pretended to gather
The tricks that the Moon meant to play with the weather.

“So Crismus an crash,
Being shortish of cash,
I thought I’d a right to partake of the hash—
 Slik mizzle an smak,
So I’m come with a pack,
To sell to the trade, of my own Almanack.

“Fiz, bobbery pershal,
Besides aims commercial,
Much wishing to honour my friend Sir John Herschel,
 Cum puddin and tame,
It’s inscribed to his name,
Which is now at the full in celestial fame.

“Wept wepton wish wept,
Pray this Copy accept”—
But here on the Stranger some Kidnappers leapt:
For why? a shrewd man
Had devis’d a sly plan
The Wonder to grab for a show Caravan.

So plotted, so done—

With a fight as in fun,
While mock pugilistical rounds were begun,
A knave who could box,
And give right and left knocks,
Caught hold of the Prize by his silvery locks.

And hard he had fared,
But the people were scared
By what the Interpreter roundly declared:
“You ignorant Turks!
You will be your own Burkes—
He holds all the keys of the lunary works!

“You’d best let him go—
If you keep him below,
The Moon will not change, and the tides will not flow;
He left her at full,
And with such a long pull,
Zounds! ev’ry man Jack will run mad like a bull!”

So awful a threat
Took effect on the set;
The fright, tho’, was more than their Guest could forget;
So taking a jump,
In the car he came plump,
And threw all the ballast right out in a lump.

Up soar’d the machine,
With its yellow and green;
But still the pale face of the Creature was seen,
Who cried from the car,
“*Dam in yooman bi gar!*”
That is,—“What a sad set of villains you are!”

Howbeit, at some height,
He threw down quite a flight
Of Almanacks, wishing to set us all right—
And, thanks to the boon,
—

We shall see very soon
If Murphy knows most, or the Man in the Moon!

A ROW AT THE OXFORD ARMS.

“Glorious Apollo, from on high behold us.”—OLD SONG.



S latterly I chanced to pass
A Public House, from which, alas!

The Arms of Oxford dangle!
My ear was startled by a din,
That made me tremble in my skin,
A dreadful hubbub from within,
Of voices in a wrangle—

Voices loud, and voices high,
With now and then a party-cry,
Such as used in times gone by
To scare the British border;
When foes from North and South of Tweed—
Neighbours—and of Christian creed—
Met in hate to fight and bleed,
Upsetting Social Order.

Surprised, I turn'd me to the crowd,
Attracted by that tumult loud,
And ask'd a gazer, beetle-brow'd,
The cause of such disquiet.
When lo! the solemn-looking man,
First shook his head on Burleigh's plan,
And then, with fluent tongue, began
His version of the riot:

A row!—why yes,—a pretty row, you might hear from this to Garmany,
And what is worse, it's all got up among the Sons of Harmony,
The more's the shame for them as used to be in time and tune,
And all unite in chorus like the singing-birds in June!
Ah! many a pleasant chant I've heard in passing here along,
When Swiveller was President a-knocking down a song;
But Dick's resign'd the post, you see, and all them shouts and hollers
Is 'cause two other candidates, some sort of larned scholars,
Are squabbling to be Chairman of the Glorious Apollers!
Lord knows their names, I'm sure I don't, no more than any yokel,
But I never heard of either as connected with the vocal;
Nay, some do say, although of course the public rumour varies,
They've no more warble in 'em than a pair of hen canaries,
Though that might pass if they were dabs at t'other sort of thing,
For a man may make a song, you know, although he cannot sing;
But lork! it's many folk's belief they're only good at prosing,
For Catnach swears he never saw a verse of their composing;
And when a piece of poetry has stood its public trials,
If pop'lar, it gets printed off at once in Seven Dials,
And then about all sorts of streets, by every little monkey,
It's chanted like the "Dog's Meat Man," or "If I had a Donkey."
Whereas, as Mr. Catnach says, and not a bad judge neither,
No ballad—worth a ha'penny—has ever come from either,
And him as writ "Jim Crow," he says, and got such lots of dollars,
Would make a better Chairman for the Glorious Apollers.

Howsomever that's the meaning of the squabble that arouses,
This neighbourhood, and quite disturbs all decent Heads of Houses,
Who want to have their dinners and their parties, as is reason
In Christian peace and charity according to the season.
But from Number Thirty-Nine—since this electioneering job,
Ay, as far as Number Ninety, there's an everlasting mob;
Till the thing is quite a nuisance, for no creature passes by,
But he gets a card, a pamphlet, or a summut in his eye;
And a pretty noise there is!—what with canvassers and spouters,
For in course each side is furnish'd with its backers and its touters;
And surely among the Clergy to such pitches it is carried,

You can hardly find a Parson to get buried or get married;
Or supposing any accident that suddenly alarms,
If you're dying for a surgeon, you must fetch him from the "Arms;"
While the Schoolmasters and Tooters are neglecting of their scholars,
To write about a Chairman for the Glorious Apollers.

Well, that, sir, is the racket; and the more the sin and shame
Of them that help to stir it up, and propagate the same;
Instead of vocal ditties, and the social flowing cup,—
But they'll be the House's ruin, or the shutting of it up,
With their riots and their hubbubs, like a garden full of bears,
While they've damaged many articles and broken lots of squares,
And kept their noble Club Room in a perfect dust and smother,
By throwing *Morning Herald*s, *Times*, and *Standards* at each other;
Not to name the ugly language Gemmen oughtn't to repeat,
And the names they call each other—for I've heard 'em in the street—
Such as Traitors, Guys, and Judases, and Vipers, and what not,
For Pasley and his divers ain't so blowing-up a lot.
And then such awful swearing!—for there's one of them that cusses
Enough to shock the cads that hang on opposition 'busses;
For he cusses every member that's agin him at the poll,
As I wouldn't cuss a donkey, tho' it hasn't got a soul;
And he cusses all their families, Jack, Harry, Bob or Jim,
To the babby in the cradle, if they don't agree with him.
Whereby, altho' as yet they have not took to use their fives,
Or, according as the fashion is, to sticking with their knives,
I'm bound there'll be some milling yet, and shakings by the collars,
Afore they choose a Chairman for the Glorious Apollers!

To be sure it is a pity to be blowing such a squall,
Instead of clouds, and every man his song, and then his call—
And as if there wasn't Whigs enough and Tories to fall out,
Besides politics in plenty for our splits to be about,—
Why, a Cornfield is sufficient, sir, as anybody knows,
For to furnish them in plenty who are fond of picking crows—
Not to name the Maynooth Catholics, and other Irish stews,
To agitate society and loosen all its screws;
And which all may be agreeable and proper to their spheres —

And which all may be agreeable and proper to their spheres,
But it's not the thing for musicals to set us by the ears.
And as to College larning, my opinion for to broach,
And I've had it from my cousin, and he driv a college coach,
And so knows the University, and all as there belongs,
And he says that Oxford's famouser for sausages than songs,
And seldom turns a poet out like Hudson that can chant,
As well as make such ditties as the Free and Easies want,
Or other Tavern Melodists I can't just call to mind—
But it's not the classic system for to propagate the kind,
Whereby it so may happen as that neither of them Scholars
May be the proper Chairman for the Glorious Apollers!

For my part in the matter, if so be I had a voice,
It's the best among the vocalists I'd honour with the choice;
Or a Poet as could furnish a new Ballad to the bunch;
Or at any rate the surest hand at mixing of the punch;
Cause why, the members meet for that and other tuneful frolics—
And not to say, like Muffincaps, their Catichiz and Collec's.
But you see them there Itinerants that preach so long and loud,
And always takes advantage like the prigs of any crowd,
Have brought their jangling voices, as far as they can compass,
Have turn'd a tavern shindy to a seriouser rumpus,
And him as knows most hymns—altho' I can't see how it follers—
They want to be the Chairman of the Glorious Apollers!

Well, that's the row—and who can guess the upshot after all?
Whether Harmony will ever make the "Arms" her House of call,
Or whether this here mobbing—as some longish heads foretel it,
Will grow to such a riot that the Oxford Blues must quell it.
Howsomever, for the present, there's no sign of any peace,
For the hubbub keeps a growing, and defies the New Police;—
But if *I* was in the Vestry, and a leading sort of Man,
Or a Member of the Vocals, to get backers for my plan,
Why, I'd settle all the squabble in the twinkle of a needle,
For I'd have another candidate—and that's the Parish Beadle,
Who makes such lots of Poetry, himself, or else by proxy,
And no one never has no doubts about his orthodoxy;
Whereby—if folks was wise—instead of either of them Scholars

whereby—if folks was wise—instead of either of them scholars,
And straining their own lungs along of contradictory hollers,
They'll lend their ears to reason, and take my advice as follers,
Namely—Bumble for the Chairman of the Glorious Apollers!

A TABLE OF ERRATA.

(HOSTESS LOQUITUR.)



WELL! thanks be to heaven,
The summons is given;
It's only gone seven
And should have been six;
There's fine overdoing
In roasting and stewing,
And victuals past chewing
To rags and to sticks!

How dreadfully chilly!
I shake, willy-nilly;
That John is so silly
And never will learn!
This plate is a cold one,
That cloth is an old one,
I wish they had told one
The lamp wouldn't burn.

Now then for some blunder,
For nerves to sink under;
I never shall wonder
Whatever goes ill.
That fish is a riddle!
It's broke in the middle,
A Turbot! a fiddle!
It's only a Brill!

It's quite over-boil'd too,
The butter is oil'd too,
The soup is all spoil'd too,
It's nothing but slop.
The smelts looking flabby,
The soles are as dabby,
It all is so shabby
That Cook shall not stop!

As sure as the morning,

She gets a month's warning,
My orders for scorning—
 There's nothing to eat!
I hear such a rushing,
I feel such a flushing,
I know I am blushing
 As red as a beet!

Friends flatter and flatter,
I wish they would chatter;
What *can* be the matter
 That nothing comes next?
How very unpleasant!
Lord! there is the pheasant!
Not wanted at present,
 I'm born to be vext!

The pudding brought on too
And aiming at ton too!
And where is that John too,
 The plague that he is?
He's off on some ramble:
And there is Miss Campbell,
Enjoying the scramble,
 Detestable Quiz!

The veal they all eye it,
But no one will try it,
An Ogre would shy it
 So ruddy as that!
And as for the mutton,
The cold dish it's put on,
Converts to a button
 Each drop of the fat.

The beef without mustard!
My fate's to be fluster'd,
And there comes the custard
 —

To eat with the hare!
Such flesh, fowl, and fishing,
Such waiting and dishing,
I cannot help wishing
A woman might swear!

Oh dear! did I ever—
But no, I did never—
Well, come, that is clever,
To send up the brawn!
That cook, I could scold her,
Gets worse as she's older;
I wonder who told her
That woodcocks are drawn!

It's really audacious!
I cannot look gracious,
Lord help the voracious
That came for a cram!
There's Alderman Fuller
Gets duller and duller.
Those fowls, by the colour,
Were boil'd with the ham!

Well, where is the curry?
I'm all in a flurry,
No, cook's in no hurry—
A stoppage again!
And John makes it wider,
A pretty provider!
By bringing up cider
Instead of champagne!

My troubles come faster!
There's my lord and master
Detects each disaster,
And hardly can sit:
He cannot help seeing,
A thing or two coming

All things disagreeing;
If *he* begins d—ing
I'm off in a fit!

This cooking?—it's messing!
The spinach wants pressing,
And salads in dressing
Are best with good eggs.
And John—yes, already—
Has had something heady,
That makes him unsteady
In keeping his legs.

How *shall* I get through it!
I never can do it,
I'm quite looking to it,
To sink by and by.
Oh! would I were dead now,
Or up in my bed now,
To cover my head now
And have a good cry!

THE GREEN MAN.



TOM SIMPSON was as nice a kind of man
As ever lived—at least at number Four,
In Austin Friars, in Mrs. Brown's first floor,
At fifty pounds,—or thereabouts,—per ann.
The Lady reckon'd him her best of lodgers,
His rent so punctually paid each quarter,—
He did not smoke like nasty foreign codgers—
Nor play French horns like Mr. Rogers—
Or talk his flirting nonsense to her daughter—
Not that the girl was light behaved or courtable—
Still on one failing tenderly to touch,
The Gentleman did like a drop too much,
(Tho' there are many such)
And took more Port than was exactly portable.
In fact,—to put the cap upon the nipple,
And try the charge,—Tom certainly *did* tipple.
He thought the motto was but sorry stuff
On Cribb's Prize Cup—Yes, wrong in ev'ry letter—
That "D——d be he who first cries *Hold Enough!*"
The more cups hold, and if enough, the better.
And so to set example in the eyes
Of Fancy's lads, and give a broadish hint to them,
All his cups were of such ample size
That he got into them.

Once in the company of merry mates,
In spite of Temperance's ifs and buts,
So sure as Eating is set off with *plates*,
His Drinking always was bound up with *cuts*!

Howbeit, such Bacchanalian revels
Bring very sad catastrophes about;
Palsy, Dyspepsy, Dropsy, and Blue Devils,
Not to forget the Gout.
Sometimes the liver takes a spleenful whim
To grow to Strasbourg's regulation size,
As if for those hepatical goose pies—
Or out of depth the head begins to swim—

Poor Simpson! what a thing occurred to him!
'Twas Christmas—he had drunk the night before,—
Like Baxter, who “so went beyond his last”—
One bottle more, and then *one* bottle more,
Till, oh! the red-wine *Ruby-con* was pass'd!
And homeward, by the short small chimes of day,
With many a circumbendibus to spare,
For instance, twice round Finsbury Square,
To use a fitting phrase, he *wound* his way.

Then comes the rising, with repentance bitter,
And all the nerves—(and sparrows)—in a twitter,
Till settled by the sober Chinese cup:
The hands, o'er all, are members that make motions,
A sort of wavering just like the ocean's,
Which has its swell, too, when it's getting up—
An awkward circumstance enough for elves

Who shave themselves;
And Simpson just was ready to go thro' it
When lo! the first short glimpse within the glass—
He jump'd—and who alive would fail to do it?—
To see, however it had come to pass,
One section of his face as green as grass!

In vain each eager wipe,
With soap—without—wet—hot or cold—or dry,
Still, still, and still, to his astonished eye
One cheek was green, the other cherry ripe!
Plump in the nearest chair he sat him down,
Quaking, and quite absorb'd in a deep study,—

But verdant and not brown,
What could have happened to a tint so ruddy?
Indeed it was a very novel case,
By way of penalty for being jolly,
To have that evergreen stuck in his face,
Just like the windows with their Christmas holly.

“All claret marks,”—thought he—Tom knew his forte—
“Are red—this colour CANNOT come from Port!”

THE RED — HIS COLOUR CANNOT COME FROM FEAR.

One thing was plain; with such a face as his,
'Twas quite impossible to ever greet
Good Mrs. Brown; nay, any party meet,
Altho' 'twas such a parti-coloured phiz!
As for the public, fancy Sarcy Ned,
The coachman, flying, dog-like, at his head,
With "Ax your pardon, Sir, but if you please—
Unless it comes too high—
Vere ought a fellow, now, to go to buy
The t'other half, Sir, of that 'ere green cheese?"
His mind recoil'd—so he tied up his head,
As with a raging tooth, and took to bed;
Of course with feelings far from the serene,
For all his future prospects seemed to be,
To match his customary tea,
Black mixt with green.

Meanwhile, good Mrs. Brown
Wondered at Mr. S. not coming down,
And sent the maid up-stairs to learn the why;
To whom poor Simpson, half delirious,
Returned an answer so mysterious
That curiosity began to fry;
The more, as Betty, who had caught a snatch
By peeping in upon the patient's bed,
Reported a most bloody, tied-up head,
Got over-night of course—"Harm watch, harm catch,"
From Watchmen in a boxing-match.

So, liberty or not,—
Good lodgers are too scarce to let them off in
A suicidal coffin—
The dame ran up as fast as she could trot;
"Appearance,—fiddlesticks!" should not deter
From going to the bed,
And looking at the head:
"La! Mister S——, he need not care for her!
A married woman that had had

A married woman that had had

Nine boys and gals, and none had turned out bad—
Her own dear late would come home late at night,
And liquor always got him in a fight,
She'd been in Hospitals—she wouldn't faint
At gores and gashes fingers wide and deep;
She knew what's good for bruises and what ain't—
Turlington's Drops she made a p'int to keep.
Cases she'd seen beneath the surgent's hand—
Such skulls jappann'd—she meant to say trepann'd!
Poor wretches! you would think they'd been in battle,
And hadn't hours to live,
From tearing horses' kicks or Smithfield cattle,
Shamefully over-driv!—
Heads forced to have a silver plate atop,
To get the brains to stop.
At imputations of the legs she'd been,
And neither screech'd nor cried—
Hereat she pluck'd the white cravat aside,
And lo! the whole phenomenon was seen—
“Preserve us all! He's going to gangrene!”

Alas! through Simpson's brain
Shot the remark, like ball, with mortal pain;
It tallied truly with his own misgiving,
And brought a groan,
To move a heart of stone—
A sort of farewell to the land of living!
And as the case was imminent and urgent,
He did not make a shadow of objection
To Mrs. B.'s proposal for a “surgent,”
But merely gave a sight of deep dejection,
While down the verdant cheek a tear of grief
Stole, like a dew-drop on a cabbage-leaf.

Swift flew the summons,—it was life or death!
And in as short a time as he could race it,
Came Doctor Puddicome as short of breath,
To try his Latin charms against *Hic Jacet*.

“Pshaw, you are not on a whaling voyage, where everything that offers is game.”—THE PILOT.

EN BLUFF was a whaler, and many a day
Had chased the huge fish about Baffin's old Bay,
But time brought a change his diversion to spoil,
And that was when Gas took the shine out of Oil.

He turn'd up his nose at the fumes of the Coke,
And swore the whole scheme was a bottle of smoke:
As to London he briefly delivered his mind,
"Sparma-city," said he—but the City declined.

So Ben cut his line in a sort of a huff,
As soon as his whales had brought profits enough,
And hard by the Docks settled down for his life,
But, true to his text, went to Wales for a wife.

A big one she was, without figure or waist,
More bulky than lovely, but that was his taste;
In fat she was lapp'd from her sole to her crown,
And, turn'd into oil, would have lighted a town.

But Ben like a Whaler was charm'd with the match,
And thought, very truly, his spouse a great catch;
A flesh-and-blood emblem of Plenty and Peace,
And would not have changed her for Helen of Greece.

For Greenland was green in his memory still;
He'd quitted his trade, but retain'd the good-will;
And often, when soften'd by bumbo and flip,
Would cry—till he blubber'd—about his old ship.

No craft like the Grampus could work through a floe,
What knots she could run, and what tons she could stow.
And then that rich smell he preferr'd to the rose,
By just nosing the whole without holding his nose!

Now Ben he resolved, one fine Saturday night,
A snug Arctic Circle of friends to invite,
Old Tars in the trade, who related old tales

Old tars in the trade, who related old tales,
And drank, and blew clouds that were “very like whales.”

Of course with their grog there was plenty of chat,
Of canting, and flinching, and cutting up fat;
And how Gun Harpoons into fashion had got,
And if they were meant for the Gun-whale or not?

At last they retired, and left Ben to his rest,
By fancies cetaceous, and drink, well possess’d,
When, lo! as he lay by his partner in bed,
He heard something blow through two holes in its head.

“A start!” mutter’d Ben, in the Grampus afloat,
And made but one jump from the deck to the boat!
“Huzza! pull away for the blubber and bone—
I look on that whale as already my own!”

Then groping about by the light of the moon,
He soon laid his hand on his trusty harpoon;
A moment he poised it, to send it more pat,
And then made a plunge to imbed it in fat!

“Starn all!” he sang out, “as you care for your lives—
Starn all, as you hope to return to your wives—
Stand by for the flurry! she throws up the foam!
Well done, my old iron, I’ve sent you right home!”

And scarce had he spoken, when lo! bolt upright
The Leviathan rose in a great sheet of white,
And swiftly advanced for a fathom or two,
As only a fish out of water could do.

“Starn all!” echoed Ben, with a movement aback,
But too slow to escape from the creature’s attack;
If flippers it had, they were furnish’d with nails,—
“You willin, I’ll teach you that Women an’t Whales!”

“Avast!” shouted Ben, with a sort of a screech,

“I’ve heard a Whale spouting, but *here* is a speech!”
“A-spouting, indeed!—very pretty,” said she;
“But it’s you I’ll blow up, not the froth of the sea!”

“To go to pretend to take *me* for a fish!
You great Polar Bear—but I know what you wish—
You’re sick of a wife, that your hankering baulks,—
You want to go back to some young Esquimax!”

“O dearest,” cried Ben, frighten’d out of his life,
“Don’t think I would go for to murder a wife
I must long have bewailed”—“But she only cried Stuff!
Don’t name it, you brute, you’ve *be-whaled* me enough!”

“Lord, Polly!” said Ben, “such a deed could I do?
I’d rather have murder’d all Wapping than you!
Come, forgive what is passed.” “O you monster!” she cried,
“It was none of your fault that it passed of one side!”

However, at last she inclined to forgive;
“But, Ben, take this warning as long as you live—
If the love of harpooning so strong must prevail,
Take a whale for a wife, not a wife for a whale.”

SALLY SIMPKIN'S LAMENT;

OR, JOHN JONES'S KIT-CAT-ASTROPHE.

"He left his body to the sea,
And made a shark his legatee."

BRYAN AND PERENNE.

“Oh! what is that comes gliding in,
And quite in middling haste?
It is the picture of my Jones,
And painted to the waist.

“It is not painted to the life,
For where’s the trowsers blue?
Oh Jones, my dear!—oh dear! my Jones,
What is become of you?”

“Oh! Sally dear, it is too true,—
The half that you remark
Is come to say my other half
Is bit off by a shark!

“Oh! Sally, sharks do things by halves,
Yet most completely do!
A bite in one place seems enough,
But I’ve been bit in two.

“You know I once was all your own,
But now a shark must share!
But let that pass—for now to you
I’m neither here nor there.

“Alas! death has a strange divorce
Effected in the sea,
It has divided me from you,
And even me from me!

“Don’t fear my ghost will walk o’ nights
To haunt, as people say;
My ghost *can’t* walk, for, oh! my legs
Are many leagues away!

“Lord! think, when I am swimming round,
And looking where the boat is,
A shark just snags away a *half*

A shark just snaps away a tail,
Without 'a *quarter*'s notice.'

"One half is here, the other half
Is near Columbia placed;
Oh! Sally, I have got the whole
Atlantic for my waist.

"But now, adieu—a long adieu!
I've solved death's awful riddle,
And would say more, but I am doomed
To break off in the middle!"

I'M GOING TO BOMBAY.

"Nothing venture, nothing have."—OLD PROVERB.

"Every Indiaman has at least two mates."—FALCONER'S
Marine Guide.

I.



Y hair is brown, my eyes are blue,
And reckon'd rather bright;
I'm shapely, if they tell me true,
And just the proper height;
My skin has been admired in verse,
And called as fair as day—
If I *am* fair, so much the worse,
I'm going to Bombay!

II.

At school I passed with some éclât;
I learned my French in France;
De Wint gave lessons how to draw,
And D'Egville how to dance;—
Crevelli taught me how to sing,
And Cramer how to play—
It really is the strangest thing—
I'm going to Bombay!

III.

I've been to Bath and Cheltenham Wells,
But not their springs to sip—
To Ramsgate—not to pick up shells,—
To Brighton—not to dip.
I've tour'd the Lakes, and scour'd the coast
From Scarboro' to Torquay—
But tho' of time I've made the most,
I'm going to Bombay!

IV.

By Pa and Ma I'm daily told
To marry now's my time,
For though I'm very far from old,
I'm rather in my prime.
They say while we have any sun,
We ought to make our hay—
And India has so hot an one,
I'm going to Bombay!

V.

My cousin writes from Hyderapot
My only chance to snatch,
And says the climate is so hot,
It's sure to light a match.—
She's married to a son of Mars,
With very handsome pay,
And swears I ought to thank my stars
I'm going to Bombay!

VI.

She says that I shall much delight
To taste their Indian treats,
But what she likes may turn me quite,
Their strange outlandish meats.—
If I can eat rupees, who knows?
Or dine, the Indian way,
On doolies and on bungalows—
I'm going to Bombay!

VII.

She says that I shall much enjoy,—
I don't know what she means,—
To take the air and buy some toy,
In my own palankeens,—
I like to drive my pony-chair,
Or ride our dapple gray—
But elephants are horses there—
I'm going to Bombay!

VIII.

Farewell, farewell, my parents dear,
My friends, farewell to them!
And oh, what costs a sadder tear,
Good-bye to Mr. M.!—
If I should find an Indian vault,
Or fall a tiger's prey,
Or steep in salt, it's all *his* fault,
I'm going to Bombay!

IX.

That fine new teak-built ship, the Fox
A. 1—Commander Bird,
Now lying in the London Docks,
Will sail on May the Third;
Apply for passage or for freight,
To Nichol, Scott, and Gray—
Pa has applied and seal'd my fate—
I'm going to Bombay!

X.

My heart is full—my trunks as well;
My mind and caps made up,
My corsets shap'd by Mrs. Bell,
Are promised ere I sup;
With boots and shoes, Rivarta's best,
And dresses by Ducé,
And a special license in my chest—
I'm going to Bombay!

JOHN JONES.

A PATHETIC BALLAD.

“I saw the iron enter into his soul.”—STERNE.



JOHN JONES he was a builder's clerk,
On ninety pounds a year,
Before his head was engine-turn'd
To be an engineer!

For, finding that the iron roads
Were quite the public tale,
Like Robin Redbreast, all his heart
Was set upon a rail.

But oh! his schemes all ended ill,
As schemes must come to nought,
With men who try to make short cuts,
When cut with something short.

His altitudes he did not take,
Like any other elf;
But first a spirit-level took,
That levelled him, himself.

Then getting up, from left to right
So many tacks he made,
The ground he meant to go upon
Got very well survey'd.

How crows may fly he did not care
A single fig to know;—
He wish'd to make an iron road,
And not an iron crow.

So, going to the Rose and Crown,
To cut his studies short,
The nearest way from *pint* to *pint*,
He found was through a quart.

According to this rule he plann'd
His railroad o'er a cup;
But when he came to lay it down

But when he came to lay it down,
No soul would take it up!

Alas! not his the wily arts
Of men as shrewd as rats,
Who out of one sole *level* make
A precious lot of *flats*!

In vain from Z to crooked S,
His devious line he show'd;
Directors even seemed to wish
For some directer road.

The writers of the public press
All sneered at his design;
And penny-a-liners wouldn't give
A penny for his line.



OVERTAKER AND UNDERTAKER.



THE BATH GUIDE.

Yet still he urged his darling scheme,
In spite of all the fates;
Until at last his zigzag ways
Quite brought him into *straits*.

His money gone, of course he sank
In debt from day to day,—
His way would not pay *him*—and so
He could not pay his way.

Said he, “All parties run me down—
How bitter is my cup!
My landlord is the only man
That ever runs me up!

“And he begins to talk of scores,
And will not draw a cork;”—
And then he rail’d at Fortune, since
He could not rail at York!

The morrow, in a fatal noose
They found him hanging fast;
This sentence scribbled on the wall,—
“I’ve got my line at last!”

Twelve men upon the body sate,
And thus, on oath, did say,
“We find he got his *gruel*, ‘cause
He couldn’t have his way!”

POMPEY'S GHOST.

A PATHETIC BALLAD.

"Skins may differ, but affection
Dwells in white and black the same."—COWPER.

'Twas twelve o'clock, not twelve at night,
But twelve o'clock at noon,
Because the sun was shining bright,
And not the silver moon:
A proper time for friends to call,
Or Pots, or Penny Post;
When, lo! as Phœbe sat at work,
She saw her Pompey's Ghost!

Now when a female has a call
From people that are dead,
Like Paris ladies, she receives
Her visitors in bed:
But Pompey's Spirit could not come
Like spirits that are white,
Because he was a Blackamoor,
And wouldn't show at night!

But of all unexpected things
That happen to us here,
The most unpleasant is a rise
In what is very dear:
So Phœbe scream'd an awful scream,
To prove the seaman's text,
That after black appearances,
White squalls will follow next.

"Oh, Phœbe dear! oh, Phœbe dear!
Don't go to scream or faint;
You think because I'm black I am
The Devil, but I ain't!
Behind the heels of Lady Lambe
I walk'd whilst I had breath;
But that is past, and I am now
A-walking after Death!

"No murder, though, I come to tell,

By base and bloody crime;
So, Phœbe dear, put off your fits
Till some more fitting time;
No Crowner, like a boatswain's mate,
My body need attack,
With his round dozen to find out
Why I have died so black.

“One Sunday, shortly after tea,
My skin began to burn,
As if I had in my inside
A heater, like the urn.
Delirious in the night I grew,
And as I lay in bed,
They say I gather'd all the wool
You see upon my head.

“His Lordship for his doctor sent,
My treatment to begin—
I wish that he had call'd him out,
Before he call'd him in!
For though to physic he was bred,
And pass'd at Surgeons' Hall,
To make his post a sinecure
He never cured at all!

“The doctor look'd about my breast,
And then about my back,
And then he shook his head and said,
'Your case looks very black.'
And first he sent me hot cayenne,
And then gamboge to swallow,—
But still my fever would not turn
To Scarlet or to Yellow!

“With madder and with turmeric
He made his next attack;
But neither he nor all his drugs

Could stop my dying black.
At last I got so sick of life,
And sick of being dosed,
One Monday morning I gave up
My physic and the ghost!

“Oh, Phœbe dear, what pain it was
To sever every tie!
You know black beetles feel as much
As giants when they die—
And if there is a bridal bed,
Or bride of little worth,
It’s lying in a bed of mould,
Along with Mother Earth.

“Alas! some happy, happy day
In church I hoped to stand,
And like a muff of sable skin
Receive your lily hand;
But sternly with that piebald match
My fate untimely clashes—
For now, like Pompe-double-i,
I’m sleeping in my ashes!

“And now farewell!—a last farewell!
I’m wanted down below,
And have but time enough to add
One word before I go,—
In mourning crape and bombazine
Ne’er spend your precious pelf—
Don’t go in black for me,—for I
Can do it for myself.

“Henceforth within my grave I rest,
But Death who there inherits,
Allow’d my spirit leave to come,
You seem’d so out of spirits;
But do not sigh, and do not cry,
Because I am not dead—”

By grief too much engross'd—
Nor, for a ghost of colour, turn
The colour of a ghost!

“Again farewell, my Phœbe dear!
Once more a last adieu!
For I must make myself as scarce
As swans of sable hue.”
From black to grey, from grey to nought,
The shape began to fade,
And, like an egg, though not so white,
The Ghost was newly laid!

TO MR. WRENCH AT THE ENGLISH OPERA HOUSE.[\[14\]](#)



Q H very pleasant Mr. Wrench,—
The first, upon the pit's first bench,
I've scrambled to my place,
To hail thee on these summer boards
With joy, even critic-craft affords,
And watch thy welcome face!

Ere thou art come, how I rejoice
To hear thy free and easy voice,
Lounging about the slips;
And then thy figure comes and owns
The voice as careless as the tones
That saunter from thy lips.

Oh come and cast a quiet glance,
To glad a nameless friend, askance
The lamps' ascending glare;
Better it is than bended knees,
Heart-squeezing, and profound congés—
That old familiar air.

Even in the street, in that apt face,
Full of gay gravity, I trace
The soul of native whim;
A constant, never-failing store
Of quiet mirth, that ne'er runs o'er,
But aye is near the brim.

Quoth I, "There goes a happy wight,
Inimical to spleen and spite,
And careless of all care;
Who oils the ruffled waves of strife,
And makes the work-day suit of life
Of very easy wear.

Lord! if he had some people's ills
To cope—their hungry bonds and bills,

How faintly they would tease;
Things that have cost both tears and sighs—
Their foes, as motelings in his eyes—
Their duns, his summer fleas!

The stage, I guess, is not thy school—
Thou dost not antic like the fool
That wept behind his mask;
Thy playing is thy play—a sport—
A revel, as perform'd at Court,
And not a trade—a task!

Gay *Freeman*, art thou hired for *him*?
No—'tis thy humour and thy whim
To be that easy guest;
Whereas whoever plays for pelf,
(Like Bennett) only gives *him*-self,
Or *her*—like Mrs. West!

Nay, thou—to look beyond the stage,
Thy life is but another page
Continued of the play;
The same companionable sprite—
Thy whim and pleasantry by night
Are with thee in the day!

LOVE, WITH A WITNESS.

E has shav'd off his whiskers and blacken'd his brows,
Wears a patch and a wig of false hair,—
But it's him—Oh it's him!—we exchanged lovers' vows,
When I lived up in Cavendish Square.

He had beautiful eyes, and his lips were the same,
And his voice was as soft as a flute—
Like a Lord or a Marquis he look'd when he came,
To make love in his master's best suit.

If I lived for a thousand long years from my birth,
I shall never forget what he told;
How he lov'd me beyond the rich women of earth,
With their jewels and silver and gold?

When he kiss'd me and bade me adieu with a sigh,
By the light of the sweetest of moons,
Oh how little I dreamt I was bidding good-bye
To my Missis's tea-pot and spoons!

LINES BY A SCHOOL-BOY.



WHEN I was first a scholar, I went to Dr. Monk,
And elephant-like I had, sir, a cake put in my trunk;
The Rev. Doctor Monk, sir, was very grave and prim,
He stood full six foot high, sir, and we all looked up to him.

They didn't pinch and starve us, as here they do at York,
For every boy was ask'd, sir, to bring a knife and fork.
And then I had a chum too, to fag and all of that,
I made him sum up my sums too, and eat up all my fat.

For goodness we had prizes, and birch for doing ill,
But none of the Birch that visits the bottom of Cornhill.
And we'd half a dozen ushers to teach us Latin and Greek,
And all we'd got in our heads, sir, was combed out once a week.

And then we had a shop, too, for lollipops and squibs,
Where I often had a lick, sir, at Buonaparty's ribs!
Oh! if I was at Clapham, at my old school again,
In the rod I could fancy honey, and sugar in the cane.

ADDRESS TO MARIA DARLINGTON

ON HER RETURN TO THE STAGE.

“It was Maria!—

And better fate did Maria deserve than to have her banns forbid—

She had, since that, she told me, strayed as far as Rome, and walked round
St. Peter’s once—and returned back—.”

See the whole story in Sterne and the newspapers.



THOU art come back again to the stage
Quite as blooming as when thou didst
leave it;

And 'tis well for this fortunate age
That thou didst not, by going off, grieve it!
It is pleasant to see thee again—
Right pleasant to see thee, by Herclé,
Unmolested by pea-colour'd Hayne!
And free from that thou-and-thee Berkeley!

Thy sweet foot, my Foote, is as light
(Not *my* Foote—I speak by correction)
As the snow on some mountain at night,
Or the snow that has long on thy neck shone.
The Pit is in raptures to free thee,
The Boxes impatient to greet thee,
The Galleries quite clam'rous to see thee,
And thy scenic relations to meet thee!

Ah, where was thy sacred retreat?
Maria! ah, where hast thou been,
With thy two little wandering Feet,
Far away from all peace and pea-green!
Far away from Fitzhardinge the bold,
Far away from himself and his lot!
I envy the place thou hast stroll'd,
If a stroller thou art—which thou'rt not!

Sterne met thee, poor wandering thing,
Methinks, at the close of the day—
When thy Billy had just slipp'd his string,
And thy little dog quite gone astray—
He bade thee to sorrow no more—
He wish'd thee to lull thy distress
In his bosom—he couldn't do more,
And a Christian could hardly do less!

Ah, me! for thy small plaintive pipe
I fear we must look at thine eye—
That eye—forced so often to wipe
That the handkerchief never got dry!
Oh sure 'tis a barbarous deed
To give pain to the feminine mind—
But the wooer that left thee to bleed
Was a creature more killing than kind!

The man that could tread on a worm
Is a brute—and inhuman to boot;
But he merits a much harsher term
That can wantonly tread on a Foote!
Soft mercy and gentleness blend
To make up a Quaker—but he
That spurn'd thee could scarce be a *Friend*,
Though he dealt in that Thou-ing of thee!

They that loved thee, Maria, have flown!
The friends of the midsummer hour!
But those friends now in anguish atone,
And mourn o'er thy desolate bow'r.
Friend Hayne, the Green Man, is quite out,
Yea, utterly out of his bias;
And the faithful Fitzhardinge, no doubt,
Is counting his Ave Marias!

Ah, where wast thou driven away
To feast on thy desolate woe?
We have witness'd thy weeping in play,
But none saw the earnest tears flow—
Perchance thou wert truly forlorn,—
Though none but the fairies could mark
Where they hung upon some Berkeley thorn,
Or the thistle in Burderop Park!

Ah, perhaps, when old age's white snow
Has silver'd the crown of Hayne's nob—
—

For even the greenest will grow
As hoary as “White-headed Bob—”
He’ll wish, in the days of his prime,
He had been rather kinder to one
He hath left to the malice of Time—
A woman—so weak and undone!

ODE TO R. W. ELLISTON, ESQ.,

THE GREAT LESSEE!

“Rover. Do you know, you villain, that I am this moment the greatest man living?”—WILD OATS.



H! Great Lessee! Great Manager! Great Man!
Oh, Lord High Elliston! Immortal Pan
Of all the pipes that play in Drury Lane!
Macready's master! Westminster's high *Dane*
(As Galway Martin, in the House's walls,
Hamlet and Doctor Ireland justly calls)
Friend to the sweet and ever-smiling Spring!
Magician of the lamp and prompter's ring!
Drury's Aladdin! Whipper-in of actors!
Kicker of rebel preface-malefactors!
Glass-blowers' corrector! King of the cheque-taker!
At once Great Leamington and Winston-Maker!
Dramatic Bolter of plain Bunns and cakes!
In silken *hose* the most reform'd of *Rakes*!
Oh, Lord High Elliston! lend me an ear!
(Poole is away, and Williams shall keep clear)
While I, in little slips of prose, not verse,
Thy splendid course, as pattern-work, rehearse!

Bright was thy youth—thy manhood brighter still—
The greatest Romeo upon Holburn Hill—
Lightest comedian of the pleasant day,
When Jordan threw her sunshine o'er a play!
But these, though happy, were but subject-times,
And no man cares for bottom-steps, that climbs—
Far from my wish it is to stifle down
The hours that saw thee snatch the Surrey crown!
Though now thy hand a mightier sceptre wields,
Fair was thy reign in sweet St. George's Fields.
Dibdin was *Premier*—and a *Golden Age*
For a short time enrich'd the subject stage.
Thou hadst, than other Kings, more peace-and-plenty;
Ours but one Bench could boast, but thou hadst twenty;
But the times changed—and Booth-acting no more
Drew Rulers' shillings to the gallery door.
Thou didst, with bag and baggage, wander thence,
Repentant, like thy neighbour Magdalens!

Next, the Olympic Games were tried, each feat
Practised the most bewitching in Wych Street.
Charles had his royal ribaldry restored,
And in a downright neighbourhood drank and whored;
Rochester there in dirty ways again
Revell'd—and lived once more in Drury Lane:
But thou, R. W., kept thy moral ways,
Pit-lecturing 'twixt the farces and the plays,
A lamplight Irving to the butcher-boys
That soil'd the benches and that made a noise:—
“YOU,—in the back!—can scarcely hear a line!
Down from those benches—butchers—they are MINE!”

Lastly—and thou wert built for it by nature!—
Crown'd was thy head in Drury Lane Theâtre!
Gentle George Robins saw that it was good,
And renters cluck'd around thee in a brood.
King thou wert made of Drury and of Kean!
Of many a lady and of many a Queen!
With Poole and Larpent was thy reign begun—
But now thou turnest from the Dead and Dun,
Hook's in thine eye, to write thy plays, no doubt,
And Colman lives to cut the damnlets out!

Oh, worthy of the house! the King's commission!
Isn't thy condition “a most bless'd condition?”
Thou reignest over Winston, Kean, and all
The very lofty and the very small—
Showest the plumbless Bunn the way to kick—
Keepest a Williams for thy veriest stick—
Seest a Vestris in her sweetest moments,
Without the danger of newspaper comments—
Tellest Macready, as none dared before,
Thine open mind from the half-open door!—
(Alas! I fear he has left Melpomene's crown,
To be a Boniface in Buxton town!)—
Thou holdst the watch. as half-price people know.

And callest to them, to a moment,—“Go!”
Teachest the sapient Sapio how to sing—
Hangest a cat most oddly by the wing—”
Hast known the length of a Cubitt-foot—and kiss’d
The pearly whiteness of a Stephen’s wrist—
Kissing and pitying—tender and humane!
“By heaven she loves me! Oh, it is too plain!”
A sigh like this thy trembling passion slips,
Dimpling the warm Madeira at thy lips!

Go on, Lessee! Go on, and prosper well!
Fear not, though forty glass-blowers should rebel—
Show them how thou hast long befriended them,
And teach Dubois *their* treason to condemn!
Go on! addressing pits in prose—and worse!
Be long, be slow, be anything but terse—
Kiss to the gallery the hand that’s gloved—
Make Bunn the Great, and Winston the Beloved,
Go on—and but in this reverse the thing,
Walk backward with wax lights before the King—
Go on! Spring ever in thine eye! Go on!
Hope’s favourite child! ethereal Elliston!

SHOOTING PAINS.

“The charge is prepared.”—MACHEATH.

 I shoot any more I'll be shot,
For ill-luck seems determined to star me,
I have march'd the whole day
With a gun—for no pay—
Zounds, I'd better have been in the army!

What matters Sir Christopher's leave?
To his manor I'm sorry I came yet!
With confidence fraught,
My two pointers I brought,
But we are not a point towards game yet!

And that gamekeeper too, with advice!
Of my course he has been a nice chalker,
Not far, were his words,
I could go without birds:
If my legs could cry out, they'd cry "Walker!"

Not Hawker could find out a flaw,—
My appointments are modern and Mantony,
And I've brought my own man,
To mark down all he can,
But I can't find a mark for my Antony!

The partridges,—where can they lie?
I have promised a leash to Miss Jervas,
As the least I could do;
But without even two
To brace me,—I'm getting quite nervous!

To the pheasants—how well they're preserved!
My sport's not a jot more beholden,
As the birds are so shy,
For my friends I must buy;—
And so send "silver pheasants and golden."

I have tried ev'ry form for a hare,
Every patch, every furze that could breed her

Every patch, every tuze that could shroud her,
 With toil unrelax'd,
 Till my patience is tax'd,
But I cannot be taxed for hare-powder.

I've been roaming for hours in three flats
In the hope of a snipe for a snap at;
 But still vainly I court
 The percussioning sport,
I find nothing for "setting my cap at!"

A woodcock,—this month is the time,—
Right and left I've made ready my lock for,
 With well-loaded double,
 But spite of my trouble,
Neither barrel can I find a cock for!

A rabbit I should not despise,
But they lurk in their burrows so lowly;
 This day's the eleventh,
 It is not the seventh,
But they seem to be keeping it hole-y.

For a mallard I've waded the marsh,
And haunted each pool, and each lake—oh!
 Mine is not the luck,
 To obtain thee, O Duck,
Or to doom thee, O Drake, like a Draco!

For a field-fare I've fared far a-field,
Large or small I am never to sack bird,
 Not a thrush is so kind
 As to fly, and I find
I may whistle myself for a blackbird!

I am angry, I'm hungry, I'm dry,
Disappointed, and sullen, and goaded,
 And so weary an elf,
 I am sick of myself,

And with Number One seem overloaded.

As well one might beat round St. Paul's,
And look out for a cock or a hen there;
I have search'd round and round
All the Baronet's ground,
But Sir Christopher hasn't a wren there!

Joyce may talk of his excellent caps,
But for nightcaps they set me desiring,
And it's really too bad,
Not a shot I have had
With Hall's Powder, renown'd for "quick firing."

If this is what people call sport,
Oh! of sporting I can't have a high sense,
And there still remains one
More mischance on my gun—
"Fined for shooting without any license."

THE DUEL.

A SERIOUS BALLAD.

“Like the two Kings of Brentford smelling at one nosegay.”

N Brentford town, of old renown,
There lived a Mister Bray,
Who fell in love with Lucy Bell,
And so did Mr. Clay.

To see her ride from Hammersmith,
By all it was allow'd,
Such fair outsides are seldom seen,
Such Angels on a Cloud.

Said Mr. Bray to Mr. Clay,
“You choose to rival me,
And court Miss Bell, but there your court
No thoroughfare shall be.

“Unless you now give up your suit,
You may repent your love;
I who have shot a pigeon match,
Can shoot a turtle dove.

“So pray before you woo her more,
Consider what you do;
If you pop aught to Lucy Bell,—
I’ll pop it into you.”

Said Mr. Clay to Mr. Bray,
“Your threats I quite explode;
One who has been a volunteer
Knows how to prime and load.

“And so I say to you unless
Your passion quiet keeps,
I who have shot and hit bulls’ eyes,
May chance to hit a sheep’s.”

Now gold is oft for silver changed,
And that for copper red;
But these two went away to give

But these two went away to give
Each other change for lead.

But first they sought a friend a-piece,
This pleasant thought to give—
When they were dead, they thus should have
Two seconds still to live.

To measure out the ground not long
The seconds then forbore,
And having taken one rash step
They took a dozen more.

They next prepared each pistol-pan
Against the deadly strife,
By putting in the prime of death
Against the prime of life.

Now all was ready for the foes,
But when they took their stands,
Fear made them tremble so they found
They both were shaking hands.

Said Mr. C. to Mr. B.,
“Here one of us may fall,
And like St. Paul’s Cathedral now,
Be doom’d to have a ball.

“I do confess I did attach
Misconduct to your name;
If I withdraw the charge, will then
Your ramrod do the same?”

Said Mr. B., “I do agree—
But think of Honour’s Courts!
If we go off without a shot,
There will be strange reports.

“But look, the morning now is bright,

Though cloudy it begun;
Why can't we aim above, as if
We had call'd out the sun?"

So up into the harmless air,
Their bullets they did send;
And may all other duels have
That upshot in the end!

DOG-GREL VERSES, BY A POOR BLIND.

“Hark! hark! the dogs do bark,
The beggars are coming...” —OLD BALLAD.



What shall I do for a dog?
Of sight I have not got a particle,
Globe, Standard, or Sun,
Times, Chronicle—none
Can give *me* a good leading article.

A Mastiff once led me about,
But people appeared so to fear him—
I might have got pence
Without his defence,
But Charity would not come near him.

A Blood-hound was not much amiss,
But instinct at last got the upper;
And tracking Bill Soames,
And thieves to their homes,
I never could get home to supper.

A Fox-hound once served me as guide,
A good one at hill and at valley;
But day after day
He led me astray,
To follow a milk-woman's tally.

A turnspit once did me good turns
At going and crossing, and stopping;
Till one day his breed
Went off at full speed,
To spit at a great fire in Wapping.

A Pointer once pointed my way,
But did not turn out quite so pleasant,
Each hour I'd a stop
At a Poulterer's shop
To point at a very high pheasant.

A Pug did not suit me at all,
The feature unluckily rose up.

The feature unluckily rose up,
 And folks took offence
 When offering pence,
Because of his turning his nose up.

A Butcher once gave me a dog,
 That turn'd out the worst one of any;
 A Bull dog's own pup,
 I got a toss up,
Before he had brought me a penny.

My next was a Westminster Dog,
 From Aistrop the regular cadger;
 But, sightless, I saw
 He never would draw
A blind man so well as a badger.

A greyhound I got by a swop,
 But, Lord! we soon came to divorces:
 He treated my strip
 Of cord like a slip,
And left me to go my own courses.

A poodle once tow'd me along,
 But always we came to one harbour,
 To keep his curls smart,
 And shave his hind part,
He constantly call'd on a barber.

My next was a Newfoundland brute,
 As big as a calf fit for slaughter;
 But my old cataract
 So truly he back'd
I always fell into the water.

I once had a sheep-dog for guide,
 His worth did not value a button;
 I found it no go,
 A Smithfield Ducrow,

To stand on four saddles of mutton.

My next was an Esquimaux dog,
A dog that my bones ache to talk on,
For picking his ways
On cold frosty days
He pick'd out the slides for a walk on.

Bijou was a lady-like dog,
But vex'd me at night not a little,
When tea-time was come
She would not go home,
Her tail had once trail'd a tin kettle.

I once had a sort of a Shock,
And kiss'd a street post like a brother,
And lost every tooth
In learning this truth—
One blind cannot well lead another.

A terrier was far from a trump,
He had one defect, and a thorough,
I never could stir,
'Od rabbit the cur!
Without going into the Borough.

My next was Dalmatian, the dog!
And led me in danger, oh crikey!
By chasing horse heels,
Between carriage wheels,
Till I came upon boards that were spiky.

The next that I had was from Cross,
And once was a favourite spaniel
With Nero,^[15] now dead,
And so I was led
Right up to his den like a Daniel.

A mongrel I tried, and he did,
As far as the profit and lossing,
Except that the kind
Endangers the blind,
The breed is so fond of a crossing.

A setter was quite to my taste,
In alleys or streets broad or narrow,
Till one day I met
A very dead set,
At a very dead horse in a barrow.

I once had a dog that went mad,
And sorry I was that I got him;
I came to a run,
And a man with a gun
Pepper'd *me* when he ought to have shot him.

My profits have gone to the dogs,
My trade has been such a deceiver,
I fear that my aim
Is a mere losing game,
Unless I can find a Retriever.

“UP THE RHINE.”



HY, Tourist, why
With Passports have to
do?
Pr'ythee stay at home and pass
The Port and Sherry too.

Why, Tourist, why
Embark for Rotterdam?
Pr'ythee stay at home and take
Thy Hollands in a dram.

Why, Tourist, why
To foreign climes repair?
Pr'ythee take thy German Flute,
And breathe a German air.

Why, Tourist, why
The Seven Mountains view?
Any one at home can tint
A hill with Prussian Blue.

Why, Tourist, why
To old Colonia's walls?
Sure, to see a *Wrenish* Dome,
One needn't leave St. Paul's.

THE COMET.

AN ASTRONOMICAL ANECDOTE.

“I cannot fill up a blank better than with a short history of this self-same *Starling*.”—STERNE’S
SENTIMENTAL JOURNEY.



AMONGST professors of astronomy,
Adepts in the celestial economy,
The name of H*****I's very often cited;
And justly so, for he is hand and glove
With ev'ry bright intelligence above;
Indeed, it was his custom so to stop,
That once upon a time he got be-knighted
In his observatory thus coquetting
With Venus—or with Juno gone astray,
All sublunary matters quite forgetting
In his flirtations with the winking stars,
Acting the spy—it might be upon Mars—
A new André;
Or, like a Tom of Coventry, sly peeping,
At Dian sleeping:
Or ogling thro' his glass
Some heavenly lass
Tripping with pails along the Milky Way;
Or Looking at that Wain of Charles the Martyr's:—
Thus he was sitting, watchman of the sky,
When lo! a something with a tail of flame
Made him exclaim,
“My stars!”—he always puts that stress on *my*—
“My stars and garters!”

“A comet, sure as I'm alive!
A noble one as I should wish to view;
It can't be Halley's though, *that* is not due
Till eighteen thirty-five.
Magnificent!—how fine his fiery trail!
Zounds! 'tis a pity, though he comes unsought—
Unask'd—unreckon'd,—in no human thought—
He ought—he ought—he ought
To have been caught
With scientific salt upon his tail!”

“I look'd no more for it, I do declare,

Than the Great Bear!
As sure as Tycho Brahe is dead,
It really enter'd in my head
No more than Berenice's Hair!"

Thus musing, Heaven's Grand Inquisitor
Sat gazing on the uninvited visitor
Till John, the serving-man, came to the upper
Regions, with "Please your Honour, come to supper."

"Supper! good John, to-night I shall not sup
Except on that phenomenon—look up!"
"Not sup!" cried John, thinking with consternation
That supping on a *star* must be *starvation*,
Or ev'n to batten

On Ignes Fatui would never fatten.
His visage seem'd to say, "that very odd is,"
But still his master the same tune ran on,
"I can't come down,—go to the parlour, John,
And say I'm supping with the heavenly bodies."

"The heavenly bodies!" echoed John, "Ahem!"
His mind still full of famishing alarms,
" 'Zooks, if your Honour sups with *them*,
In helping, somebody must make long arms!"
He thought his master's stomach was in danger,
But still in the same tone replied the Knight,
"Go down, John, go, I have no appetite,
Say I'm engaged with a celestial stranger."—
Quoth John, not much au fait in such affairs,
"Wouldn't the stranger take a bit down stairs?"

"No," said the master, smiling and no wonder,
At such a blunder,
"The stranger is not quite the thing you think,
He wants no meat or drink,
And one may doubt quite reasonably whether
He has a mouth,
Seeing his head and tail are join'd together,

Behold him,—there he is, John, in the South.”

John look’d up with his portentous eyes,
Each rolling like a marble in its socket.
At last the fiery tad-pole spies,
And, full of Vauxhall reminiscences, cries,
“A rare good rocket!”

“A what! A rocket, John! Far from it!
What you behold, John, is a comet,
One of those most eccentric things
That in all ages
Have puzzled sages
And frighten’d kings;
With fear of change that flaming meteor, John,
Perplexes sovereigns, throughout its range”—
“Do he?” cried John;
“Well, let him flare on,
I haven’t got no sovereigns to change!”

MORE HULLAH-BALOO.

“Loud as from numbers without number.”—MILTON.

“You may do it extempore, for it’s nothing but roaring.”—QUINCE.



AMONGST the great inventions of this age,
Which every other century surpasses,
Is one,—just now the rage,—
 Called “Singing for all Classes —
That is, for all the British millions,
 And billions,
 And quadrillions,
 Not to name *Quintilians*,
That now, alas! have no more ear than asses,
 To learn to warble like the birds in June,
 In time and tune,
Correct as clocks, and musical as glasses!

 In fact, a sort of plan,
Including gentleman as well as yokel,
 Public or private man,
To call out a Militia,—only Vocal
 Instead of Local,
And not designed for military follies,
 But keeping still within the civil border,
 To form with mouths in open order,
 And sing in volleys.

Whether this grand harmonic scheme
Will ever get beyond a dream,
 And tend to British happiness and glory,
 Maybe no, and maybe yes,
 Is more than I pretend to guess—
However, here’s my story.

In one of those small, quiet streets,
 Where business retreats,
To shun the daily bustle and the noise
 The shoppy Strand enjoys,
But Law, Joint-Companies, and Life Assurance
 Find past endurance—
In one of those back streets, to Peace so dear,

The other day, a ragged wight
Began to sing with all his might,
“*I have a silent sorrow here!*”

The place was lonely; not a creature stirred
Except some little dingy bird;
Or vagrant cur that sniffed along,
Indifferent to the Son of Song;
No truant errand-boy, or Doctor’s lad,
No idle filch or lounging cad,
No Pots encumbered with diurnal beer,
No printer’s devil with an author’s proof,
Or housemaid on an errand far aloof,
Lingered the tattered Melodist to hear—
Who yet, confound him! bawled as loud
As if he had to charm a London crowd,
Singing beside the public way,
Accompanied—instead of violin,
Flute, or piano, chiming in—
By rumbling cab, and omnibus, and dray,
A van with iron bars to play *staccato*,
Or engine *obligato*—
In short, without one instrument vehicular
(Not even a truck, to be particular),
There stood the rogue and roared,
Unasked and unencored,
Enough to split the organs called auricular!

Heard in that quiet place,
Devoted to a still and studious race,
The noise was quite appalling!
To seek a fitting simile and spin it,
Appropriate to his calling,
His voice had all Lablache’s *body* in it;
But oh! the scientific tone it lacked,
And was, in fact,
Only a forty-boatswain-power of bawling!

'Twas said, indeed, for want of vocal *nous*,
The stage had banished him when he attempted it,
For tho' his voice completely filled the house,
It also emptied it.
However, there he stood
Vociferous—a ragged don!
And with his iron pipes laid on
A row to all the neighbourhood.

In vain were sashes closed
And doors against the persevering Stentor,
Though brick, and glass, and solid oak opposed,
Th' intruding voice would enter,
Heedless of ceremonial or decorum,
Den, office, parlour, study, and sanctorum;
Where clients and attorneys, rogues, and fools,
Ladies, and masters who attended schools,
Clerks, agents, all provided with their tools,
Were sitting upon sofas, chairs, and stools,
With shelves, pianos, tables, desks, before 'em—
How it did bore 'em!

Louder, and louder still,
The fellow sang with horrible goodwill,
Curses both loud and deep his sole gratuities,
From scribes bewildered making many a flaw
In deeds of law
They had to draw;
With dreadful incongruities
In posting ledgers, making up accounts
To large amounts,
Or casting up annuities—
Stunned by that voice, so loud and hoarse,
Against whose overwhelming force
No in-voice stood a chance, of course!

The Actuary pshawed and pished,
And knit his calculating brows, and wished

The singer “a bad life”—a mental murther!
The Clerk, resentful of a blot and blunder
 Wished the musician further,
 Poles distant—and no wonder!
For Law and Harmony tend far asunder—
The Lady could not keep her temper calm,
Because the sinner did not sing a psalm—
The Fiddler in the very same position
 As Hogarth’s chafed musician
(Such prints require but cursory reminders)
Came and made faces at the wretch beneath,
And wishing for his foe between his teeth,
 (Like all impatient elves
 That spite themselves)
Ground his own grinders.

But still with unrelenting note,
 Though not a copper came of it, in verity,
The horrid fellow with the ragged coat,
 And iron throat,
Heedless of present honour and prosperity,
Sang like a Poet singing for posterity,
 In penniless reliance—
And, sure, the most immortal Man of Rhyme
 Never set Time
 More thoroughly at defiance!

From room to room, from floor to floor,
From Number One to Twenty-four
The Nuisance bellowed, till all patience lost,
 Down came Miss Frost,
Expostulating at her open door—
 “Peace, monster, peace!
 Where is the New Police!
I vow I cannot work, or read, or pray,
 Don’t stand there bawling, fellow, don’t!
You really send my serious thoughts astray,
Do—there’s a dear good man—do go away.”

Says he, "I won't!"

The spinster pulled her door to with a slam,
That sounded like a wooden d—n,
For so some moral people, strictly loth
To swear in words, however up,
Will crash a curse in setting down a cup,
Or through a doorpost vent a banging oath—
In fact, this sort of physical transgression
Is really no more difficult to trace
Than in a given face
A very bad expression.

However, in she went,
Leaving the subject of her discontent
To Mr. Jones's Clerk at Number Ten;
Who, throwing up the sash,
With accents rash,
Thus hailed the most vociferous of men:
"Come, come, I say, old feller, stop your chant!
I cannot write a sentence—no one can't!
So just pack up your trumps,
And stir your stumps—"
Says he, "I shan't!"

Down went the sash
As if devoted to "eternal smash,"
(Another illustration
Of acted imprecation),
While close at hand, uncomfortably near,
The independent voice, so loud and strong,
And clanging like a gong,
Roared out again the everlasting song,
"I have a silent sorrow here!"

The thing was hard to stand!
The Music-master could not stand it—
But rushing forth with fiddle-stick in hand

As savage as a bandit,
Made up directly to the tattered man,
And thus in broken sentences began—
But playing first a prelude of grimace,
Twisting his features to the strangest shapes,
So that to guess his subject from his face,
He meant to give a lecture upon apes—

“Com—com—I say!
You go away!
Into two parts my head you split—
My fiddle cannot hear himself a bit,
When I do play—
You have no bis’ness in a place so still!
Can you not come another day?”
Says he—“I will.”

“No—no—you scream and bawl!
You must not come at all!
You have no rights, by rights, to beg—
You have not one off-leg—
You ought to work—you have not some complaint—
You are not cripple in your back or bones—
Your voice is strong enough to break some stones”—
Says he—“It ain’t!”

“I say you ought to labour!
You are in a young case,
You have not sixty years upon your face,
To come and beg your neighbour,
And discompose his music with a noise
More worse than twenty boys—
Look what a street it is for quiet!
No cart to make a riot,
No coach, no horses, no postilion,
If you will sing, I say, it is not just,
To sing so loud.”—Says he, “I MUST!
I’m singing for the million!”

— —

THERE'S NO ROMANCE IN THAT.



DAYS of old, O days of Knights,
Of tourneys and of tilts,
When love was balk'd and valour stalk'd
On high heroic stilts—
Where are ye gone?—adventures cease,
The world gets tame and flat,—
We've nothing now but New Police—
There's no Romance in that!

I wish I ne'er had learn'd to read,
Or Radcliffe how to write!
That Scott had been a boor on Tweed,
And Lewis cloister'd quite!
Would I had never drunk so deep
Of dear Miss Porter's vat;
I only turn to life, and weep—
There's no Romance in that!

No Bandits lurk—no turban'd Turk
To Tunis bears me off—
I hear no noises in the night
Except my mother's cough,—
No Bleeding Spectre haunts the house,
No shape,—but owl or bat,
Come flitting after moth or mouse,—
There's no Romance in that!

I have not any grief profound,
Or secrets to confess,
My story would not fetch a pound
For A. K. Newman's press;
Instead of looking thin and pale,
I'm growing red and fat,
As if I lived on beef and ale—
There's no Romance in that!

It's very hard, by land or sea

Some strange event I court,
But nothing ever comes to me
That's worth a pen's report:
It really made my temper chafe,
Each coast that I was at,
I vow'd, and rail'd, and came home safe,—
There's no Romance in that!

The only time I had a chance
At Brighton one fine day,
My chestnut mare began to prance,
Took fright, and ran away;
Alas! no Captain of the Tenth
To stop my steed came pat;
A Butcher caught the rein at length,—
There's no Romance in that!

Love—even love—goes smoothly on
A railway sort of track—
No flinty sire, no jealous Don!
No hearts upon the rack;
No Polydore, no Theodore—
His ugly name is Mat,
Plain Matthew Pratt and nothing more—
There's no Romance in that!

He is not dark, he is not tall,
His forehead's rather low,
He is not pensive—not at all,
But smiles his teeth to show;
He comes from Wales and yet in size
Is really but a sprat;
With sandy hair and greyish eyes—
There's no Romance in that!

He wears no plumes or Spanish cloaks,
Or long sword hanging down;
He dresses much like other folks,
.

And commonly in brown;
His collar he will not discard,
Or give up his cravat,
Lord Byron-like—he's not a Bard—
There's no Romance in that!

He's rather bald, his sight is weak,
He's deaf in either drum;
Without a lisp he cannot speak,
But then—he's worth a plum.
He talks of stocks and three per cents.
By way of private chat,
Of Spanish Bonds, and shares, and rents,—
There's no Romance in that!

I sing—no matter what I sing,
Di Tanti—or Crudel,
Tom Bowling, or God save the King,
Di piacer—All's Well;
He knows no more about a voice
For singing than a gnat—
And as to Music “has no choice,”
There's no Romance in that!

Of light guitar I cannot boast,
He never serenades;
He writes, and sends it by the post,
He doesn't bribe the maids:
No stealth, no hempen ladder—no!
He comes with loud rat-tat,
That startles half of Bedford Row—
There's no Romance in that!

He comes at nine in time to choose
His coffee—just two cups,
And talks with Pa about the news,
Repeats debates, and sups.
John helps him with his coat aright,
And then—

And Jenkins nands his nat;
My lover bows, and says good-night—
There's no Romance in that!

I've long had Pa's and Ma's consent,
My aunt she quite approves,
My Brother wishes joy from Kent,
None try to thwart our loves;
On Tuesday reverend Mr. Mace
Will make me Mrs. Pratt,
Of Number Twenty, Sussex Place—
There's no Romance in that!

THE PAINTER PUZZLED.

“Draw, Sir!”—*Old Play*.



ELL, something must be done for May,
The time is drawing nigh,
To figure in the catalogue
And woo the public eye.

Something I must invent and paint;
But, oh! my wit is not
Like one of those kind substantives
The answer Who and What?

Oh, for some happy hit! to throw
The gazer in a trance;
But *posé là*—there I am posed,
As people say in France.

In vain I sit and strive to think,
I find my head, alack!
Painfully empty, still, just like
A bottle “on the rack.”

In vain I task my barren brain
Some new idea to catch,
And tease my hair—ideas are shy
Of “coming to the scratch.”

In vain I stare upon the air,
No mental visions dawn;
A blank my canvas still remains,
And worse—a blank undrawn:

An “aching void” that mars my rest
With one eternal hint,
For, like the little goblin page,
It still keeps crying “Tint!”

But what to tint? ay, there’s the rub,
That plagues me all the while,
As ~~Salkirk-like~~ I sit without

AS, SCURRY-ING, I SIT WITHOUT
A subject for my *i'le*.

“Invention’s seventh heaven” the bard
Has written—but my case
Persuades me that the creature dwells
In quite another place.

Sniffing the lamp, the ancients thought,
Demosthenes *must* toil;
But works of art are works indeed,
And always “smell of oil.”

Yet painting pictures some folks think,
Is merely play and fun;
That what is on an easel set
Must easily be done.

But, zounds! if they could sit in this
Uneasy easy-chair,
They’d very soon be glad enough
To cut the camel’s hair.

Oh! who can tell the pang it is
To sit as I this day—
With all my canvas spread, and yet
Without an inch of way.

Till, mad at last to find I am
Amongst such empty skullers,
I feel that I could strike myself,
But no—I’ll “strike my colours.”

A TRUE STORY.



O'F all our pains, since man was curst,
I mean of body, not the mental,
To name the worst, among the worst,
The dental sure is transcendental;
Some bit of masticating bone,
That ought to help to clear a shelf,
But let its proper work alone,
And only seems to gnaw itself;
In fact, of any grave attack
On victual there is little danger,
'Tis so like coming to the *rack*,
As well as going to the manger.

Old Hunks—it seemed a fit retort
Of justice on his grinding ways—
Possessed a grinder of the sort,
That troubled all his latter days.
The best of friends fall out, and so
His teeth had done some years ago,
Save some old stumps with ragged root,
And they took turn about to shoot;
If he drank any chilly liquor,
They made it quite a point to throb;
But if he warmed it on the hob,
Why then they only twitched the quicker.

One tooth—I wonder such a tooth
Had never killed him in his youth—
One tooth he had with many fangs,
That shot at once as many pangs,
It had an universal sting;
One touch of that ecstatic stump
Could jerk his limbs, and make him jump,
Just like a puppet on a string;
And what was worse than all, it had
A way of making others bad.
There is, as many know, a knack,

With certain farming undertakers,
And this same tooth pursued their track,
By adding *achers* still to *achers*!

One way there is, that has been judged
A certain cure, but Hunks was loth
To pay the fee, and quite begrudged
To lose his tooth and money both;
In fact, a dentist and the wheel
Of Fortune are a kindred cast,
For after all is drawn, you feel
It's paying for a blank at last;
So Hunks went on from week to week,
And kept his torment in his cheek.
Oh! how it sometimes set him rocking,
With that perpetual gnaw—gnaw—gnaw,
His moans and groans were truly shocking
And loud,—altho' he held his jaw.
Many a tug he gave his gum,
And tooth, but still it would not come;
Tho' tied by string to some firm thing,
He could not draw it, do his best,
By draw'rs, although he tried a chest.

At last, but after much debating,
He joined a score of mouths in waiting,
Like his, to have their troubles out.
Sad sight it was to look about
At twenty faces making faces,
With many a rampant trick and antic,
For all were very horrid cases,
And made their owners nearly frantic.
A little wicket now and then
Took one of these unhappy men,
And out again the victim rushed,
While eyes and mouth together gushed;
At last arrived our hero's turn,
Who plunged his hands in both his pockets.

And down he sat, prepared to learn
How teeth are charmed to quit their sockets.

Those who have felt such operations,
Alone can guess the sort of ache,
When his old tooth began to break
The thread of old associations;
It touched a string in every part,
It had so many tender ties;
One chord seemed wrenching at his heart,
And two were tugging at his eyes;
“Bone of his bone,” he felt of course,
As husbands do in such divorce;
At last the fangs gave way a little
Hunks gave his head a backward jerk,
And to! the cause of all this work,
Went—where it used to send his victual!

The monstrous pain of this proceeding
Had not so numbed his miser wit,
But in this slip he saw a hit
To save, at least, his purse from bleeding;
So when the dentist sought his fees,
Quoth Hunks, “Let’s finish, if you please.”
“How, finish! why it’s out!”—“Oh! no—
I’m none of your before-hand tippers,
'Tis you are out, to argue so;
My tooth is in my head no doubt,
But as you say you pulled it out,
Of course it’s there—between your nippers.”
“Zounds! sir, d’ye think I’d sell the truth
To get a fee? no, wretch, I scorn it.”
But Hunks still asked to see the tooth,
And swore by gum! he had not drawn it.

His end obtained, he took his leave,
A secret chuckle in his sleeve;
The ioke was worthv to produce one.

~~The joke was worthy to please one,~~
To think, by favour of his wit,
How well a dentist had been bit
By one old stump, and that a loose one!
The thing was worth a laugh, but mirth
Is still the frailest thing on earth:
Alas! how often when a joke
Seems in our sleeve, and safe enough,
There comes some unexpected stroke,
And hangs a weeper on the cuff!

Hunks had not whistled half a mile,
When, planted right against the stile,
There stood his foeman, Mike Maloney,
A vagrant reaper, Irish-born,
That helped to reap our miser's corn,
But had not helped to reap his money,
A fact that Hunks remembered quickly;
His whistle all at once was quelled,
And when he saw how Michael held
His sickle, he felt rather sickly.

Nine souls in ten, with half his fright,
Would soon have paid the bill at sight,
But misers (let observers watch it)
Will never part with their delight
Till well demanded by a hatchet—
They live hard—and they die to match it.
Thus Hunks, prepared for Mike's attacking,
Resolved not yet to pay the debt,
But let him take it out in hacking;
However, Mike began to stickle
In word before he used the sickle;
But mercy was not long attendant:
From words at last he took to blows,
And aimed a cut at Hunks's nose;
That made it what some folks are not—
A Member very independent.

Heaven knows how far this cruel trick
Might still have led, but for a tramper
That came in danger's very nick,
To put Maloney to the scamper.
But still compassion met a damper;
There lay the severed nose, alas!
Beside the daisies on the grass,
"Wee, crimson-tipt" as well as they,
According to the poet's lay:
And there stood Hunks, no sight for laughter!
Away ran Hodge to get assistance,
With nose in hand, which Hunks ran after,
But somewhat at unusual distance.
In many a little country place
It is a very common case
To have but one residing doctor,
Whose practice rather seems to be
No practice, but a rule of three,
Physician—surgeon—drug-decocter;
Thus Hunks was forced to go once more
Where he had ta'en his tooth before.
His mere name made the learn'd man hot—
"What! Hunks again within my door!
I'll pull his nose;" quoth Hunks, "you cannot."

The doctor looked and saw the case
Plain as the nose *not* on his face.
"O! hum—ha—yes—I understand."
But then arose a long demur,
For not a finger would he stir
Till he was paid his fee in hand;
That matter settled, there they were,
With Hunks well strapped upon his chair.

The opening of a surgeon's job—
His tools, a chestful or a drawful—
Are always something very awful,
And give the heart the strangest throb.

And give me heart the strangest mood,
But never patient in his funks
Looked half so like a ghost as Hunks,
Or surgeon half so like a devil
Prepared for some infernal revel:
His huge black eye kept rolling, rolling,
Just like a bolus in a box:
His fury seemed above controlling,
He bellowed like a hunted ox:
“Now, swindling wretch, I’ll show thee how
We treat such cheating knaves as thou;
Oh! sweet is this revenge to sup;
I have thee by the nose—it’s now
My turn—and I will turn it up.”

Guess how the miser liked the scurvy
And cruel way of venting passion;
The snubbing folks in this new fashion
Seemed quite to turn him topsy turvy;
He uttered prayers, and groans, and curses,
For things had often gone amiss
And wrong with him before, but this
Would be the worst of all *reverses*!
In fancy he beheld his snout
Turned upward like a pitcher’s spout;
There was another grievance yet,
And fancy did not fail to show it,
That he must throw a *summerset*,
Or stand upon his head to blow it.

And was there then no argument
To change the doctor’s vile intent,
And move his pity?—yes, in truth,
And that was—paying for the tooth.
“Zounds! pay for such a stump! I’d rather—”
But here the menace went no farther,
For with his other ways of pinching,
Hunks had a miser’s love of snuff,

A recollection strong enough
To cause a very serious flinching;
In short he paid and had the feature
Replaced as it was meant by nature;
For tho' by this 'twas cold to handle,
(No corpse's could have felt more horrid,)
And white just like an end of candle,
The doctor deemed and proved it too,
That noses from the nose will do
As well as noses from the forehead;
So, fixed by dint of rag and lint,
The part was bandaged up and muffled.
The chair unfastened, Hunks arose,
And shuffled out, for once unshuffled;
And as he went, these words he snuffled—
“Well, this is ‘paying thro’ the nose.’ ”

THE LOGICIANS.

AN ILLUSTRATION.

“Metaphysics were a large field in which to exercise the weapons logic had put into their hands
—“—SCRIBLERUS.



SEE here two cavillers,
Would-be unravellers
Of abstruse theory and questions mystical
In tête-à-tête,
And deep debate,
Wrangling according to form syllogistical.

Glowing and ruddy
The light streams in upon their deep brown study,
And settles on our bald logician's skull:
But still his meditative eye looks dull
And muddy,
For he is gazing inwardly, like Plato;
But to the world without
And things about,
His eye is blind as that of a potato:
In fact, logicians
See but by syllogisms—taste and smell
By propositions;
And never let the common dray-horse senses
Draw inferences.
How wise his brow! how eloquent his nose!
The feature of itself is a negation!
How gravely double is his chin, that shows
Double deliberation;
His scornful lip forestalls the confutation!
O this is he that wisely with a major
And minor proves a greengage is no gauger!—
By help of ergo,
That cheese of sage will make no mite the sager,
And Taurus is no bull to toss up Virgo!
O this is he that logically tore his
Dog into dogmas—following Aristotle—
Cut up his cap into ten categories,
And cork'd an abstract conjuror in a bottle!
O this is he that disembodied matter,
And proved that incorporeal corporations

Put nothing in no platter,
And for mock turtle only supp'd sensations!
O this is he that palpably decided,
With grave and mathematical precision
How often atoms may be subdivided
By long division;
O this is he that show'd I is not I,
And made a ghost of personal identity;
Proved "Ipse" absent by an alibi,
And frisking in some other person's entity;
He sounded all philosophies in truth,
Whether old schemes or only supplemental;—
And had, by virtue of his wisdom-tooth,
A dental knowledge of the transcendental!

The other is a shrewd severer wight,
Sharp argument hath worn him nigh the bone:
For why? he never let dispute alone,
A logical knight-errant,
That wrangled ever—morning, noon, and night,
From night to morn; he had no wife apparent
But Barbara Celárent!
Woe unto him he caught in a dilemma,
For on the point of his two fingers full
He took the luckless wight, and gave with them a
Most deadly toss, like any baited bull.
Woe unto him that ever dared to breathe
A sophism in his angry ear! for *that*
He took ferociously between his teeth,
And shook it—like a terrier with a rat!—
In fact old Controversy ne'er begat
One half so cruel
And dangerous as he, in verbal duel!
No one had ever so complete a fame
As a debater;
And for art logical his name was greater
Than Dr. Watts's name!—

Look how they sit together!
Two bitter desperate antagonists,
Licking each other with their tongues, like fists,
Merely to settle whether
This world of ours had ever a beginning—
Whether created,
Vaguely undated,
Or time had any finger in its spinning:
When, lo!—for they are sitting at the basement—
A hand, like that upon Belshazzar's wall,
Lest fall
A written paper through the open casement.

“O foolish wits! (thus runs the document)
To twist your brains into a double knot
On such a barren question! Be content
That there is such a fair and pleasant spot
For your enjoyment as this verdant earth.
Go eat and drink, and give your hearts to mirth,
For vainly ye contend;
Before you can decide about its birth,
The world will have an end!”

LITTLE O'P.—AN AFRICAN FACT.



T was July the First, and the great hill of Howth
Was bearing by compass sow-west and by south,
And the name of the ship was the Peggy of Cork,
Well freighted with bacon and butter and pork.
Now, this ship had a captain, Macmorris by name,
And little O'Patrick was mate of the same;
For Bristol they sailed, but by nautical scope,
They contrived to be lost by the Cape of Good Hope.
Of all the Cork boys that the vessel could boast,
Only little O'P. made a swim to the coast;
And when he revived from a sort of a trance,
He saw a big Black with a very long lance.
Says the savage, says he, in some Hottentot tongue,
"Bash Kuku my gimmel bo gumborry bung!"
Then blew a long shell, to the fright of our elf,
And down came a hundred as black as himself.
They brought with them *guattul*, and pieces of *klam*,
The first was like beef, and the second like lamb;
"Don't I know," said O'P., "what the wretches are at?
They're intending to eat me as soon as I'm fat!"
In terror of coming to pan, spit, or pot,
His rations of *jarbul* he suffered to rot;
He would not touch *purry* or *doolberry-lik*,
But kept himself *growing* as thin as a stick.
Though broiling the climate, and parching with drouth,
He would not let *chobbery* enter his mouth,
But kicked down the *krug* shell, tho' sweetened with *natt*,—
"I an't to be pisoned the likes of a rat!"
At last the great *Joddry* got quite in a rage,
And cried, "O mi pitticum dambally nage!
The *chobbery* take, and put back on the shelf,
Or give me the *krug* shell, I'll drink it myself!
The *doolberry-lik* is the best to be had,
And the *purry* (I chewed it myself) is not bad;
The *jarbul* is fresh, for I saw it cut out,
And the *Bok* that it came from is grazing about.
Mv *iimho*! hut run off to Billerv Nang

my jumbo! but ran on to Billery Nang,
And tell her to put on her *jigger* and *tang*,
And go with the *Bloss* to the man of the sea,
And say that she comes as his *Wulwul* from me.”
Now Billery Nang was as Black as a sweep,
With thick curly hair like the wool of a sheep,
And the moment he spied her, said little O’P.,
“Sure the Divil is dead, and his Widow’s at me!”
But when, in the blaze of her Hottentot charms,
She came to accept him for life in her arms,
And stretched her thick lips to a broad grin of love,
A Raven preparing to bill like a Dove,
With a soul full of dread he declined the grim bliss,
Stopped her Molyneux arms, and eluded her kiss;
At last, fairly foiled, she gave up the attack,
And *Joddry* began to look blacker than black;
“By Mumbo! by Jumbo!—why here is a man,
That won’t be made happy, do all that I can;
He will not be married, lodged, clad, and well fed,
Let the *Rham* take his *shangwang* and chop off his head!”

THE ASSISTANT DRAPERS' PETITION.

ITY the sorrows of a class of men,
Who, though they bow to fashion and frivolity;
No fancied claims or woes fictitious pen,
But wrongs ell-wide, and of a lasting quality.

Oppress'd and discontented with our lot,
Amongst the clamorous we take our station
A host of Ribbon Men—yet is there not
One piece of Irish in our agitation.

We do revere Her Majesty the Queen;
We venerate our Glorious Constitution:
We joy King William's advent should have been,
And only want a Counter Resolution.

Tis not Lord Russell and his final measure,
'Tis not Lord Melbourne's counsel to the throne,
Tis not this Bill, or that, gives us displeasure,
The measures we dislike are all our own.

The Cash Law the "Great Western" loves to name,
The tone our foreign policy pervading;
The Corn Laws—none of these we care to blame,
Our evils we refer to over-trading.

By Tax or Tithe our murmurs are not drawn;
We reverence the Church—but hang the cloth!
We love her ministers—but curse the lawn!
We have, alas! too much to do with both!

We love the sex:—to serve them is a bliss!
We trust they find us civil, never surly;
All that we hope of female friends is this,
That their last linen may be wanted early.

Ah! who can tell the miseries of men
That serve the very cheapest shops in town?
~~Till faint and weary they leave off at ten~~

in pain and weary, they leave off at ten,
Knock'd up by ladies beating of 'em down!

But has not Hamlet his opinion given—
O Hamlet had a heart for Drapers' servants!
“That custom is”—say custom after seven—
“More honour'd in the breach than the observance.”

O come then, gentle ladies, come in time,
O'erwhelm our counters, and unload our shelves;
Torment us all until the seventh chime,
But let us have the remnant to ourselves!

We wish of knowledge to lay in a stock,
And not remain in ignorance incurable;—
To study Shakespeare, Milton, Dryden, Locke,
And other fabrics that have proved so durable.

We long for thoughts of intellectual kind,
And not to go bewilder'd to our beds;
With stuff and fustian taking up the mind,
And pins and needles running in our heads!

For oh! the brain gets very dull and dry,
Selling from morn till night for cash or credit;
Or with a vacant face and vacant eye,
Watching cheap prints that Knight did never edit.

Till sick with toil, and lassitude extreme,
We often think when we are dull and vapoury,
The bliss of Paradise was so supreme,
Because that Adam did not deal in drapery.

SYMPTOMS OF OSSIFICATION.

“An indifference to tears, and blood, and human suffering, that could only belong to a *Boney-parte*.—*Life of Napoleon*.



TIME was, I always had a drop
For any tale of sigh or sorrow;
My handkerchief I used to sop
Till often I was forced to borrow;
I don't know how it is, but now
My eyelids seldom want a-drying;
The doctor, p'rhaps, could tell me how—
I fear my heart is ossifying!

O'er Goethe how I used to weep,
With turnip cheeks and nose of scarlet,
When Werter put himself to sleep
With pistols kiss'd and clean'd by Charlotte;
Self-murder is an awful sin,
No joke there is in bullets flying,
But now at such a tale I grin—
I fear my heart is ossifying!

The Drama once could shake and thrill
My nerves, and set my tears a-stealing,
The Siddons then could turn at will
Each plug upon the main of feeling;
At Belvidera now I smile,
And laugh while Mrs. Haller's crying;
'Tis odd, so great a change of style—
I fear my heart is ossifying!

That heart was such—some years ago,
To see a beggar quite would shock it,
And in his hat I used to throw
The quarter's savings of my pocket:
I never wish—as I did *then*!—
The means from my own purse supplying,
To turn them all to gentlemen—
I fear my heart is ossifying!

We've had some serious things of late,

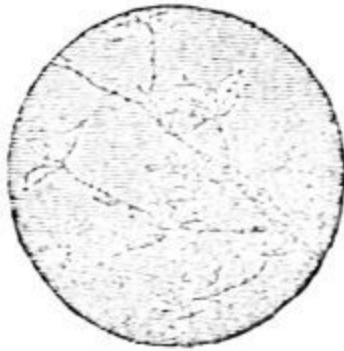
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FOOTNOTES:

[1] Tarantula.

[2] The name of a well-known lion at that time in the Zoological Gardens.

[3] A word caught from some American Trader in passing.

[4] See the story of Sidi Nonman, in the “Arabian Nights.”

[5] Captain Kater, the moon’s surveyor.

[6] The doctor’s composition for a *night-cap*.

[7] “Since this poem was written, Doctor Ireland and those in authority under him have reduced the fares. It is gratifying to the English people to know that while butcher’s meat is rising tombs are falling.”—*Note in Third Edition.*

[8] The daughter of William Harvey, the artist.

[9] Solomon Eagle.

[10] The late favourite of the King’s Theatre, who left the *pas seul* of life, for a perpetual *Ball*. Is not that her effigy now commonly borne about by the Italian image vendors—an ethereal form holding a wreath with both hands above her head—and her husband, in emblem, beneath her foot?

[11] Geysers:—the boiling springs in Iceland.

[12] Query, *purly*?—Printer’s Devil.

[13] This word is omitted in the later edition.

[14] The Adelphi.

[15] The name of the lion in the Zoological Gardens.

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